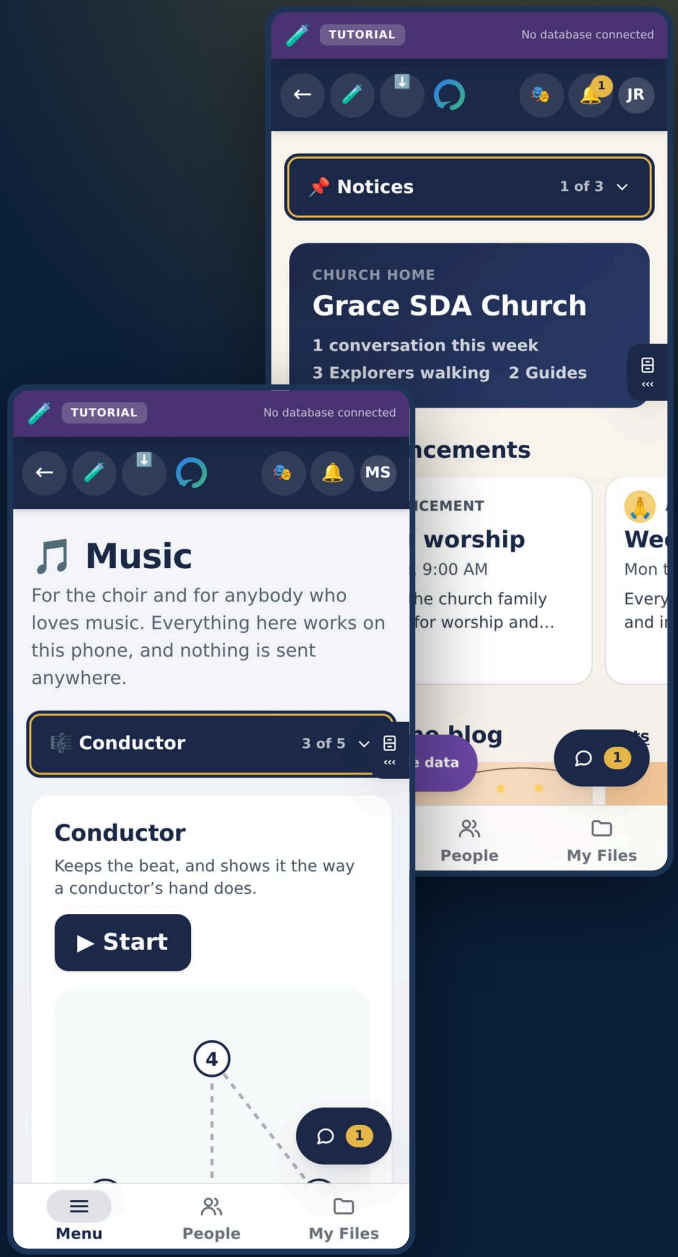
THE COMPLETE GUIDE

Using Hope Beacon

Every room, every folder and every role, explained in plain words and shown on a phone and a computer.

- Explorers, Guides, Directors and Executive Directors
- The church office, and whoever helps people get started
- Anybody deciding whether their church should use it



BEFORE YOU BEGIN

About this guide

This is the complete guide to **using** Hope Beacon: every room, every folder and every role, in plain words, with a picture of each screen on a phone and on a computer.

Its companion, *Building Hope Beacon*, is for the people who set the app up, host it and change it. You do not need it to use the app.

Who it is for

If you are…	Start with	Then
An Explorer, somebody the church is walking with	*Getting it on your phone*, then *If you are an Explorer*	*The Study Room* and *The Music room*
A Guide, walking with Explorers	*If you are a Guide*	*Running it, week to week*, and your own screens in *Every screen, in pictures*
A Director or **Executive Director**	*The four roles* and *Onboarding a church*	*If you are a Director*, then all of Part IV
The church office, or whoever helps people get started	*Getting started* (Part II)	*If something looks wrong* and *Questions people ask*
Deciding whether your church should use it	*Hope Beacon in one look*	*What it costs*, *Your information* and *Showing it to a church*

Nobody needs to read it all. Every chapter stands on its own, and the **Contents** page numbers are clickable.

How it is laid out

- **Part I, Welcome.** What the app is and the idea behind it.
- **Part II, Getting started.** Installing it, signing in, finding your way, and making it comfortable to read.
- **Part III, A tour, role by role.** The app as each person meets it.
- **Part IV, Running it, week to week.** The detail behind every task.
- **Part V, Every screen, in pictures.** An atlas of the whole app, role by role, a phone beside a computer.
- **Part VI, Help and reference.** When something looks wrong, common questions, your information, cost, a glossary and what changed.

What the pictures show

Every picture is the real app, photographed on the day this edition was built. None of it is drawn or mocked up.

The people in the pictures are the **sample church**: John Reyes (an Explorer), Maria Santos (a Guide), Pastor Ramos (a Director) and Bishop Alonzo (an Executive Director). They are invented. The sample church runs inside the browser with no database at all, which is why a purple bar along the top says *Tutorial* and *No database connected*. **No real member of any church appears anywhere in this guide.**

Your church's own app looks the same, without that bar, and with your own people in it.

GOOD TO KNOW

You can open the sample church yourself

When the app has no database behind it, its front door opens the sample church: press **Choose someone to be** and pick who to be. In Settings, the **Help** folder has **Start a tutorial**, a guided walk through your own part of the app. Nothing you do in either reaches a real person, so they are the safest way to practise anything in this guide before doing it for real.

The words used for what you see

- A **room** is one of the places listed in the **Menu**: Home, Music, the Office, and so on.
- A **folder** is one part of a room. The button at the top of a room says which folder you are in, such as *My Guide, 1 of 4*. Tap it to see the rest.
- **Bold words** are what is written on the screen, so you can look for them: **Write a post**, **Apply**, **Listen for the A**.
- *The four roles* have a chapter of their own, and every other word the app uses is in the **Glossary** near the end.

The notes in coloured boxes mean:

NOTE

Something worth knowing, but not a step.

GOOD TO KNOW

A shortcut, or a way to make something easier.

IMPORTANT

Read this before you do the step it is next to.

> **CAUTION**
>
> This cannot be undone, or it affects somebody else.

This edition

This edition was built from the app's own documents on the date on its cover. The guide is generated from the same writing the project keeps on GitHub, and the pictures are retaken each time, so a new edition always shows the app as it is. If something here no longer matches what you see, the app has moved on: tell the people who look after your church's copy, or use **Send feedback** in the app.

Hope Beacon is open source, under the GNU Affero General Public License, version 3. A church may run its own copy, change it, and share it, on the terms of that licence.

Contents

I	**Welcome**	**6**
1	Hope Beacon in one look	7
2	What the app is	12
3	The four roles	15
4	The journey	17
5	Onboarding a church	19
II	**Getting started**	**25**
6	Getting it on your phone	26
7	Your phone, getting around, and the looks	44
8	Settings, looks and reading comfort	69
9	Which platforms this runs on	80
III	**A tour, role by role**	**83**
10	If you are an Explorer	84
11	How to use the Study Room	93
12	If you are a Guide	99
13	If you are a Director	115
14	The guided walk	117
IV	**Running it, week to week**	**118**
15	People: inviting, pairing and looking after accounts	119
16	Conversations, meetings, the library, prayer and writing	125
17	Rooms, folders and the Office	142
18	Cases, safeguarding, the audit and the numbers	160
19	The Music room, in full	164
20	Reports, trials and the record	177
V	**Every screen, in pictures**	**183**
21	Explorer screens	184
22	Guide screens	196
23	Director screens	209
24	Executive Director screens	226
25	On a tablet, and before signing in	243

VI Help and reference 255

26 If something looks wrong 256

27 When something breaks 257

28 Questions people ask 262

29 Your information, and how it is protected 267

30 What it costs 271

31 Showing it to a church 272

32 Live presentation runbook 285

33 Glossary 287

34 What changed, release by release 290

35 What is not finished yet 305

PART I

Welcome

What Hope Beacon is, who it is for, and the idea it is built around: one person walking with another.

1 Hope Beacon in one look 7

2 What the app is 12

3 The four roles 15

4 The journey 17

5 Onboarding a church 19

CHAPTER 1

Hope Beacon in one look

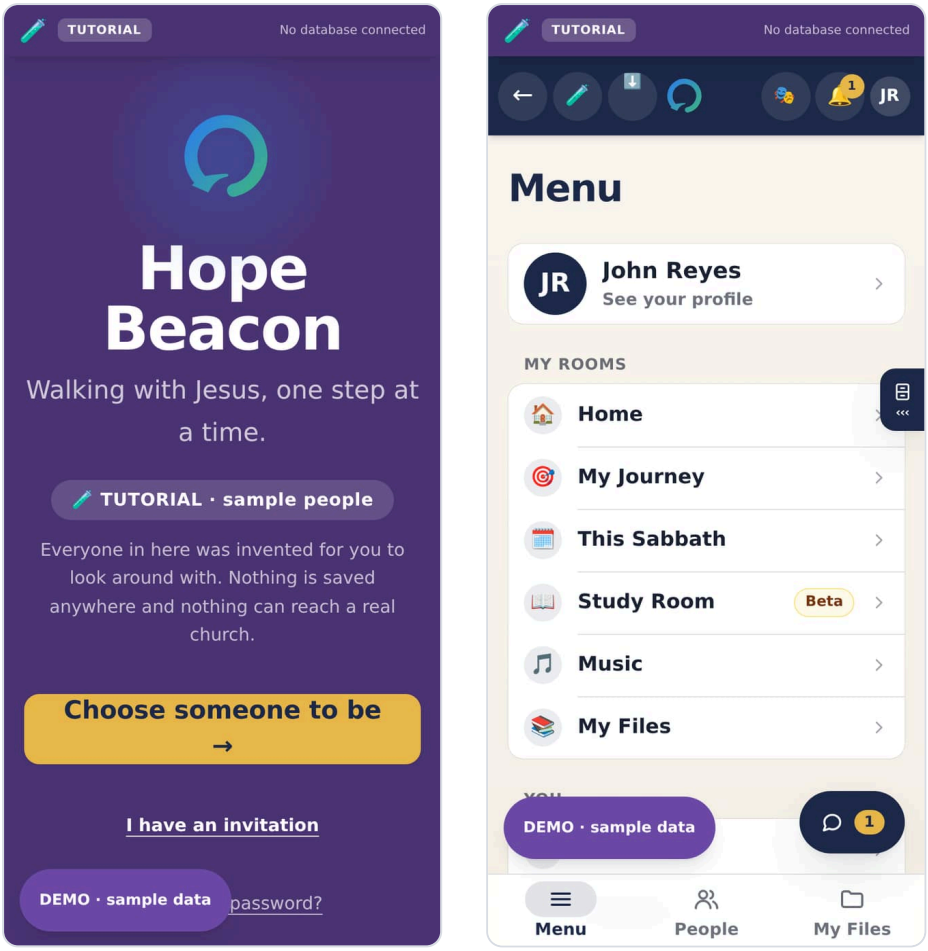
From `docs/guides/using/01-in-one-look.md`

IN THIS CHAPTER

What it is, and what it is not 8
The four roles, at a glance 8
The rooms each role has 9
Three words along the bottom 9
Rooms and folders 10
Where your information lives 10
Working with no signal 11
Where to go next 11

Hope Beacon is a private app for a church to walk with people one at a time. Somebody who is exploring faith is paired with one person from the church, a **Guide**, and the app is built around that one relationship: a private conversation, the lessons the Guide sends, prayer in both directions, and nothing that turns a person into a number on somebody else's screen.

Around that relationship sits what a church needs to run it: inviting people, pairing them, the Sabbath program, evangelistic meetings, a church home with notices and a blog, a music room for the choir, and the numbers a leader needs without any of the private detail.



The front door, and the Menu an Explorer sees once signed in.

What it is, and what it is not

It is	It is not
Invitation only. Nobody can sign up on their own; the church invites them.	A public social network. There is no profile anybody outside can find.
One Guide per Explorer. A conversation belongs to the two people in it.	A group chat. Leaders cannot read conversations, except the part somebody reports.
A website that installs like an app, on any phone or computer, with no app store.	Something to buy or download from a store.
Your church's own copy, with its own database and its own people.	A service run by somebody else who holds your members' details.
Open source. Anybody may read how it works, and a church may change it.	Finished. The last chapters say plainly what is still being built.

The four roles, at a glance

Everybody in the app has one role. It is chosen by the church when they are let in, and **nobody can change their own role**: that rule is kept by the database itself, not just by the screens.

Role	Who they are	What they mainly do
Explorer	Somebody the church is walking with	Talks with their Guide, reads what they send, asks for prayer
Guide	A church member walking with a few Explorers	Talks, sends lessons, records each step, plans the Sabbath
Director	Runs the church's account	Invites, approves, pairs Explorers with Guides, reads safeguarding reports
Executive Director	Oversees one or more churches	Everything a Director does, across every church they oversee

The chapter *The four roles* says exactly what each can and cannot see.

The rooms each role has

The **Menu** lists every room a person has. These are the rooms in a church's own app; the sample church also has a **Mail** room for everybody, to show what the app would send.

Room	Explorer	Guide	Director	Executive Director
Home: notices, blog, prayer wall	✓	✓	✓	✓
My Journey: my Guide, study, church, prayer	✓			
My Explorers: the people I walk with		✓		
Admin: approvals, pairing, safeguarding			✓	✓
Office: numbers, lessons, Sabbath program, meetings, reports		✓	✓	✓
This Sabbath: the program the church has shared	✓	✓	✓	✓
Study Room: my own notes while I read	✓			
Music: player, tuner, conductor, pieces	✓	✓	✓	✓
My Files: my own files on this device	✓	✓	✓	✓
Admin Reports: reports and the record			✓	✓
Profile and **Settings**	✓	✓	✓	✓
Mail: invitations still open			✓	✓

A Guide or an Explorer who is part of a report reaches it through **Settings**, so it is never out of reach for the person it concerns.

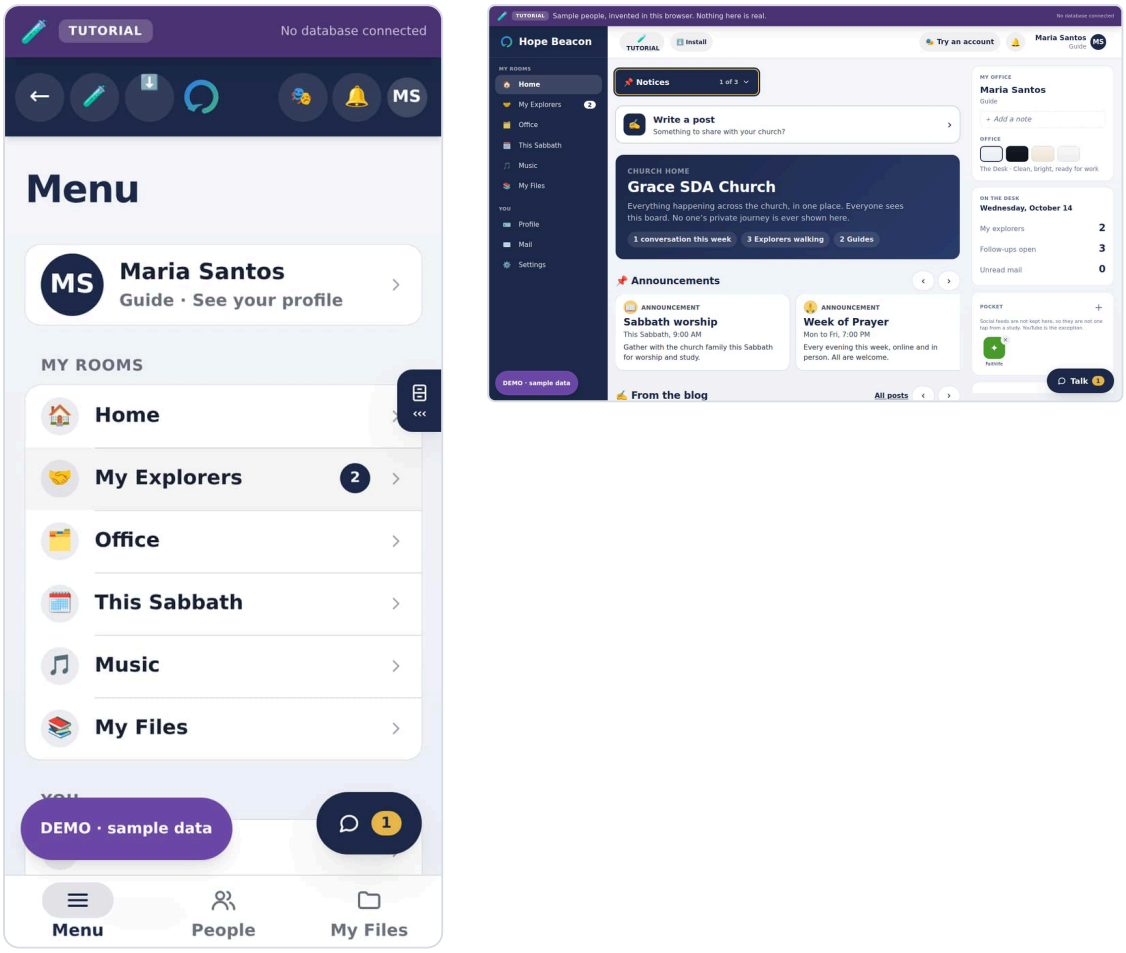
Three words along the bottom

On a phone and a tablet, three words sit along the bottom of every screen:

- **Menu**: every room you have, written out.
- **People**: the people you walk with. For an Explorer, that is their Guide.

- **My Files**: your own files, on this device.

On a computer the rooms run down the left-hand side instead, and the same three words are not needed. The round **Talk** button in the corner is your conversation, on every screen and every device, with a number on it when somebody has written.



A Guide's Menu on a phone, and the same Guide's Home on a computer, with the rooms down the left.

Rooms and folders

Most rooms hold a few **folders**. The button at the top of the room names the folder you are in and how many there are, such as *My Guide, 1 of 4*. Tap it, and the list of folders opens; tap one to go there. The app remembers the last folder you used in each room, so it opens where you left it.

Nothing in the app is a long page to scroll looking for something. If you cannot find a button, it is almost always in another folder of the same room.

Where your information lives

- **Conversations, lessons, prayer, the church's notices and accounts** are kept in your church's own database, behind rules that decide who may read each row. The chapter *Your information, and how it is protected* says what is kept and for how long.

- **My Files, the Music room and your settings** are kept on the device you are holding. They are never uploaded, and they are there with no signal.
- **The Study Room** keeps an Explorer's pages in the church's database, under rules that let only that Explorer read them: not their Guide, not a Director, not the person who set up the app.
- **The Sabbath program and evangelistic meetings** are kept on the device as you type, so they work with no signal, and in a church's own app they also follow you to every device where you sign in.

Working with no signal

Hope Beacon keeps working in a church hall with no signal. The rooms you have opened before open again, This Sabbath shows the last program you saw, your music plays, and anything you write waits on the phone and goes up by itself when the signal returns. The app updates itself the same way: quietly, the next time it starts, with nothing to press.

Where to go next

- **New to the app?** *Getting it on your phone*, in Part II.
- **An Explorer?** *If you are an Explorer*, in Part III.
- **A Guide?** *If you are a Guide*, in Part III.
- **A Director?** *The four roles* and *Onboarding a church*, then *If you are a Director* and all of Part IV.
- **Looking for one screen?** Part V shows every one of them.

CHAPTER 2

What the app is

From `docs/HANDBOOK.md`

IN THIS CHAPTER

It is invitation only 12
A conversation belongs to two people 12
A message can be corrected, or taken back 13
A reply, a reaction, a voice message 14
Nobody can flood a room 14
The limit is people, not computers 14

Hope Beacon is a discipleship app for one church. A member of that church walks alongside one other person at a time, and the app carries what that takes: the conversation, the readings, the prayer requests, and a quiet record of how far along the journey somebody has come.

Three things define it, and every decision in the rest of this handbook comes back to one of them.

It is invitation only

There is no public sign-up and there never will be. Somebody at the church enters a name and an email address, the app sends an invitation, and that is the only door. A stranger who finds the web address sees a sign-in screen and a tutorial, and nothing else.

A conversation belongs to two people

What an Explorer says to their Guide is readable by those two and no other account in the app. Not other Guides, not Directors. It is encrypted on its way and where it is stored, but not end to end: whoever runs the church's database could reach it there, outside the app, which is why the privacy manual limits who that is. The only exception is a safeguarding report, which a Director may read in place, and the app says so plainly on the screen where a report is made.

A conversation, in the sample church. The line at the top says who can read it: the two people walking together, and nobody else.

A message can be corrected, or taken back

You can edit or delete your own messages, and only your own. An edited one is marked **edited**, because the other person read the first version and a silent rewrite is a way to make somebody doubt what they remember. A deleted one leaves a line saying **"You deleted a message"** or **"Maria deleted a message"** — never a gap, because a message that vanishes without trace reads as one that was never sent, and the other person is left believing they imagined it.

Deleting removes the words from the conversation, not from the record. What the message said is kept where neither of you can read it, and a Director sees it only when a safeguarding report is being looked at. This is the same rule as the Guild Room, where a reported post's words are copied into the report before anybody can remove them: the first thing somebody does after being reported is delete. Take back a message you regret and it is gone from the screen; it is not gone from the account of what happened.

CAUTION

Until 9 September 2026, either person could rewrite the other's words

The rule that lets a recipient mark a message as read was written in a way that also permitted editing the whole message, including one you did not write, with nothing shown on screen. Nobody appears to have used it. It is closed, and the conversation is now the one thing in this app that only its author can change.

A reply, a reaction, a voice message

Since 1 October 2026 a conversation does what the messaging apps people already use do. **Reply** to one message so the answer carries a quote of it, **react** with one of six (praying first, because "I'm praying for you" is the reaction a Guide and an Explorer reach for most), and **speak** a voice message of up to two minutes. Part 4, *The conversation*, says how. The same rule covers all three: they belong to the two people in the conversation and nobody else.

All three need the database update that came with them (migration `20261001120000`). On a database without it the conversation is exactly what it was, the words, the photos and the live refresh, and the three are simply not offered. Part 9 says why that matters.

Nobody can flood a room

One account can send forty messages a minute and no more, across the conversation, the Guild wall and the Guides' room. That is two a second held for a full minute, which nobody types; it is set to stop a script rather than a person, and somebody who somehow reaches it is told plainly to wait a moment rather than shown an error code.

Files and reactions have their own ceilings. Ten files a minute into a conversation, because forty ten-megabyte photos a minute is not a limit, it is a storage bill. Thirty reaction changes a minute, because a reaction is one tap and every change wakes the other person's screen.

It bounds the machine, not the behaviour. Forty unkind messages a minute is still forty unkind messages, and the answer to that is the report route and a Director — the same answer as everywhere else in this app. No counter substitutes for a person whose job it is to look.

The limit is people, not computers

A Guide walks with at most as many Explorers as the church has set, and the database enforces it rather than the screen. The figure started at five, which is roughly what one person can actually walk with; this congregation has raised it to a hundred. The app will run a church of a hundred without complaint, on the plan it is on today and with room to spare. See What it costs →docs/WHAT-IT-COSTS.md for the measured figures. What it cannot do is find you a sixth Guide. Growth here means recruiting and training people, and the app is built to keep that constraint visible rather than hide it behind a number that keeps rising.

CHAPTER 3

The four roles

From `docs/HANDBOOK.md`

A person's role is chosen when they are approved, and it decides everything they can see for as long as they are in the church. **Nobody can change their own role, including the Executive Director.** That is enforced in the database, not in the app.

Role	What they do	What they can see
Explorer	Walks the journey. Reads what their Guide sends, talks with them, asks for prayer.	Their own journey, and their conversation with their Guide. Nothing about anybody else.
Guide	Walks with up to the church's own limit of Explorers. Chooses what to share and when. Recommends new people, but cannot invite them.	Only the Explorers paired with them. Never another Guide's people.
Director	Runs the church. Invites, approves, pairs, and reads safeguarding reports.	Everyone in their church and the counts behind them. Not private conversations, except inside a report.
Executive Director	Oversees one or more churches, and appoints Directors.	Everything a Director sees, across every church they oversee.

NOTE

The Head Executive Director

One account is the root of authority. It cannot be suspended or removed by anybody, including itself, so a church can never lock itself out of its own app. Guard the password for that account the way you would guard the keys to the building.

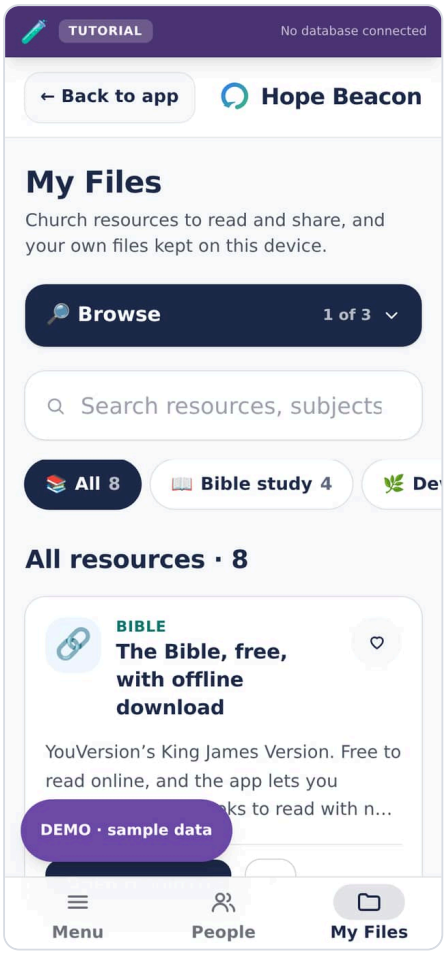
What an Explorer's shelf opens with

The starter shelf is the same nineteen resources for everybody, but an Explorer is shown eight of them first, in this order:

> A Bible they can read on a phone · Jesus 101 · The Desire of Ages · Steps to Christ · BibleProject · Discover Bible Guides · What Seventh-day Adventists Believe · Sabbath School this quarter

One doctrinal page, deliberately. Somebody deciding whether to follow Jesus is not helped by being handed the twenty-eight fundamental beliefs and the full prophetic history on their first day, and the Guide walking with them is the right way to meet the rest.

Nothing is hidden. The Great Controversy, the collected writings of Ellen G. White, the quarterly archive and the General Conference publications are all still in the shelf for everyone else, and for an Explorer the moment they go looking. What changed is only what is put in front of somebody first.



The shelf, as an Explorer sees it. First on it is a Bible they can read on a phone, with whole books saved for reading with no signal.

The shelf is a constant in `lib/starter-kit.ts`, not a table, so it costs no storage and no query. `tests/the-explorer-starts-with-jesus.mjs` keeps the short list short. The twenty links point at other people's websites, so `links.yml` checks weekly that every one of them still opens.

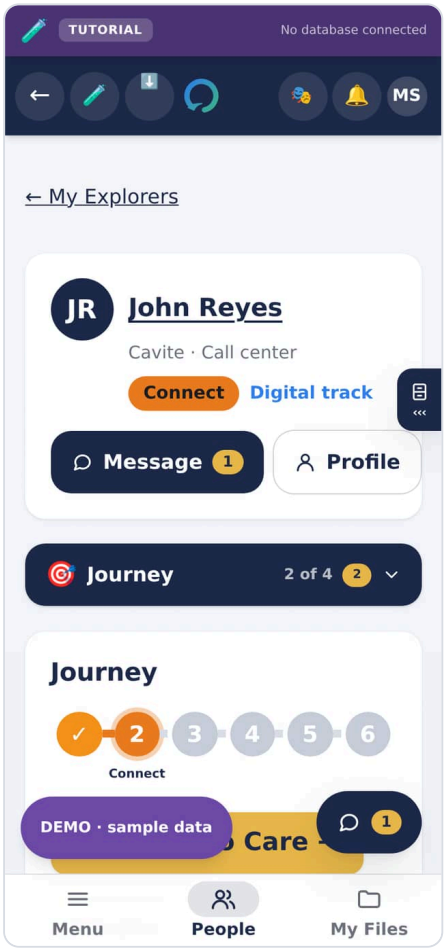
CHAPTER 4

The journey

From `docs/HANDBOOK.md`

Five stages, and an Explorer moves through them at their own pace. The stage is a note for the Guide, not a score, and nothing in the app hurries anybody along.

Stage	What it means
Beginner	Just beginning. Somebody has said yes to being walked with.
Connect	Building rapport. Getting to know each other.
Care	Walking alongside. The longest stage, and usually the most valuable.
Call	A point of decision.
Cultivate	Growing in faith after that decision.



An Explorer's page, as their Guide sees it. The journey reads left to right, and this Explorer has reached Connect, the second stage.

The first stage was called *Create* until August 2026. That named what the church was doing; *Beginner* names where the Explorer is, which is whose journey it is. Nothing changed in the database, so no history moved.

A sixth idea sits behind these: **Commission**. An Explorer who has been walked with becomes a Guide, and walks with somebody else. That is the whole point of the design, and it is the only kind of growth that does not run out.

CHAPTER 5

Onboarding a church

From `docs/ONBOARDING.md`

IN THIS CHAPTER

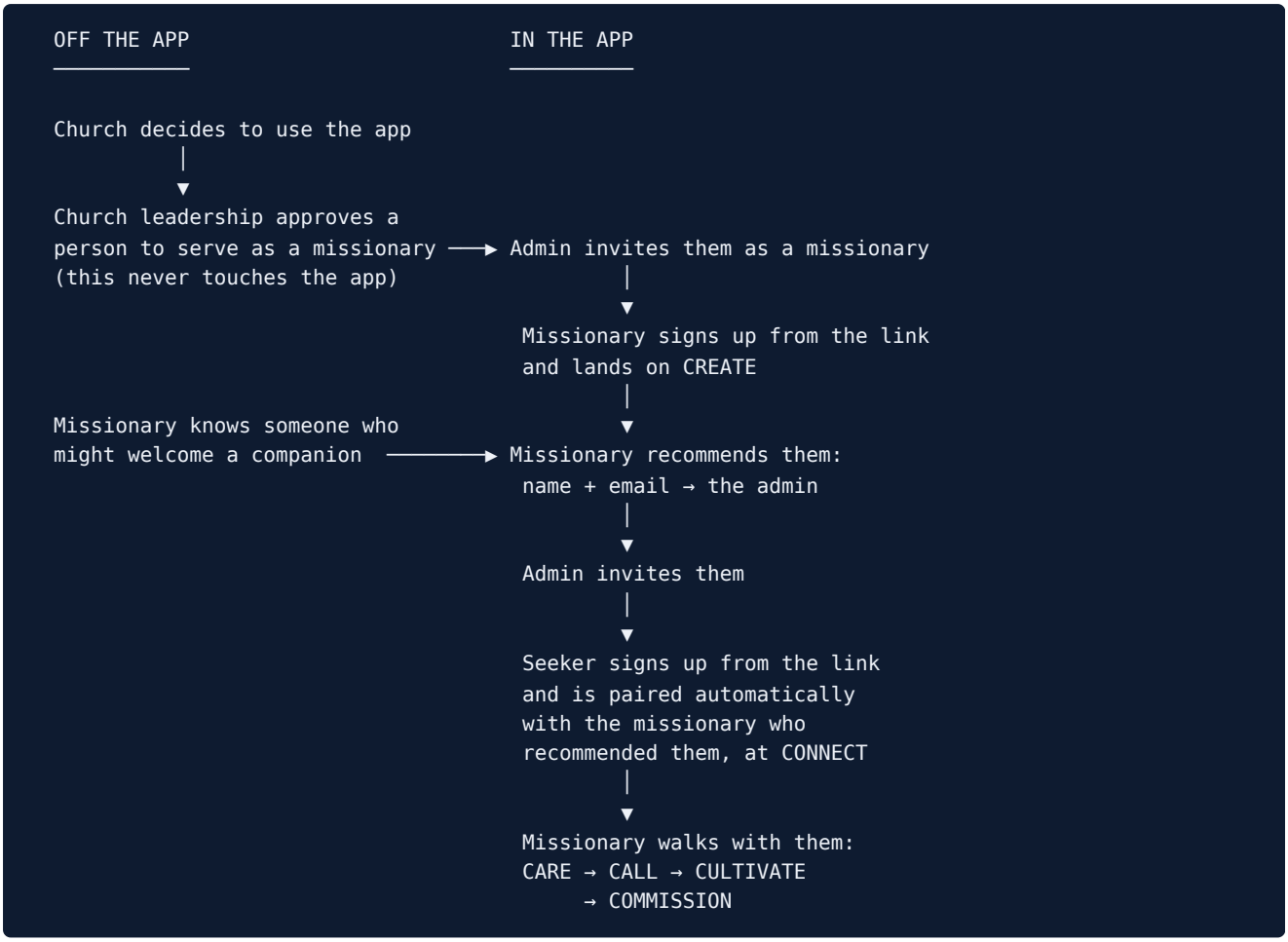
The short version 20
Step by step 20
Who sees what 22
Before the session: the demo teaches each person their own job 22
What to prepare before onboarding day 23
A realistic first session 24
The direction this is heading 24
Troubleshooting 24

How a church actually uses this app: who does what, in what order, and which steps deliberately do **not** happen in the app at all.

Read the first section and you will know the model. The rest is detail.

> **What you are running.** As shipped there is no backend. Every account, message and pairing lives in your own browser, and nothing leaves your device. The flow below is the real one and you can click all of it — but where it says a rule is enforced by the database, that is a rule *your* deployment has to enforce once you connect one. See BACKENDS.md → docs/BACKENDS.md and SECURITY.md → docs/SECURITY.md.

The short version



The journey begins at Create for a Guide and at Connect for an Explorer. An Explorer is never at Create, because by the time they have an account a Guide already brought them.

Step by step

1. Create the church, and its Director

Whoever runs the deployment creates the church record and invites its first **Director**. The Director is the only account that has to exist before anything else can happen.

The Director is the church's coordinator: they approve people, invite people, pair people, and keep the resource library. In a small church this is the pastor.

2. Church leadership approves Guides — off the app

The board, elders, or whoever decides in your church **has no account here and does not need one.** They meet, they decide who is fit to serve, and they tell the Director. None of that is recorded in the app, because none of it happens there.

This matters for two reasons:

- Nobody waits for a "board approval" screen that does not exist.

- If a board member wants numbers, the Director shows them. There is no login to hand out, no password to manage, and no Explorer's identity exposed to a group of people who have no reason to see it.

If your church works differently, this is a decision and not a law — but think carefully before giving a login to anybody whose job is to read totals.

3. The Director invites the Guides

Director → **Invite** → name, email, role **Guide**.

In a real deployment the person receives an email with a one-time link. Make it expire, and make it work only for the address it was sent to, so forwarding it achieves nothing.

They open the link, set a password, and they are in. **A Guide starts at Create**: an account, and no Explorers yet.

4. A Guide recommends an Explorer

This is the step the whole model turns on.

A Guide knows someone — a neighbour, a colleague, a friend who asked a question after a service. That person has **no account and has never heard of the app**.

Guide → **Recommend someone to the Director** → their name, their email, and optionally why.

The Guide **cannot invite them**. They recommend; the Director decides. In a real deployment, enforce that line in the database and in whatever function sends invitations — not only in the screens. A Guide who can invite is a Guide who can add anybody to the church's records.

5. The Director invites the recommended Explorer

The recommendation reaches the Director with the Guide's name against it. The Director has two answers:

- **Invite** — an invitation goes out, carrying the recommending Guide with it.
- **Not now** — the recommendation is closed and the Guide is told. Nothing is deleted. A Guide who hears nothing back assumes the app ate it, and stops recommending people.

6. The Explorer joins, already paired

The Explorer opens their link, sets a password, and completes a short profile.

At that moment — in the same transaction that creates their account — **the pairing is created**: with the Guide who recommended them, at stage **Connect**. Nobody has to remember to do it, and there is no window in which a new Explorer exists with nobody attached.

7. The journey

The Guide walks with them: **Care → Call → Cultivate → Commission**. Only the Guide and the Director ever see which stage someone is on.

Who sees what

	Sees
Director	Everything in their own church. Approves, invites, pairs, monitors.
Executive Director	The same, across every church they oversee.
Guide	**Only the Explorers paired with them.** Their conversations, their journeys, their own private notes. Nothing about another Guide's Explorers.
Explorer	Their own page, their own Guide, and what has been shared with them.
Church leadership	No account. Aggregate numbers from the Director, when they ask.

Two rules are worth stating plainly, because churches ask about both.

An Explorer never sees a journey stage — including their own. A stage is a note the church keeps about a person's progress. Shown to that person it reads as a grade. It appears on the Guide's and the Director's screens, and nowhere an Explorer can reach. `tests/e2e/seeker-no-stage.js` enforces this; keep it passing.

A Guide's private notes about an Explorer are private from everyone, including the Director and including the Explorer. They exist so a Guide can remember what was actually said without it becoming a church record.

As shipped, both rules are enforced by the screens alone, which is fine for evaluating the flow and wrong to rely on for anything real — everything here is sample data about invented people. When you connect a backend, enforce them in your data rules, where a request that never touches your screens still meets them.

Before the session: the demo teaches each person their own job

The people deciding whether a church adopts this are often in their forties, capable, and not especially interested in software. They can learn it. What they cannot learn from is a tutorial about somebody else's job.

So there is **one guided walk per role**. The app opens by asking *"Who are you in your church?"* and each answer leads somewhere different.

Who	Tasks	What it teaches
Executive Director	3	The church at a glance, the journey chart, and the gate everyone passes through to join. Counts, never conversations.
Director	5	Who is waiting, letting someone in with a role, acting on a Guide's recommendation, pairing a Guide with an Explorer, and stocking the library.
Guide	5	Open an Explorer, message them, advance their journey, share a resource, make your profile yours.
Explorer	3	Say hello, open a lesson, ask for prayer. No stage name appears anywhere.

Each step names the screen it happens on, so that when the arrow is gone the person still knows where the thing lives. That is the difference between being led through a demo and being able to use the app.

Run the walks before onboarding day. Ten minutes each, on sample data, on a phone. Nothing anyone presses reaches a real person. Whoever is facilitating should have done all four, so they can answer the question that always comes: *"can they see my messages?"*

The walks are in the app under **Settings › Tutorial**, so somebody who wants to run theirs again a week later needs nobody's help.

The walks live in `lib/quest.ts`. If you change a screen, change the walk that points at it — `tests/e2e/quest-roles.js` completes every walk in a real browser and fails if an arrow points at something that is not there.

What to prepare before onboarding day

A church needs surprisingly little:

1. **One Director**, with an email address they actually read.
2. **The leadership's decision** about who will serve as Guides — made before the session, since it happens off the app anyway.
3. **An email address for each Guide.** This is the only thing that commonly holds a session up. Shared family addresses and addresses nobody checks both cause trouble later, when an invitation goes unread.

Explorers need nothing in advance. They arrive later, through a Guide.

Nothing is emailed in this build. Every message the app would have sent is captured in the Mail screen instead, worded exactly as it would arrive, so you can read it and follow the links with no mail server anywhere.

A realistic first session

Create the church, invite the Director	5 min
Director signs in, sets the church name, looks around	10 min
Invite the Guides (2 min each)	20 min for 10
Walk one Guide through recommending someone	10 min
Questions	15 min

The Guides do not all need to be in the room. Their invitations wait.

The direction this is heading

An Explorer becoming a Guide is the point of the whole six-stage shape: Commission is where somebody being walked with starts walking with somebody else.

The promotion itself is **not built**, and it is worth saying why rather than implying it arrives next week. It needs decisions nobody has made:

- What happens to the pairing they were in? Does it close, or stay as a relationship with a different shape?
- Who approves the promotion — the Director alone, or the church leadership off the app, like every other Guide?
- What carries over? Their journey history is a record of them as an Explorer, and their new Explorers should not be able to read it.

Until those are answered, promotion is done the honest way: leadership approves them like anyone else, and the Director changes their role.

If your church has answered those questions, this is a good thing to contribute.

Troubleshooting

"I never got the invitation." Check spam first. If your deployment expires invitations, an old one needs replacing — the Director sends a new one. A link that only works for the address it was sent to will fail if it was forwarded.

"I signed up but I have no Explorers." That is correct for a new Guide. Recommend someone, or wait for the Director to pair you.

"An Explorer joined but is not paired with me." This happens when the Director invited them directly rather than from your recommendation. Ask the Director to pair you; it takes ten seconds.

"Can the board have a login?" They can, if you build it — but the design says no. Ask the Director for the numbers. A login exists to *do* something, and reading a total is not that.

PART II

Getting started

Getting the app onto a phone or a computer, signing in, finding your way around, and making it comfortable to read.

6 Getting it on your phone 26

7 Your phone, getting around, and the looks 44

8 Settings, looks and reading comfort 69

9 Which platforms this runs on 80

CHAPTER 6

Getting it on your phone

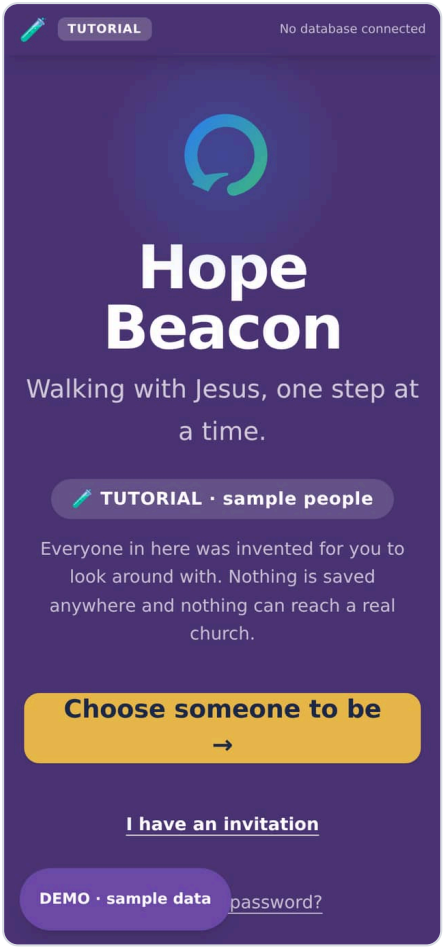
From `docs/HOW-TO-USE.md`

IN THIS CHAPTER

The link, and what you see first 27
Install it, so it opens like an app 27
Bigger words 28
Signing in 32
Finding your way 33
Music 36

Hope Beacon is a website that behaves like an app. There is nothing to find in the App Store or Play Store, and nothing to pay for. You open a link once and then keep it on your home screen.

The link, and what you see first



The front door. Anybody can open this; it is the only page that does not need an account. I have an invitation is the way in.

Install it, so it opens like an app

Installing means the app gets its own icon, opens without the browser's address bar, and remembers you. It is the same app either way, only tidier.

On an iPhone or iPad (Safari)

1. Open the link in **Safari**. It has to be Safari; Chrome on an iPhone cannot install a web app.
2. Tap the **Share** button at the bottom of the screen (the square with an arrow coming out of the top).
3. Scroll down the list and tap **Add to Home Screen**.
4. Tap **Add**. The icon appears with your other apps.

On an Android phone (Chrome)

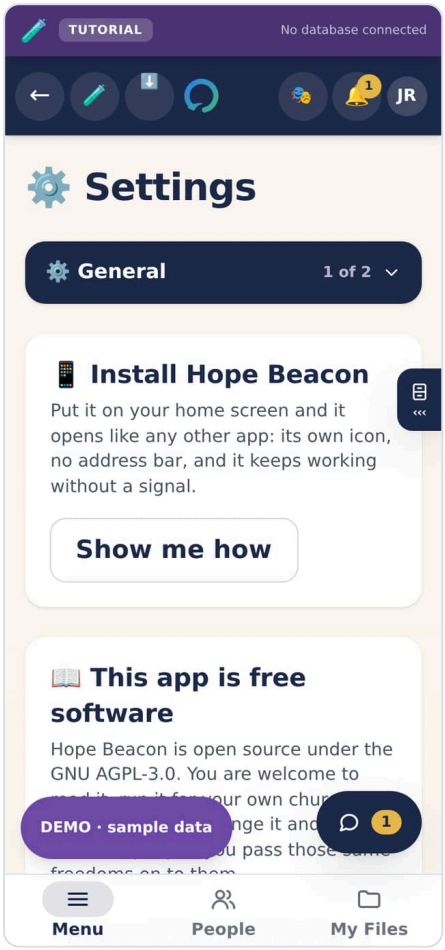
1. Open the link in **Chrome**.
2. Tap the **three dots** at the top right.
3. Tap **Add to Home screen**, then **Install**.

On a computer

Chrome and Edge show a small install icon at the right-hand end of the address bar. Safari on a Mac has **File → Add to Dock**.

> **If you are asked to sign in again after installing**, that is normal once. The installed copy starts its own session. It will remember you afterwards.

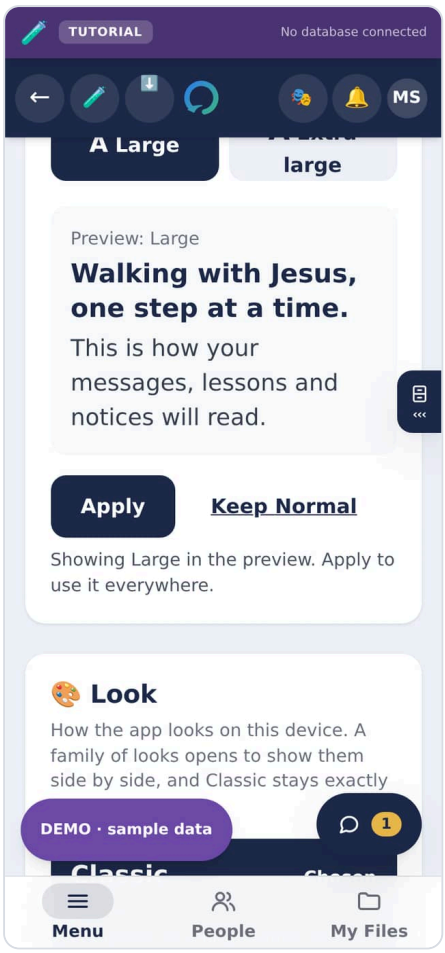
Everything to do with installing also lives inside the app, under Settings, so nobody has to keep this page to hand:



Settings. Installing, alerts, text size and language all live here, in the General folder.

Bigger words

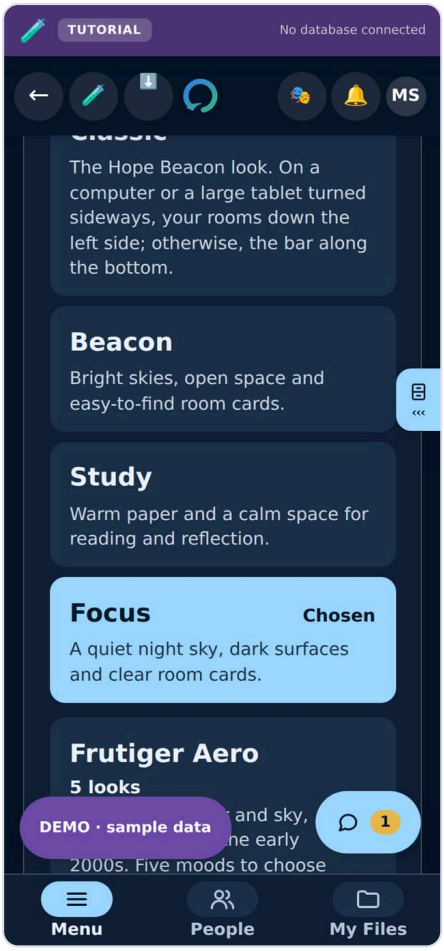
If the writing is too small, open **Settings**, stay in **General**, and choose a larger **Text size**. The preview below the sizes shows it first; when it reads well, press **Apply**, and every screen follows it, conversations included.



Text size. Large is tried in the preview; Apply makes it the size everywhere, Keep Normal leaves it as it was.

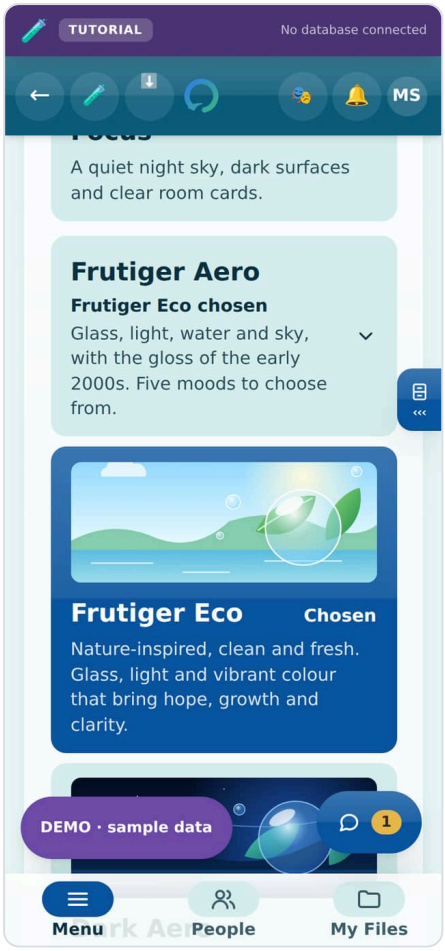
Just below it is **Look**, with **Classic** chosen. On a computer, and on a large iPad turned sideways, Classic has your rooms down the left side and a light bar across the top; on a phone or a smaller tablet, the bar along the bottom.

You can choose three other looks there: **Beacon** (bright and blue), **Study** (warm paper) and **Focus** (dark, like a night sky). The rooms and everything in them stay the same; only the colours and shapes change. The choice is kept on this phone or computer, and **Classic** takes you back.

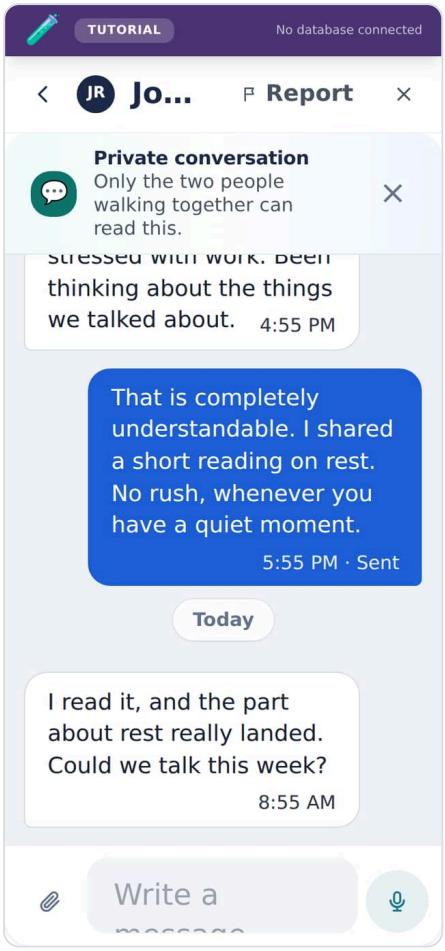


Look in Settings: Classic, Beacon, Study and Focus. Focus is chosen here.

Below them is **Frutiger Aero**, a row that opens to show five more looks, each with a picture and a line about it: **Frutiger Eco** (sky, water and leaves), **Dark Aero** (deep blue glass), **Technozen** (calm and minimal), **DORFic** (playful, early-2000s blue) and **Four Colors** (a bright colour for each room). Tap the row to open it, then tap the one you like.



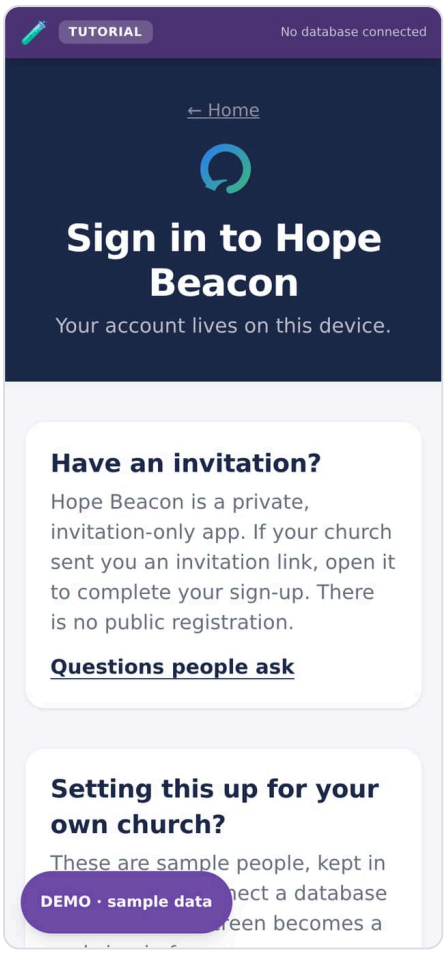
Frutiger Aero opened in Settings: five looks, each with its picture. Frutiger Eco is chosen here.



A conversation with Text size at its largest. The words grow and still fit the screen.

Signing in

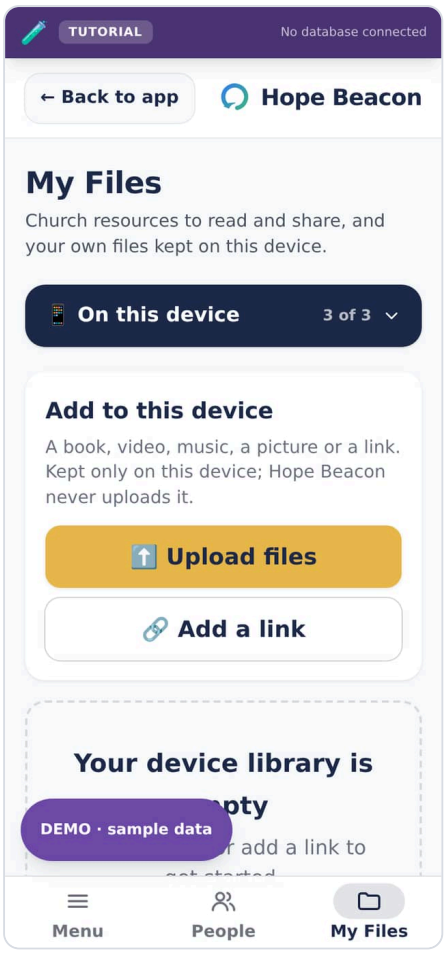
You need an invitation from your church. When you have one, you pick who you are and the app takes you to your own part of it.



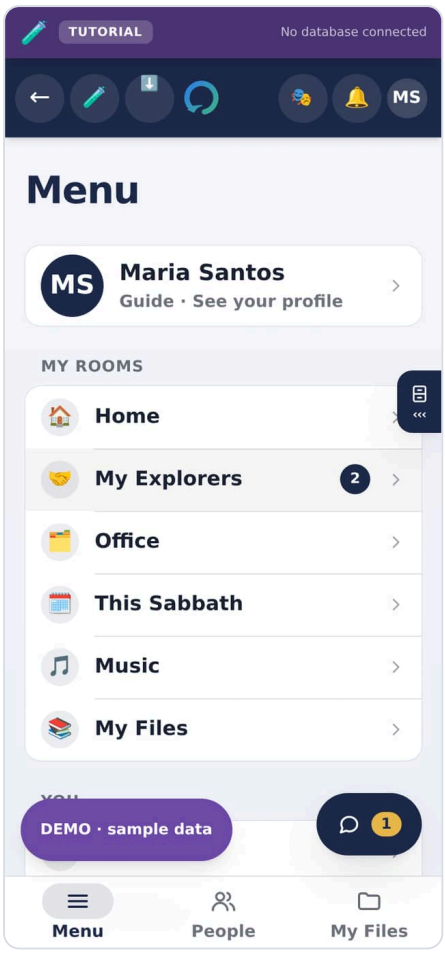
Signing in. There is no public sign-up: if you have no invitation yet, ask your church for one.

Finding your way

Along the bottom of every screen are three words. **Menu** lists every place you can go, written out. **People** opens the people you walk with. **My Files** opens the church's resources and your own files. On a phone or a pad, tap a chip under the search box (Bible study, Devotion and the rest) to narrow the list, and choose **On this device** for your own files: **Upload files** or **Add a link** at the top, and Delete asks a second time before anything goes.



My Files on a phone, On this device: Upload files and Add a link at the top, then your own files.



The Menu. Every room is written out, with your own profile at the top.

Some screens hold several **folders**. The button at the top names the one you are in and how many there are; tap it to see them all, then tap one to go there.

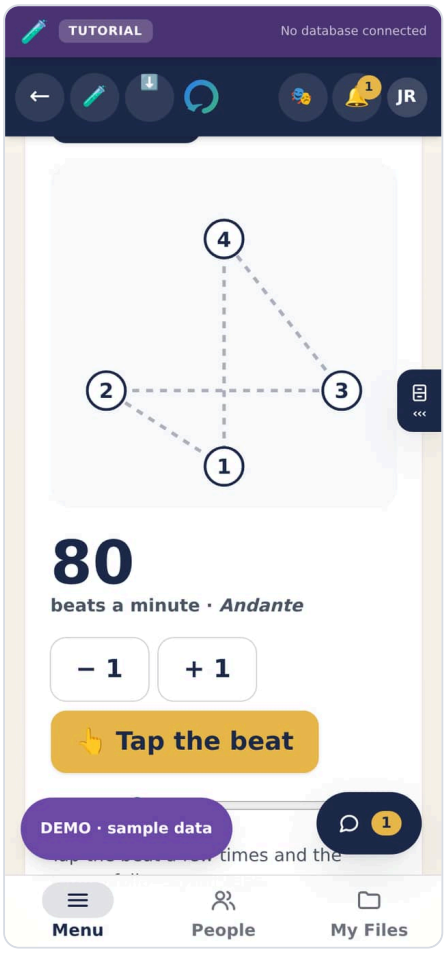
A folder list, open. It says you are in My Guide, 1 of 4, and lists the rest.

Music

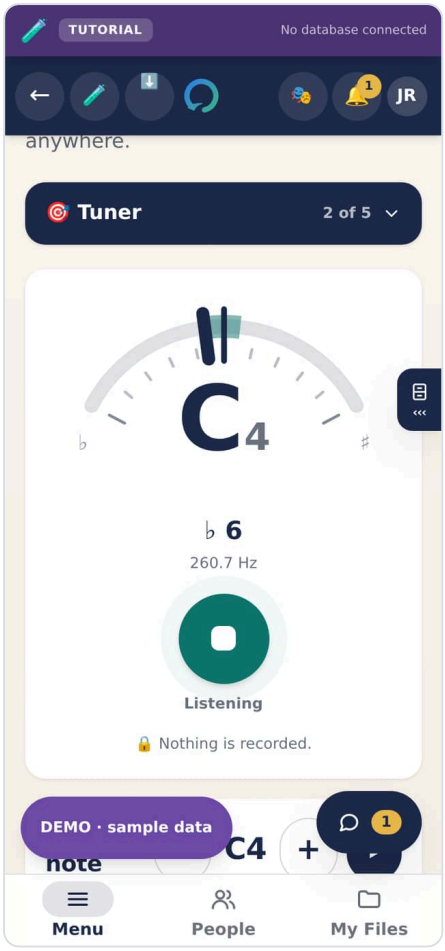
Music, in the Menu, is for everybody: the choir, and anybody who loves music. Everything in it happens on your phone, and nothing is sent anywhere. It has five folders. Each opens simple; tick **Advanced settings** at the end of a folder for more, and untick it to put the folder back as it was.

- **Listen** plays your own music and videos, in playlists if you like, and has calming sounds for the background. Your music is still in My Files as well, and each file there has its own Play button for a quick listen.
- **Tuner** is a dial with the note in the middle. Tap the round **microphone** button and sing or play: the marker leans left when you are flat (♭), right when you are sharp (♯), and the dial says ✓ **In tune** inside the green band. Your phone asks once whether the app may use the microphone; it records nothing. Tap the button again to stop. **Starting note** plays a note for the choir, like a pitch pipe. **Concert pitch** (tap it to open) is where the choir's A sits: 440 is the standard; tap 442 or 432 and you hear the new A, and to match an organ or a piano, ask for its A and tap **Listen for the A**. In **Advanced**: **Sing the note**, a keyboard: tap a key, sing it and hold it, and it says **Perfect**, **Close** or **Try again** (and what you sang), with a burst of notes for Perfect. **More tools** holds a line drawing your voice over the last ten seconds, a **drone** to sing against, and the notes as a clarinet, trumpet, saxophone or horn reads them.

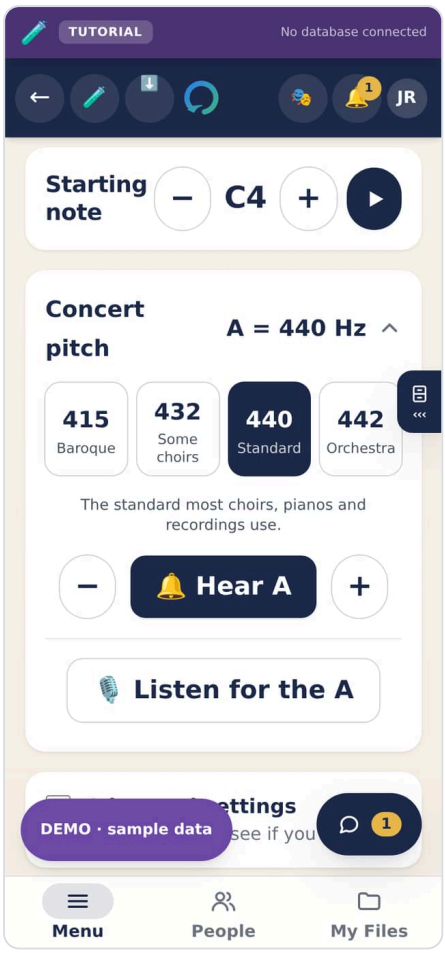
- **Pieces** keeps your choir's music. **Scan a page**: take a photo of a printed page, drag the four dots onto its corners, and tap **Make a clean page**. **Open a score or PDF**: a MusicXML file from MuseScore, Sibelius, Finale or Dorico, or a PDF that MuseScore or Dorico made, read note by note on the phone (check it against the page; a scanned PDF stays a picture). Choose **Your part** to hear it louder, slow it down, and tap the notes to start from anywhere. In **Advanced**: move it up or down to suit your voices, loop a hard passage, silence your own part to sing it, and choose the sound.
- **Play** is a piano keyboard: press and hold a key to hear it. In **Advanced**: the chords of any key a tap each, and a beat maker with a bass drum, snare and hi-hat, with your own beats saved by name.



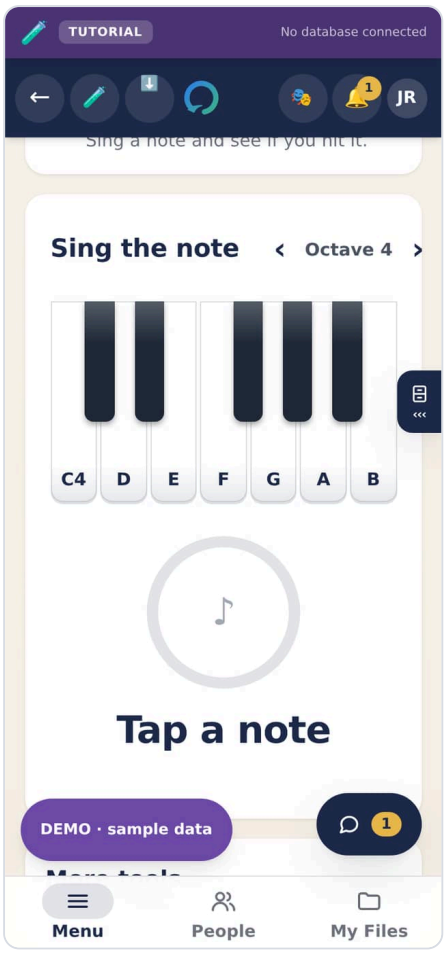
The Music room's Conductor. The pattern for four beats, numbered where the hand falls, with the tempo beside it.



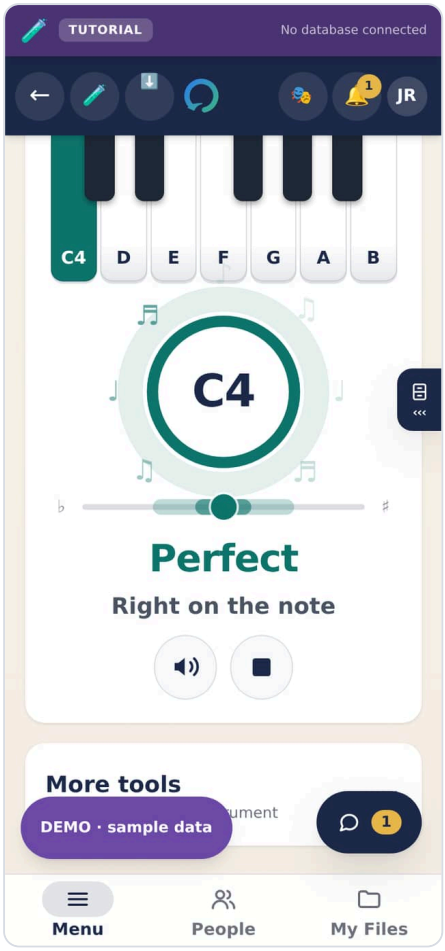
The Tuner: the dial, a C4 sung and in tune, and the round button.



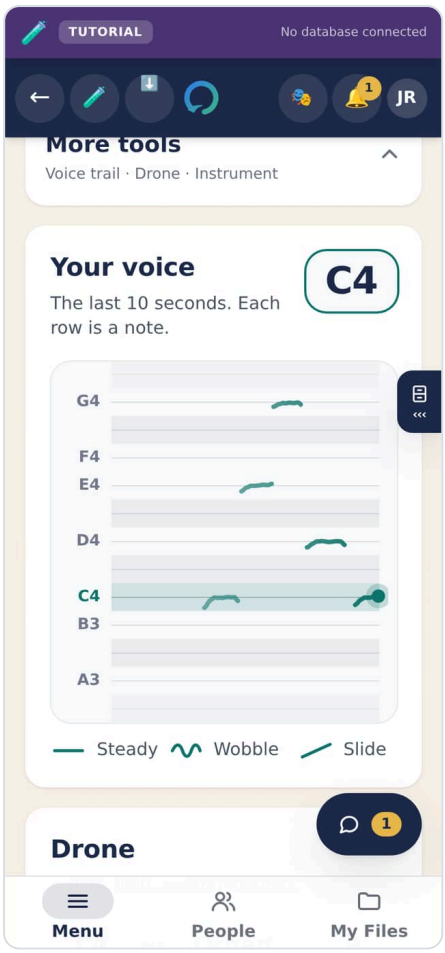
The Tuner's Concert pitch, opened. One tap for each common A, a line saying what it does, Hear A, and Listen for the A.



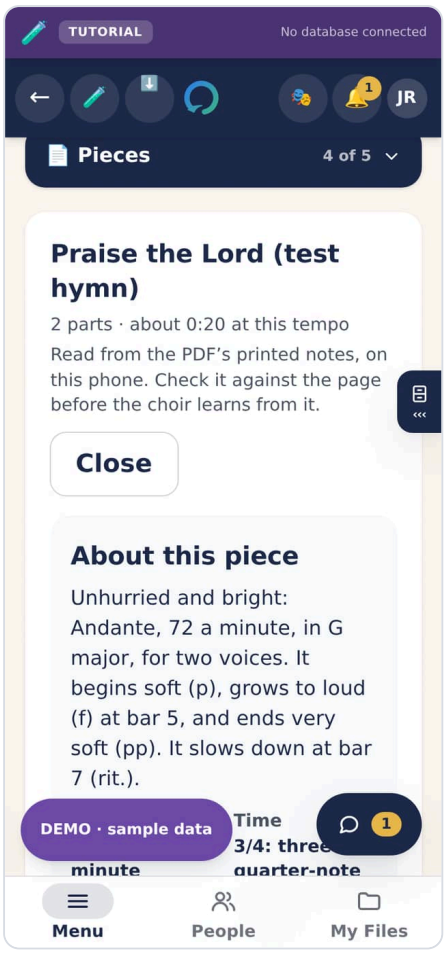
Sing the note, in the Tuner's Advanced settings: a keyboard, waiting for a key to be tapped.



C4 tapped and sung: Perfect, with a burst of notes.



Your voice, in the Tuner's Advanced settings: one octave of notes, each named, and a short tune sung across them, a line for each note.



Pieces with a choir PDF opened on the phone. Under the title it says it was read from the printed notes, and About this piece explains it.

CHAPTER 7

Your phone, getting around, and the looks

From `docs/HANDBOOK.md`

IN THIS CHAPTER

If you are not in Safari: one tap 45
iPhone and iPad, by hand 45
Every other browser 46
Updates 48
Something to listen to 48
The Music room 49
How you get around: Menu, People, My Files 57
On the desk 60
Pop-ups on a phone held upright 62
Waiting 62
Movement 62
The look: Classic 63
Beacon, Study and Focus 64
Frutiger Aero: five looks in one drop-down 65
Your desk's colours, in every look 66
Notifications 67

Hope Beacon installs from the browser. There is no app store, no download, and no review process. Once installed it has its own icon, opens without an address bar, and keeps working when the signal does not.

IMPORTANT

iPhone and iPad: only Safari can install

Apple permits only Safari to add an app to the Home Screen. Chrome, Firefox, Edge and Opera on an iPhone cannot do it, and no amount of work on our side can change that. Neither can the browser inside Messenger, Facebook or Instagram.

What we can do is make leaving take one tap instead of three steps, and that is what the app now does.

If you are not in Safari: one tap

Open the app in Chrome, Firefox, Edge, or from a link inside Messenger or Facebook, and it says which browser you are in and offers a single button: **Open this page in Safari**. Tapping it reopens the page you are on, in Safari, with nothing retyped. From there, Share and Add to Home Screen work normally.

This matters most for somebody holding an invitation. The old advice was to switch to Safari, and people did that by opening Safari and typing the address, which loses the invitation link they were on. That is the version of the bug reported as "they switch to Safari and it still does not work". The button carries the exact page across.

> **CAUTION**
>
> Honest about the limits of this
>
> The handoff uses a URL scheme Apple has never documented. Most browsers and most in-app browsers honour it. Some refuse, and when they do, *nothing happens and nothing says why*.
>
> So the written steps stay on the screen underneath the button, always, and there is a Copy link button for the person whose browser refuses both. It has been tested with simulated iPhone browsers in an automated test. It has **not** been tested on a physical iPhone.

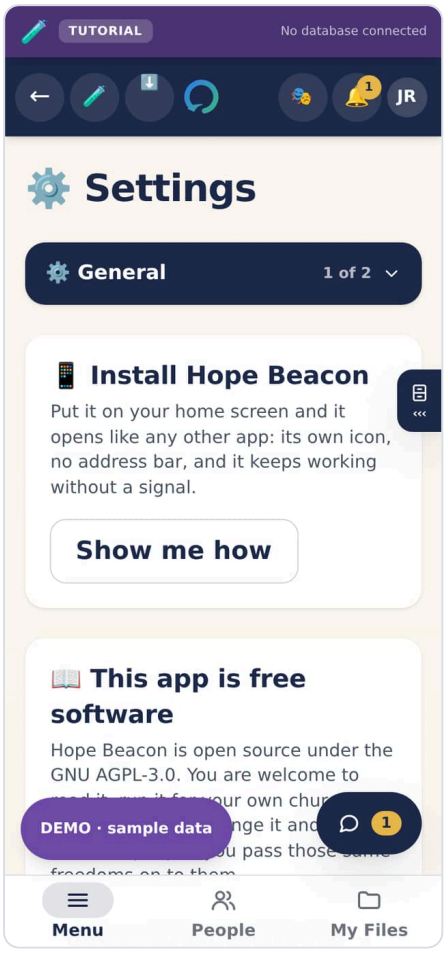
iPhone and iPad, by hand

1. Open the church's address **in Safari**. If you are in another browser or inside a chat app, use its ••• menu and choose **Open in Safari**.
2. Tap **Share**, the square with an arrow coming out of it.
3. Scroll down and tap **Add to Home Screen**.
4. Tap **Add**, top right.

> **CAUTION**
>
> If somebody installed before 26 August 2026
>
> What they have is a bookmark, not an app, and it will not convert itself. Older iPhones needed a tag the framework had stopped emitting, so Add to Home Screen produced an icon that opened Safari with the address bar showing. Nothing errored, which is why it was reported as "the install does not work".
>
> The fix is deployed. Those people must **delete the old icon and add it again**.

Every other browser

Settings asks which browser you are in and gives that browser's steps. It guesses from the browser itself and opens on the right one, and the whole list is one tap away if the guess is wrong.



Settings, General. Installing is the first card, and Show me how gives the steps for the browser you are in.

Browser	Where	What to press
Chrome	Android, Windows, Mac, Linux, Chromebook	Phone: ⋮ then **Add to Home screen**. Computer: the install icon at the right-hand end of the address bar.
Microsoft Edge	Android, Windows, Mac	Phone: ••• at the bottom, then **Add to phone**. Computer: the install icon, or ••• then **Apps** then **Install this site as an app**.
Samsung Internet	Samsung phones and tablets	☰ at the bottom right, then **Add page to**, then **Home screen**.
Opera	Android, Windows, Mac	Phone: the menu, then **Add to**, then **Home screen**. Computer: the install icon in the address bar.
Brave	Android, Windows, Mac	Phone: ⋮ then **Add to Home screen**. Computer: the install icon, or ☰ then **Install Hope Beacon**.
Vivaldi	Android, Windows, Mac, Linux	The menu, then **Add to Home screen**. Computer: the install icon.
Firefox	Android only	⋮ then **Add to Home screen**.
Hola, and any other Chromium browser	Android, Windows, Mac	Open the menu and look for **Install**, **Install app** or **Add to Home screen**.
Safari	iPhone, iPad	**Share**, then **Add to Home Screen**. The only one that works on Apple.
Safari	Mac	**File**, then **Add to Dock**.

NOTE

Why the list ends with a catch-all rather than every name

Hola, Kiwi, Yandex, UC, DuckDuckGo and the rest are all built on the same engine as Chrome, so they install the same way and only the wording moves. Naming every browser that exists is a list that is wrong the week after it is written; **Install** or **Add to Home screen** is what to look for in any of them.

Two things decided that the browser is *offered as a choice* rather than detected. **Brave does not put its own name in the identifier a browser sends**, so it cannot be recognised that way at all. And searching that identifier for "Hola" matches `Le Hola`, which is a **phone model**, not a browser: a member on that handset would have been told they were using something they have never installed. Both are checked by a test.

GOOD TO KNOW

Firefox on a computer cannot install web apps

Not a setting, and nothing to turn on. Use Chrome, Edge or Safari on a computer. Firefox on a phone is fine and is in the table above. The app says this plainly rather than offering steps that cannot work.

GOOD TO KNOW

On a computer, the invitation to install stays out of the way

In Safari on a Mac, and in Chrome when it offers to install, a card in the bottom-right corner invites you to add the app. It sits above the **Talk** button, and it is not there at all while a conversation, the bell's list or any other panel you opened is showing, so it can never cover **Send**, **Report** or your notifications. Until 4 October 2026 it sat on top of Talk, and on a Mac the conversations could not be opened until the card was closed. Close it with its ×, or **I already have Beacon installed**.

Updates

Nobody reinstalls. When a new version ships, every open copy notices within seconds and offers to refresh. The app will not reload while a message is half written.

GOOD TO KNOW

An update does not sign anybody out

Signing in is stored in the browser, tied to the database project, and shipping new code does not touch it. Nor does the offline cache being rebuilt, nor the crash recovery, which clears caches only. There is a test that fails the build if that ever stops being true.

Two things do end every session, and both are in Part 7: moving to a different database project, and changing the web address.

Something to listen to

There is one player, in two sizes, and they are two views of the same thing rather than two players.

The small one sits in the right-hand column of every room. Shut, it shows what is playing and the volume. The ⋯ at its top right opens it, and it remembers which you chose on that device. Open, it has the same three tabs as the full one.

The full one is the first thing in the **Music** room, in its **Listen** folder, and it is the only place it appears. It moved there from My Files on 4 October 2026, with the playlists and the calming sounds (see *The Music room* below); each file in My Files keeps its own Play button for a quick listen. Before that it had also sat on My Journey and on a Guide's workspace, where it was the largest card on a screen meant to be about somebody's next step.

It is a real player, not a play button. Both sizes have:

- a **progress bar you can drag**, with the time so far on the left and the time remaining on the right;
- **previous** and **next** through whatever is queued;
- **back ten seconds** and **forward ten seconds**, which is what you actually want in a talk;
- **mute**, and a volume slider.

Pressing previous once restarts the track you are on, the way every player people already use behaves. Pressing it again goes back a track.

Video plays too, with a picture. A video's picture appears in whichever player you are looking at, and follows you: start one in the Music room, go back to your room, and it keeps playing with its picture in the rail.

Three tabs, in the order most people want them.

- **Vault** is your own music and video, saved on this device. There is a search box over it, because a vault worth having is a vault too long to scroll, and a **Save music or video** button that puts more in. Files stay on the device and are never uploaded.
- **Playlists** are your own, saved on the device and never uploaded: name one, then add whatever is playing to it. A playlist can mix ambience and your own recordings, so rainfall behind a sermon is one list.
- **Ambience** is **made on the device as it plays**. There is no file to download, it costs no data, and it works with no signal. It has no progress bar, because it has no end; the player says so rather than showing a bar that never moves. It comes in **two groups, and the split is the point**: *Calm* (rainfall, distant surf, night wind) is made to sit with while you read, and *White noise* (soft hush, plain hush) is brighter and flatter to cover the people talking around you. They used to be one list of three, and people looking for something restful kept landing on the flattest thing in it and reporting that the sound was unpleasant. Each one now says what it sounds like underneath its name, including the honest warning on the harshest.

Both sizes drive the same element, so starting a track in the Music room and walking back to your room keeps it playing.

What somebody listens to while they read is nobody else's business, which is why the vault and the playlists stay on the device rather than in the church's database.

The Music room

Asked for on 4 October 2026: "another room for music for music lovers and choir". **Music** is a room for every role, in the Menu and down the left on a computer, and it works the same on the live app and in the sample church because it never touches the church's database. Its five folders each open simple, with a tick box at the end, **Advanced settings** (asked for on 5 October 2026: "more dynamic but also simple"), that opens the rest; it is off until ticked, remembered on the device, and unticking it puts the folder back as it was:

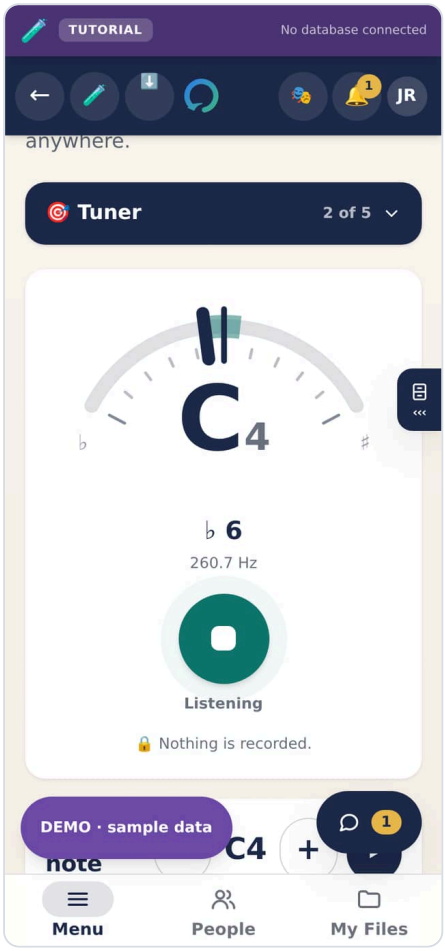
- **Listen**: the full player above, its playlists, and the calming sounds. Music added here is saved with the rest of your files on the device, so My Files lists it too.
- **Tuner**: a dial with the note in the middle and one round microphone button (redrawn on 15 October 2026, when the owner said the Tuner had "so many words on it. Let the design speaks for itself": it showed 245 words, and shows 25). Sing or play a held note and it names the note (A, C♯) and its octave; a marker on the dial leans left when you are flat and right when you are sharp, and the dial says ✓ **In tune** or how far off (♭ **12**). The in-tune zone (within 5 cents) is a green band with a bold centre line, drawn in colours that follow

the look, light or dark. Since 6 October 2026 it reads every frame, moves to a new note within about a tenth of a second, keeps the reading steady on a singer's vibrato, and holds the last note for a moment when the singing stops (`lib/music/pitch-tracker.ts`). **Starting note** plays a note for two seconds, like a pitch pipe. **Concert pitch** is one line until tapped; opened, it moves A from 440 Hz (anything from 400 to 480), the common pitches one tap away (415 Baroque, 432, 440 Standard, 442 Orchestra), every change played and said in a line ("2 Hz above the standard 440: every note sounds about 8 cents higher"), and **Listen for the A** takes the A of the organ or piano in the room and offers it, never set without asking. The phone remembers the choice, and the dial shows it when it is not 440. **Advanced** opens **Sing the note** (14 October 2026, made simple on 15 October 2026: "just tap or click a note and I will just sing"): a piano keyboard; tap a key, sing it and hold it, and after about two-thirds of a second it says **Perfect** (within 10 cents, with a burst of notes that stands still under Reduce Motion), **Close** (within 25, and which way to go) or **Try again** (and what was sung, such as *You sang C4 ↑*); sing again after a breath and it grades again. The tuner's ear was measured against real singing marked by people (vocadito) and every note five voice parts sing, and four faults were fixed; `docs/MUSIC-RESEARCH.md` has the numbers. **More tools** holds **Your voice**, the last ten seconds of the voice drawn across one octave of named rows that follows it, each note its own line; a **drone** held for as long as wanted at the concert pitch, in a soft voice, organ or flute; and the notes as a B♭, E♭ or F instrument reads them (a concert A reads B on a B♭ clarinet).

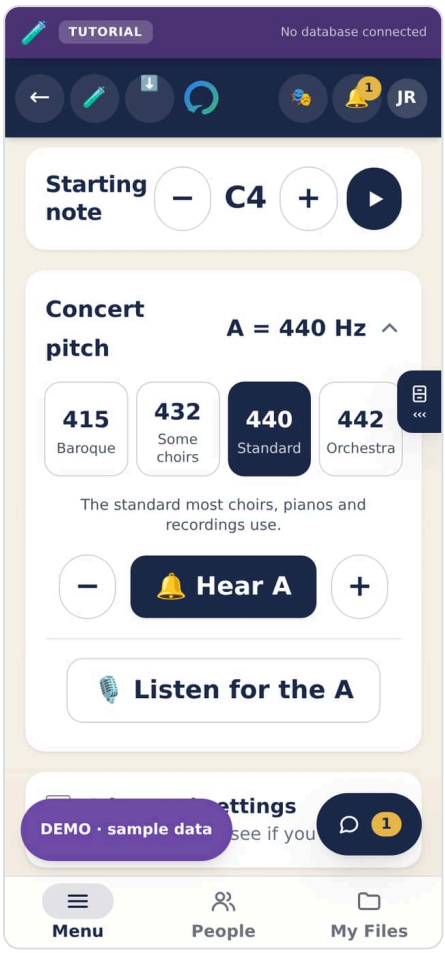
- **Conductor**: a metronome from 30 to 240 beats a minute, with its Italian name (Largo, Andante, Allegro), and a drawing of the conductor's hand for 2/4, 3/4, 4/4 and 6/8 that falls into each beat. **Tap the beat** sets the tempo from your own taps. Untick **Sound the clicks** to follow the hand in silence. The screen stays on while it runs. **Advanced** adds quieter clicks between the beats (2, 3 or 4 to a beat), each beat loud, normal or silent (a silent beat still moves the hand), **Count in, then silent** (one bar of clicks, then the hand alone), a **speed trainer** that adds a few beats a minute every so many bars up to a tempo you choose and never past it, and **saved tempos** by name.
- **Pieces**: **Scan a page** turns a photo of printed music into a clean page: straightened, cropped to the paper, black on white, even with a shadow across it. **Open a score or PDF** reads MusicXML (.musicxml, .xml, or compressed .mxl), or a PDF that a notation program exported (6 October 2026: MuseScore, Dorico and others with a SMuFL music font, read note by note on the phone by `lib/music/pdf-score.ts` from what pdf.js finds in it; 99.78% of notes exactly right on 80 chorales it had never seen; a scanned PDF is told it is a picture), and plays every part, with **Your part** louder, any part silent, any tempo, from any beat you tap. Both are kept on the phone; a PDF is kept as itself and read again each time, and says under its title that it was read from the print. **Advanced**, on a score: transpose up or down a semitone at a time (an octave each way), loop a passage between two beats, **I sing my part** (your part silent and drawn faintly), and the sound. A line above the strip says what it will play. **About this piece** (6 October 2026) explains every score from its own markings (`lib/music/explain.ts`): a sentence or two on its character (pace from the tempo, bright or reflective from a major or minor key, the shape of its loud and soft, where it slows), its tempo, time, key and length, each marking bar by bar, each part's range and widest leap (flagged to practise at a sixth or more, or a tritone), and the words joined back into words.

When the file names no mode, the key is told from where the lowest part ends. **Conduct this piece** opens the Conductor set to the score's time and tempo.

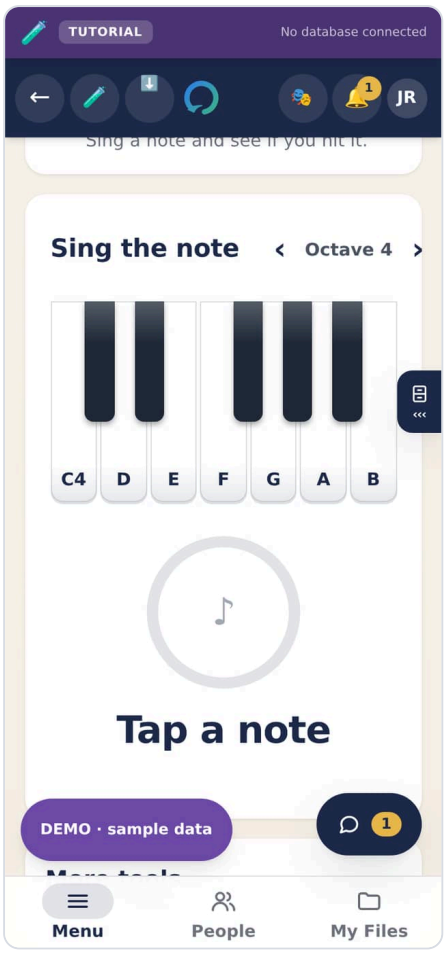
- **Play**: a piano keyboard of one octave at the concert pitch, held keys sounding for as long as they are held, **Lower** and **Higher** an octave at a time. **Advanced** adds the sound, the six chords of a key (I, ii, iii, IV, V, vi) a tap each, and a **beat maker**: bass drum, snare and hi-hat in sixteen steps, four ready-made beats and an empty grid, a tempo that changes while it plays, and beats saved by name on the device. Leaving Play or locking the phone closes its audio.



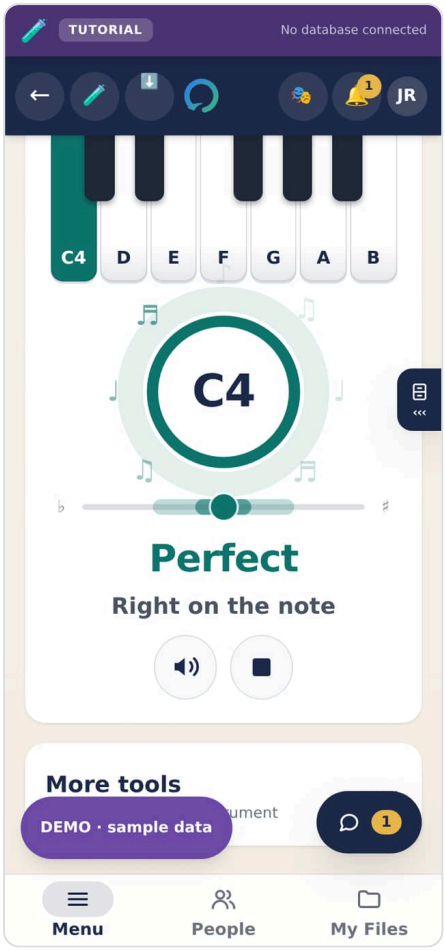
The Tuner on a phone: the dial, a C4 sung and in tune, and the round button, green while it listens.



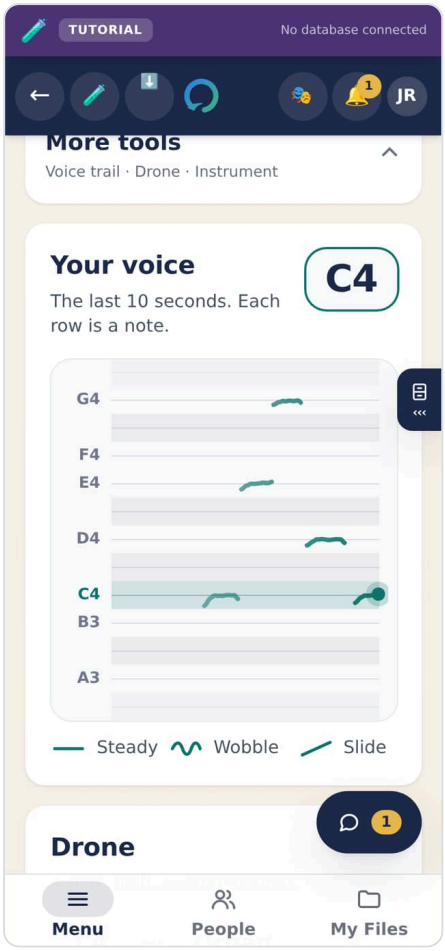
The Tuner's Concert pitch, opened: one tap for each common A, a line saying what it does, Hear A, and Listen for the A.



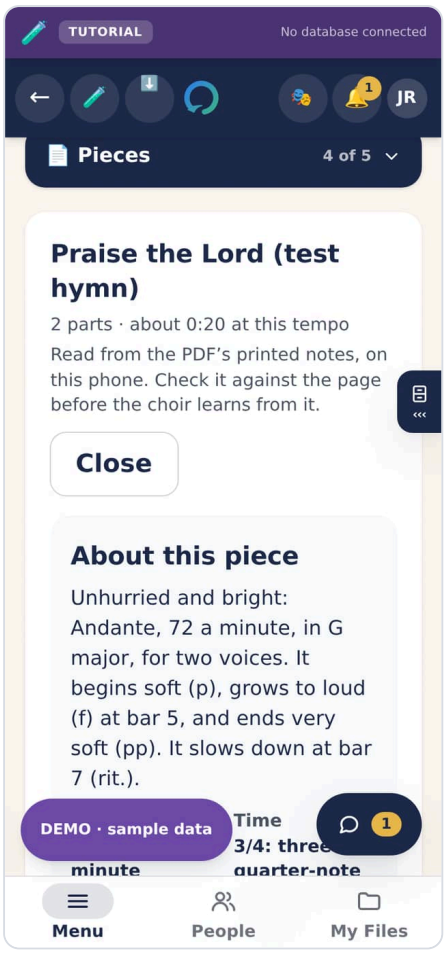
Sing the note on a phone, in the Tuner's Advanced settings: a keyboard, waiting for a key to be tapped.



Sing the note after C4 was tapped and sung: Perfect, with a burst of notes.



Your voice on a phone: one octave of named rows that follows the voice, C4 lit as the note being sung, and C4, E4, G4 and D4 each drawn as a line of its own.



Pieces with the test hymn's PDF opened on a phone: the note under the title says it was read from the printed notes, and About this piece explains the score from its own markings.

GOOD TO KNOW

The microphone, and what is kept

The tuner asks for the microphone only when its round microphone button (or a key in Sing the note) is tapped. It measures the sound on the phone and throws it away: nothing is recorded, kept or sent. It lets go of the microphone when the button is tapped again, on leaving the Tuner, and when the phone locks or another app comes to the front, which turns the phone's recording light off. A scanned page is kept as the clean page only, never the photo, so nothing the camera wrote into the photo (such as where it was taken) is kept.

GOOD TO KNOW

What is not there yet

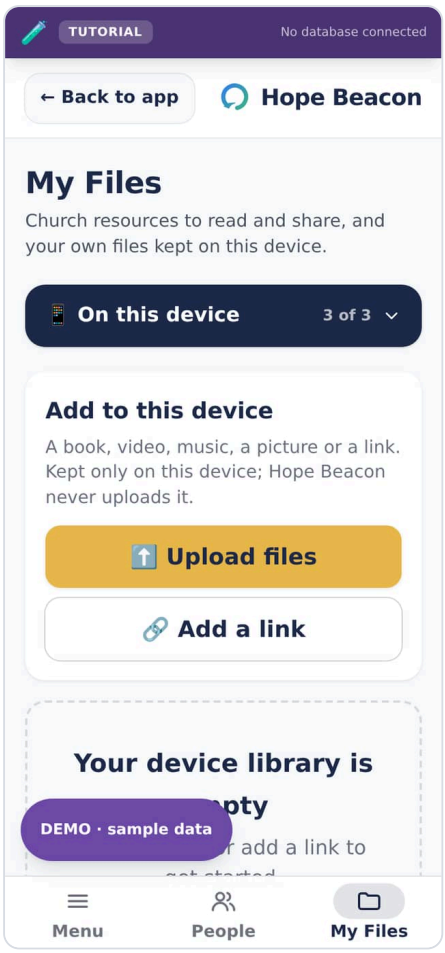
The score is drawn as notes on a strip (higher notes higher, longer notes longer), not as printed music: printed notation needs a library this app's security rules do not allow. A scanned page does not play: turning a photo into notes was left out on 4 October 2026, by the owner's decision, because every way of doing it sends the photo to a server or loosens the security rules. `docs/MUSIC-RESEARCH.md` has both reasons in full.

How you get around: Menu, People, My Files

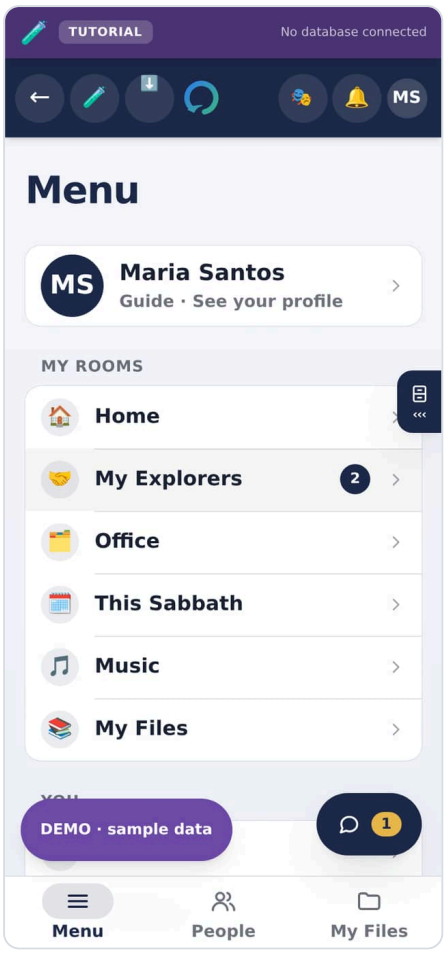
On a phone and an iPad, a bar along the bottom of the screen has three words on it, and it **is** the navigation. On a computer the same rooms are listed down the left side instead, and a light bar runs across the top (see *The look* below). So does a large iPad turned sideways, which is as wide as a laptop: the owner chose to keep the sidebar there (3 October 2026, "keep the sidebar on large iPads"):

- **Menu** lists every room you have, written out: Home (with its **Blog** and **Announcements** folders), your own screen, **This Sabbath**, **Music**, My Files; the **Study Room** for Explorers; the **Office** for Guides and leadership; and **Admin Reports** for leadership. Your profile is at the top; Settings is under **You**; the way out (Sign out) is at the bottom. **Signing out ends that sign-in for good**, not only on the screen in front of you: the app tells the sign-in server too, for this device only, so your other devices stay signed in. If the phone is offline it still signs out, and the server's copy runs out on its own. The sample church also has **Mail** under You, a pretend inbox; a church's own app does not.
- **People** opens your own people: a Guide's Explorers, an Explorer's Guide, a Director's Admin.
- **My Files** opens your own files.

On a phone or a pad (6 October 2026), My Files opens with a short title rather than a banner, one row of filter chips with a count on each, and cards held to three lines. **On this device** puts **Upload files** and **Add a link** at the top, the link form opening only when asked for, and deleting a file kept only on the device takes a second tap. On a computer it is the page it was.



My Files on a phone, On this device: Upload files and Add a link at the top at one width, then the device's own files, then the note that music has its own room.



The Menu, for a Guide in the sample church. Every room is written out, with the bar along the bottom that a phone and an iPad use.

Six of those rooms have **subrooms** inside them, offered as **one drop-down** at the top when you open one. Closed, it names the subroom you are in, says how many there are (*2 of 4*), and shows a count when something is waiting in another one; tap it and every subroom is listed. It is a drop-down on every screen size, because people did not know to swipe the row it replaced. The sections of one person's page (Appointments, Journey, Care and the rest) open the same way. See *Rooms and subrooms* in Part 4.

IMPORTANT

There is no left column any more

Until 30 September 2026 a laptop had a column of rooms down the left side, and a phone had a row of small icons under the header instead. Two lists of the same rooms drifted apart: Office, Publish and Cases were added to the column and never to the row, so for several weeks they could not be reached on a phone. Now there is one list, and the Menu draws it at every size. There is a check that fails the build if the Menu stops drawing it.

The sidebar on a computer (3 October 2026) brings a column back, from that same one list: a room added for the Menu appears in the sidebar without anybody remembering to add it.

The conversation is a bubble, the round **Talk** button in the corner of every screen, with a number on it when somebody has written. On a phone or an iPad it opens to the whole screen; on a computer it opens beside the page. **Report** is at the top of it.

Your desk (the study timer, your note, the pocket, the player) sits beside the page on a wide screen. On a phone or an iPad it is a drawer: tap the small cabinet with ‹‹‹ on the right edge, or swipe in from that edge, and it slides in; tap ››› to put it away. Its colour squares change the colours of the whole app, in every look: see *Your desk's colours* below.

Tutorial, What's new and Feedback are cards inside Settings, not rows in the Menu. On a live church that was half true for a while: only the tutorial made the move, so What's new and Feedback existed in the sample-data build and nowhere else. Both are now on a **Help and feedback** card in Settings, on both. They were rows for a while, put there because each had been reported as missing when it was only reachable by scrolling Settings. That fixed the wrong half: it made the column six entries long for three things somebody uses about once a month, and the column is what people look at all day. The unread mark for a new release sits on Settings itself, so it is still visible from every screen.

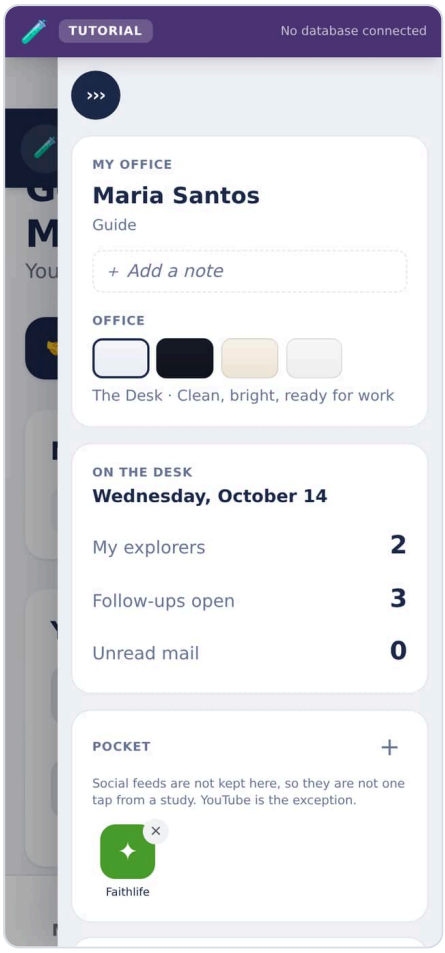
On the desk

The right-hand column carries a panel for Guides, Directors and Executive Directors: what is **coming up**, and what is **waiting for you**.

Coming up is the next three meetings, with the day and the time; pressing one opens the conversation it belongs to. Waiting for you is everything somebody is waiting on you for: unread notifications, prayer requests, people awaiting approval, Explorers with no Guide, open safeguarding reports, and Guides asking to be paired with somebody.

Every line goes to the exact card, not the top of a page. *Prayer requests waiting* opens the prayer card itself; *Waiting to be approved* opens Admin already on Approvals rather than on whichever tab you last used; *Guides asking to walk with somebody* opens the Office at that card. The card is marked briefly when you arrive, so you can see which one answered the press. *Unread notifications* is the one exception and it is not a link: the bell is in the header of every screen, so pressing that line opens the bell where you already are.

Lines disappear when the work is done, so an empty panel means an empty desk.



The desk on a phone is a drawer that slides in from the right edge: the date, the counts that are waiting, and the pocket.

NOTE

This is what "it doesn't go to the feature" was

The lines were links, but they pointed at pages. Arriving at the top of a long screen and having to find the thing you just pressed is the same as not being sent — and pressing an `/admin` line while already on Admin did nothing at all, because the address changed and the screen did not. The desk rail is drawn on the page it links to, so that was the usual case rather than an unlucky one.

Explorers get the study timer here instead. An Explorer has no queue of work, and giving them a "waiting for you" panel would invent one.

NOTE

This panel used to be empty always

It was passed a hard-coded empty list, so every signed-in person was told "Nothing waiting. A good place to be." whatever was actually waiting. It looked like a considered empty state and had never been connected to anything.

Pop-ups on a phone held upright

Every panel that opens over the page (the bell, the account menu, the player's menu, the share sheet, the install card) is measured against the screen the phone actually has, and is pinned inside it.

Three things were wrong, and all three showed up only in portrait:

- **A panel was measured against the wrong screen.** The unit used for "most of the height" is the page's idea of the viewport, which on a phone is the height with the address bar hidden. Held upright, a panel asking for 90% of that was taller than the screen and its bottom was unreachable.
- **A panel anchored to a button near the right edge ran off the side**, because it was positioned from that button rather than clamped to the screen. In landscape there was room and nobody saw it.
- **Anything pinned to the bottom sat under the home indicator** on a modern iPhone, which reserves about 34 points that a fixed offset knows nothing about.

They are all one component now, so a new panel gets the behaviour instead of somebody having to remember it.

Waiting

Opening the app shows one screen while it signs you in: the app's own mark with a halo breathing behind it, the name, and a bar that travels without pretending to know how far along it is.

There were three waiting states and the app showed the plainest of them. The designed one existed and nothing ever drew it; what people saw was a second, flatter screen written inside the live shell, with a lighthouse drawn by hand rather than the app's actual logo. So somebody saw one mark while waiting and a different one for the rest of the session. The church app this grew out of had already found that and fixed it, and this is the same fix.

Anywhere the app is fetching something smaller, it shows the same mark turning with a word for what it is waiting on, rather than the word "Loading" on its own or nothing at all. A screen that is still fetching and a screen that has finished and found nothing used to look identical, so people pressed the button again.

A device set to reduce motion gets the same message without the spin.

Movement

Things move a little, quickly, and never for their own sake. A panel unfolds from the button that opened it and folds back into it; a new subroom fades in where the old one was; a conversation slides in. Every movement in the app uses one of three lengths, 160, 220 and 280 thousandths of a second, so nothing drifts.

Reduce motion turns all of it off. Phones have that setting for people whom movement on a screen makes dizzy or sick, and the app honours it everywhere: nothing slides, fades or bobs, and panels simply appear. A check fails the build if any animation in the app cannot be stilled.

The look: Classic

The app's look has a name: Classic. Settings → General → **Look** shows it, chosen. Asked for on 3 October 2026: "I want the current UI to be called "classic" in the settings right now, ChatGPT or Codex will introduce new theme UI that users can pick, but make sure the classic UI remains the same please."

Classic is the app exactly as it is: choosing it changes nothing, and it has no styles of its own to drift. Other looks appear beside Classic as further choices, kept on the device like the text size, and Classic stays as it is. Since 4 October 2026 there are three of their own, *Beacon, Study and Focus*, and a family of five, *Frutiger Aero*, both below. A new look is added by the rule in `AGENTS.md` (section 2) and `lib/ui-themes.ts`: its styles live in a file of their own and reach only the people who chose it. Two checks hold it: one fails the build if Classic gains a style or a look's styles reach beyond that look, and a browser walk measures Classic's colours, type and shapes against the day it was named.

New features still arrive in Classic, drawn the way it already draws things. What does not change, unless the owner decides it should, is how Classic looks.

On a computer, Classic is the desktop design. Asked for the same day, with a screenshot of a Guide's home on a wide screen: "This UI is not desktop friendly, can we make the desktop have it's own UI too". On a computer (1280 pixels wide and up) every room is down the left side, the same rooms the Menu lists, with the one you are in lit, and the bar along the bottom is put away; the page starts after the sidebar. On a phone or a tablet the bar along the bottom is the navigation, as before; a large iPad turned sideways (1280 pixels and wider) has the sidebar, by the owner's choice. For a few hours this was a second look called **Desktop**, beside a Classic that still put the phone's bar and navy band on a computer. The owner, the same evening, looking at it: "this is the classic. I dont want the UI classic with the outdated version where the UI is still mobile in desktop". So it is Classic now, there is nothing to choose, and a computer that had chosen Desktop sees exactly the same screen.

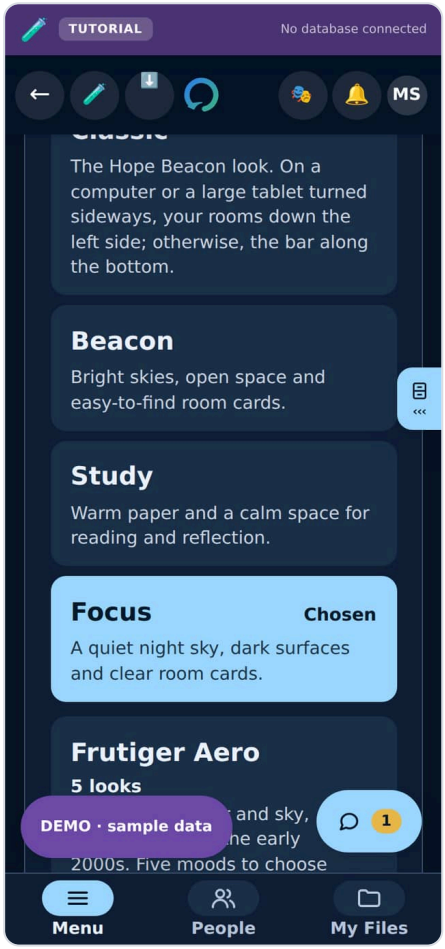
A computer's top bar, not a phone's. The owner, the same day, with a screenshot of the live app on a computer: "Top UI still looks like mobile, change the desktop to real desktop design please". On a computer the navy band across the top, with its Back arrow and a second logo beside the sidebar's, is a light bar across the page instead: the logo is in the sidebar, a computer has its own Back, and the bell, your name and Sign out sit at the right edge. The bar and the sidebar's logo row end on one line. On a phone or a tablet the header is the navy band, as before. A new look recolours the bar through its `--top-bar-*` variables (`app/desktop-layout.css`).

The desk stays below the header, in every look. On a computer the desk on the right sticks beside the page as you scroll, and it used to stick a fixed 76 pixels from the top, which is less than the header is tall on the live side (and less than the header plus the sample church's purple strip). So its first card slid underneath as the page scrolled. Both halves now measure

their header, and the desk sticks just below whatever height that is. The owner asked for this in Classic too ("yes fix it in Classic too"), so it is the one change to Classic since it was named: where the desk stops, not how anything looks.

The first frame is already in your look. The server cannot see which look a device chose, so pages used to arrive as Classic and switch a moment later. A small script at the top of every page now puts the stored look on the page before anything is drawn. When the switch was measured it fell on a blank page and nobody saw it; it matters for a look that colours the whole page, such as a dark one.

Beacon, Study and Focus



Settings → General → Look on a phone: Classic, Beacon, Study and Focus, with Focus chosen.

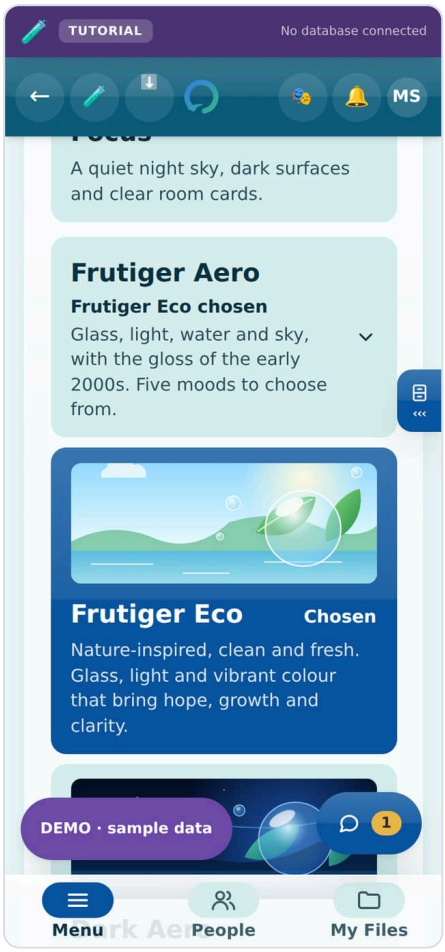
Three more looks sit beside Classic in Settings → General → **Look**:

- **Beacon**: bright sky, blue accents, and room cards that are easy to find.
- **Study**: warm paper and brown accents, calm for reading.
- **Focus**: a night sky with dark surfaces and pale blue accents.

Each one has the same rooms, the same people and the same rules as Classic; only how the screens look changes. The choice belongs to the device, like the text size: it is not part of anybody's account, and a church cannot set it for its members. Choose Classic to go back. The

looks were drawn by Codex, alongside the rest of the work; the files are listed in `docs/FRESH-LOOKS.md`.

Frutiger Aero: five looks in one drop-down



Settings → General → Look on a phone: the Frutiger Aero row opened, each look with its picture and description, Frutiger Eco chosen.

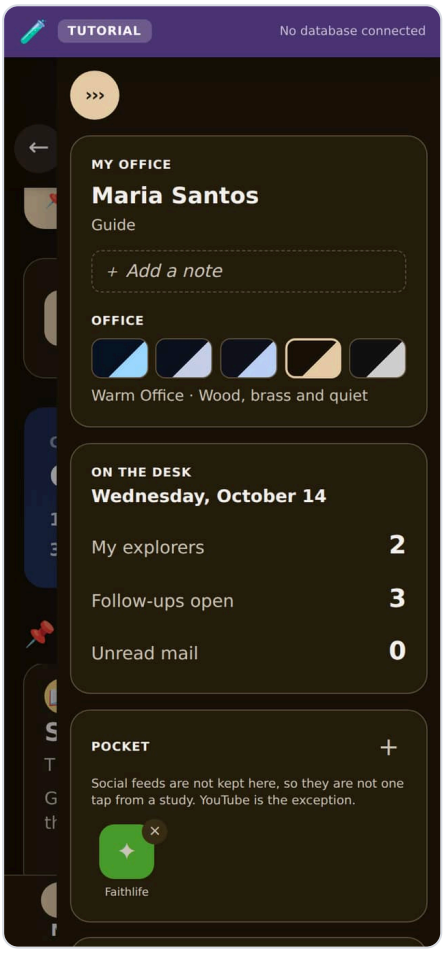
Below the four looks is one more row, Frutiger Aero, that opens to show five. Asked for on 4 October 2026, with four design sheets: "Can we make more UI theme for fruteger aero, as sub file for 'look' so people can see the difference. Please make subfiles with drop down on it (with description)". Each look in it has its own picture, drawn for the app, and a line saying what it is like:

- **Frutiger Eco**: sky, water and leaves; clean and fresh.
- **Dark Aero**: deep blue glass and glowing light, for long, focused sessions.
- **Technozen**: calm and minimal, soft sage, very little shine.
- **DORFic**: playful and futuristic, the glossiest of the five, early-2000s blue.
- **Four Colors**: clean and colourful; each room on the Menu gets a bright tile of its own, blue, green, orange or purple.

All five are glass and light: cards a little see-through over soft glows, a bright edge and a sheen across their tops, and a shine on the top half of every button. It is drawn with colour alone, no blur and no photographs, so a phone does no extra work to scroll it. Choose one and the row says so ("Frutiger Eco chosen") and opens on it next time. The rooms, the people and the rules are the same as in Classic, and the desk's colour squares work in these too.

Two things are measured for every one of them, on top of what every look is held to: a button's words still read on the brightest part of its shine, and words on a glass card still read over every glow behind it (`tests/themes-are-readable.mjs`). `tests/e2e/frutiger-aero-looks.js` walks the row and all five looks on a phone and a computer.

Your desk's colours, in every look



The desk drawer on a phone, under Focus, with Warm Office chosen: the page, the cards and the drawer turn a warm dark brown.

The colour squares on your desk work in every look. Asked for on 4 October 2026, with a picture of the Office squares on the desk: "This colors doesnt work for other Themes in settings, please integrate it too". Under Beacon, Study and Focus the look used to paint over them, so pressing one changed nothing.

- **The first square is the look's own colours**, called "Focus's own" (or Beacon's, or Study's). It is chosen until you choose another.

- **The others recolour the look**: the page, the cards, the desk, the top bar and the buttons. Guides and leadership have the four Office colours; Explorers have the five Study colours.
- **Each look keeps its own light or dark.** In Focus, Warm Office is a warm evening brown, not cream; in Beacon, Slate is a cool light grey-blue, not dark. That is on purpose. Each look also has colours of its own (a pale red for a warning, a gold badge) chosen to be read on its own light or dark. A first version put the colours on exactly as they are, and a cream colour under Focus left that pale red at 1.5 to 1, unreadable. So every colour keeps the brightness the look gives it, and everything reads as well as it does in the look itself. Each square shows exactly what you will get.
- **Each look remembers its own choice**, on this device. Classic's choice is Classic's, as it always was.

`lib/room-theme.ts` does the work; `tests/room-colours-keep-the-look-light.mjs` checks every look against every colour, and `tests/e2e/room-colours-in-every-look.js` walks it on a computer and a phone.

Text keeps its contrast in every look. Measuring each look's own colours on the busiest screens on 4 October 2026 found a few places where a light box kept its white under Focus while its text turned pale: *What's new*, *Send feedback* and *Share Beacon* in Settings, the *Which Beacon is this* box, and the Pocket's remove button, all at about 1.1 to 1. They now take their colours the same way the rest of the app does, so every look recolours them, and `tests/text-and-ground-change-together.mjs` refuses a new one.

Notifications

The bell in the header holds both the list and its switch. Alerts in the app are **on by default**.

Pressing one opens what it is about. A safeguarding notice opens the Safeguarding room for a Director and the Cases room for anybody who has been called to one; a prayer notice opens the prayer card; an approval opens Approvals. It also marks the notice read, which it always did — before tonight that was *all* it did, so the bold went away and the person was left on whatever screen they were already on with no idea where to go.

They pop up on the device, not only in the list. Tap **Turn on device alerts**, allow it when the browser asks, and one appears straight away so you can see it worked. After that, anything new reaches the notification tray on your phone or computer while Beacon is open in a tab or installed, and tapping it opens the app on the right screen.

At most three pop up at once. Somebody coming back to eleven unread things needs to be told, not buried, so the rest stay on the badge.

You are told when you arrive, not only while you are watching. Signing in, or coming back to the app after being offline, checks what is waiting and says so. Before this, an alert only ever appeared if you happened to be looking at the app the moment it was created, so somebody who closed their laptop on Friday and opened it on Sunday was greeted by a silent screen with a number on a bell they had no reason to look at.

If several things arrived while you were away, you get one line saying how many rather than a stack of pop-ups.

NOTE

What is not built

A notification when Beacon is **completely closed** needs a push service and a signing key held on a server, which this church does not have set up. The app is ready for it: the service worker already handles a push and a tap. Until those keys exist, alerts arrive while Beacon is open in a tab or running as an installed app, which for a phone with the icon on the home screen is most of the time.

Device alerts are the browser's to grant: the panel offers to ask once, and if a browser has already refused it says where to change that rather than offering a button that would do nothing. Once granted, the panel says so, because the only other way to know it worked was to wait for one.

CHAPTER 8

Settings, looks and reading comfort

From `docs/guides/using/02-settings-and-looks.md`

IN THIS CHAPTER

The folders in Settings 69
Making the words bigger 70
Choosing a look 70
Your desk's colours 71
Alerts 71
Language 71
Movement, and reduce motion 71
Installing, from Settings 72
Every look, side by side 72
Every look, on a phone 73
Every look, on a computer 78

Everything that is about **this device and this account**, rather than about the church, is in **Settings**: the last room in the Menu, under *You*. This chapter goes through it folder by folder, then shows every look the app has, on a phone and on a computer, so you can choose one before you try it.

The folders in Settings

Folder	Who has it	What is in it
General	Everybody	Installing the app, alerts, **Text size**, **Look**, and language
Password	Everybody, in a church's own app	Changing your password. First for anybody who arrived on a password sent by email
Admin Reports	Everybody, in a church's own app	Any report or case you are part of, so it is never out of reach
Church	Directors	The church's name, and its data
Help	Everybody	**Start a tutorial**, what is new, **Send feedback**, and where to find help

The sample church has General, Church and Help; a church's own app adds Password and Admin Reports, because those only mean something with real accounts behind them.

Making the words bigger

1. Open **Settings**. You are in **General**.
2. Under **Text size**, tap a larger size. The preview underneath shows it first, on a sample of real text.
3. When it reads well, tap **Apply**. Every screen follows, conversations included. **Keep Normal** leaves it as it was.

Text size belongs to the device, not to your account: a phone can have large words while your computer stays at Normal. It is kept when the app updates.

GOOD TO KNOW

For somebody who finds reading on a phone hard

Choose the largest size, then the **Study** look (warm paper, dark ink), and hold the phone on its side in a conversation. Every screen is built to still fit at the largest size; if one does not, that is a fault worth reporting.

Choosing a look

A **look** changes the colours and shapes of the whole app. It never changes the rooms, the people, what anybody can see, or where any button is. The choice is kept on this device only, and **Classic** always takes you back.

1. Open **Settings**, stay in **General**, and find **Look**.
2. Tap **Classic**, **Beacon**, **Study** or **Focus**.
3. Or tap the **Frutiger Aero** row to open five more, each with a picture and a line about it, and tap the one you like.

Look	What it is like	A good choice for
Classic	The app as it was first drawn: navy and gold, clear and plain	Everybody; it is the default
Beacon	Bright sky and blue accents, room cards easy to spot	A bright room, or people who like colour
Study	Warm paper and brown ink	Long reading, and tired eyes
Focus	A night sky: dark surfaces, pale blue accents	Evenings, and dim rooms
Frutiger Eco	Sky, water and leaves; clean and fresh	A light, cheerful look
Dark Aero	Deep blue glass and glowing light	Long, focused sessions in the evening
Technozen	Calm and minimal, soft sage, very little shine	People who find busy screens tiring
DORFic	Playful and futuristic, the glossiest of all	Younger groups, and fun
Four Colors	A bright colour for each room	Finding rooms by colour at a glance

Every look is checked before each release: words on a button must still be readable on the brightest part of its shine, and text must keep its contrast on every card. If you find a place where it does not, use **Send feedback**.

Your desk's colours

Guides and leaders have a **desk**: on a computer it is down the right-hand side; on a phone it is a drawer, opened from the small cabinet on the right edge. The colour squares at its top recolour the whole app, in every look:

- **The first square is the look's own colours.** Choose it to go back.
- **The others recolour the page, the cards, the desk and the buttons**, while keeping the look light or dark. Under Focus, *Warm Office* is a warm evening brown rather than cream, so nothing becomes hard to read.
- **Each look remembers its own choice**, on this device.

Alerts

The **bell** at the top holds your alerts and their switch. Alerts are on by default. Tapping one opens what it is about and marks it read.

To have them appear on your phone or computer like any other app's, tap **Turn on device alerts** and allow it when the browser asks. One appears straight away, so you can see it worked. After that, anything new reaches your notification tray while Hope Beacon is open or installed.

> **NOTE**
> When the app is completely closed
>
> Alerts reach a phone while the app is open, or installed and running. Alerts to a phone where the app is fully closed need a push service that each church sets up for itself; the companion guide explains it.

Language

The app can be shown in English, Spanish, Portuguese, French, German, Italian, Tagalog and Cebuano. English is complete; the others translate the app's main words, titles and buttons, and fall back to English for the longer sentences until a native speaker has reviewed them. Choose yours in **General**.

Movement, and reduce motion

Panels unfold from the button that opened them, and a new folder fades in. If movement on a screen makes you dizzy, turn on **Reduce motion** in your phone's or computer's own accessibility settings: Hope Beacon follows it everywhere, and panels simply appear.

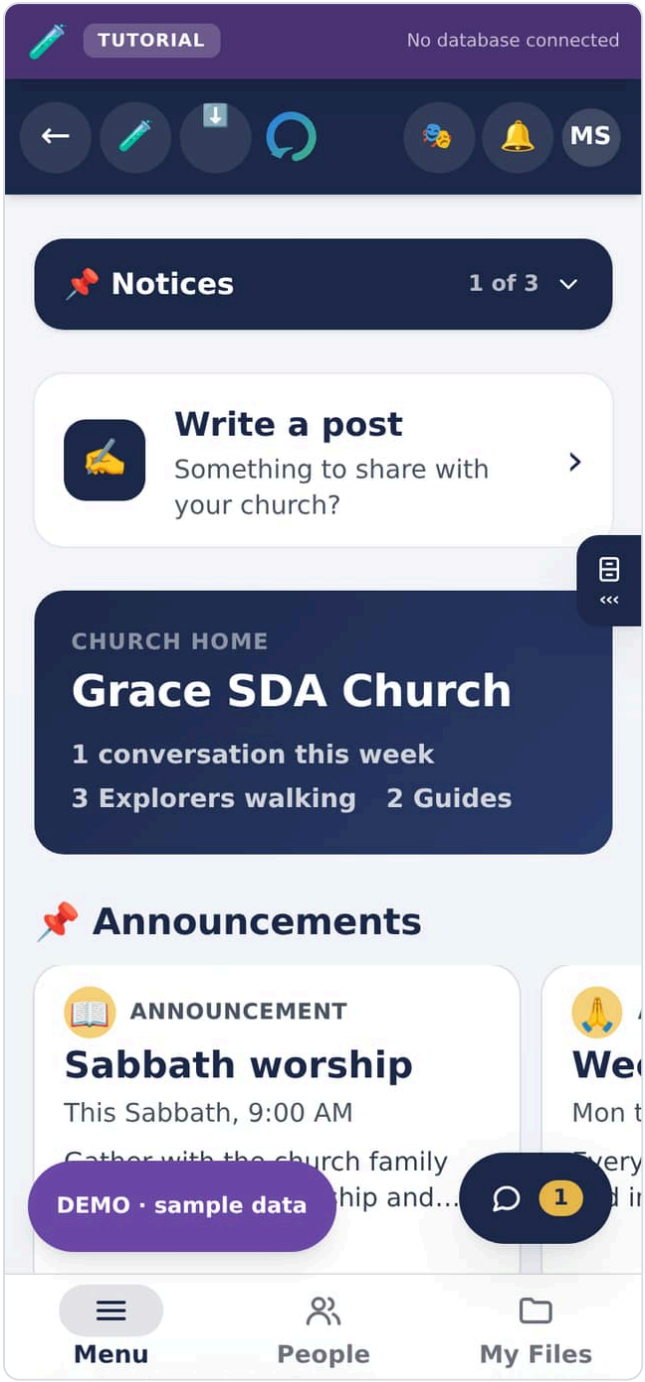
Installing, from Settings

The **General** folder has the steps for installing the app on the device you are holding, worked out for that device: Safari on an iPhone or iPad, Chrome on Android, or a computer. They are written out in full in *Getting it on your phone*.

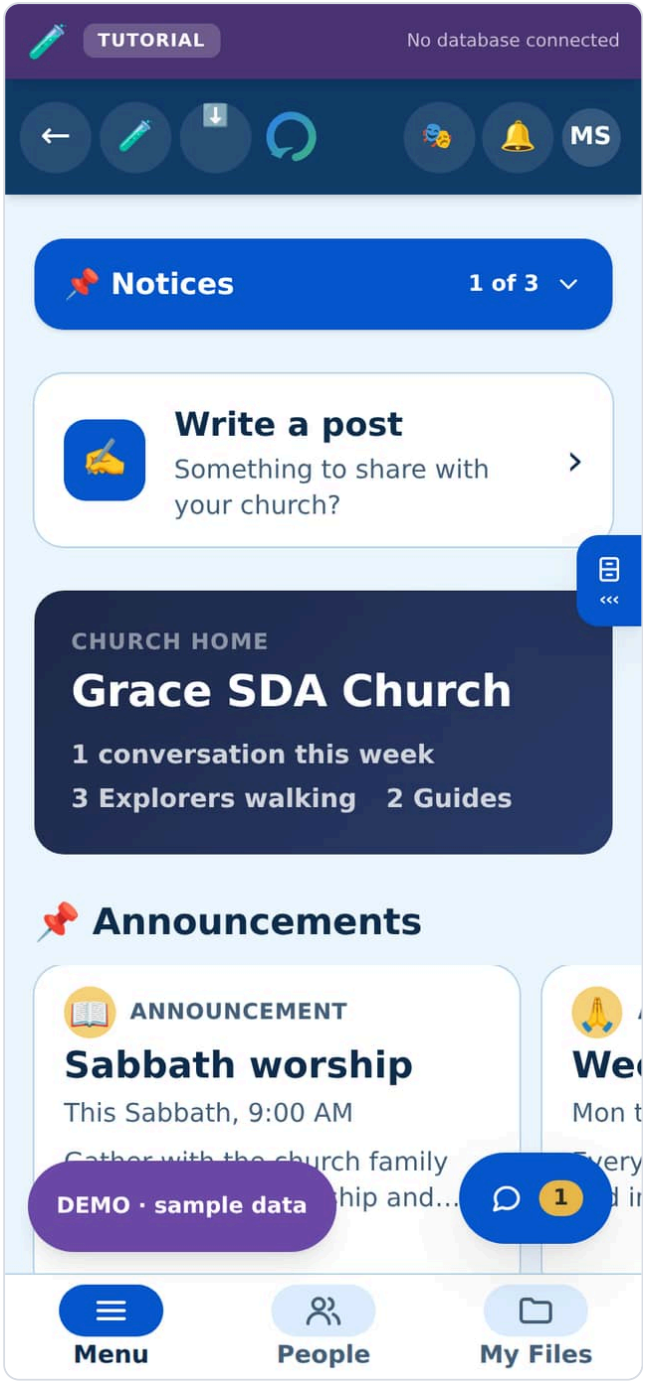
Every look, side by side

The pages that follow show the same screen, a Guide's **Home**, in each look, first on a phone and then on a computer, so the difference you see is the look alone.

Every look, on a phone

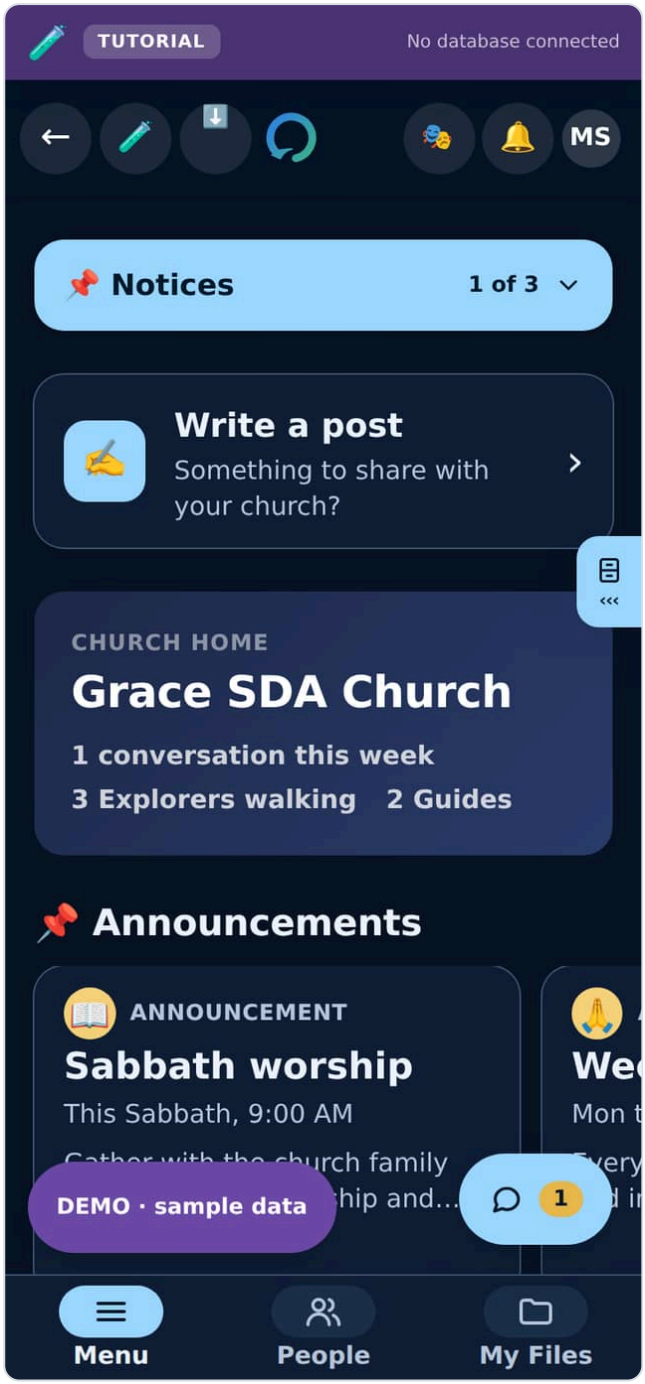


The Classic look, on a phone

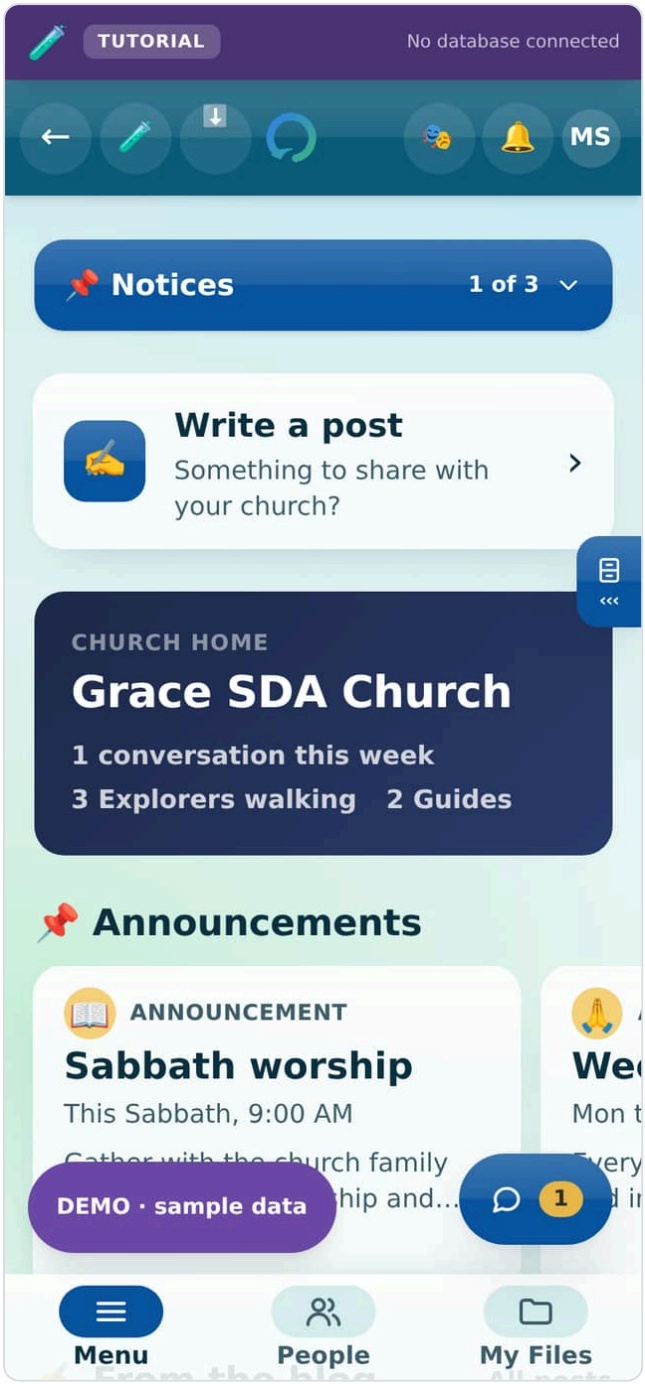


The Beacon look, on a phone

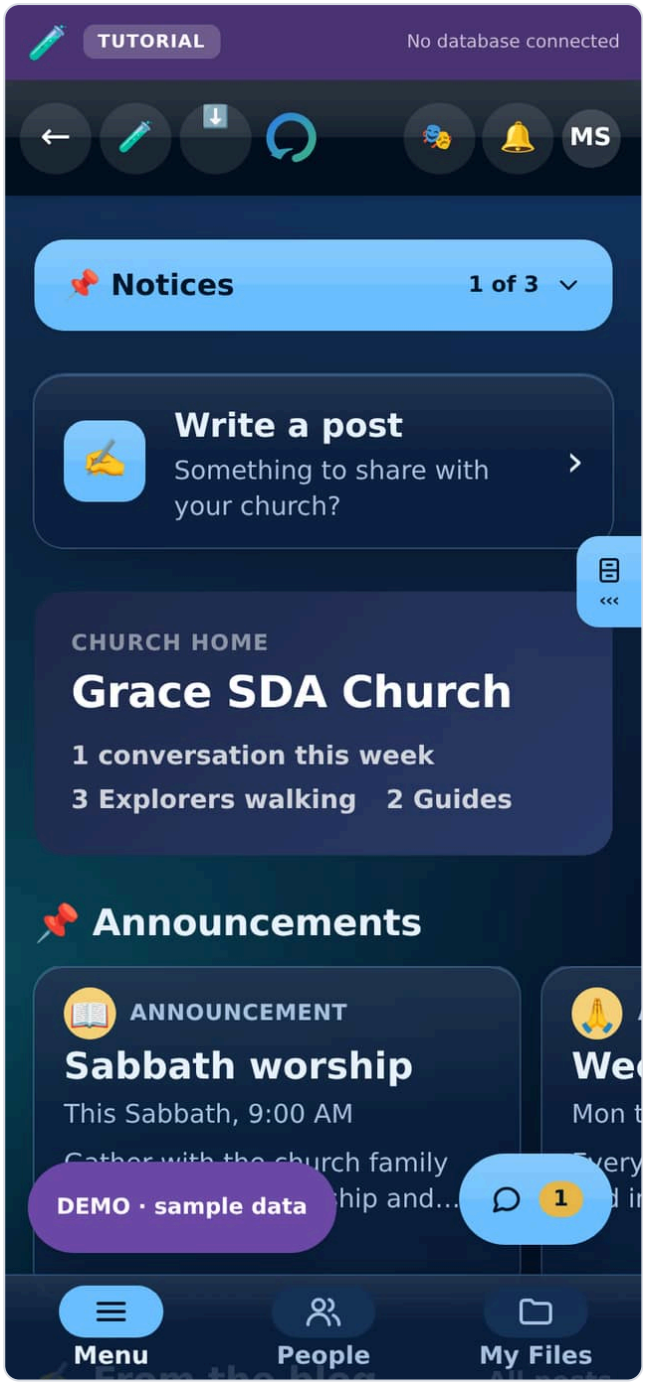
The Study look, on a phone



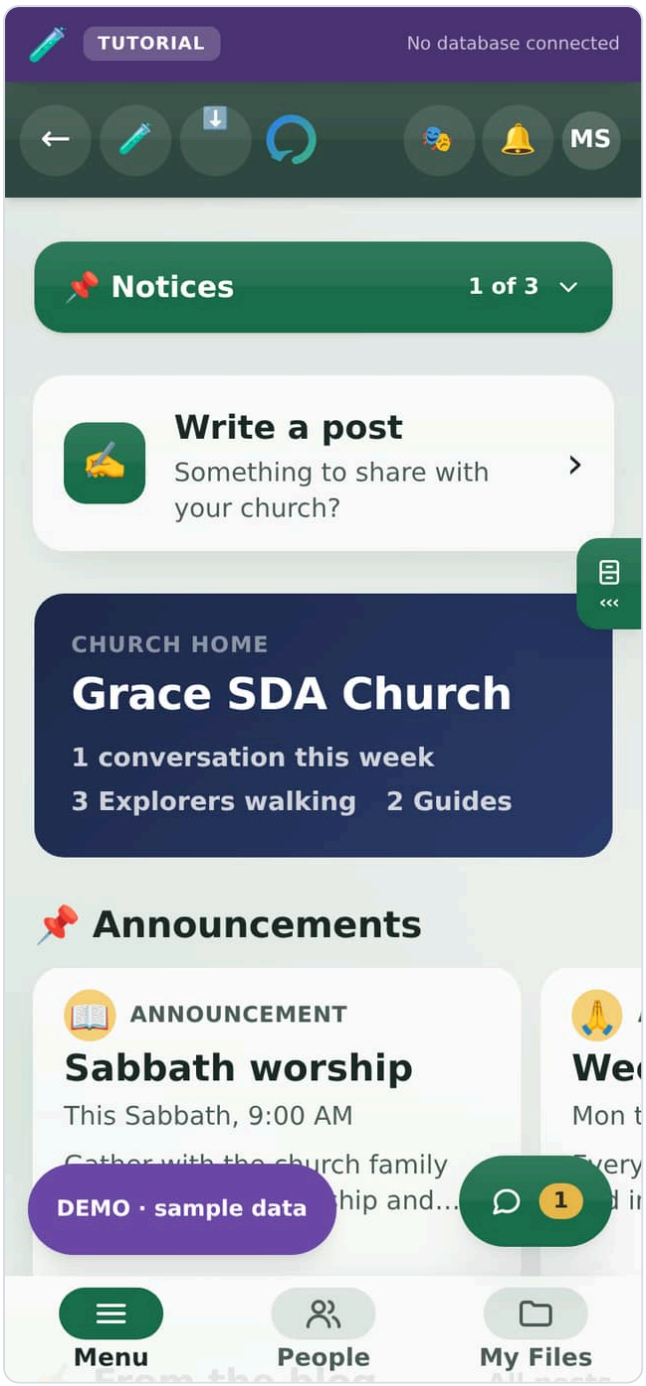
The Focus look, on a phone



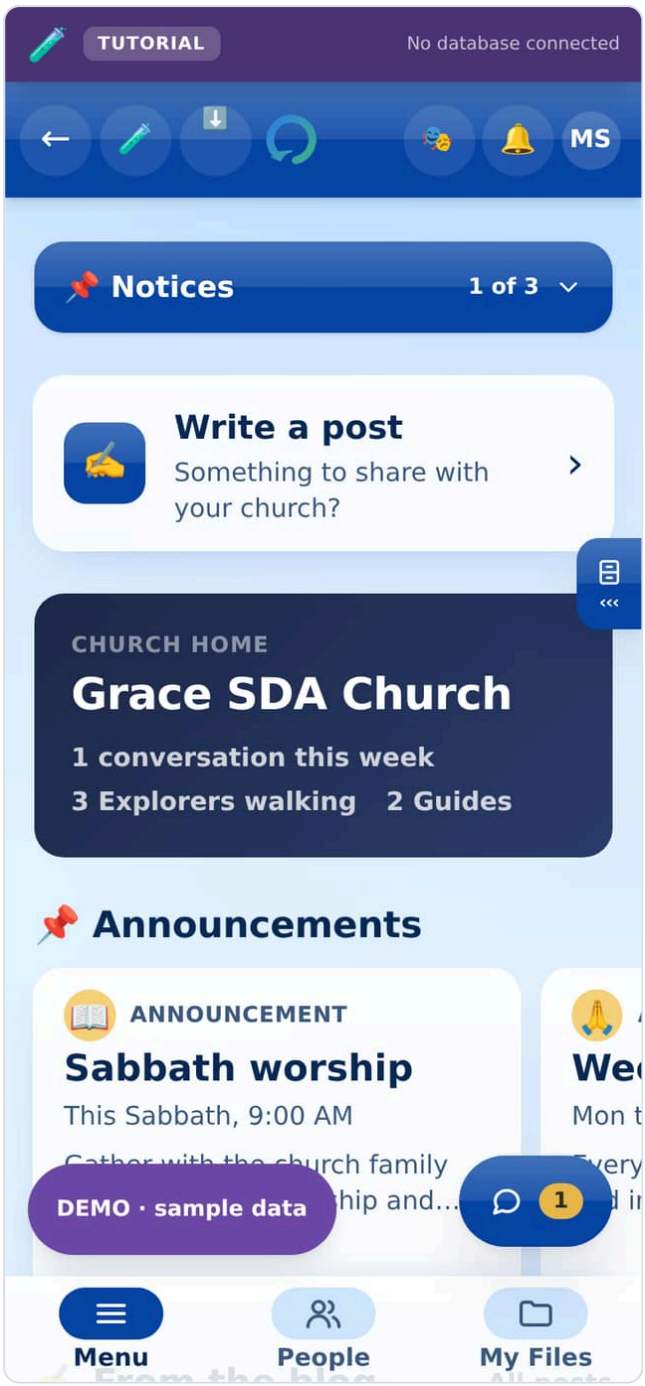
The Frutiger Eco look, on a phone



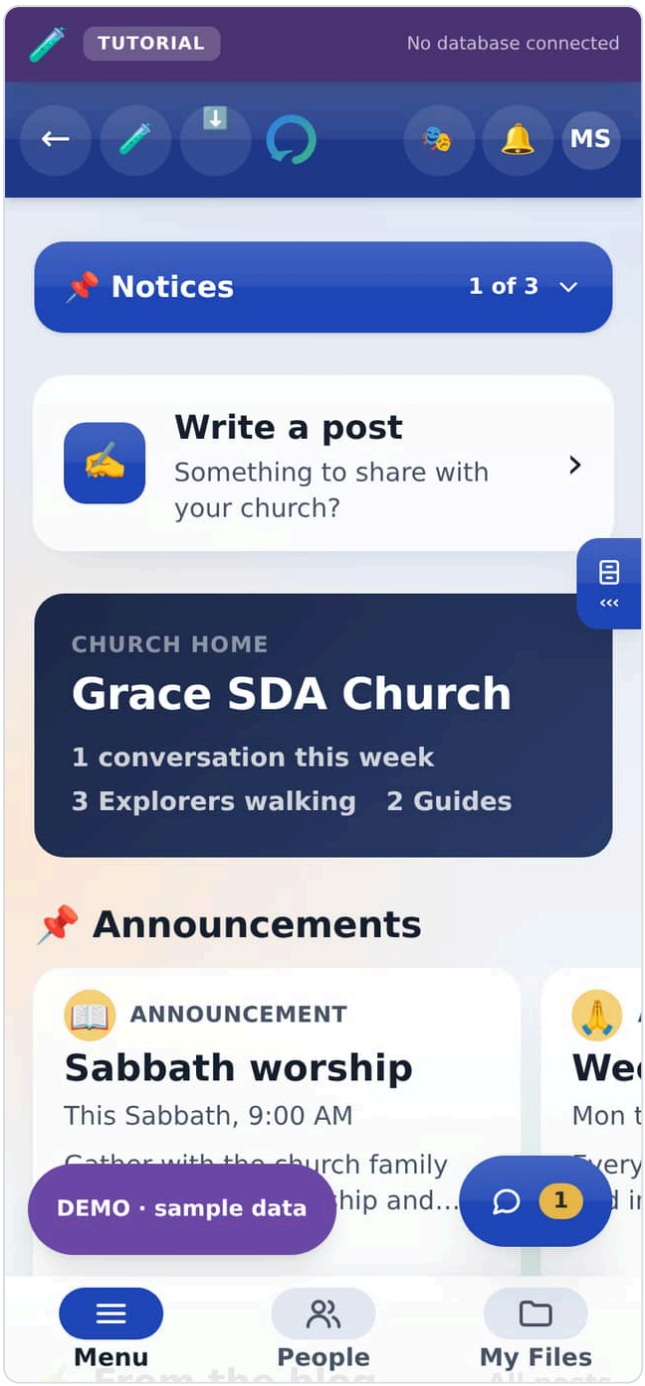
The Dark Aero look, on a phone



The Technozen look, on a phone

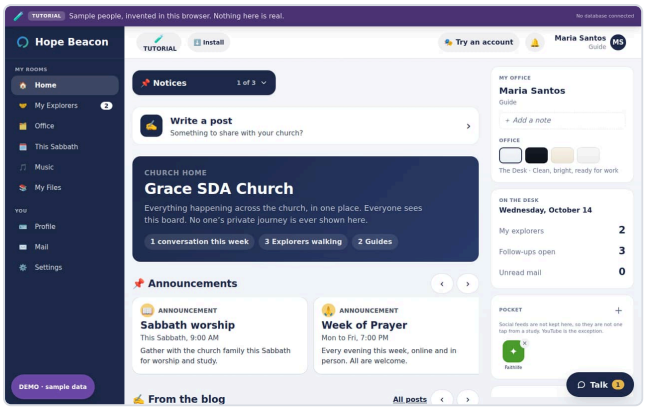


The DORFic look, on a phone

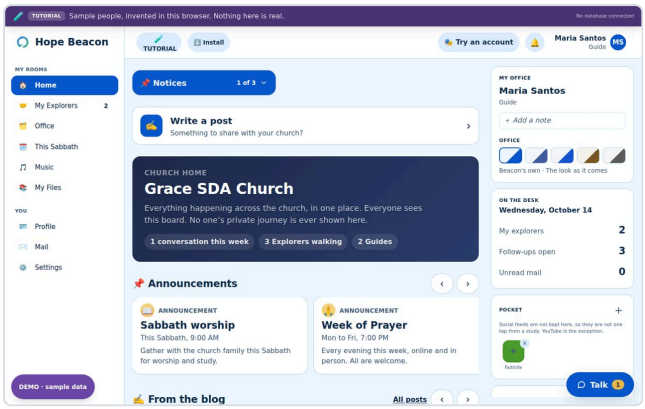


The Four Colors look, on a phone

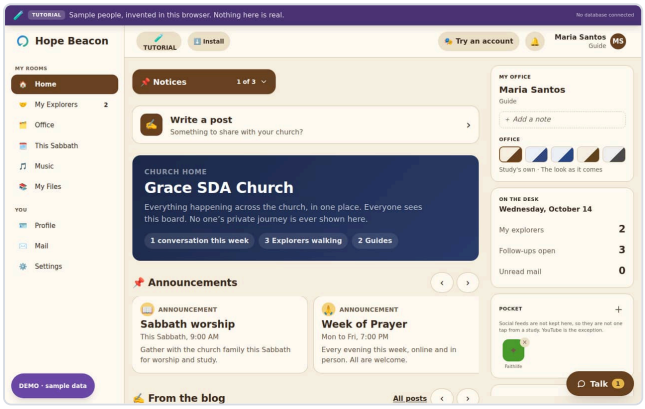
Every look, on a computer



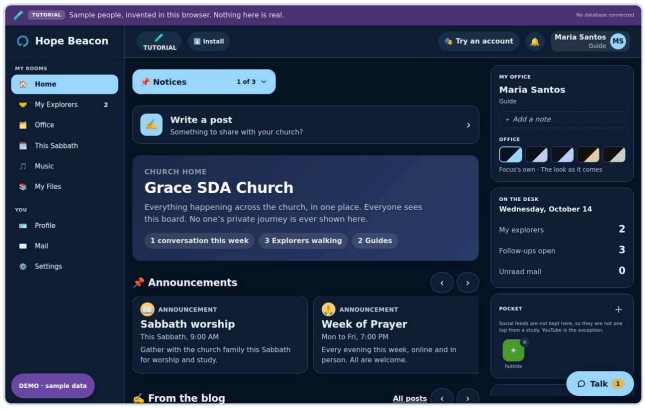
The Classic look, on a computer



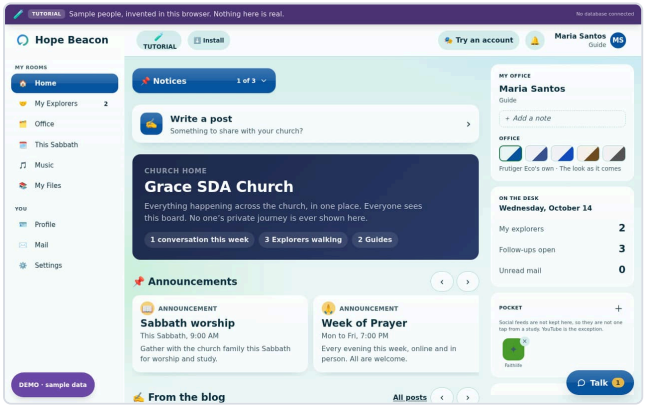
The Beacon look, on a computer



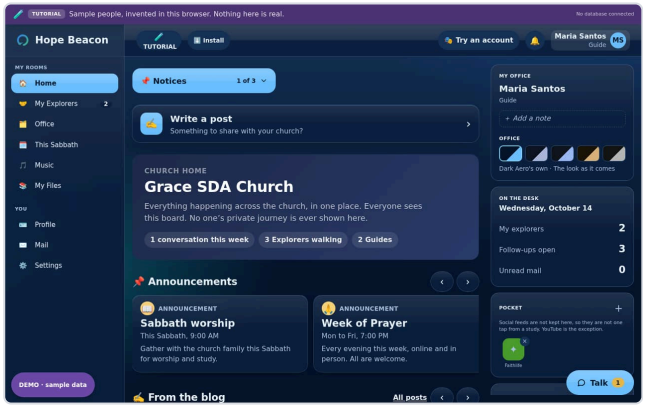
The Study look, on a computer



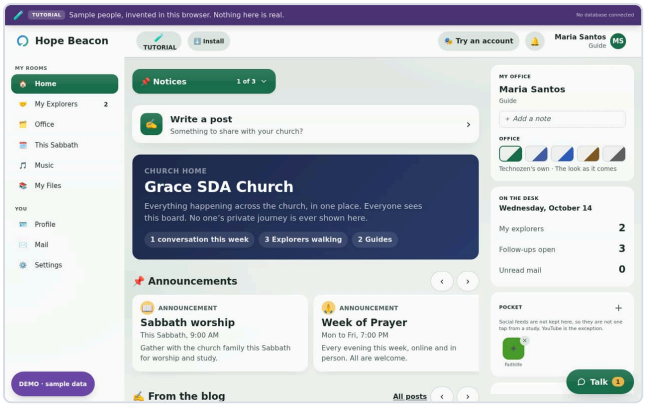
The Focus look, on a computer



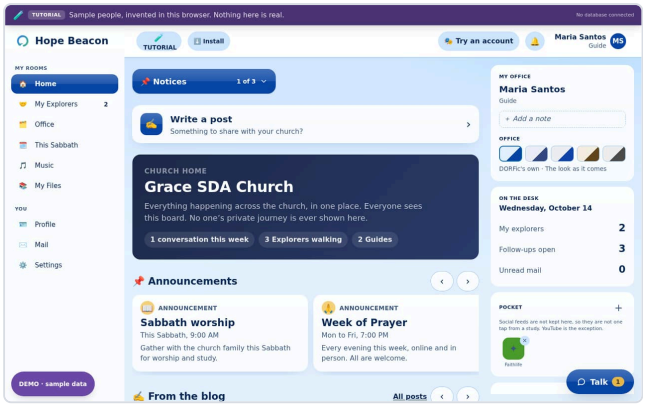
The Frutiger Eco look, on a computer



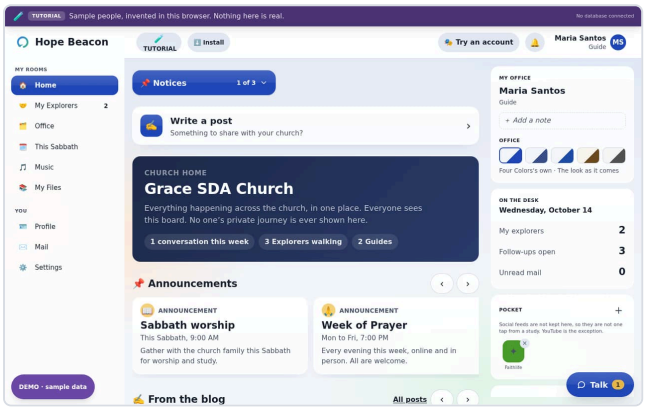
The Dark Aero look, on a computer



The Technozen look, on a computer



The DORFic look, on a computer



The Four Colors look, on a computer

CHAPTER 9

Which platforms this runs on

From `docs/PLATFORMS.md`

IN THIS CHAPTER

Running the app 80
Building and contributing 81
The iOS caveat, stated properly 81
Version floors 81
What is not supported, and will not be 82

The short answer: any current phone or computer, and it installs from the browser with no app store on any of them.

The longer answer separates **what has been tested** from **what is expected to work**, because those are not the same thing and a document that blurs them is worse than no document.

Running the app

Platform	State	How we know
Chrome, Edge, Brave (desktop)	**Tested**	Every end-to-end walk runs in Chromium on each push.
Android (Chrome)	**Tested**	`tests/e2e/mobile-devices.js` runs at Pixel 5 size with touch input and a real file attachment.
iPhone and iPad (Safari)	**Expected, engine not tested**	Layout and touch are covered at iPhone size; Safari's own engine is not run here. See below.
Firefox	**Expected, not tested**	No known blockers. Nothing in the app uses a Chromium-only API. Firefox on a computer cannot INSTALL a web app; the app says so rather than offering steps that fail.
Samsung Internet, Opera, Vivaldi, Hola and other Chromium browsers	**Install steps tested, engine not tested**	`tests/e2e/install-every-browser.js` loads Settings under each browser's real identifier and checks the steps shown are that browser's. The engine underneath is Chromium in every case, which IS tested; the shell around it is not run here.
Windows / macOS / Linux	**Tested**	CI runs the full static suite on all three.

Building and contributing

Platform	State	How we know
Linux	**Tested**	CI.
Windows	**Tested**	CI, since it caught a real failure — see below.
macOS	**Tested**	CI.

Everything you need is Node 22 and npm. Every script in `package.json` is `node scripts/<something>.mjs` — no shell built-ins, no `rm`, no environment variables set inline — so the same command works in PowerShell, cmd, bash and zsh without a compatibility layer.

The iOS caveat, stated properly

iPhones and iPads run **WebKit**, and no other engine is permitted on them. Our test browser is Chromium. Running Chromium with an iPhone's screen size, pixel ratio and touch input catches the things that break phones in practice — content pushed off screen, tap targets too small for a thumb, horizontal scrolling, features that quietly need a mouse — and that is what `mobile-devices.js` does.

It does **not** catch WebKit engine differences, and pretending otherwise would be the kind of claim this project exists to avoid. Two specific iOS behaviours were found by reading the code rather than by testing, and both are now fixed:

- **Video would have gone fullscreen.** iOS pulls a `<video>` out of the page and plays it over everything unless `playsInline` is set. An attached video would have thrown the reader out of the conversation. Desktop testing would never have shown this.
- **Attaching a file would have thrown on plain http.** `crypto.randomUUID()` is a secure-context API: it is undefined over `http://` on a LAN address — which is exactly how a church tries something on its own machine first — and absent before Safari 15.4. It now falls back instead of throwing.

Before a church commits to iOS, open it on a real iPhone and try four things: attach a photo, play an attached video, add it to the home screen, and use it with the wifi off. If you can, try one of those in a Private tab too — Safari restricts storage there and the app should degrade rather than break.

Version floors

Nothing here is exotic, but these are the honest minimums:

Feature	Needs	If older
Live sync between windows	`BroadcastChannel` — Safari 15.4+, Chrome 54+	Silently off. The app works, windows just do not update each other.
Attachments	IndexedDB	The attachment is refused and removed rather than left broken.
Install to home screen	Safari 11.3+, Chrome 68+	Runs as a normal web page.
Offline use	Service workers, and **https** (or localhost)	Over plain http it works online only.

That last row is the one that surprises people. **Service workers require a secure context.** A church serving this over `http://` on its own network gets a working app with no offline support, and no error explaining why.

What is not supported, and will not be

- **Internet Explorer.** No.
- **A native app in the App Store or Play Store.** There isn't one, and that is the point: no review queue, no gatekeeper, and updates arrive the next time somebody opens it. The trade is that there is no store listing to be found in, so distribution is a link you send.
- **Syncing between two devices without a backend.** Live sync is between windows on one device. Two phones need a server to sync through; see `docs/BACKENDS.md`.

PART III

A tour, role by role

The app as each person meets it. Read the part for your own role first; the others are there when you want to know what somebody else sees.

10 If you are an Explorer 84

11 How to use the Study Room 93

12 If you are a Guide 99

13 If you are a Director 115

14 The guided walk 117

CHAPTER 10

If you are an Explorer

From `docs/HOW-TO-USE.md`

IN THIS CHAPTER

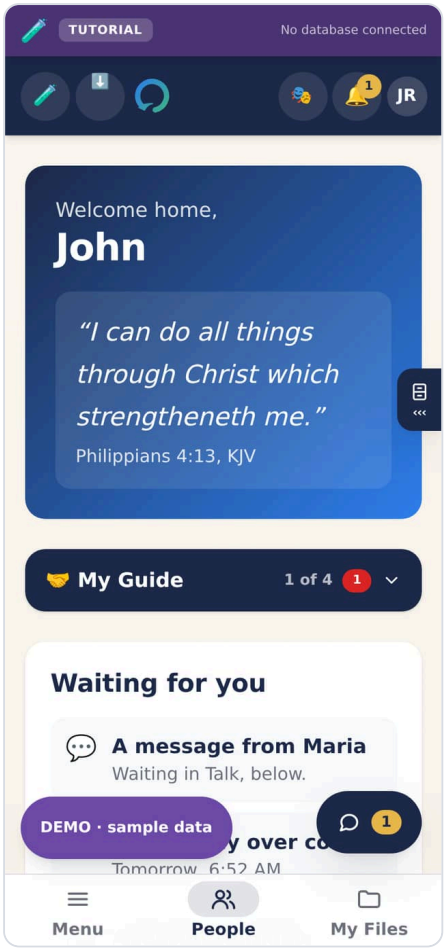
My Guide 84
Talking with your Guide 85
Study 88
Church 89
Prayer 90
Your shelf 91

An Explorer is somebody the church is walking with. You have one Guide, and the app is built around that one relationship.

Your screen has four folders: **My Guide**, **Study**, **Church** and **Prayer**. Tap the button at the top to go straight to one. You never have to scroll a long page looking for something.

My Guide

Your Guide, and anything waiting from them. Your conversation with them is the round **Talk** button in the corner of every screen, with a number on it when they have written. It is private between the two of you. Church leaders cannot read it.



My Guide. What is waiting for you, and a reminder of where the conversation is.

Talking with your Guide

Type in the box at the bottom and press the arrow. The paper clip sends a photo or a file.

Tap a message to react to it or reply to it. Holding it does the same.

Tap a message: six reactions along the top, then Reply and Copy. Edit and Delete appear on your own messages.

- **React** with one tap. The praying hands come first, because that is the one people reach for most. Tap the same one again to take it back.
- **Reply** to answer one message in particular. Your answer carries a quote of it. Swiping a message to the right does the same.

A reply, with the message it answers quoted above it. The praying hands under the earlier message are a reaction.

Say it instead of typing it. When the box is empty, the button beside it is a microphone. Tap it once and speak; the phone asks for the microphone the first time. Tap the arrow to send, or the bin to throw it away. It stops at two minutes and never sends on its own.

Recording a voice message. The clock counts while you speak; the bin throws it away, the arrow sends it.

> **If you do not see Reply, the reactions or the microphone**, your church has not switched them on yet. Everything else in the conversation works the same.

Study

The lessons your Guide has sent you, in the order they sent them. There is no schedule and nothing you are behind on. Open one, read it, and mark it done when you have finished.

Study. Your lessons, at your own pace.

Church

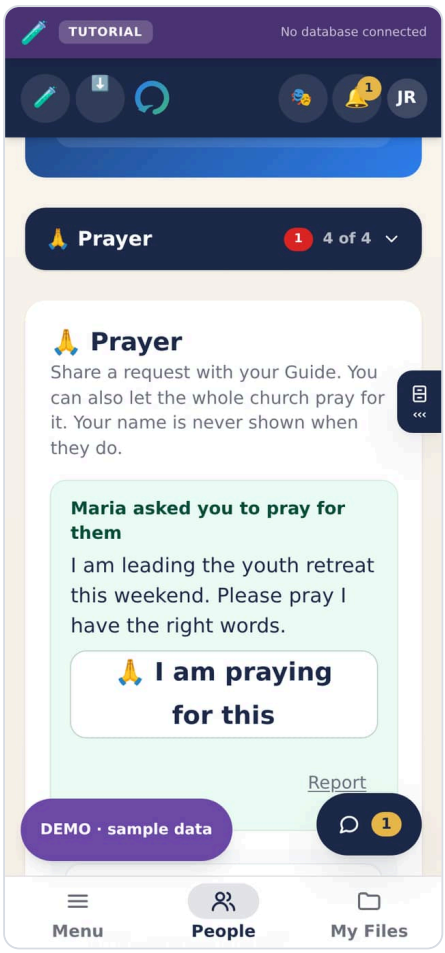
What the whole church is saying: notices, and anything the Guides have written for everybody. You can read it without owing anyone a reply.

Church. Notices and writing from the church, in your own time.

Prayer

Ask for prayer. By default your request goes to your Guide alone. If you tick the box, the whole church can pray for it, and **your name is never shown when they do**.

Your Guide can ask you to pray for them too. It shows at the top of Prayer. Press **I am praying for this** and they are told. If something in it worries you, **Report** is on the same card.

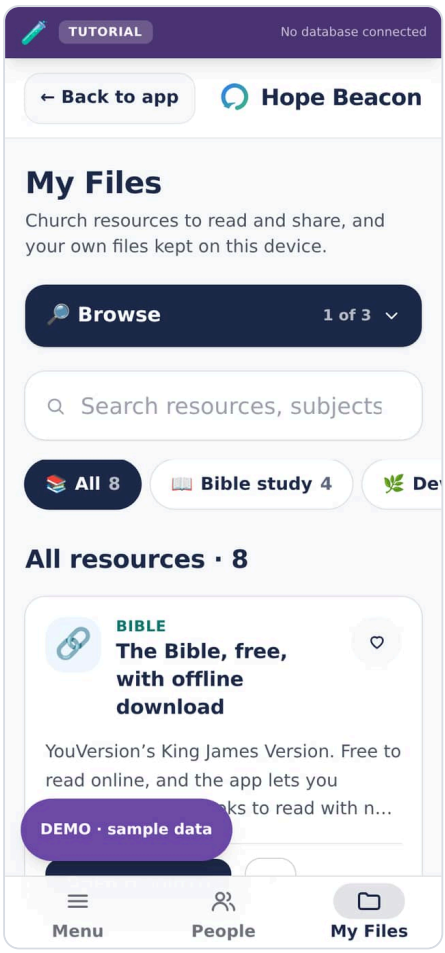


Prayer. Your request goes to your Guide unless you choose otherwise.

Your shelf

Eight things to read and watch, in the order we would hand them to you. A Bible you can read on a phone, then Jesus, then a way into studying for yourself, and then what this church teaches.

Nothing is hidden. Everything your Guide can see, you can find too. This is simply where we would start.



The shelf. Eight resources, and it opens with a Bible and with Jesus.

Tap the heart on anything to keep it on your own device, so it opens with no signal.

CHAPTER 11

How to use the Study Room

From `docs/STUDY-ROOM.md`

IN THIS CHAPTER

Opening it, and leaving it 93
Simple and Advanced 93
The shelf 94
Writing on a page 94
Looking after your pages 95
Saving, and what to do if it says it has not saved 96
Who can see what you write 96
Tags, and finding things later 96
Folders and saved views 97
The journal: a page for each day 97
The whiteboard 97
Pictures, tables, databases and the rest 98
The one thing that does not work properly 98
If you get stuck 98

For Explorers. Everything in here is yours.

The Study Room is your own place to write while you read. It is not a chat, it is not shared, and nobody is waiting for you to finish anything in it.

Opening it, and leaving it

Tap 📖 **Study Room** in My Rooms. It fills the whole screen, because it is a room rather than a box on a page.

To leave, tap **← Hope Beacon** at the top left. That puts you back in the app exactly where the rest of your journey is. Nothing is lost by leaving; there is no Save button anywhere in this room and there does not need to be.

Simple and Advanced

The room starts **Simple**: your pages, **+ New page**, search, and the **Bin**. On a page you get its name, the writing, and four things to add: a heading, a list, a to-do and a quote. That is all most people need, and it is all a new Explorer is shown.

Tap **Advanced**, under the room's name, for everything else: **Starred** and the **Journal**, folders, tags and saved views, the star on each page, the **whiteboard**, the rest of the things you can add to a page, and taking your pages to and from Obsidian. Tap **Simple** to put them away again.

The choice is remembered on that phone or computer. Switching never hides or changes anything you have written: a page you filed in a folder or tagged in Advanced keeps its folder and tags, they are only out of sight in Simple. The rest of this guide describes Advanced where it mentions those.

In **Focus** and **Dark Aero**, the looks with a dark page, the writing on a page is light. Until 7 October 2026 it stayed almost black, on almost black.

The shelf

The room opens on your pages rather than on a page, the same way the Library opens on books.

Each row is one page and shows its name, the first line of what you have written on it, and when you last wrote in it. Tap a row to open it.

The places are along the top on a phone and down the side on a bigger screen. Simple shows the first and the last; Advanced shows all four:

All pages	Everything you have, newest writing first
Starred	The ones you tap the star on (Advanced)
Journal	A page for each day (Advanced)
Bin	Pages you have put away

Search looks at both the name and the words on the page, so you can find a page by something you remember writing on it even if you never named it.

+ New page starts a fresh one and opens it straight away.

Your pages are grouped by when you last wrote in them: Today, Yesterday, Earlier this week, This month, Older. That is usually how you are looking for them.

Writing on a page

The first line is the **name of the page**. Type there to name it; the name is what you will see on the shelf and in search. You can leave it blank and name it later.

Below that is the page itself. Start typing.

Type `/` for anything that is not a plain sentence

Press the `/` key on a line and a menu opens. This is the one thing worth remembering, because everything else lives behind it:

- **Heading 1, 2, 3** for the parts of a study
- **Bulleted list** and **Numbered list**
- **To-do** for things to come back to, with a box you can tick
- **Quote** for a verse or a line from a book
- **Divider** to separate one day from the next
- **Table** for a comparison
- **Callout** for something you want to stand out
- **Today**, **Tomorrow**, **Yesterday** to drop a date in
- **Image** and **Attachment** for a photograph or a file
- **Table view** and **Kanban** for a database you can sort and group
- **Equation** for mathematical notation
- **Linked doc** to point at another of your pages
- **Code block**, **Bookmark**, and the embeds

There are over four hundred entries in that menu, which is AFFiNE's whole list. Start typing after the `/` to narrow it, then press Enter.

Select words to format them

Highlight any words and a small bar appears with **bold**, *italic*, underline, strikethrough, inline code, a link, and text colour. The same bar can turn a paragraph into a heading or a list.

On a phone, the bar sits above the on-screen keyboard while you are typing.

Keyboard shortcuts, if you are on a computer

Bold	Ctrl+B (Cmd+B on a Mac)
Italic	Ctrl+I
Underline	Ctrl+U
Link	Ctrl+K
Undo	Ctrl+Z

Looking after your pages

Star a page with the star at the end of its row and it appears in Starred. Tap again to unstar it.

Move to bin — the bin at the end of a page's row — takes a page off the shelf without destroying it. It waits in the Bin until you decide.

Put it back returns a page from the Bin to All pages.

Delete forever lives only in the Bin, is the only red button in the room, and asks you once before it does anything. After that the page is gone and cannot be recovered.

Saving, and what to do if it says it has not saved

Your writing saves itself as you go. There is nothing to press.

If something is wrong, the room tells you instead of pretending:

"Not saved yet" in red means your writing has not reached the church's database. Keep the page open. It keeps trying, and what you have written is still on the screen. When it gets through, the message disappears on its own. If it stays for more than a few minutes, it is almost always the connection.

"Your study room did not answer" means the app could not reach your pages at all when you opened it. Nothing has been lost; your pages are in the database and this device simply could not get to them. Tap **Try again**.

"Your saved pages are taking a while to arrive" means the room opened before everything had come back. What is on the screen is yours to read; give it a moment before you rely on new writing being kept.

Who can see what you write

Nobody. Not your Guide, not a Director, not the person who set up the app.

Your Guide can see **that** you have been working in your study room and **when** you last did. They cannot see the pages, the names of the pages, or a single word you have written. That is deliberate and it is enforced by the database rather than by a setting anybody can change.

Tags, and finding things later

A page can carry tags: **Romans**, **Sabbath**, **Prayer meeting**, whatever you would look for it by. Add them under the page's name, one at a time, pressing Enter or the comma key after each.

- The box **offers the tags you already use**, so you end up with one *Romans* rather than *Romans*, *romans* and *Romans 8*.
- On the shelf, every tag in your room is a row of buttons above the list. Tap one and the list narrows to it; tap **Every tag** to see them all again.
- The search box looks at tags as well as titles and words.

A page can have as many tags as you like, and the same page can sit under all of them. That is the point of tags rather than folders: a page about Romans 8 is about the book, the sermon it came from and the group it was written for, all at once, and a folder would make you pick one.

Folders and saved views

Three ways to find a page, and they are not the same thing.

A tag is what a page is *about*. A page can have as many as you like.

A folder is where you *put* it. One folder per page, and you never create one: type a name in the Folder box on a page and the folder exists because something is in it. When the last page leaves, it is gone.

- Folders appear as a row above the list. Tap one to see only what is in it.
- Start a new page while a folder is showing and it is filed there already.

A saved view is a *question* you keep. Narrow the shelf by a tag or a search, press **Save this view**, and give it a name.

- It keeps the question, not the pages. A page you write next week that matches it turns up in it without you doing anything.
- Forgetting a saved view does not touch a single page.

If you are not sure which to use: tag everything, make a folder when a study gets long enough that you want it in one place, and save a view when you find yourself typing the same search twice.

The journal: a page for each day

Journal (in the sidebar, or along the top on a phone) gives every day a page of its own. Press **Today's page** and you are writing in today.

- It is named for the day, in full, so you never have to name it.
- Pressing Today again **opens the same page**, not a new one, however many times you press it and whatever you have renamed it to.
- The journal is ordered by the day each page is about, so correcting last Sabbath's notes does not move them above this morning's.

It is meant for morning devotion, a sermon, a prayer that was answered: the things nobody names and everybody wants to find again.

The whiteboard

Every page can be looked at two ways, and the switch above the page says which: **Page** is the document, **Whiteboard** is the same page on an infinite canvas. It is one page, not two: there is nothing to copy across.

On the whiteboard you have shapes, arrows that stay attached to what they join, a pen, text anywhere you like, mindmaps and frames. It is for the things a column of text is bad at: how a passage is built, who is related to whom, a plan for a study on a wall.

Pictures, tables, databases and the rest

Everything AFFiNE can do, this room can do, because it is the same editor with the same set of blocks. Press `/` on a computer, or use the bar of buttons on a phone:

- **Pictures and files.** Put a photograph of a page straight into your notes. They are kept in the church's own database like everything else in your room, and they are still there tomorrow. There is a size limit of about one megabyte a picture, which is a generous photograph, because the database is shared by the whole church.
- **Tables**, and **databases** with a **table view** and a **kanban board** if you want to track a study across weeks.
- **Equations**, in proper mathematical notation.
- `@` **to link to another page** of yours, or to a date. A page that links to another shows the link at the bottom of the page it points at, so you can walk back the way you came.
- **Bookmarks and embeds**: a link laid out as a card, a YouTube video, and a whole page of yours embedded inside another.
- **Code**, if you ever want it.

The one thing that does not work properly

Code has no colours. The block works, keeps what you type and copies out fine, but the words are all one colour. The thing that colours them needs a permission this app's security rules do not grant, and widening that rule is a security decision rather than a styling one. Say the word if you want it and it will be put to you properly.

If you get stuck

Anything the room cannot do, it says on the screen. If a message here does not match what you are seeing, that is worth reporting: a screenshot of the room with the message in it is the fastest way to get it fixed.

CHAPTER 12

If you are a Guide

From `docs/HOW-TO-USE.md`

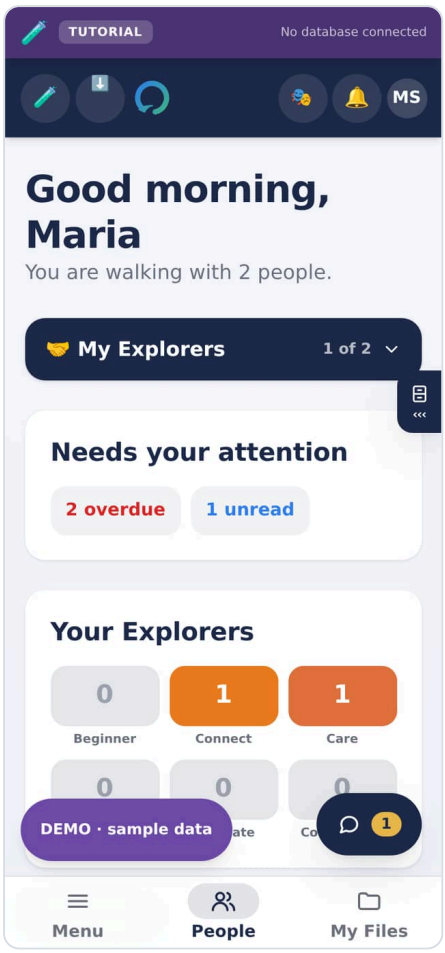
IN THIS CHAPTER

Your desk 99
Talking with somebody 100
Moving somebody along 101
The Office 102
Your progress report 103
The Sabbath program 105
Evangelistic meetings 107
On your calendar, and on your other devices 108
This Sabbath 109
Your desk drawer 110
Writing for the church 112

A Guide walks with up to the number of Explorers the church has set. It is a limit the app enforces, not a suggestion: somebody carrying forty names is not walking with anybody.

Your desk

Everyone you walk with, and what needs you today.



A Guide's desk. Who you walk with, and what is waiting.

Talking with somebody

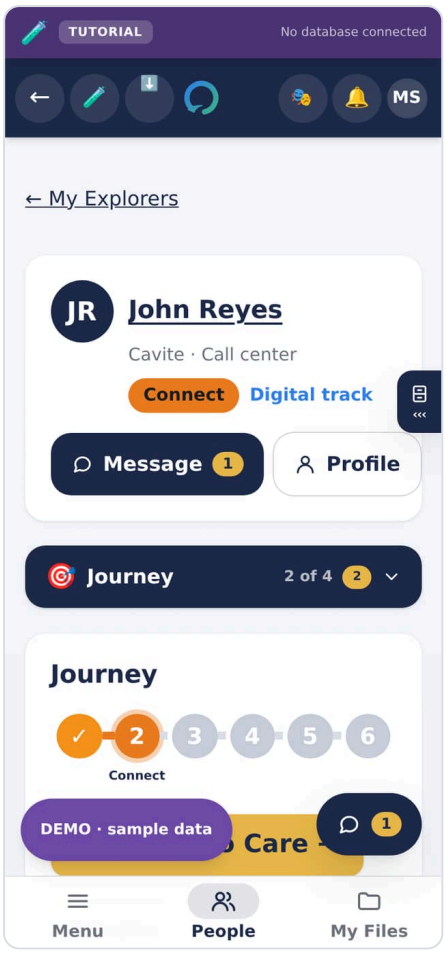
Open a person and press **Message**, or use the round **Talk** button in the corner. It is private between the two of you. You can attach a photograph or a file, and photographs are made smaller and have their location removed before they are sent. Replying, reacting and voice messages work as they do for an Explorer (Part 2).

A conversation. The line at the top says it: only the two people walking together can read it.

Prayer runs both ways. On a person's **Care** tab you can read what they asked and tell them you are praying, and ask them to pray for you. Only they see what you ask, and you see when they are praying for it.

Moving somebody along

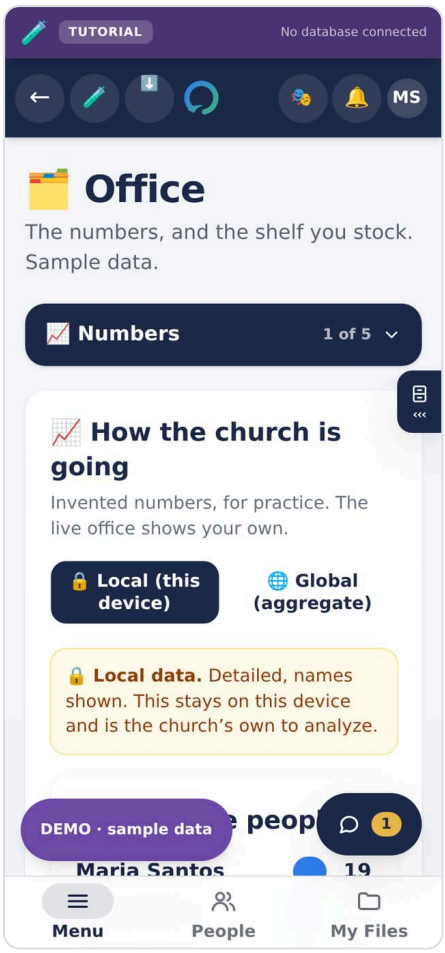
The Journey tab is where you record where somebody has reached, and send them the next lesson.



The journey. Where somebody has reached, and what comes next.

The Office

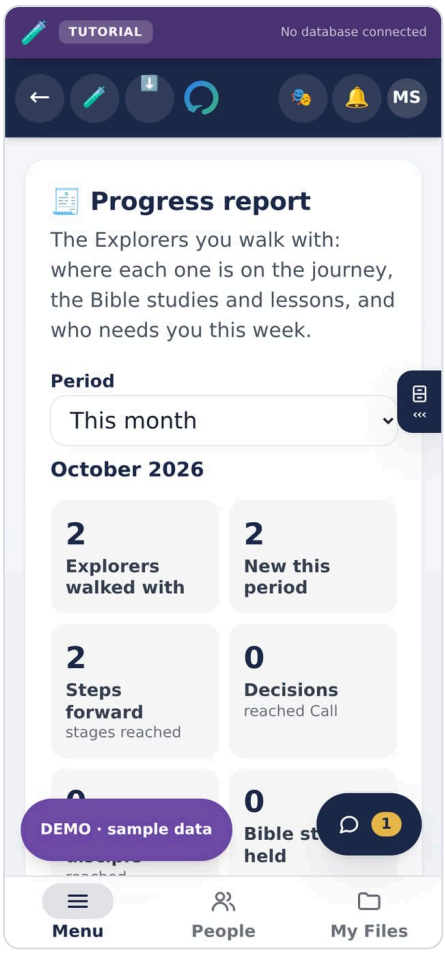
Everything that is your work rather than your conversation: lesson studies, the Sabbath program, evangelistic meetings, resources, the Guides' room, putting a name forward, and your progress report. Each is a subroom, so you tap once and you are there.



The Office in the sample church, open on Numbers. The sample has five of its folders; your church's Office has them all.

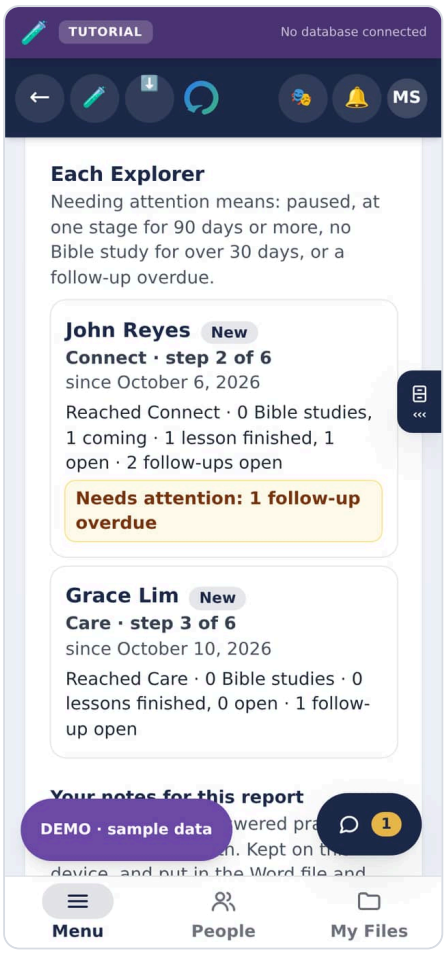
Your progress report

Reports, in the Office, shows how the Explorers you walk with are doing, for this month, last month, this quarter or last quarter. Choose one under **Period**.



The progress report. How many you walk with, who moved a step, and the Bible studies held.

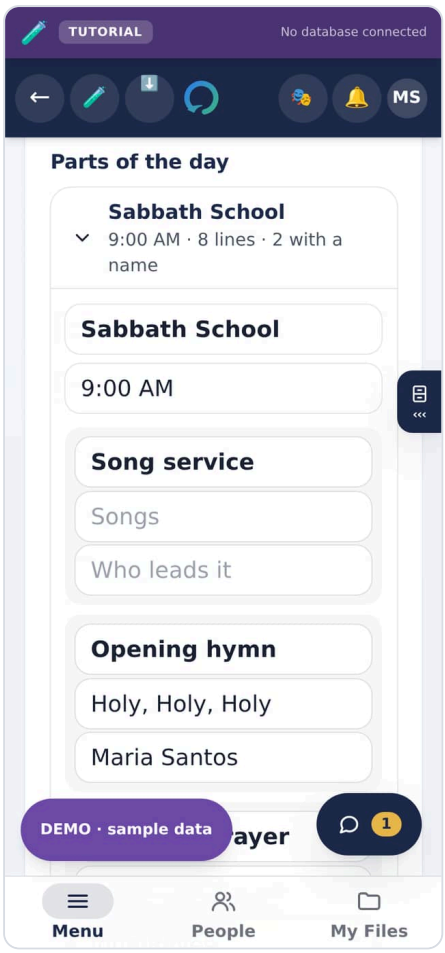
- The numbers at the top: how many you walk with, who is new, the steps forward, decisions, Bible studies held, lessons finished and follow-ups done.
- **Each Explorer**: where they are on the journey and what this month held. Anybody who needs you comes first, with the reason in words, such as "1 follow-up overdue" or "No Bible study for 35 days".
- **Your notes for this report**: what the numbers miss, such as an answered prayer. They stay on your phone and go into the Word file.
- **Download Word file** or **Copy as text** to hand it in.



Each Explorer, and who needs attention.

The Sabbath program

The **Sabbath program** folder in the Office plans a Sabbath's order of service. Press **New program**. It starts with Sabbath School, the Divine Service, the afternoon program and sunset vespers, ready for names. Type who leads each part, and the hymn or passage if you like. Tap a part of the day to open it. Under the date it says how many lines still need somebody.



The Sabbath program. Each line says what happens, which hymn or passage, and who leads it.

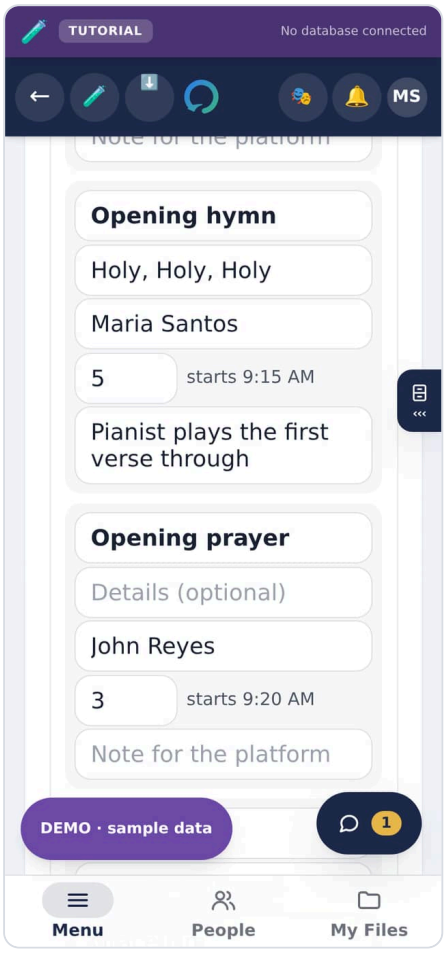
- **Download Word file** gives you a file that opens in Word, in Pages, and in Google Docs (upload it to Google Drive, or open it in the Google Docs app).
- **Download picture** gives you a picture of the program for a group chat. On a phone, **Share the picture** sends it straight to Messenger, Viber or email.
- **Copy as text** is for pasting into a group chat.
- **Post it**, under **Share in the app**, puts it in the app for the people you walk with, or for everyone in the church. They find it on **This Sabbath**, in the Menu.
- **Reuse next week** starts next week's program from this one, names and all.
- **Arrange lines**, under a part, is for moving a line or taking it out.
- **Folder** keeps programs in order: type a name such as "Quarter 4", and the list groups them.
- **Add to calendar** puts each part of the day that has a time on your phone's calendar.

To design it in Canva, a free account is enough. In Canva, choose **Upload** and add the picture or the Word file. The app does not connect to Canva.

Advanced settings, a tick box above your programs, adds more:

- **Minutes** for each line, so each line shows when it starts. If one part runs into the next, the program tells you.

- **A note** on any line, for the people on the platform. Choose **For the platform, with times and notes** before you download to get a copy with them. The copy for the congregation, the picture and the post never have the notes.
- **Your own details**, for anything the boxes do not cover, such as "Deacons on duty". Press **Add a detail**, give it a name, and write what it says. It prints under the theme.
- **Save as a template**, to start next time from your own layout.
- **Reminders**: everyone named, each with a message ready to copy and send.



Advanced settings. Each line has its minutes, when it starts, and a note for the platform.

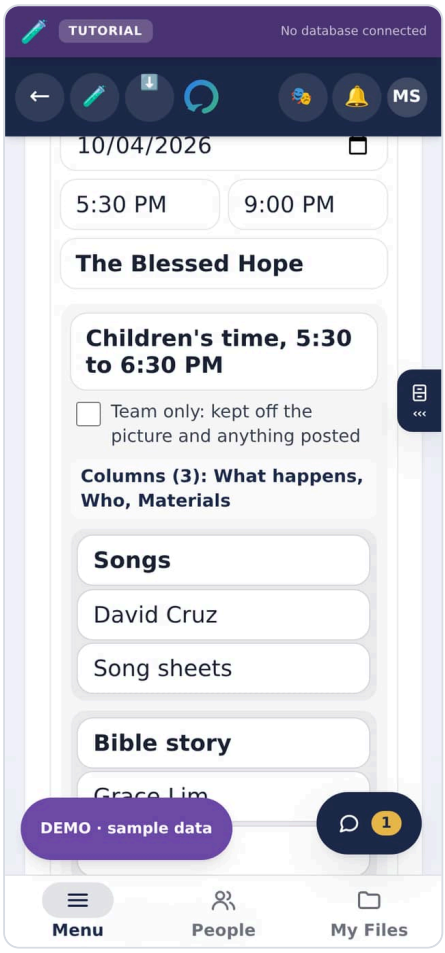
Your programs are saved on your phone or computer as you type, and work with no signal. In your church's app they also follow you to any phone or computer where you sign in. Nobody else sees them until you post them or download them. Directors have the same folder.

Evangelistic meetings

The **Evangelistic meetings** folder in the Office plans a series of meetings your own way. Press **New meetings**, choose the first night and how many nights, then **Start with a plan** or **Start blank**. The plan gives each night from 5:30 to 9:00 PM: children's time (songs, a Bible story, craft making), health time, Bible study, and snacks, plus a team and a to-do list. Change any of it.

- Tap a night to open it. Give it a date, when it starts and ends, and a topic.

- **Add a block** puts a program, a team, a schedule, a list, a paragraph or a checklist on a night or on the whole series. **Arrange blocks** moves them.
- A list's **Columns** lets you name its columns yourself, up to six.
- **Copy to a new night** makes the next night from this one.
- **Its look** chooses a colour, a heading style, and where the name sits, for the Word file and the picture.
- Tick **Team only** on anything that is not for the public. It stays out of the picture and anything you post.
- **Folder** keeps many series in order, such as "Youth Week".



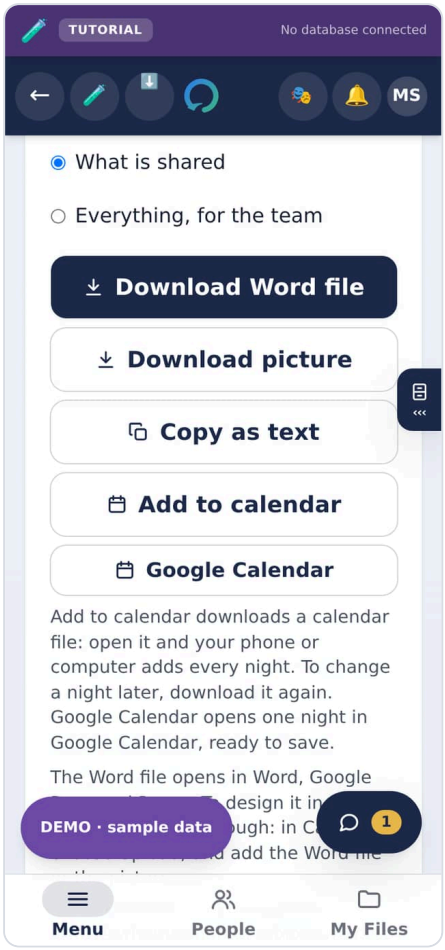
Evangelistic meetings. A night's children's time, with a column you added yourself.

Under **Take it away**, choose the whole series or one night, then download a Word file or a picture, or **Post it** for the people you walk with or the whole church.

On your calendar, and on your other devices

Add to calendar downloads a calendar file. Open it and your phone or computer adds every night (or each part of a Sabbath program that has a time). On an iPhone it is one tap. On a computer, Google Calendar takes it under **Settings**, **Import**. If you change a night, download it again.

Google Calendar appears when you choose one night: it opens Google Calendar with that night filled in, ready to save.

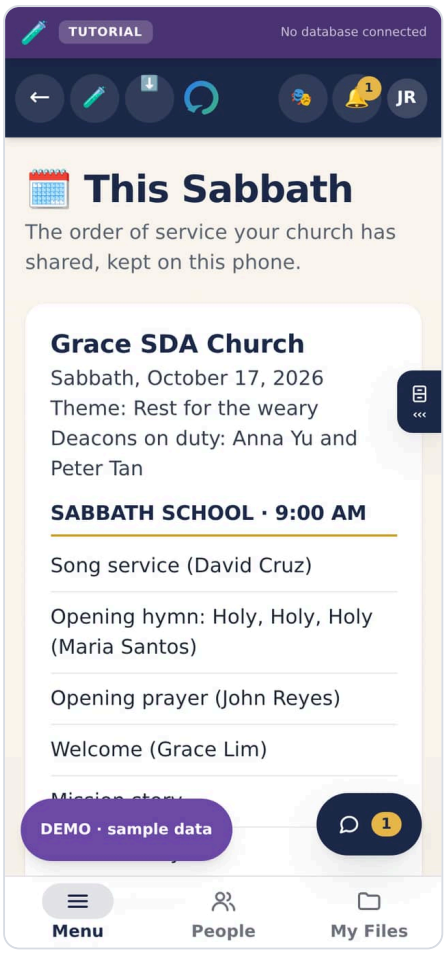


Add to calendar and Google Calendar, under Take it away.

On another phone or computer, sign in with the same account and open the Office: in your church's app, your programs and meetings are there. Under **Saved** it says whether they have reached your account yet. With no signal, they wait on the phone and go up by themselves when the signal comes back.

This Sabbath

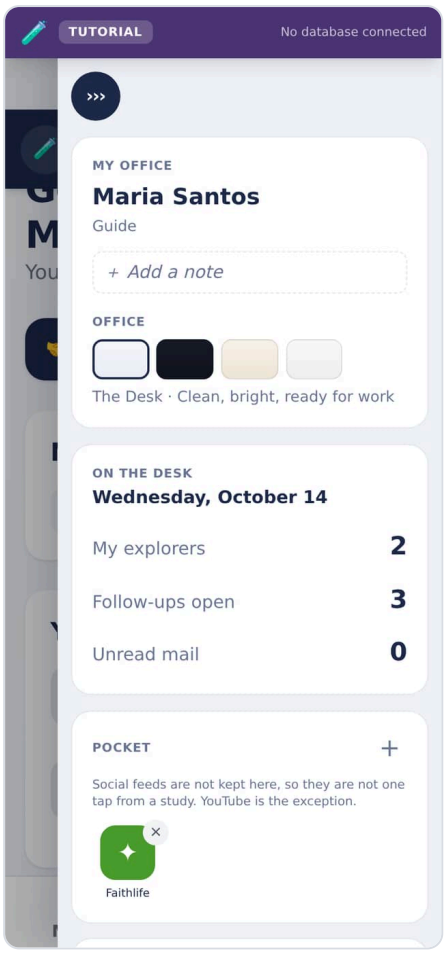
This Sabbath, in the Menu, shows the Sabbath program your Guide or your church has posted, with who shared it, and any evangelistic meetings they have posted. Once you have opened it with a signal, it opens again with none, so you can read it in a church hall without signal.



This Sabbath on a phone. The church, the date, the theme, then each part of the day and who leads it.

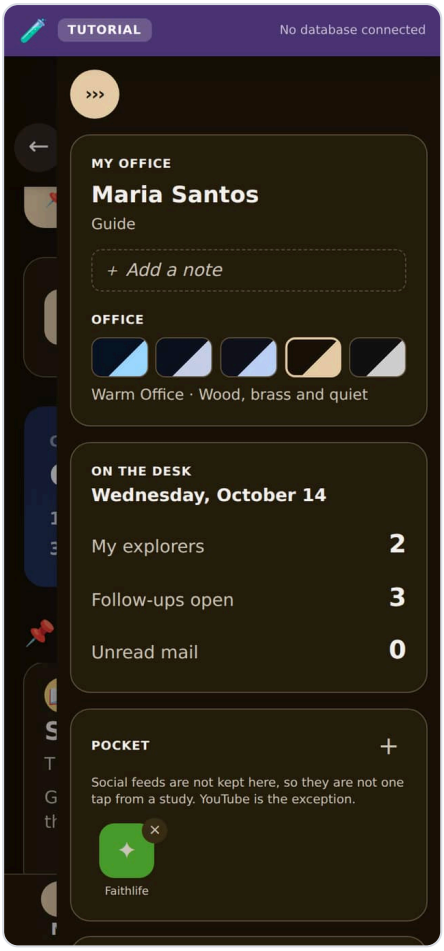
Your desk drawer

On a phone, your desk is a drawer. Tap the small cabinet on the right edge, or swipe in from that edge: the date, what is waiting, a note to yourself, and a pocket of links. Tap ››› to put it away.



The desk drawer, open: today's date, what is waiting, a note, and the pocket.

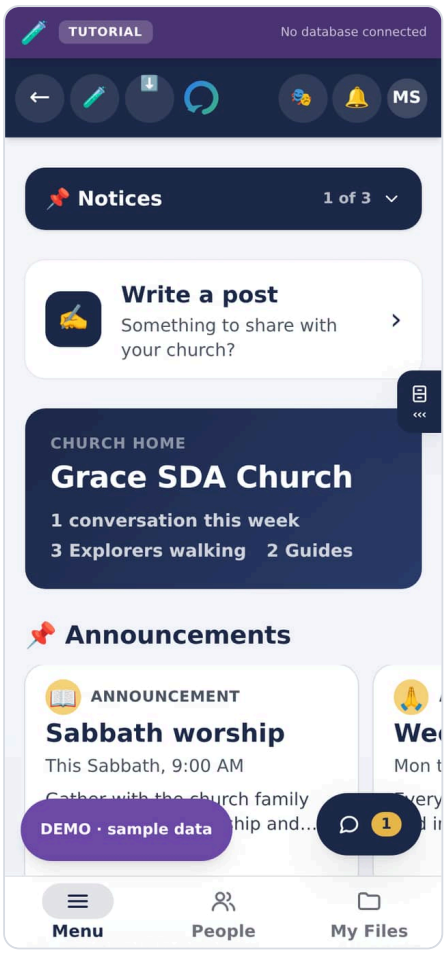
The colour squares at the top of your desk change the colours of the whole app. They work in every look. The first square is the look's own colours, so you can always go back. In Focus, which is dark, a colour stays dark: Warm Office becomes a warm evening brown. Each look remembers its own choice.



The desk under Focus with Warm Office chosen: the whole page turns a warm dark brown.

Writing for the church

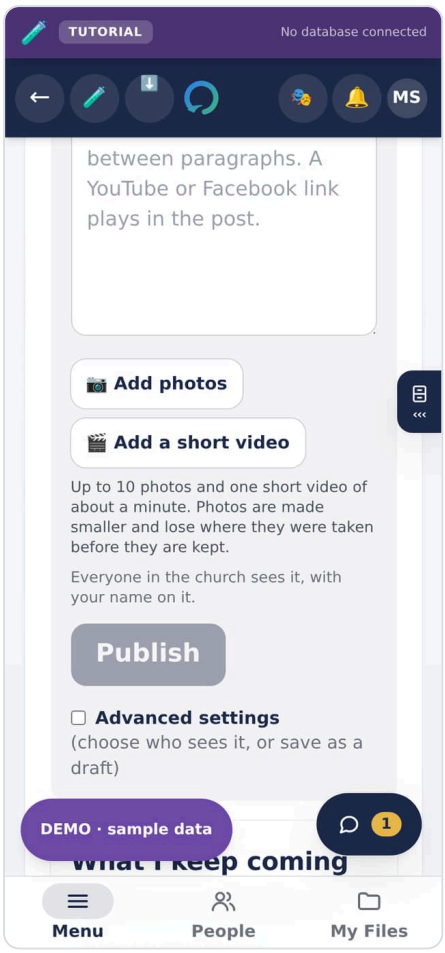
On **Home**, press **Write a post**, near the top. The writing box opens with the cursor already in **Title**: give it a title, write, and press **Publish**. Everybody in the church reads it, with your name on it, and the box says so once it has gone.



Home opens with Write a post near the top.

That is all most posts need. Under **Publish**, **Advanced settings** is there if you want it: send the post only to the people you walk with, or to people you choose, or **Save as draft** to finish it later. You never have to open it.

The same box is in Home's **Blog** folder, with what the church wrote below it.



Write a post: a title, the post, Publish, and Advanced settings under it if you want it.

To pin a notice at the top of everybody's Home, open Home's folder button and choose **Announcements**: a title, the words, **Pin it**. **Advanced settings** adds when it happens, such as "This Sabbath, 9:00 AM". Take a notice down from **Notices**, beside the notice itself.

CHAPTER 13

If you are a Director

From `docs/HOW-TO-USE.md`

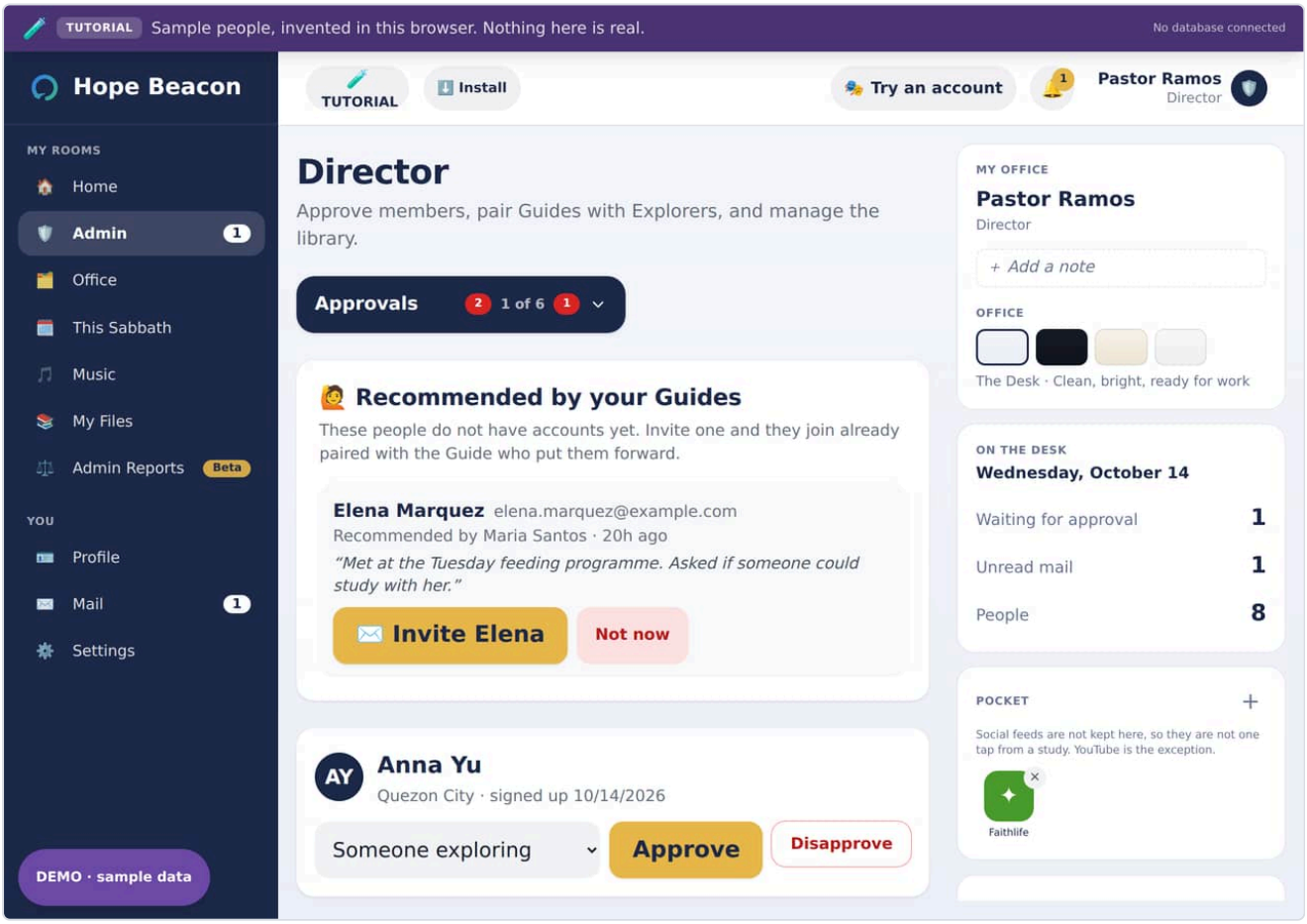
IN THIS CHAPTER

Who is waiting 115
The church home 116
The progress report 116

Directors run the church's account: who gets in, and who walks with whom.

Who is waiting

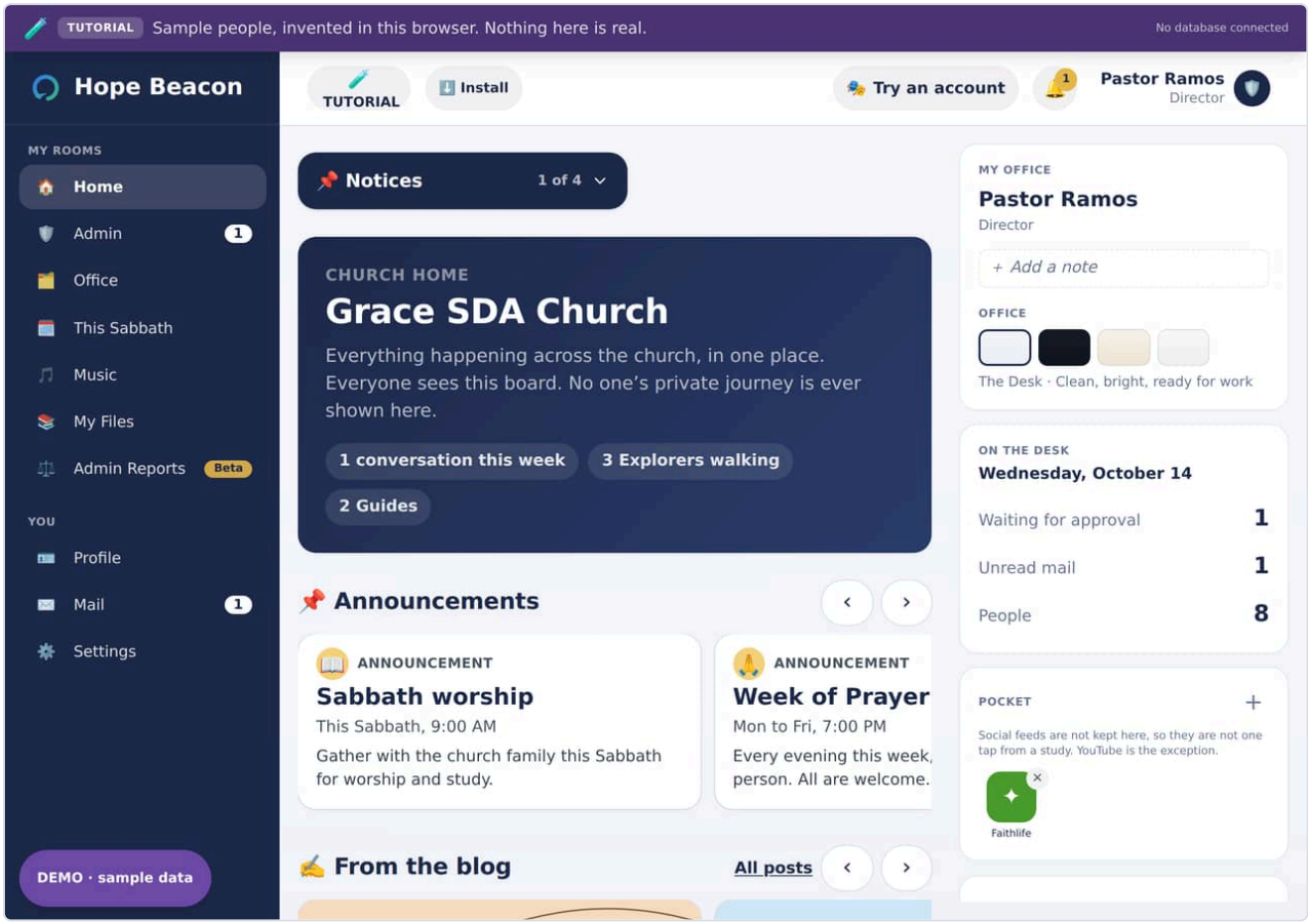
The single most important screen in the app. **An Explorer with no Guide has no app**, so anything above zero here is somebody being ignored.



Approvals. Who is waiting to be let in, and who is waiting to be paired.

The church home

Notices, your **Blog**, **Announcements**, the prayer wall, and the numbers.



The church home.

Four questions, once a week, five minutes:

1. Is anybody unpaired?
2. Is any Guide at their limit of five while Explorers wait?
3. Is any guild flagged "Needs a look"?
4. Is there anything in the trial room?

Without that rhythm the numbers are decoration.

The progress report

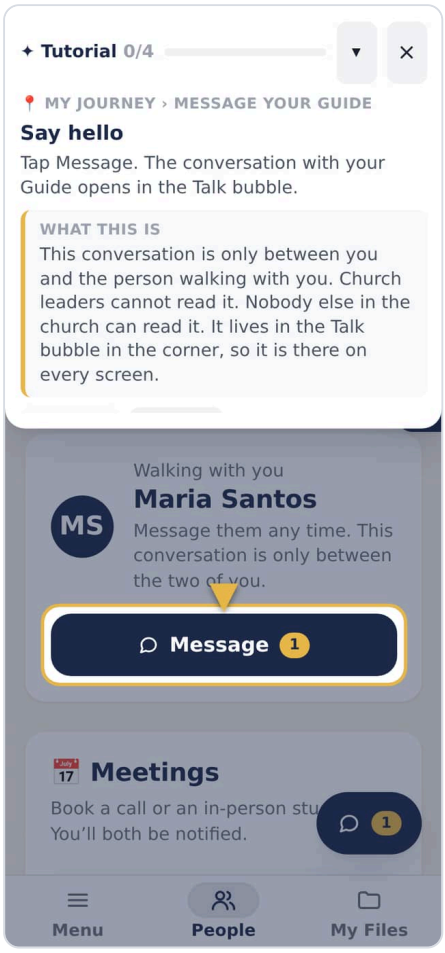
Reports, in the Office, shows every Explorer in the church by stage and by Guide, for a month or a quarter, with who needs somebody to look. Bible studies, lessons and follow-ups stay between each Guide and Explorer, so they are in each Guide's own report, not yours. Ask a Guide for theirs.

CHAPTER 14

The guided walk

From `docs/HOW-TO-USE.md`

If you would rather be shown than told, the app will walk you through your own part of it. Pick who you are on the front door and follow the highlight. It points at the next thing to tap, and explains what it is before you tap it.



The guided walk. It highlights the next thing, and says what it is for.

It takes two or three minutes, uses safe sample data, and nothing you press reaches a real person.

PART IV

Running it, week to week

The detail behind every task a church does in the app: people, conversations, the Office, the numbers, music, and the record.

15 People: inviting, pairing and looking after accounts 119

16 Conversations, meetings, the library, prayer and writing 125

17 Rooms, folders and the Office 142

18 Cases, safeguarding, the audit and the numbers 160

19 The Music room, in full 164

20 Reports, trials and the record 177

CHAPTER 15

People: inviting, pairing and looking after accounts

From `docs/HANDBOOK.md`

IN THIS CHAPTER

Inviting somebody 119
Pairing a Guide with an Explorer 120
Seeing an Explorer's profile 121
Your Guide is a real person 121
Finding one person 121
The "New" mark 122
Disapprove, or delete 122
Acting on several accounts at once 123

Inviting somebody

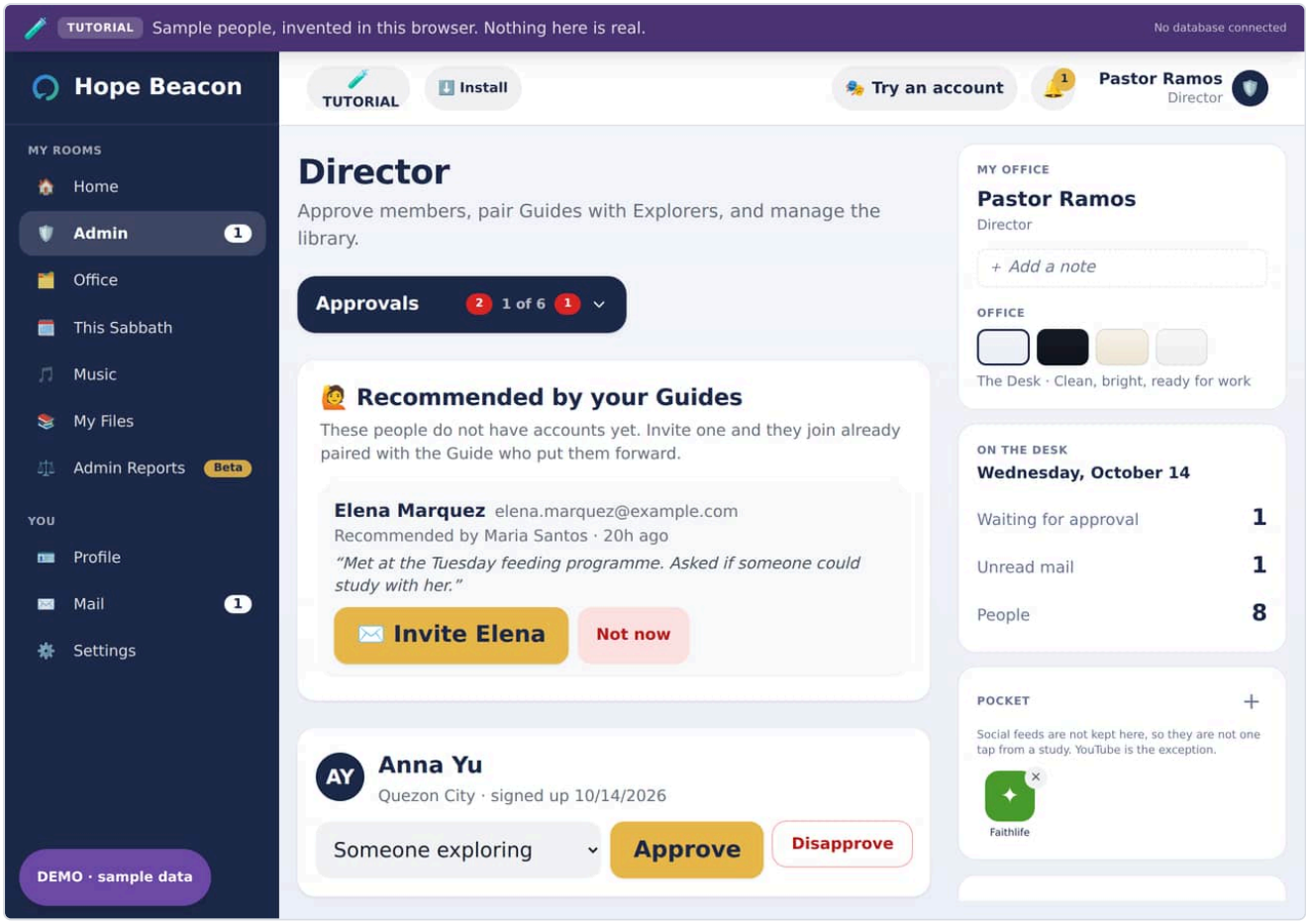
Step 1. Sign in as a Director, open **Admin**, then the **Approvals** room.

Step 2. Enter their name and email address, choose the role, and press **Send invitation**.

Step 3. They receive an email written for that role. An Explorer, a Guide and a Director each get a different message, because each is being asked for something different.

Step 4. They choose a password. That is what finishes the sign-up.

Step 5. They appear under **Awaiting approval**. Approve them, and they can enter.



A Director's Approvals, on a computer, with the rooms down the left side. A name a Guide put forward waits at the top with Invite; somebody who has signed up waits below with Approve and Disapprove. The desk on the right counts what is waiting.

CAUTION

One live invitation per person

Sending a second invitation to the same address switches off the first. If somebody says the link does not work, ask whether they have two emails, and tell them to use the newest one. Never open somebody else's invitation link yourself: it works once, and opening it signs you out and starts their sign-up on your device.

Pairing a Guide with an Explorer

Open the **Pairings** room, choose one of each, and press **Create pairing**. They can talk from that moment. A Guide already carrying five will not appear in the list, because the database will not allow a sixth.

The ceiling is the church's, and a church can move it. A Guide walks with as many Explorers as the congregation has set, enforced by the database. It may be raised in Church settings, up to a hundred. Only a Director or an Executive Director can, and only for their own church: a Guide can never give themselves more people.

Five was the original figure and the number the discipleship shape was designed around. Raising it does not make one person able to walk with more people; it makes the app stop refusing. What the cap protects is not the servers, it is the Explorer at the bottom of a long

list.

Raising it is a decision, not a drift. Five is the number the design is built around because it is how many people one person can actually walk with.

The one number worth watching is unpaired Explorers. An Explorer with no Guide has been invited into an app where nothing happens. Your dashboard opens on that number for exactly this reason.

Seeing an Explorer's profile

A Guide opens an Explorer from **People**, and their page has **Profile** beside **Message**: what that person chose to say about themselves, with their picture. A Director opens anybody from the rooms of people in **Admin**, where every row has **Profile** too. Faces are shown wherever a Guide or a Director reads a list of names, when the person has chosen one; everybody else is two initials on a circle.

Nothing new is shown to anybody by this. A Guide sees the profile of the people they walk with and nobody else's, and the address somebody was invited at and the day they arrived stay with the Directors, as they always did.

Your Guide is a real person

An Explorer's screen opens with the person walking with them: their picture, their name, their city and what they said they care about. All of it is what that Guide typed on their own profile.

It was a name on a line, and everything else on that screen is generated (the greeting, the stages, the notices), so a name in the same typeface as the rest proved nothing. Somebody who has been handed a stranger's name by an app has no way to tell whether anybody is really on the other end, and the whole product rests on them believing there is.

> **IMPORTANT**
>
> Ask your Guides to set a picture
>
> Almost none have one. Where there is no photograph and no icon the card falls back to two initials on a coloured circle, which is exactly the problem it was built to solve. A Guide's own screen now asks them for one and stops asking the moment either is set. An icon is a single tap, on **Profile**.

Nothing else about the Guide reaches the Explorer: no birthday, no contact details, nothing anybody else recorded about them.

Finding one person

The approved list gets long. Once it passes five accounts a search box appears above it: type any part of a name and the list narrows as you type, showing "4 of 37" so a short list is never mistaken for a lost account.

Past six accounts the list gets a scroll bar of its own rather than growing down the page. Forty accounts is roughly four thousand pixels, and every control above the list, the search box and the bulk buttons, used to scroll out of sight the moment somebody started reading names. Now the roll and the things you do to it stay on screen together.

The "New" mark

Anybody who finished signing up in the last seven days carries a green **New** badge on the rosters and on a Guide's cards. It works out the answer from the date every time it draws, so it can never be left on somebody by mistake, and it counts from when they chose a password rather than when a Director typed their address.

The badge gives a soft ring twice when the screen draws, then stops. A mark that pulses forever is a mark people stop seeing, and then it is only noise on somebody's name. Every role gets the same badge, which is deliberate: a different mark for a new Explorer would tell everybody who can see the list which members are Explorers, and the app takes care elsewhere not to say that.

A device set to reduce motion gets a still outline instead of the ring.

Disapprove, or delete

These are different acts and the difference matters.

	Disapprove	Delete
What happens	The account is switched off. They cannot enter, but they and their history stay.	The account, its messages and its pairings are removed for good.
Reversible	Yes. Approve them again.	No.
Their email	Still in use by that account.	Freed. They can be invited again as a brand new member, in any role.
Use it when	Somebody is away, or you are looking into something.	Somebody has left, or an account was created by mistake.

Delete asks a second time in the row itself rather than through a browser pop-up, because on a phone that dialog appears under the thumb that just tapped Delete and the button dismissing it is the one that agrees. It says what will go before it goes. The removal is recorded in a log that outlives the person it describes, so a church can always answer who removed whom and when.

The dangerous buttons are smaller and red, and they are the only red in the app. Delete, Remove, Disconnect and Disapprove are drawn one size down from an ordinary button, in red on white rather than filled. They are still a full touch target, because discouraged is not the same as fiddly, but they no longer look like the thing to press.

Change Guide, beside Disconnect, gives an Explorer a different Guide in one step. Choose the new Guide and press **Change Guide**: the first pairing ends, a new one begins, and the Explorer keeps their place on the journey. The conversation with the first Guide stays between

the two of them; the new Guide starts a new one. Nobody in leadership is ever part of a conversation, so changing a pair never lets a Director or an Executive Director read one. The owner, 7 October 2026: "EDs and Directors can change pairs but they can't see the Guide and Explorer's chat or communication." A pairing cannot be edited onto other people any other way: the database refuses it.

Who may make whom what. Only an Executive Director makes somebody a Director or an Executive Director, by invitation or by changing a role, and only an Executive Director approves somebody who signed up as one. A Director approves, disapproves and changes the role of Guides and Explorers in their own church. Nobody changes their own role, and nobody reaches the Head Executive Director from inside the app. Suspension, guardian consent and the record of who approved whom each have their own step and are never written by hand. These rules are kept by the database, and tested as invented people on every fresh install (`supabase/tests/a-leader-stays-within-their-rank.sql`).

Who answers for whom. The Director who brought a Guide or an Explorer into the app, by inviting or approving them, is responsible for them. The owner, 7 October 2026: "If there are any odd things happened to both Guide and Explorers, it is the Director's responsibility who put them in the app to manage them." That Director looks into it with the leadership tools (pairings, journey stages, counts and dates, reported messages), never by reading the conversation. The app keeps who sent each invitation and who approved each person, so the responsible Director can always be found. Any Director can still suspend an account or end a pairing at once to keep somebody safe; the responsible Director follows up. That follow-up is the church's procedure, written in its privacy manual; the app does not enforce it.

A Director asked for this. Disconnect was larger than the thing beside it and read as the more inviting of the two. The thing beside it was not a button at all: *Connect* is the name of the second stage of the journey. The screen now says **Stage · Connect** in that stage's own colour, and a status can no longer be mistaken for an action.

Both presses of a two-step removal are red: the first says the path is dangerous, the second is the act itself. That was backwards in one place, where the harmless first press was red and the irreversible confirmation was grey.

Acting on several accounts at once

Every row in the approved list has a tick box. Tick a few, or use **Select all**, and two buttons appear: **Disapprove selected** and **Delete selected**.

Three things about it are worth knowing before you use it on twenty people.

- **Select all means what you can see.** With a search showing four of thirty-seven, it takes those four. It never quietly reaches the rows the search is hiding.
- **The confirmation names everybody.** Not "delete 12 accounts", but the twelve names, because there is no way to check afterwards and no way to undo.
- **One refusal does not undo the rest.** If the database refuses one person, for instance a Director you may not act on, everybody else is still done and you are told which one failed and why.

NOTE

Who may delete whom

Decided by the database, not the screen. An Executive Director may act on anyone in a church they oversee. A Director may act on Guides and Explorers only, never another Director. Nobody may act on themselves, and nobody at all may act on the Head Executive Director. If an action is refused you are told why, in a sentence.

CHAPTER 16

Conversations, meetings, the library, prayer and writing

From `docs/HANDBOOK.md`

IN THIS CHAPTER

The conversation 125
Meetings 129
The library, and who watches it 131
Prayer 132
Lesson studies 133
Blog and Announcements, in Home 134
Questions people ask 135
Home is a billboard 136
Announcements 137
Community Blogs 138
The Guild Room 139
Undoing a step 141
Numbers a Guide can see 141

The conversation

Open it with Message on a Guide's page for one Explorer or on an Explorer's own screen, or with the round **Talk** bubble in the corner of every screen, which carries a number when somebody has written. On a phone it fills the screen; on a computer it opens beside the page. **Report** is in its header, in words, far from Send.

What you see. Your messages on the right in blue with white writing, theirs on the left in white, as every phone draws a conversation; in the dark looks (Focus and Dark Aero) theirs are a lifted slate instead. Until 7 October 2026 they were a pale teal and a pale sand, which looked like one colour on a phone in daylight and were exactly one colour in the dark looks. Messages sent close together sit together, with the day written between days and the time inside each bubble. **Seen** appears once, under your own latest message, when the other person has opened it: once, and never beside every line, because a receipt on everything is pressure on whoever has not answered yet. There is deliberately no "typing…" and no "online now": nobody here should feel watched, or watched for a reply.

Tap a message for what you can do with it. Holding it, right-clicking it on a computer, or the ⋯ beside it on a computer do the same. A panel rises from the bottom with the message quoted at the top, the six reactions, and then:

Choice	What it does
Reply	The message box shows what you are answering. Send, and your message carries a quote of it; tapping the quote takes you to the original. **Swiping a message to the right** does the same.
Copy	Copies the words, and says so.
Edit	Your own messages only. The words go back into the box; Save, and the message shows **edited**.
Delete	Your own only, after asking. A line remains saying the message was deleted, never a gap.
Open, **Remove**	For a photo or a file: open it, or (if you sent it) take it back.

Tap a message: the six reactions, then Reply and Copy. Edit and Delete appear only on your own messages.

A reply carries a quote of the message it answers. The praying hands under the message above it are a reaction.

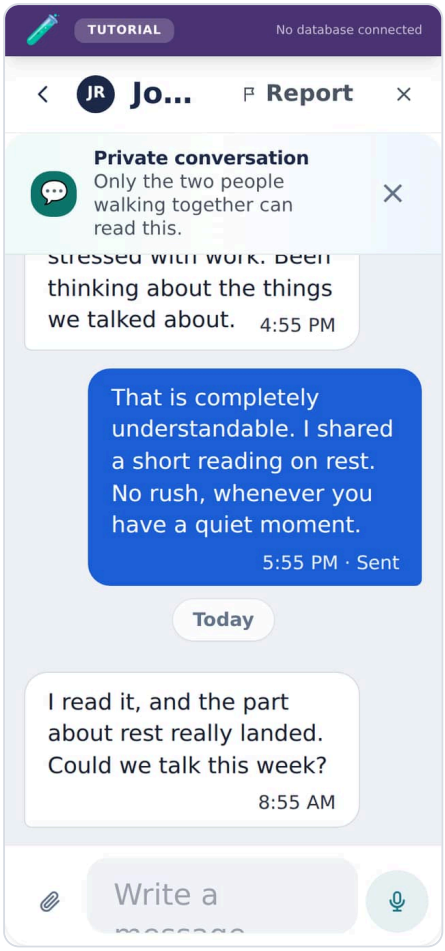
Reactions. Praying, love, like, haha, wow and sad, in that order. One each per message: choosing another replaces yours, and choosing yours again takes it back. They sit on the lower edge of the bubble; tapping them opens the same panel.

Photos and files. The paper clip beside the box sends one. A photo is made smaller and loses where it was taken before it leaves the phone (Part 9), and arrives as the picture: tap it for the full size, with **Save** in the corner. Anything else arrives as its name and size.

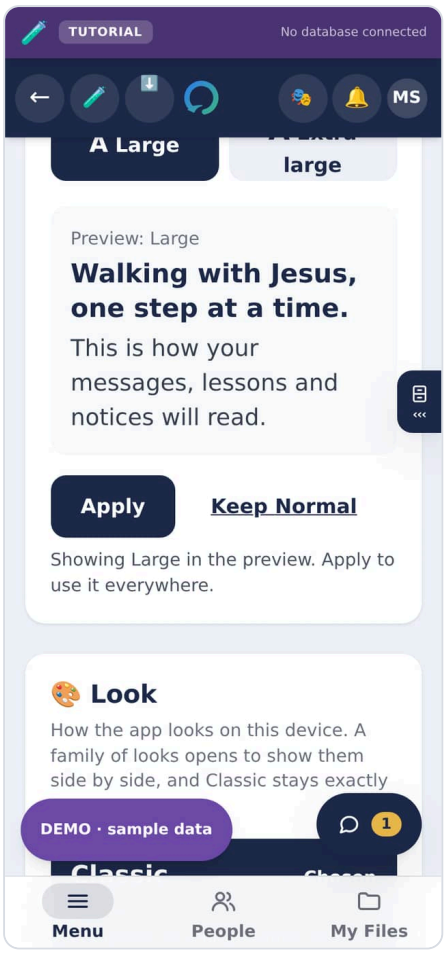
Voice messages. With nothing typed, the button beside the box is a microphone. Tap it to start; the browser asks for the microphone the first time, and only then. A red dot and a clock show it is recording; **the bin** throws it away and **the arrow** sends it. It stops at two minutes and waits for you; it never sends on its own. Tap, not hold, on purpose: holding a button for a minute is hard on an older hand, and a slipping thumb sends something half said. The microphone is let go of the moment recording stops, so the phone's microphone light goes off when it should.

Recording a voice message. The clock counts up to the two-minute limit; the bin on the left throws it away, the arrow on the right sends it.

It follows Text size. Settings → General → **Text size** changes the conversation's words as well as every other screen's. A size is tried in the card's preview first, drawn at exactly that size, and changes the app only when **Apply** is pressed (the owner, 3 October 2026: "text size should be tested and see first before applying, there should be an apply button"). Until 1 October 2026 the chat was drawn in fixed sizes and did not.



The same conversation with Text size at its largest. The words grow and still wrap; nothing runs off the side.



Text size in Settings. Large is being tried in the preview; nothing else has changed until Apply.

The tutorial teaches it. Both the Guide's walk and the Explorer's have a step that points at a message and asks for a reaction or a reply.

> NOTE
>
> If Reply, reactions and the microphone are not there
>
> The church's database has not had the update that brings them (migration `20261001120000`). Nothing is wrong: the conversation keeps its words, photos and live refresh, and the three appear on their own once the update has run. See *When the code is newer than the database* in Part 9.

Meetings

A Guide and an Explorer arrange a time together on the same card, and both see it. Either may propose one: a title, a date and time, and online or in person. The other person confirms it, and either can cancel. Nobody else in the church sees any of it.

A called-off time stays on the card, marked as off. It says **Called off** (or **Not this time**, for a proposal somebody could not make), who said so and when, so the other person is not left wondering where it went. It is not counted under *Upcoming appointments* and has no **Join**

button or map, here or in the desk's *Coming up*. Once you have seen it, **Clear from my list** takes it from your own list on that phone or computer; the other person still sees it until its time has passed.

The card is the first thing you reach, on both sides. A Guide's page for one Explorer opens on **Appointments**, and an Explorer's own screen has the card right after their Guide and the church's notices. Until 30 September 2026 the card sat under the conversation, so arranging a time meant scrolling past the whole thread; the conversation now lives in the **Talk** bubble, and **Message** on either screen opens it. The card has never lived under **Journey**, the one tab the Explorer never sees, and must not: it is a thing the two of them do *together*, not something the Guide does *about* them.

In person asks where, and will not let you skip it. Start typing a place and the box suggests where you might mean: places you two have met before first, then places from the map, each with its street, barangay, city and province. Type *jollibee imus* and you see each branch with its own street, so you can tell which one you mean. Tap one and it is pinned: the card says **Meeting here** with the name and address, and **Check it on the map** opens that exact spot before anybody is asked to go there. The other person's **Open in Maps** button opens the same spot in whichever map app they already use.

You can still type an address yourself, for example *Church cafe, 12 Rizal St, Cavite*, or paste a map link someone shared; the list offers **Use "..." as typed**. A place too small to be on the map, or a search that is not answering, never stops two people meeting.

> **NOTE**
>
> What the place search sends
>
> Only the words typed, and the town you last met in rounded to about ten kilometres, go to the map search (Photon, over OpenStreetMap). They go from the church's server, not from the phone, so nobody's name, account or internet address goes with them, and nothing about the search is kept. The privacy notice says the same.

> **NOTE**
>
> A link, never an embedded map
>
> An embedded map needs a Google Maps key, which means a billing account and a key that reaches every browser in the congregation. A link costs nothing, needs no account of ours, and opens the app people already use.

Online asks for the link, and turns it into a button. Paste a Zoom, Meet, Teams, Whereby, Jitsi, Messenger or Skype address and the card shows **Join on Zoom**, named after whichever service it recognises, so the person tapping it knows what is about to open. An address it does not recognise still works, and reads **Join the meeting**.

Before this, an online meeting had a title and a time and nowhere to put the address, so the link went into the conversation as a message and slid up out of sight, and the older the meeting, the further up it had gone.

CAUTION

Only http and https become a button

A meeting link is text one member types and another taps, which is the exact shape of an attack. Anything that is not an ordinary web address is shown as plain text and is not tappable, whatever it claims to be.

The library, and who watches it

Anybody in the church can put a link or a file in the library and share it. A Guide and an Explorer both can, without asking a Director first. That freedom is the point: somebody who finds a reading worth passing on should be able to pass it on.

A file is kept by the church, within the limits the app already had. Drag it onto the Resources card, or tap **+ Add** and drag it into the box or choose it from the phone. Pictures, PDFs, Word, Excel and PowerPoint files, audio and text, up to 10 MB each; no video (put it on YouTube and add the link). It goes on the shelf under its own name, with nothing to fill in, and can be renamed under *Edit*. Only the person who added it can open it until they send it to somebody, and then that person can too. Nobody else can open it, and that includes the church's leaders. Deleting the resource deletes the file.

Each resource shows what you can do with it: *Send to ...*, *Edit* and *Delete*. *Send* opens a small panel with an optional line saying why, the people you walk with (anybody who already has it is ticked), and *Share outside the app* for WhatsApp, a text or anybody without an account. For a file, *Share outside the app* sends the file itself; on a computer that cannot do that, the file is saved so you can attach it. *Delete* asks first and says what goes with it. On something another person added, the red button says *Hide*: it takes the item off your own shelf and leaves it for everybody else. The rare settings sit inside *Edit* under *More options*: whether it shows as a video, music, a PDF, a picture or a document, and (for leadership) putting it on the church shelf. A row shows the site a link goes to (*youtube.com*), or a file's name and size, not a whole address.

Adding a link asks for the link first. The name and why it helps (optional) appear once the link is pasted. The app works out from the link whether it is a video, music, a PDF or a picture.

The card says what it is for where it appears: **Resources** in the Office, **Send John something** on one Explorer's page, and **Your resources** in an Explorer's own Study folder, which opens on what was sent to them and their studies before their own.

What a Director sees, and what an Executive Director sees

Freedom to share is not freedom from oversight, and the oversight is a record afterwards rather than a gate in front of every share.

You are	You see the record for	You do not see
A Director	Guides and Explorers in your church	Other Directors, or an Executive Director
An Executive Director	Directors	Guides and Explorers

Each rank watches the rank below it and no further down, which is the same shape as the security audit. The record is in **Admin → Security**, under the audit, and shows who added or shared what, with whom, and when. Nothing from a conversation appears in it.

> **IMPORTANT**
>
> The record is kept for 30 days and then deleted
>
> It is there to answer "what happened recently", not to be an archive, and a file of everybody's reading kept forever is a different and worse thing. **If something in it needs to outlast the month, raise a safeguarding report about it.** Those are never deleted, and that is the difference between the two.

Stopping somebody

A Director can **block a Guide or an Explorer** from sharing anything. An Executive Director can block a Director. Nobody can block themselves, and nobody can block upward or sideways; the database refuses it rather than the screen hiding a button.

Blocking takes away the library and nothing else. The person keeps their account and their conversation, and can be let back in with one press. It is the right answer for somebody misusing the shelf, and the wrong answer for somebody who needs a safeguarding report or a case.

Prayer

An Explorer asks for prayer on their own screen, at the foot of it. It goes to the Guide walking with them and to nobody else. There is no audience to choose, and the choice to broadcast one was taken out on purpose.

The Guide presses "I'm praying" and the Explorer is told. Not that the request was read, and not the words of it: the Explorer sees *"Your Guide is praying for this"* with the date, on their own copy of the request.

The date is not decoration. "Somebody is praying about my mother" is worth knowing the day of, and an Explorer who wrote something hard and saw nothing change had no way to tell whether anybody had seen it at all.

It runs both ways. A Guide can ask the Explorers they walk with to pray for them: from the Prayer folder, choosing each person, or from one Explorer's **Care** tab. Every person asked gets their own copy and sees only their own, so nobody learns who else was asked, and a Guide's request never goes on the church wall. The Explorer finds it at the top of their Prayer folder, with a count on the tab, and presses *"I am praying for this"*; the Guide is told, by name. Only whoever asked can withdraw a request or call it answered: the other side can say they are praying, and nothing else.

Each side is told when the other asks, in a notification that never carries the words: a notification becomes a pop-up on a locked phone. And whoever a request was written **to** can report it from the request itself. The words are copied into the report, so a request withdrawn

a moment later still reads in the Directors' queue, and every Director is told. The person reported is not.

> **NOTE**
>
> What the notice does not carry
>
> The Explorer's own words are never repeated back to them in the notice, and nothing about the request leaves the two of them. If the person pressing the button is the person who asked, nothing is sent at all: nobody is notified about themselves.

A Guide's own screen puts the requests waiting for them at the top, before the roster, with a mark on each Explorer who has one open. The mark clears when they press it, which is what keeps it worth reading instead of becoming permanent furniture.

Lesson studies

A Guide writes their own, in one form. Tap **+ New series**, give it a name, and write the studies underneath it: a title and the study for each, **+ Add another study** for the next, and handouts dragged into the box beside each study (or chosen from the phone). Then tap **Save and share** to put it on the church's shelf, or **Save as a draft** to finish later; a draft is only yours to see. A study left without a title is called *Study 1*, *Study 2* and so on. Anybody in the church can then open the series, read the studies and open the files.

Simple or Advanced. Every form for writing a study has a **Simple · Advanced** switch at the top, and it starts on **Simple**: the name, the studies, their handouts and drawings, and Save. **Advanced** adds the topic that groups the series on the shelf, the line shown under its name, and **Formatting tips** for bold or slanted text. The choice is remembered on that phone or computer, and switching back to Simple never throws away anything already typed.

Draw a picture. Under the handouts of every study being written is **Draw a picture**, which opens a drawing board (Excalidraw) over the whole screen: boxes, arrows, lines, a pencil and words in a hand-drawn style. **Save drawing** puts it on the study as a picture, which everybody reading the study sees under the words and can open full size. Whoever drew it can press **Change drawing** to carry on with the same shapes, or **Remove**. Leaving the board with changes that were not saved asks first. A drawing is kept like a handout, in the church's own storage, up to the same 10 MB. Photos cannot be put inside a drawing: add a photo as a handout instead, where it loses its location before it is sent.

The shelf opens on the studies, not on a form. A series row is just its name; tap it to open it. Inside, each study has **Mark as read**, and for writers **Edit this study**, which is also where you drag in more handouts or delete the study. Removing a handout deletes the file too. **+ Add a study** at the foot of a series takes its handouts in the same step. **Rename**, **Share with the church** / **Hide from the church** and **Delete series** sit at the foot of an open series. Deleting a series or a study asks first and says what it takes with it: until 25 September 2026 deleting a series, with every study in it, was one tap on a red word beside *Rename*.

On one Explorer's **Lessons** tab a Guide sees the studies the way that Explorer does, with how far they have read; writing and changing studies is in the Office, one tap away.

Directors keep the same control over everything, which is what running the church means. A Guide may edit and delete only what they wrote.

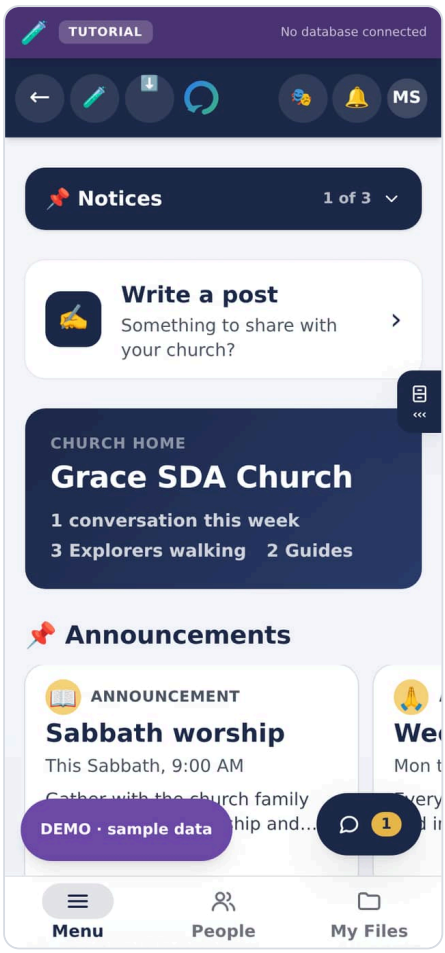
This works on a phone, and for a while it did not. The writing desk is in the Office, the Office was only ever linked from the left column, and the left column does not exist below the width of a laptop. So a Guide on a phone or an iPad held upright could read studies but never write one, with nothing on screen to suggest the room existed. Three rooms were in that state (Office, Publish and Cases) and the fix was to put them in the header row that a phone had at the time. Since 30 September 2026 every screen size steers by the bar at the bottom instead, and its **Menu** is the one list of rooms, so there is no second list for a room to be missing from.

Blog and Announcements, in Home

Writing lives in Home, beside what has been written. Home has a **Blog** folder and, for Guides and leadership, an **Announcements** folder. The owner, 3 October 2026: "Blog and announcement will be the sub rooms of home, so basically we will take out publish". There is no Publish room any more; an old link to it opens Home's Blog folder.

Write a post, from the screen Home opens on. The owner, 4 October 2026: "I would love writing the Blog to be simple (with advance settings too but that's optional) and can be easily accessible to Home page". Home opens on its Notices, and near the top is one row, **Write a post** ("Something to share with your church?"). The whole row is the button. It opens the Blog folder with the cursor already in **Title**. Whether the keyboard rises by itself is the phone's decision; an iPhone usually waits for a tap on the box. Before this, writing was in the Blog folder, behind the folder button, and nothing on Home's first screen said so.

Blog. The writing box is always open, with nothing to press first and nothing to close it with: a title, the post and **Publish**, which goes to everybody in the church with your name on it. When it has gone the box says so ("Published. Everyone in the church can read it now.") and empties for the next one. **Advanced settings** sits under Publish, so nobody has to read past it to finish a post: tick it to choose who sees it (only the people you walk with, or people you pick) or to **Save as draft**. Below the box are your own posts and then everything the church has written.



Home opens with Write a post near the top. The whole row is the button.

Announcements. A title, the words and **Pin it**, and the notice sits at the top of everybody's Home. Tick **Advanced settings** to add when it happens ("This Sabbath, 9:00 AM"). Below are the ones you have pinned already. An Explorer has no Announcements folder: notices are pinned by Guides and leadership, and what an Explorer wants to say goes in their blog, which everybody reads too.

Taking a notice down happens on Home, in the notice itself: tap it, and its writer or anybody in leadership sees **Take down** and **Delete** at the foot. A notice that is down is no longer on Home, so **Put back up** is in the Announcements folder, beside it in the list of ones you have pinned (which also has Take down and Delete).

Questions people ask

The owner, 7 October 2026: "I want a complete FAQ in the app too please before users login and inside the app in settings."

Anybody can read them, signed in or not, at `/faq`: the front door, the sign-in screen and the invitation page all link there, so somebody holding an invitation can find out what they are joining, and who can see what, before they join. Signed in, the same answers are in **Settings**, under **Help**. Fifty-seven questions in eight groups: about the app, joining and signing in, your Guide and your conversation, your information and the law, using the app, for Guides, for Directors and Executive Directors, and trying it out.

Search narrows the list and says how many matched, and when three or fewer are left their answers are already open. A link to one answer, such as `/faq#faq-sign-out`, opens that answer, so a Director can send somebody straight to it.

One file holds every answer, `lib/faq.ts`. A church that changes how its copy works (a different limit, a rule of its own) changes the answer there too, and both places follow. The answers about what the app is and who looks after it are the invitation e-mail's own sentences, and the limits on a post are read from the code that enforces them, so those cannot drift; everything else is a promise, and `tests/data-protection.mjs` holds the ones about privacy to what the privacy notice says.

Home is a billboard

The owner, 7 October 2026: "It should look the Home Screen where people can see blogs and announcements right away please like a Bill board you can just see the image and photos right away and you can scroll on it."

Home opens on two rows you swipe sideways, straight under the church's name: 📌 **Announcements**, then ✍️ **From the blog**. Each card is most of the screen's width, so the edge of the next one says there is more. On a computer, two arrows beside each heading move the row, because a mouse has no sideways swipe.

A card is its picture first. A post with a photo shows the photo; one with a short clip shows its first frame; one with a YouTube or Facebook link shows a play button. A row where nothing has a picture stays short, each card its words with its emoji beside them, so a few notices do not push the blog's pictures off a phone's first screen.

Tap a card and it opens whole, in a sheet over Home: every photo, the clip or the video, and all the writing, with who wrote it and when. Close it with the cross, the Escape key, or a tap outside it. Opening a post from Home counts as reading it, the same as opening the Blog folder, so its writer's reader count goes up by one person, never by name.

What is on it. Announcements that are up, newest first. The blog row is the twelve newest posts you may read, with any a Director has pinned at the front (marked **Start here**), by the same rule as the Blog folder: a draft is never there, and a post addressed to named people reaches only them. **All posts** beside the heading opens the Blog folder. Somebody who can pin notices sees **Write one** beside Announcements, and when nothing is pinned the row tells them where to write the first; everybody else sees no row at all on an empty day.

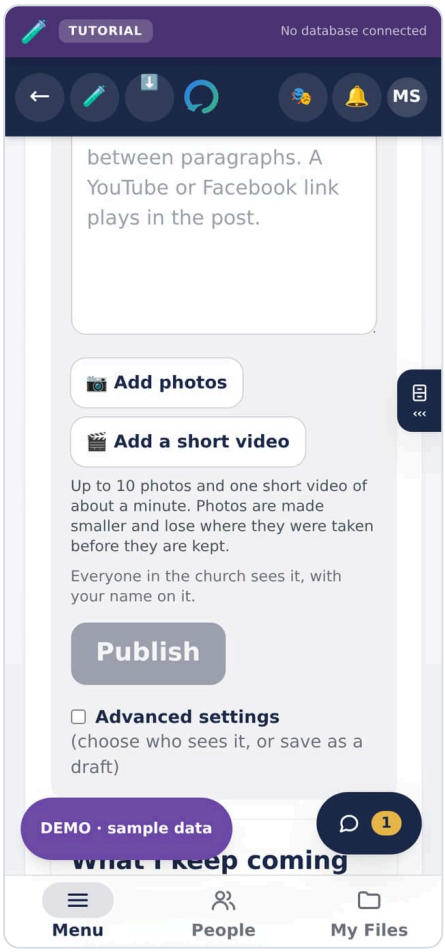
The banner is shorter on a phone. The church's name and its counts stay; the sentence about the board waits for a wider screen. That is what lets both rows start on the first screen of a phone.

Photos and a short video. Under the post you are writing, **Add photos** takes up to ten pictures and **Add a short video** one clip of about a minute (50 MB at most). Each photo is made smaller and loses the place it was taken before it is kept; a video that is too long is refused with what to do instead: put a YouTube or Facebook link in the post, which plays

inside it. Take one off with the cross on its corner. In the sample church they are kept on your own device. In a church's own app they need the church's database change for post photos; until it is applied, a link to a video still plays.

Share, on an open post or notice, sends its title and a link, through the phone's own share sheet or by copying it. It never sends the words or the photos, and the link opens only for somebody signed in to that church who may read the post, so passing it on cannot carry a member's writing outside the church. A link opens the post straight away.

The sample church has two posts for the whole church and one from the sample Guide with pictures drawn for the app, so the billboard has something on it the first time anybody opens it. They are drawings, not photographs of anybody.



Write a post, on a phone, after the tap on Home: the cursor in Title, Publish, and Advanced settings under it.

Announcements

A notice pinned where the church will see it: an icon, a title, a line of detail, and a free-text when, because "This Sabbath, 9:00 AM" and "Every evening this week" are what a church actually writes and neither is a date. Notices come down by being taken down, not by a clock nobody set.

Guides, Directors and Executive Directors can write one. Guides were left out at first, which meant a Guide arranging something for the five people they walk with had nowhere to pin it and sent the same message five times.

Explorers cannot. A notice sits above everybody's church screen, and pinning something there is an act of leading rather than of speaking. An Explorer with something to say to the church has Community Blogs, which is exactly that and does not sit above everyone else's.

Every notice goes to the whole church, and there is no audience to choose. A private option existed briefly and was taken out: a notice only part of the congregation can see is not a notice, and having the setting invites somebody to use it. The screen says so above the Post button, so nobody writes one assuming it will reach fewer people. Anything meant for fewer people belongs in a message or in Community Blogs.

Anybody in leadership can take down any notice, and an author can take down their own. A pinned notice reaches the whole church, and anything that reaches the whole church needs an off switch that does not depend on the person who wrote it being available.

Where a notice appears depends on whose screen it is, because the two jobs are different:

- **Guides, Directors and Executive Directors** see notices first, under the greeting. Their job is the church, and a Guide in particular carries the notices onward to the people they walk with.
- **An Explorer** sees them after their Guide's card and before **Message** and their appointments. An Explorer opening their journey is looking for their person, not for the church; putting the church's notices above that answered a question they had not asked.

Nothing is drawn at all when nothing is pinned, so an ordinary day costs no space on any screen.

Community Blogs

Anybody approved in the church can write a post. Explorers, Guides, Directors and Executive Directors all write from **Write a post** on Home, or Home's **Blog** folder. There was a time when only Guides and leaders could, and an Explorer who tried was shown an error from the database.

Three audiences, and the choice is made before publishing.

Audience	Who reads it
Everyone in the church	Every approved member of your church. It appears in Community Blogs.
Only the people I walk with	For a Guide, their Explorers. For an Explorer, their Guide.
Only the people I choose	The people named on it, and nobody else. It only appears when there is somebody to choose.

A post stays private until it is published, and **Make private** takes it back off without losing it.

CAUTION

A church-wide post is signed

Choosing **Everyone in the church** puts your name and your role on it, and the screen says so before you press publish. That is on purpose: a blog everyone reads where some posts are signed and others are anonymous is one nobody can hold to account. The narrower audiences follow the app's ordinary rule, which does not name an Explorer's role to people who have no reason to know it.

Community Blogs is in Home's **Blog** folder, under the writing box, and in the **Church** folder of a Guide's or an Explorer's own screen, newest first. It is deliberately never the first thing anybody sees: Home opens on its Notices, with a way to write near the top and what everybody has written one folder away, because what a person came there to do belongs above what everybody else has written.

It draws nothing at all when nobody has published, rather than leaving an empty card on the screen.

Past three posts it gets a scroll bar of its own instead of growing down the page, and **Hide** folds it away entirely. Both are remembered on that device, so somebody who would rather not read the blogs shuts them once rather than scrolling past them every time. Folded, the heading still says how many posts are waiting, because a shut panel with no count looks like an empty one and nobody opens it again.

On an Explorer's **My Journey**, the first thing on the screen is their Guide's name. The whole design says the journey is a relationship, and an Explorer opening that screen is looking for their person.

Directors and Executive Directors can delete any post in their church. That is not tidying up; it is the reason an audience open to every member is safe to have at all. A church-wide megaphone with no way to switch it off is a problem waiting for a Sabbath morning. Anybody can always delete their own.

The Guild Room

A guild is a named group inside the church, made by a Director: a Bible-study cohort, a campus, a language, a Sabbath afternoon team. A pairing is one Guide and one Explorer, which is the right shape for discipleship and the wrong shape for everything a church does in groups. Only Guides and Explorers are put into one; Directors run guilds rather than belonging to them.

Everybody in the church can see that a guild called *Palawan Campus* exists. **Who is in it is visible to Guides and leadership only**, because handing an Explorer a list of the other Explorers would turn a set of private relationships into a public roster of everybody being discipled here.

The **Guild Room** is that group's shared board: Guides and the Explorers in it, together. Four kinds of thing go on it: an **encouragement**, a **study note**, a **prayer**, or a way the guild can **care** for somebody. Anyone in the guild can say *Amen* to a post.

It shows no names. A post is signed *You*, *A Guide*, or *A fellow Explorer*, and nothing else. The board never publishes who is in the guild, which is what makes the room worth having: a group can talk without it becoming a roster of everybody's Explorers.

The board updates on its own. A post or an *Amen* from anybody in the guild appears on everyone else's screen within a second or two, with no refresh. This was the last room in the app that still needed one, and it was left until last because the obvious way to do it would have broken the paragraph above: making the posts readable by the browser would have handed over who wrote each one, which is precisely what the room exists not to do. Instead the app watches a separate signal that records only *that this guild's wall changed* — no author, no words, nothing about a person — and then re-asks for the board through the same route as always, labels and all. **Nothing about how little you are told changed; only how quickly you are told it.**

Directors and Executive Directors are not in it. A group talking honestly is what the room is for, and a Director reading over their shoulder is a different product. Guild membership itself is still managed by a Director, from the Church room.

Anybody can report a post, and a Director can take it down. That is the one way leadership sees into the room, and it opens only when somebody reports something:

- **Report this post** sits under every post that is not your own. It does not ask who wrote it, because you do not know and should not be told. The app works that out on its own and never shows you the name.
- The report lands in the same **Safeguarding** queue as everything else, and every Director is notified.
- **What the post said is copied into the report.** If the person who wrote it deletes it afterwards, which is exactly what somebody who has just been reported does, the Director still reads the words.
- A Director can **delete the post**, and that removal is written into the security audit before the post goes, so it cannot be lost.

CAUTION

This room shipped without any of that

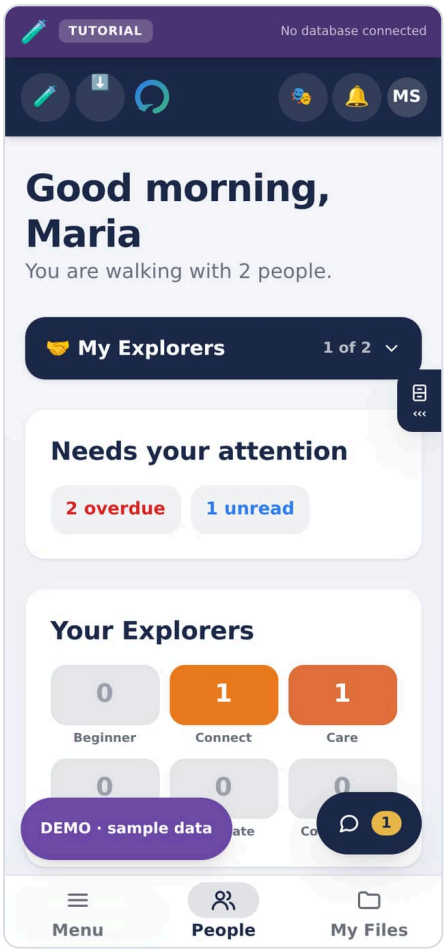
For a day the board had no way to report a post, no way for a Director to see in, and nobody but the author could delete anything. Explorers are in these guilds and some Explorers are children. Every other place in Beacon where one person can be hurt by another has the same three things on the same screen: a way to report it, somebody whose job it is to look, and a record that outlives the person it describes. **Apply that test to any new room before it ships, not after.**

Undoing a step

Advance stage is one tap, and taps go wrong. **Undo, step back** sits beside it and puts an Explorer back a level. It asks first, and it is recorded as a correction rather than erased, so the history stays honest. The Explorer is never shown their stage either way, so a correction is invisible to the person it is about.

Numbers a Guide can see

The screen a Guide lands on opens with their own figures: how many Explorers they have, how many have **graduated**, how many are still walking, and the breakdown by level. Above that sits whatever is waiting today, which is usually short: prayer requests, and the next meeting with a name and a day.



A Guide's home on a phone: how many people they walk with, what needs them today, and how many are at each stage.

Graduated means reached Commission: walked the whole journey and now sent to walk with somebody else. It is the number the whole design exists to produce.

CHAPTER 17

Rooms, folders and the Office

From `docs/HANDBOOK.md`

Rooms and subrooms

A room is a folder, and a subroom is a folder inside it. Open a room and a drop-down at the top names the subroom you are in; tap it to see them all, and tap one to go in. Nothing else is drawn, so there is nothing to scroll past.

The drop-down open on an Explorer's own screen. Closed, it says which folder you are in and that it is 1 of 4; open, it lists them all.

Six rooms work this way now. Measured on a phone, with the sample church in them:

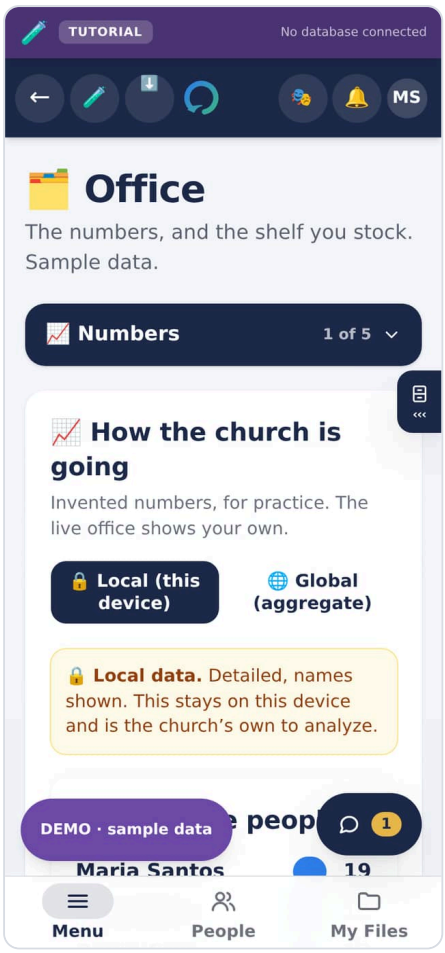
Room	Was	Now
The Library	11 screens of scrolling	3 folders: Browse, Featured, On this device. On a phone (6 October 2026) a title instead of a banner and one row of filter chips: Browse went from 5.6 screens to 3.6, and the first resource is on the first screen
Settings	7 screens	4 or 5 folders: General (installing, alerts, language, text size, look, the source code), Password, Admin Reports, Church for leadership, Help. The sample church has General, Help and, for leadership, Church
My Journey, an Explorer's own screen	7 screens	4 folders: My Guide, Study, Church, Prayer
The Church	5 screens	3 folders: Notices, Community Blogs, The numbers
My Explorers, a Guide's home	4 screens	4 folders: My Explorers, Follow-ups, Prayer, Church
The Office	3 screens, and nine cards	5 or 6 folders, below

Cases, the Guild Room, Mail and Profile are left alone. They are one or two screens and mostly one thing; a list of choices above a single card is furniture, not navigation.

The Office

Guides, Directors and Executive Directors have an **Office**, in the Menu on every screen. It holds the work: the numbers, the progress report, the downloads, the studies you write, the Sabbath program, evangelistic meetings and the shelf you stock. Its subrooms are:

A Guide's subrooms	A Director's subrooms
Lesson studies, Sabbath program, Evangelistic meetings, Resources, Guides' room, Put a name forward, Reports, Numbers	Numbers, Reports, Lesson studies, Sabbath program, Evangelistic meetings, Library, Pairing requests, Guides' room



The Office in the sample church, open on Numbers. The sample has five of these folders, Numbers, Lesson studies, the Sabbath program, Evangelistic meetings and Reports; a church's own Office has the full set above.

Three things about it are worth knowing:

- **It opens where your work is.** A Guide lands on Lesson studies, because writing is what a Guide comes here to do. A Director lands on the numbers.
- **It remembers where you were.** Somebody who lives in Lesson studies lands there tomorrow, and a Director's habit is their own rather than everybody's.
- **A link still beats the habit.** *Guides asking to pair* on the desk opens the Office already on Pairing requests, whichever subroom you were last in. Being sent to the right room and left to find the shelf is the same as not being sent.

The count beside **Pairing requests** is how many Guides are waiting on an answer. Without it a Director has to open the subroom to find out whether there is anything in it, which is the scrolling problem again with a tap on top.

NOTE

Why this room needed it most

It held nine panels down one page. A Guide who came here to write a study passed their numbers, the shelf, two pairing cards and a recommendation form on the way, every single time, and on a phone that is most of a minute of thumb. The Director's screen has worked in rooms since it was split up; the Office simply never got the same treatment, and neither had anywhere else.

NOTE

Two things that did not move

An Explorer's way out of a conversation is on the same screen as the conversation. The conversation is in the **Talk** bubble, and **Report** is in the bubble's own header, in words, at the top, far from Send, on both sides of every pairing.

A Guide still sees the church's notices before choosing a folder. They sit above the row, not inside one, because a Guide carries the notices onward to the people they walk with and was told to see them first.

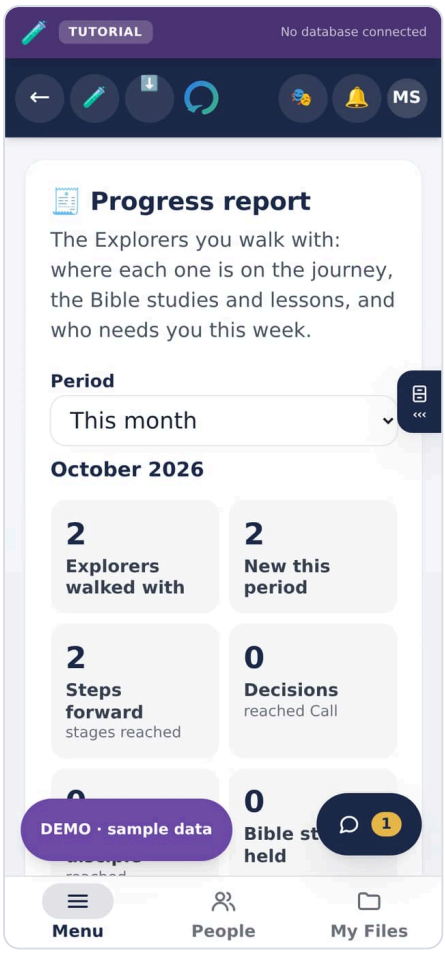
The split is by kind of work rather than by rank. A roster, a conversation, a case is about a person, and lives on that person's screen. Numbers, exports, writing and stocking a shelf are office work, and live here. Before this, a Guide's roster carried study-writing, library-stocking and a blog desk underneath the list of five people they walk with, and a Director's analytics sat three clicks inside an admin tab. The people screens were four screens long and the tools were hard to find.

Follow-ups and prayer requests stayed on the Guide's roster, because they are about the people on it.

Explorers do not have this room, and not because anything is hidden from them. None of it is theirs to do: no roster to report on, no shelf to stock, nobody to write studies for. A room that would be empty for them tells them they are missing something.

The progress report

How the Explorers you walk with are moving, for a month or a quarter, and who needs you this week. It is in the Office under **Reports**, for Guides, Directors and Executive Directors. Asked for on 2 October 2026: "a progress report for Guides and higher up accounts ... make sure it integrates with the data and relevance on how Explorers are progressing rightly."



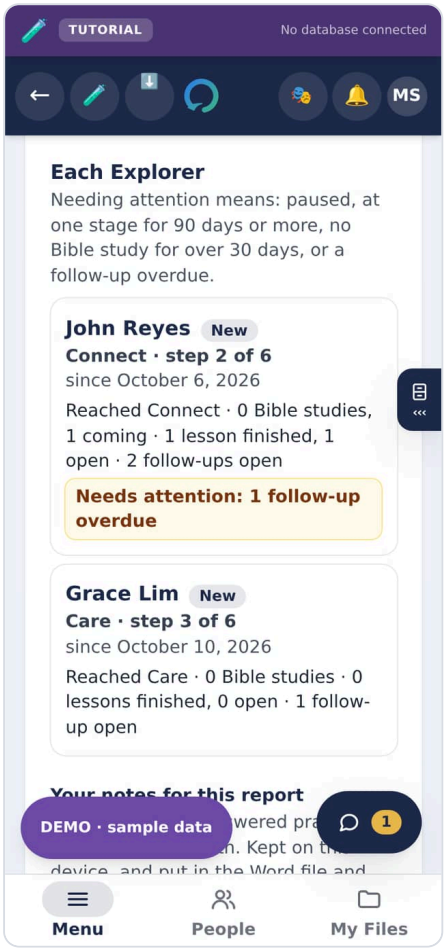
The progress report on a Guide's phone: the period, then the totals for October, each a number and what it counts.

Its shape is the one Adventist churches already keep. A Sabbath School class record is kept by the quarter, and a Bible worker's report by the month: Bible studies given, visits, decisions, baptisms, and a space to write what happened. So **Period** offers this month, last month, this quarter and last quarter (the calendar's quarters, as Sabbath School's are), and the report counts the same kinds of things in this app's own terms:

On a Bible worker's report	In this report	Counted from
Interests	**Explorers walked with**, and **New this period**	The pairings
Progress	**Steps forward**: stages reached in the period	The journey's history
Decisions	**Decisions**: Explorers who reached Call, the point of decision	The journey's history
Sent out	**Sent to disciple**: Explorers who reached Commission	The journey's history
Bible studies given	**Bible studies held**: meetings confirmed or done, and already past	Meetings
Lessons studied	**Lessons finished**, of those sent	Lesson studies sent
Visits	**Follow-ups done**	The Guide's own follow-ups

Steps forward count where somebody ended up, not every move. The report compares the stage each Explorer was at when the period began with the stage at its end, so a stage undone and done again is counted once.

Each Explorer is listed with their stage, since when, what the period held and what is coming. **Needs attention** is the point of a progress report, so it is said in words and never by colour alone: paused; no Bible study yet, two weeks after pairing; no Bible study for over 30 days; a follow-up overdue; or at one stage for 90 days or more (not Commission, where the journey arrives). Whoever needs attention is listed first.



Each Explorer: John Reyes at Connect, with a follow-up overdue, and Grace Lim at Care.

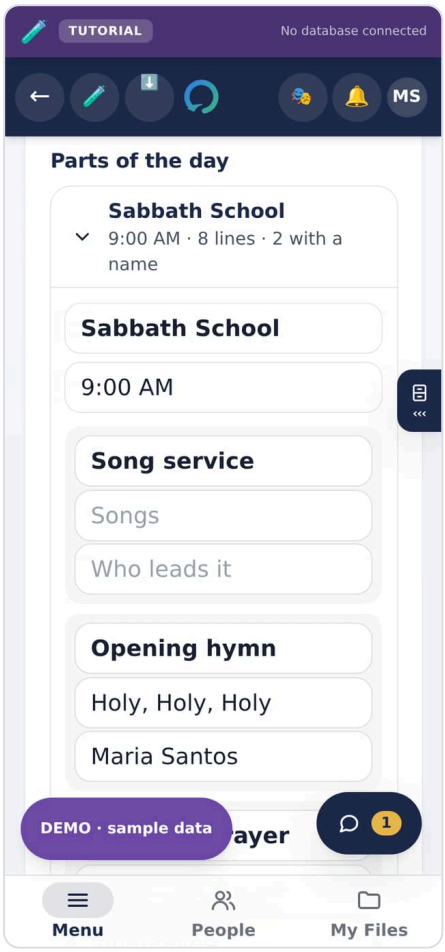
Each person's report is what the database already let them read. A Guide's is their own Explorers, in full. A Director's or an Executive Director's is every Explorer in the church, by stage and by Guide, from the stage and its history only: meetings, lessons and follow-ups stay between each Guide and Explorer, so they are in that Guide's report and not in leadership's, and the screen says so rather than showing zeros. No rule was changed or widened for it.

Your notes for this report is a box for what numbers miss: an answered prayer, a family that came along. It is kept on the device, per account and per period, and goes into the Word file and the text and nowhere else. **Download Word file** gives `Progress-report-2026-10.docx` (or `Progress-report-2026-Q4.docx` for a quarter), and **Copy as text** the same for a message. The report keeps up: a stage moved or a study confirmed elsewhere changes it while it is open.

For leadership, **Reports** also keeps the board report and the downloads, as before.

The Sabbath program

Plan a Sabbath's order of service, then send it where people will read it: a Word file, a picture, text for a group chat, or a post your Explorers find on This Sabbath. It is the **Sabbath program** folder in the Office, beside Lesson studies, for Guides, Directors and Executive Directors. Asked for on 2 October 2026, and widened the same day.



The Sabbath program on a phone: the parts of the day, each line saying what happens, which hymn or passage, and who leads it.

A new program starts from the whole day, for the coming Sabbath: Sabbath School, the Divine Service, the afternoon program (AY) and sunset vespers, each with the parts a Sabbath usually has (song service, opening hymn and prayer, mission story, sermon, benediction and the rest). Every line is three boxes: what happens, the details (which hymn, which passage, which title) and who leads it. Rename, add or remove anything. **Arrange lines**, under a part, shows arrows to move a line and a button to take it out; **Done** puts them away again, so the boxes keep the whole width of a phone while you type. One part of the day is open at a time. A part with nothing in it and no time is left off what gets printed.

It says what is left to arrange. Under the date, "16 lines still need someone to lead it" counts every line that names a part but nobody to lead it, and each program in the list says the same in short ("3 still to fill", or "everyone named"). It is the question a coordinator asks on a Friday.

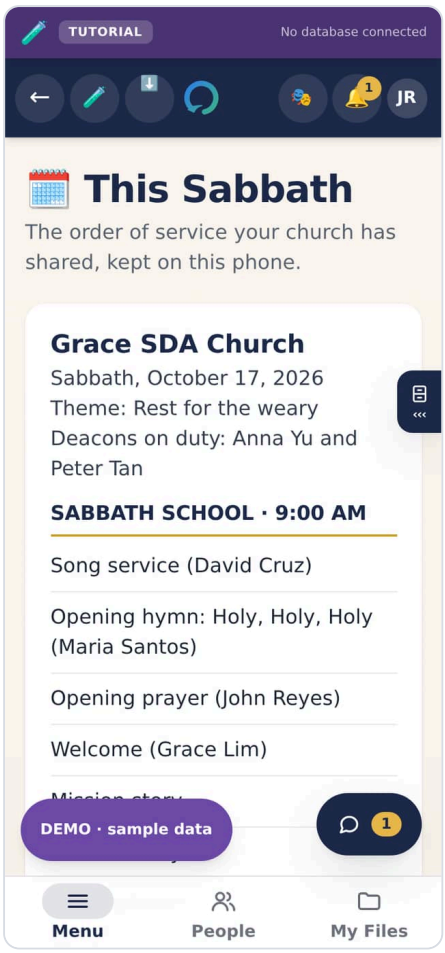
No hymn titles come with it. Every church has its own hymnal; type the number and title you sing.

Button	What it gives you
Download Word file	A .docx named for its Sabbath, such as `Sabbath-program-2026-10-03.docx`. It opens in Word, in Pages, and in Google Docs: upload it to Google Drive, or open it from the Google Docs app on a phone.
Download picture	A picture of the program (a PNG 1080 pixels wide, as tall as the program needs) for a group chat, a phone's gallery or Canva. It is drawn on the phone itself, so it works with no signal.
Share the picture	The picture, straight into Messenger, Viber, Drive or email through the phone's own share sheet. Shown only where the browser can share a file, which is most phones and few computers.
Copy as text	The program as plain text, ready to paste into a group chat.
Post it	Under **Share in the app**: the program as a post for the people you walk with, or for the whole church. See below.
Reuse next week	A copy for the following Sabbath with every part and name kept, because most weeks change only who does what.
Add to calendar	A calendar file with each part of the day that has a start time as its own event. See *Folders, calendars and every device*, below.

Sharing it with Explorers: This Sabbath

Share in the app, under the program, makes it a post. Choose **Who sees it**: **The people I walk with**, which is where a Guide's share goes unless they choose otherwise and which includes anybody paired with them later, or **Everyone in the church**, where a Director's or an Executive Director's goes, and which also puts it on the church home screen like any post for the whole church. Press **Post it**.

It is an ordinary post, with your name on it, read by the rules every post follows. So an Explorer a Guide does not walk with does not see that Guide's program, and nobody outside the church sees any of it. To take one down, open **Publish**, where the posts you have made are listed. Posting needs a signal; with none, the button says so and nothing typed is lost.



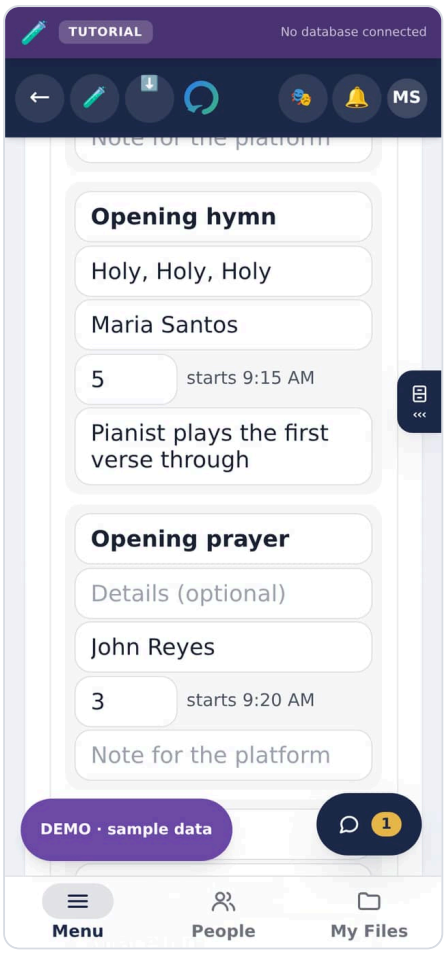
This Sabbath on an Explorer's phone: the church, the date, the theme and a detail of the church's own, then Sabbath School with who leads each part.

Explorers find it on This Sabbath, in the Menu. Guides and leadership have it too, with their own programs under the shared ones. The coming Sabbath's program is at the top with **Shared by** and the sender's name; earlier ones fold away under **Other Sabbaths**. It is shown as plain text and never as a web page, because it is something a person typed.

It opens with no signal. Each program shared with somebody is kept on their phone, the most recent 20, and the page itself is saved for offline use. Once they have opened This Sabbath with a signal after the program was posted, it opens in a church hall with none.

Advanced settings

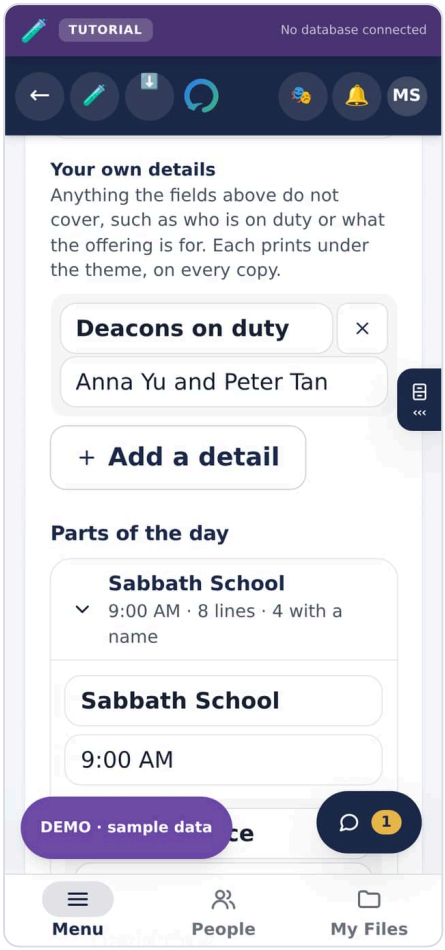
Tick **Advanced settings**, above the list. The choice is remembered for that account on that device. Simple is the default, because most weeks need nothing more than names.



Advanced settings on a phone: each line has its minutes, the time it starts, and a note for the platform.

- **Minutes and start times.** Give a part of the day its start time and each line its minutes, and every line shows when it starts ("starts 9:20 AM"). If a part runs past the start of the next, the program says so in amber: "Sabbath School runs 20 minutes into Divine Service."
- **A note for the platform.** Each line can carry a note for whoever leads it, such as "Pianist plays the first verse through". Under **Take it away**, **Which copy** chooses between **For the congregation**, without times or notes, and **For the platform, with times and notes**, a Word file ending `-platform.docx` with a column for each line's start time and the notes under their lines. **The picture and anything posted are always the congregation's copy**, so a note never leaves the device that way.
- **Details of your own.** For anything the standard boxes do not cover: press **Add a detail**, give it a name ("Deacons on duty", "Offering for", "Flowers given by") and write what it says. Every detail with something written prints under the theme on every copy, the picture and the post included; one left empty is left off. Up to twelve.
- **Your own templates. Save as a template** keeps the parts, their times and minutes, and the names of your details, under a name such as "Communion Sabbath". **New program** then asks what to start from: **The standard Sabbath**, one of yours, or **A blank page**. A template never keeps who leads what, the hymns and passages, the notes, or what a detail said: they belong to one Sabbath. Up to ten.
- **Reminders.** Lists everybody named in the program with what they are doing and when. **Copy reminder** gives a message ready to paste to that person: "Hi Grace Lim. A reminder

for Sabbath, October 3, 2026 at Grace SDA Church:" and their parts. The app sends nothing itself.



Details of your own: a name, what it says, and Add a detail for another.

Designing it in Canva, for free

A free Canva account is enough, and the app never talks to Canva. In Canva choose **Upload** and add the picture or the Word file, then design from it. There is no account to connect, no key to keep and nothing to pay, and the privacy notice gains no new company. `docs/SABBATH-PROGRAM-RESEARCH.md` gives the reasoning, the three open-source tools the ideas came from and their licences. One thing in it is unconfirmed: that Canva's free plan imports Word files was read from search results quoting Canva's help page, because the page itself could not be reached from where this was built. Try it once before telling a church it works.

Kept on this device first, and with your account. A program is saved as it is typed, in the browser on the phone or computer where it was made, so it works with no signal. In a church's own app whose database has the account copy, it then follows its maker to every device they sign in on (see *Folders, calendars and every device*, below). Nobody else reads it until somebody posts it or takes a file away. Each account keeps its own list: a second leader on a shared office computer starts with their own, not the first one's names.

CAUTION

Where the device is all there is

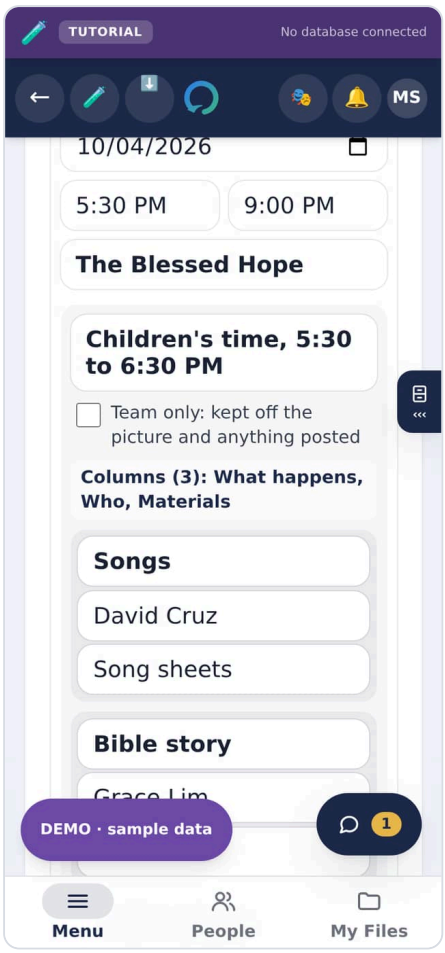
In the sample church, and on a database that has not had migration `20261002150000`, a program made on a phone is not on the laptop, and clearing the browser's site data or closing a private window deletes the programs in it. With the account copy, the next sign-in brings them back. Either way two leaders do not see each other's drafts: they post it or pass the file round, the way churches already pass a program round. If the browser refuses to save at all, the screen says so in red.

Evangelistic meetings

A series of meetings, shaped the church's own way. It is the **Evangelistic meetings** folder in the Office, beside the Sabbath program, for Guides, Directors and Executive Directors. Asked for on 2 October 2026: "super customizable, unlike Sabbath program it has a template that can put input, but for EMs users can have much more freedom to customise their meeting."

Where the Sabbath program has a fixed shape, this has none. The owner chose four freedoms, and each is there:

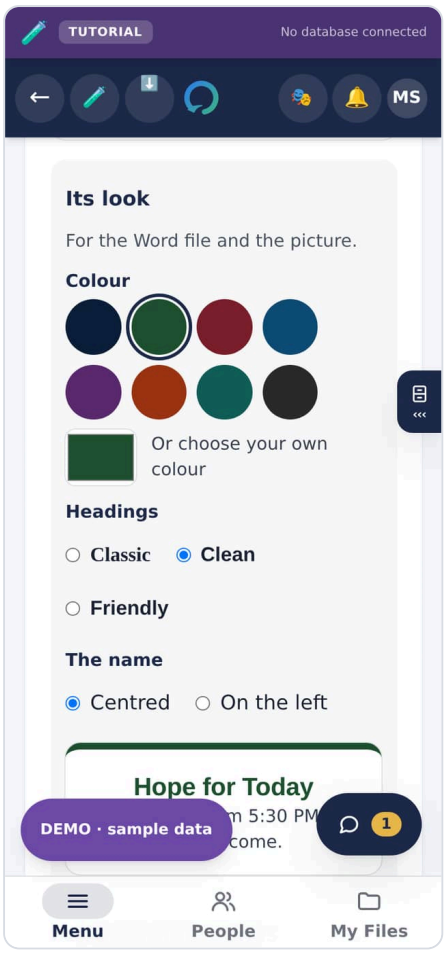
- **Blocks.** The series as a whole, and each night, is a list of blocks in any order: a list, a paragraph, a checklist. **Add a block** offers six, and three of them are lists with their columns already named: **A program** (time, what happens, who), **A team** (role and name), **A schedule** (date, time, what). **Arrange blocks** moves or removes them; a block is removed only after a second tap.
- **A list's own columns.** One to six, named anything: "Time, What happens, Who, Song", or "Village, Bible worker, Visits". Each list's **Columns** opens to rename, move, add or take one out. Taking out a column that has words in it asks first, because what it says on every line goes with it. On a phone each line is its boxes one under another; wider, they sit side by side under the column names.
- **Many nights.** Each night has its own date, start and end time, topic and blocks, and opens on its own so a week of meetings is not one long scroll. **Copy to a new night** adds a copy at the end of the series, on the day after its last night, with the same blocks and names and the topic left to choose. **Add a night** adds an empty one; **Remove this night** asks first.
- **Its own look**, for the Word file and the picture: one of eight colours or **your own colour**, a heading face (**Classic**, **Clean** or **Friendly**: Georgia, Arial and Verdana, which every computer already has, so nothing is fetched or licensed), and the name **Centred** or **On the left**. A colour too pale to read as words draws the lines only, and the words stay dark; the screen says so.



Evangelistic meetings on a phone: night 1, 5:30 to 9:00 PM, opening on Children's time, whose third column, Materials, the Guide added herself.

Nobody has to start from nothing. The plan follows how the owner's church runs its meetings (the old word was a crusade): team work, a night in parts, and snacks afterwards. **New meetings** asks for the first night and how many nights, then offers:

Choice	What it gives
Start with a plan	A night for each day, from 5:30 to 9:00 PM, in four parts: **Children's time, 5:30 to 6:30 PM** (songs, Bible story, craft making), **Health time, 6:30 to 7:30 PM** (a health lecture), **Bible study, 7:30 to 8:30 PM** (a discussion or sermon on a Bible truth) and **Snacks**. Each part is a list of what happens and who, ready for a column of your own. For the whole series: a paragraph about the meetings, the team (children's time, songs, Bible story, craft making, health lecture, Bible study, snacks, welcome, prayer team, sound and projector, with names to fill), and a checklist of what to get ready, craft materials and snacks included. Every part of it can be renamed, moved or taken out.
Start blank	One night and nothing on it.

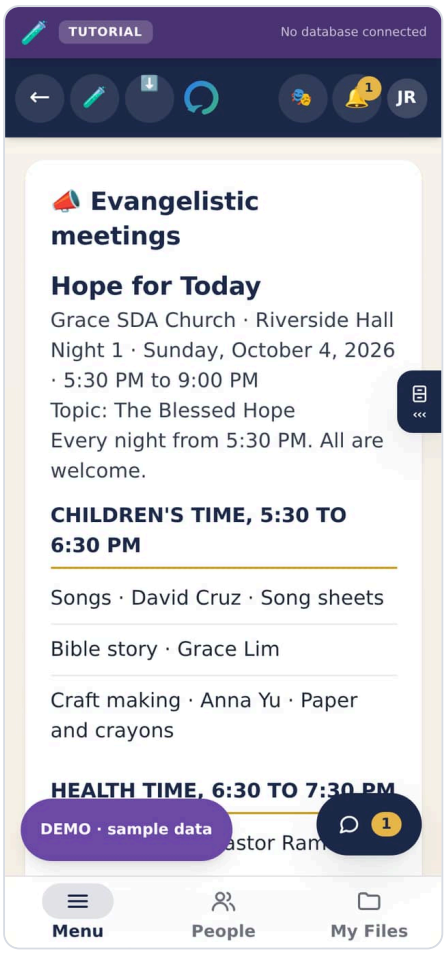


Its look: eight colours and one of your own, three heading faces, and where the name sits, with a preview.

A block can be the team's only. Planning a campaign means writing things down that are not for the public: what is still to do, who drives whom. Tick **Team only** on any block and it is in the team's copy of the Word file and nowhere else. A checklist starts that way. The picture and every post are always **what is shared**, so a team-only block never leaves the device by the app's hand.

Taking it away, under **Take it away**:

- **What**: **The whole series**, or one night. The whole series is every night in full in the Word file, and the series with its nights at a glance in the picture, the text and a post.
- **Which copy**: **What is shared**, or **Everything, for the team** (Word file and text only).
- **Download Word file**, **Download picture**, **Share the picture** (phones), **Copy as text**. Canva's free Upload takes the picture or the Word file, as for the Sabbath program.
- **Add to calendar** and, for one night, **Google Calendar**: see below.
- **Share in the app**: **Post it** posts what is chosen under What, to **The people I walk with** (a Guide's default) or **Everyone in the church** (a leader's), as an ordinary post with the sender's name. Explorers find it on **This Sabbath**, under **Evangelistic meetings**, with no signal too once they have opened it.



This Sabbath on an Explorer's phone with the first night of a series: its name, where, 5:30 to 9:00 PM, the topic, and each part of the night with every column.

Kept on the device first, and with your account, exactly as the Sabbath program is: it works with no signal, and in a church's own app with the account copy it is on every device its maker signs in on. Up to 60 series on a device, 31 nights in a series, 20 blocks in a night, six columns and sixty lines in a list. Guides and leaders can also plan on **This Sabbath**, which opens with no signal.

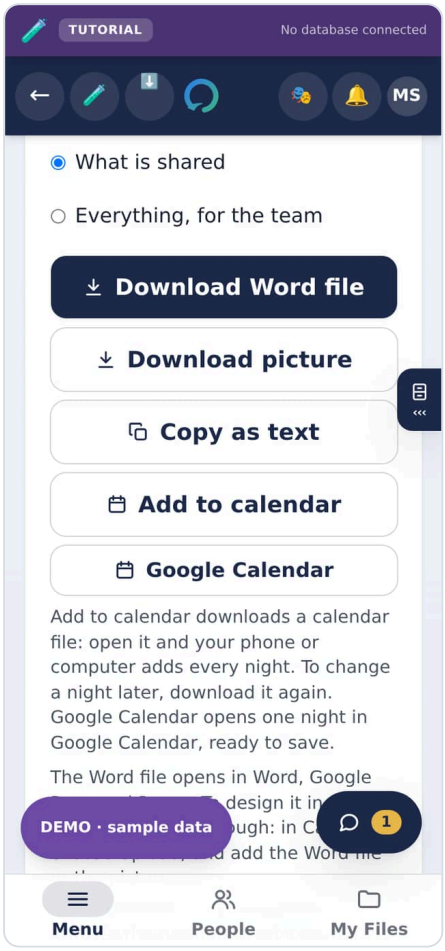
Folders, calendars and every device

Asked for on 2 October 2026: "Both Sabbath school and evangelistic meetings can have multiple storage files placed in the sub-room to be organised, and there can be an option to put it automatically on their digital calendars ... make sure it's on device first, but ALSO it's transparent to go to other devices that is login."

Folders. Every Sabbath program and every series has a **Folder** box. Type a name ("Quarter 4", "Youth Week") or pick one already used, and the list groups by folder, each one folding open and shut with how many it holds. Anything in no folder is listed first. A folder needs no making and no deleting: it is there while something is in it. A device keeps up to 120 programs and 60 series.

On your calendar. Add to calendar downloads a calendar file (`.ics`, the standard every calendar takes). For a series it holds every night, or the one night chosen under **What**; for a Sabbath program, each part of the day that has a start time. An iPhone or a Mac adds them

with one tap, Outlook opens the file, most Android calendars open it from the download, and Google Calendar imports it on a computer (**Settings**, **Import**). A night with no end time is given three hours; a part of the Sabbath runs to the end of its minutes, or to the next part, or an hour. Times carry no time zone, so 5:30 PM is 5:30 PM on the phone in the hall. **Google Calendar**, shown when one night is chosen, opens Google Calendar with that night filled in, ready to save.



Taking a series away: the Word file, the picture, text, and Add to calendar and Google Calendar, with what each does.

What the calendar is not: something that updates itself. Change a night, and download the file again. Each event keeps the same identity inside the file, which the standard says a calendar should use to replace the night it already has rather than add a second; that has been checked in the file, not yet on every calendar. What goes in is **what is shared**, never a **Team only** block or a platform note, because a calendar can itself be shared.

On every device you sign in on. The device still comes first: a program or a series is saved where it is typed, and works with no signal. In a church's own app whose database has had migration `20261002150000`, the account keeps a copy too. Under **Saved**, the screen says which:

It says	It means
Saved on this device and with your account, so it is on your other devices too.	Sent. Open the Office on the laptop and it is there, and a change on one device reaches another that is open within moments.
Saved on this device. It reaches your other devices when there is a signal.	No signal, or the account could not be reached. It goes up when the signal comes back, by itself.
(only "Saved", or "Kept on this device")	The sample church, or a database without the account copy yet. The device is all there is, as before.

If the same program is changed on two devices, **the newer change wins**, item by item: the phone's edit to one program and the laptop's to another both survive. A program deleted on one device stays deleted on the others, even one that was offline at the time. **The account's copy is its owner's alone.** Not a Director, not an Executive Director: nobody else's sign-in reads it, by the database's own rule. A program reaches other people the way it always did, as a post somebody chose to make.

Asking to walk with somebody

A Guide can see the Explorers nobody is walking with yet, and press **I have room** with an optional note. It goes to the Directors.

It puts your name forward; it does not make the pairing. A Director still creates it on the Pairings screen, where the limit of five is checked. A button that quietly created a relationship from a list of requests is how somebody ends up with six people.

The Explorer is never told they were asked for. Being wanted and not chosen is not something anybody should have to read about themselves.

> **NOTE**
>
> This widens what a Guide can see, on purpose
>
> A Guide can normally read exactly two accounts: their own and the Explorer they walk with. You cannot ask to walk with somebody you cannot name, so a Guide now sees the **name** of any Explorer in their church who is waiting. Nothing else comes with it: no birthday, no contact details, no stage, no messages, no prayer requests, no notes.

The Guides' room

A place for Guides and their Directors to talk to each other. Explorers cannot see it. Every conversation in the rest of the app is one Guide with one Explorer, which is right for that relationship and leaves a Guide with a hard week entirely alone.

CAUTION

A room, not private messages

Everybody in the room reads everything in it, and that is what makes it safe to have rather than a limitation. Guide-to-Guide direct messages would be a second private channel with no oversight, in an app whose whole design is that private conversation happens in one place and can be reported. Anyone can delete their own message; Directors can delete any.

CHAPTER 18

Cases, safeguarding, the audit and the numbers

From `docs/HANDBOOK.md`

IN THIS CHAPTER

Cases 160
Safeguarding 160
The security audit 161
Reading the numbers 161
The board report 163

Cases

Cases have a room of their own, in the Menu on every screen (for leadership, as **Admin Reports**; a Guide or an Explorer who is part of a case reaches it through Settings). A case is a formal proceeding about a person, sometimes about the person reading it, and it used to be a card partway down a dashboard: easy to scroll past on the one day it mattered, and sitting in the same visual rank as a study plan.

The link is always there, whether or not anything is open. A link that comes and goes is one nobody trusts is there, and its absence on a quiet day looks the same as it being broken. When there is nothing, the room says so.

An **Explorer** has the room too, and that matters most. An Explorer called into a case is the person in it with the least standing, and their answer has to be findable without anybody having to tell them where to look. They can write in it even while suspended: suspending somebody pending a hearing must not take away their side of it.

On a Guide's **Care** tab for one Explorer, prayer requests are always shown, even when there are none. The card used to disappear when empty, so the tab held only private notes and read as though a Guide could not see prayer requests at all.

A Director judging a case still works through it in **Admin → Safeguarding**, beside the reports the cases came from. That is a different job from answering one, and the screen tells the two apart by itself.

Safeguarding

Anybody can report a conversation. When they do:

- Every Director of that church is notified at once.

- A Director can read the conversation in place, with what came before and after, rather than as a single quoted line.
- **The person reported is never told.** No message, no notification, nothing they could notice.
- The reporter's name is visible to Directors, because a Director cannot support them or tell a genuine concern from a grudge without it.
- Reports are never deleted, whatever is decided.

A post on a guild board is reported the same way and arrives in the same queue, marked *Guild Room post*, with the post quoted underneath. The Director can close the report as usual and can also **delete the post**. Only leadership of that church can take a post down, and the removal is recorded in the security audit.

The quoted text is a copy taken when the report was made, so it is still there after the post is gone, including when the author deleted it themselves.

The security audit

Admin → Security is a plain list of things that happened to accounts: a name changed, a detail changed, a safeguarding report raised, somebody suspended, restored, removed, approved or disapproved, and a guild post taken down. Each line says who it was about, what happened, when, and how serious it is.

It carries no conversation and no file. Nothing anybody wrote to anybody else appears here, and the screen says so. It is a record of *administration*, not of speech.

Who sees whom follows rank, and only in one direction:

You are	You see activity about
A Director	Guides and Explorers in your church
An Executive Director	The same, plus Directors

A Director is not shown which *leader* acted on something, and those lines read *Church leadership*, because a Director reading a log of another Director's decisions is oversight pointing the wrong way. An Executive Director sees the names.

It lives inside Admin rather than as a room of its own, because it is a leadership tool and a door in the room list that only two roles can open is a door most of the church is invited to rattle.

Reading the numbers

The Church screen opens with four headline figures: Explorers, Guides, Graduated, and how many are waiting for a Guide. Under them sit two charts, each answering one question a Director actually asks.

Who is using it. One panel for Guides and one for Explorers, each showing everybody on the roll for today, this week and this month. The blue part of the bar is the people Beacon recorded doing something; the brown part is the rest.

CAUTION

What "active" does and does not mean

It is not a count of visits. Beacon does not record when somebody opens the app, so a number claiming to be visits would be invented. Active means the app recorded them doing something: sending a message, a step on a journey, arranging a meeting, or writing a post or a study.

An Explorer who met their Guide for coffee and wrote nothing down is in the brown part. That is not a failure and it should not be treated as one. What is worth acting on is a whole month of brown for one person, and *Waiting for a Guide* above zero.

Today will almost always look low, and that is the day, not the church. Read the week and the month.

Who is arriving. Four small charts, one for each role: Executive Directors, Directors, Guides and Explorers. Choose the period from Daily, Weekly, Monthly, Quarterly or Yearly. All four share one scale, so a tall bar means the same number of people wherever it appears.

Somebody counts as arriving on the day they finished signing up, not the day their invitation was sent. An invitation that sat unopened for three weeks would otherwise land on the wrong week.

Underneath, in the same period, is what the church decided about people: how many were let in, turned down, suspended, had a suspension lifted, and removed.

NOTE

Removed and deleted are one number

In Hope Beacon, removing somebody from the church deletes their account. There is no separate state where a person has been put out but still has a login. The record of the removal survives them, which is the point of keeping it.

NOTE

Average and middle period

Both are shown because they disagree in the case that matters. One busy week after a quiet month pulls the average up; the middle week is closer to an ordinary one.

Five ways to take the numbers with you, and each says what it is for.

Format	Use it when	Opens in
Sheets	You want to work on the numbers yourself. Keeps both tables and their headings.	Excel, Google Sheets, Numbers
Document	You are sending it to somebody who will edit it.	Word, Google Docs
PDF file	You are sending it to somebody who should not edit it. Downloads straight away.	Anything
Print	You are handing round paper at a meeting. The dialog can also save a PDF, and lets you pick the paper.	Printer, or save as PDF
CSV	You are feeding it into another program.	Anything at all

Every file carries the same explanations, not just the figures: what "active" means and does not mean, that "nothing recorded" is not the same as idle, and that removed and deleted are one number. A spreadsheet with a column headed *Active* and no definition beside it is how somebody decides that eleven of nineteen Guides are not working.

Every file also carries your church's name and the date it was made, and nobody's name is in any of them.

Every one of these numbers is a count. No name, no message and no prayer appears on this screen or in the file, and the part that counts messages runs inside the database and hands back only a total, so a Director reading "eleven Guides were active" is not reading anybody's conversation.

> **NOTE**
>
> An Explorer does not see the church counted
>
> *Your church at a glance* — Guides, Explorers, waiting for approval, graduated, where people are on the journey — is on the Church screen for Guides and leadership, and not for Explorers. It names nobody and shows no conversation, which is why it was on everyone's screen at first. Safe is not the same as theirs: it is the church looking at itself, and an Explorer opening their church screen was shown a tally of how many people like them there are and how many had "graduated". Community Blogs and the church's notices are what that screen is for.

The board report

Admin has a panel with the four numbers to read out at a board meeting, and a Print button. It names nobody. If a board member wants to know how one particular person is doing, the answer is to ask the Guide walking with them. The app will not show it.

CHAPTER 19

The Music room, in full

From `docs/guides/using/03-music-room.md`

IN THIS CHAPTER

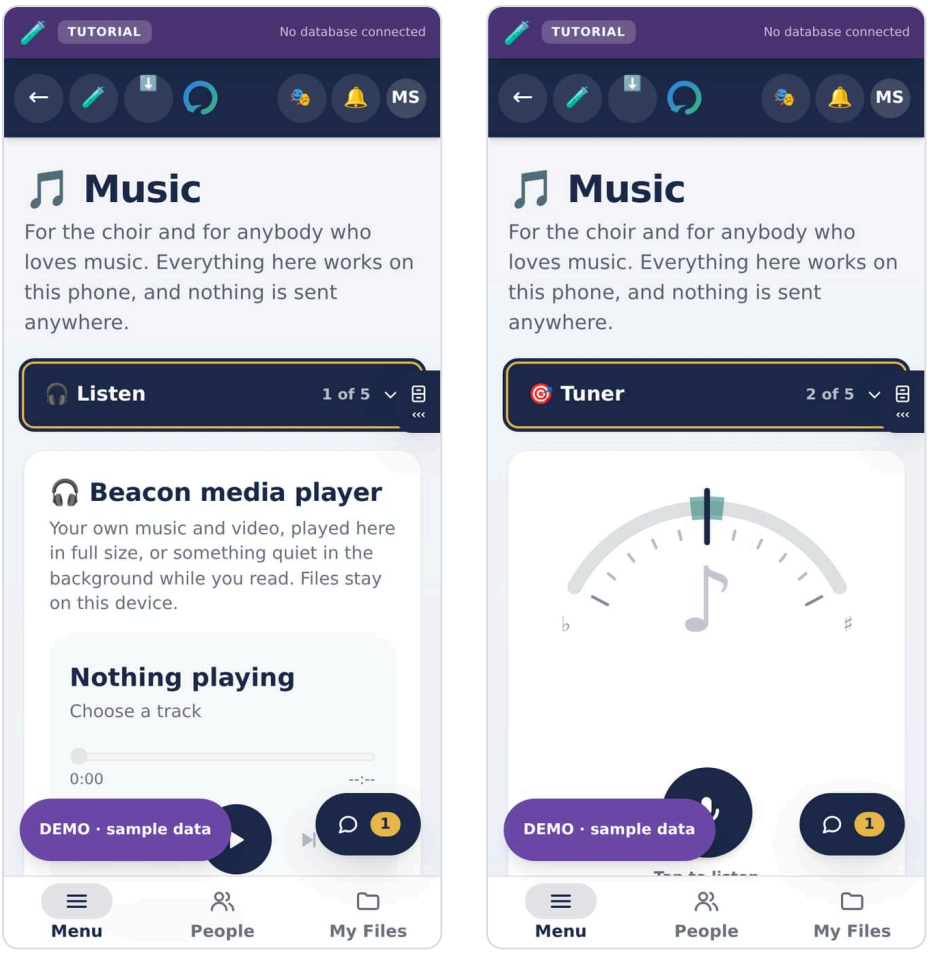
Listen: your music, your playlists, calming sounds 165
Tuner: which note, and is it in tune 166
Conductor: a steady beat, and the conductor's hand 172
Pieces: the choir's music, on the phone 173
Play: a keyboard, chords and your own beat 175
For a choir director: a rehearsal with the room 176
What it keeps, and where 176

Music is a room for everybody: the choir, its director, the person who leads the singing on Sabbath, and anybody who simply loves music. It is in every Menu, between *This Sabbath* and *My Files*.

Two promises hold for the whole room:

- **Nothing is sent anywhere.** Everything in it is worked out on the phone or computer you are holding. It never talks to the church's database, so it works the same in a church's own app and in the sample church.
- **It works with no signal.** Once the room has been opened, all five of its folders open again in a church hall with no connection.

Every folder opens simple. At the end of the Tuner, the Conductor, a score and Play there is a tick box, **Advanced settings**, that opens the rest. It is off until you tick it, the phone remembers it, and unticking it puts that folder back exactly as it was.



Listen and Tuner on a phone.

Listen: your music, your playlists, calming sounds

Listen is the full player. It has three tabs.

- **Vault**: your own music and video, saved on this device. Tap **Save music or video** to add files from your phone or computer. A search box sits over the list, because a good vault soon becomes a long one.
- **Playlists**: your own lists. Name one, then add whatever is playing to it. A playlist can mix calming sounds with your own recordings, so rainfall behind a sermon is one list.
- **Ambience**: calming sounds made on the device as they play. There is no file to download, so they cost no data and work with no signal. *Calm* (rainfall, distant surf, night wind) is for sitting with while you read; *White noise* (soft hush, plain hush) is brighter and covers voices around you.

The controls are the ones every player has: a progress bar you can drag, the time so far and the time left, previous and next, back ten seconds and forward ten seconds (which is what you want in a talk), mute and volume. Videos play with their picture, and keep playing when you walk to another room.

GOOD TO KNOW

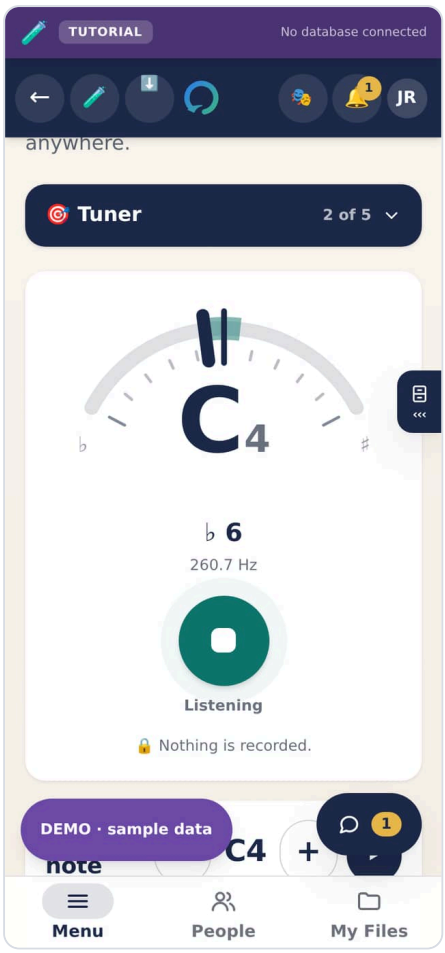
Your music stays yours

What somebody listens to is nobody else's business. The vault and the playlists live on the device and are never uploaded. Music you add here is also listed in **My Files**, where each file has its own Play button.

Tuner: which note, and is it in tune

The Tuner is a dial with the note in the middle, and one round button.

1. Open **Tuner** and tap the round **microphone** button (*Tap to listen*).
2. The first time, your phone asks whether the app may use the microphone. Say yes; it is asked only once.
3. Sing or play a steady note. The note shows in the middle of the dial (such as *A4* or *C♯3*), and a marker moves along the dial: **left when you are flat (♭)**, **right when you are sharp (♯)**. The green band at the top is *in tune* (within 5 cents), and the bold line through it is the note exactly. In the band the marker turns green and the dial says **✓ In tune**; outside it, it says how far off you are, such as **♭ 12**. A new note shows in about a tenth of a second, and when you stop, the last note stays for a moment so you can read it.
4. Tap the button again (a green square while it listens) to stop.



The Tuner on a phone: the dial, a C4 sung and in tune, and the round button, green while it listens.

Starting note gives the choir its first note, like a pitch pipe: choose the note with **−** and **+** and tap ▶. It plays for two seconds.

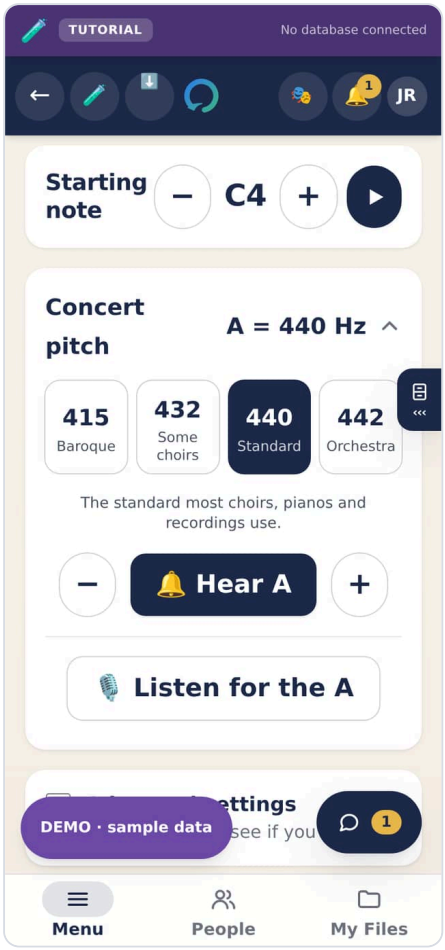
Concert pitch: where the choir's A sits

Concert pitch is the A that every other note is tuned from: **A = 440 Hz** unless you change it, the standard most choirs, pianos and recordings use. An older organ, a baroque group or an orchestra may use another, and then everything should follow it: the tuner should call a note in tune when it matches that instrument, and the starting note should sound like it.

Tap **Concert pitch** to open it.

1. Tap one of the common pitches: **415** (Baroque), **432**, **440** (Standard) or **442** (Orchestra), or move it one hertz at a time with **−** and **+**. Every change plays the new A, so you hear it, and a line says what it does to every note, such as *2 Hz above the standard 440: every note sounds about 8 cents higher*. A hundred cents is one semitone, one key on a piano. **Hear A** plays it again.
2. **To match an instrument**, ask the organist or pianist to hold an A, tap **Listen for the A**, and hold the phone near it. Once the A has been steady for a moment, the app says what it heard, such as *Heard 441.6 Hz*, and offers **Use 442 Hz**. Nothing changes until you tap it, and nothing is recorded.

When it is not 440, the dial shows the pitch it follows, such as *A = 442*. The phone remembers your concert pitch until you change it.



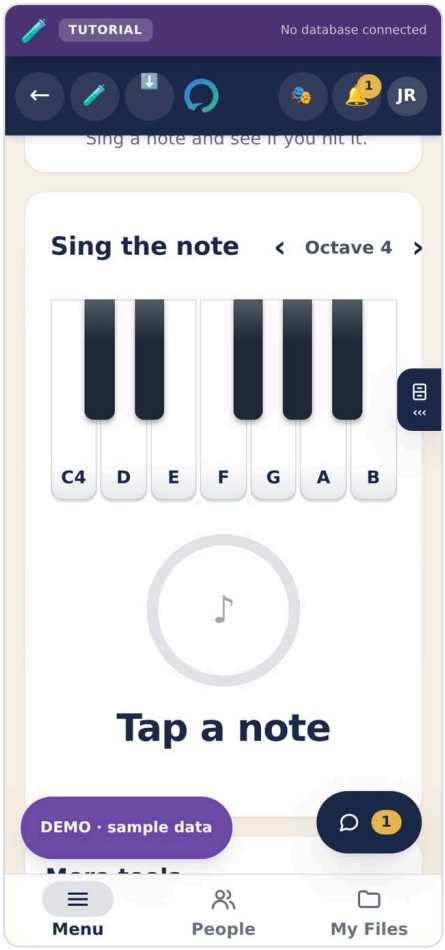
Concert pitch opened: one tap for each common A, a line saying what it does, Hear A, and Listen for the A.

Advanced: sing the note

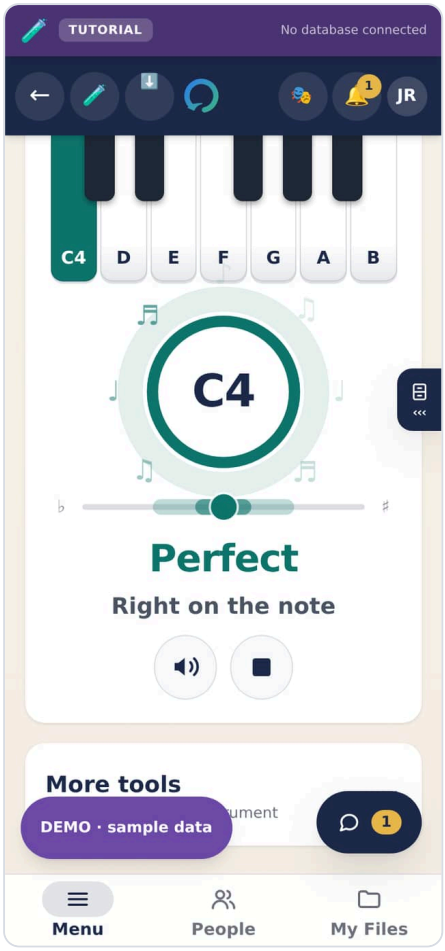
Tick **Advanced settings** and **Sing the note** opens: a piano keyboard.

1. **Tap a key.** The note shows in a ring, and the tuner starts listening. Use ‹ and › to move the keyboard down or up an octave.
2. **Sing it and hold it.** A marker shows how near you are (flat to the left, sharp to the right, the middle is the note) and the ring fills while you hold it.
3. **After about two-thirds of a second, it tells you:**
   - **Perfect**: within a tenth of a semitone (10 cents). The ring bursts with notes: perfect pitch.
   - **Close**: within a quarter of a semitone (25 cents), close enough for a choir. It says *A little sharp ↓* or *A little flat ↑*.
   - **Try again**: further off, or another note. It says what you sang, such as *You sang C4 ↑* (the arrow is the way to go), or *Too flat*.
4. **Sing again** whenever you like: take a breath and sing, and it grades you again, with no need to tap. Tap another key for another note.

The **speaker** button plays the note; the tuner does not listen while it plays, so the phone cannot pass a note by singing it to itself. The **square** stops listening.



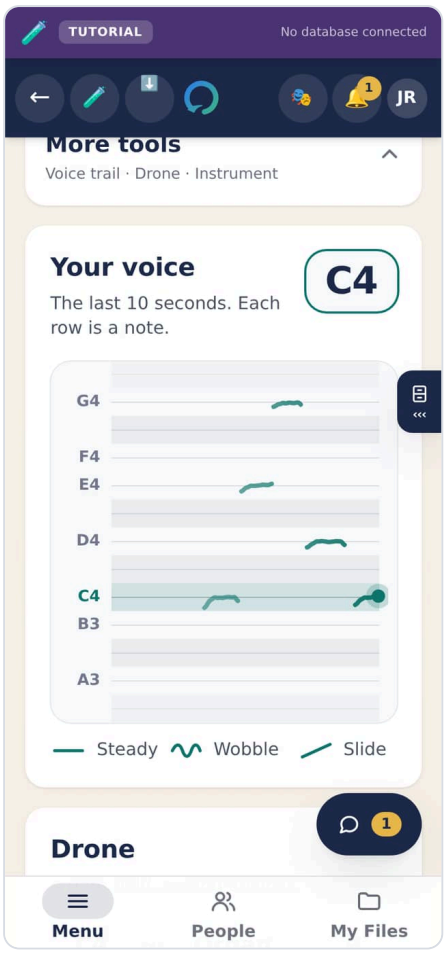
Sing the note on a phone: a keyboard, waiting for a note to be tapped.



C4 tapped and sung: Perfect, with a burst of notes.

More tools, under Sing the note, opens three more:

- **Your voice.** While the tuner listens, the last ten seconds of your voice are drawn across one octave of notes, a row for each note with its name beside it, as on a piano roll. The octave follows your voice; the note you are singing now is lit, and its name is shown large at the top. Each note you sing is a line of its own: **steady** (level), a **wobble** (a wave), or a **slide** (a slope). A line that sits on a note's row is that note in tune. Only the last ten seconds are drawn, and they are forgotten when you leave the Tuner.



Your voice on a phone: one octave of notes, each named, the note being sung lit, and each note sung a line of its own.

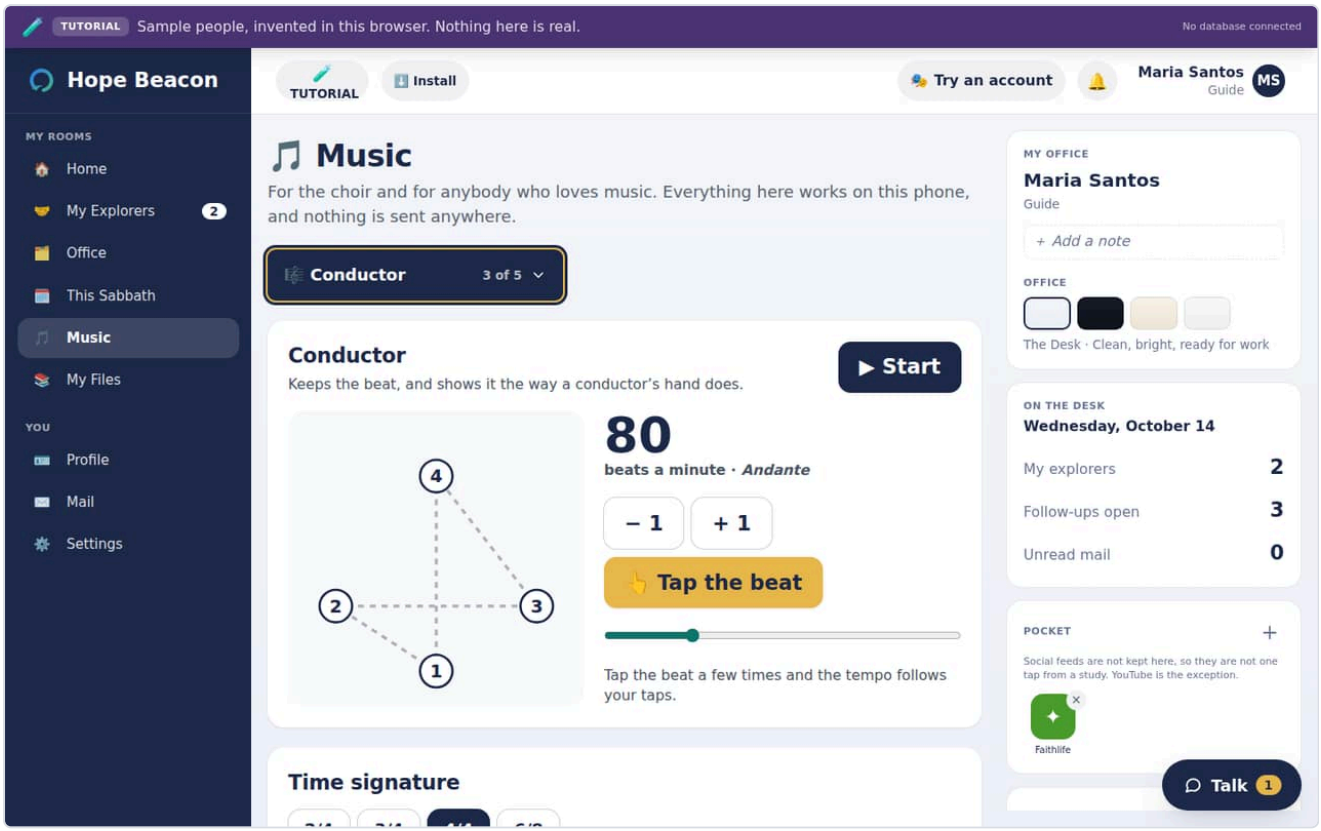
- **Drone.** One note held for as long as you like, to sing against. Choose the note and the sound (soft voice, organ or flute) and tap **Start the drone**. When your voice drifts you hear it rub against the drone. With the tuner listening at the same time, wear headphones, or the tuner hears the drone instead of you. Tapping a key in Sing the note stops it.
- **Your instrument.** A clarinet or trumpet, an alto saxophone or a French horn reads its music higher than it sounds. Choose yours and the tuner shows the note you would read, with the note it sounds underneath: a concert A on a B♭ clarinet reads *B*.

IMPORTANT

What the microphone does, and does not do

The tuner listens only after you tap the **microphone** button (or a key in Sing the note). It measures the sound on the phone and throws it away: **nothing is recorded, kept or sent**. It lets go of the microphone when you tap the button again (or ■ in Sing the note), when you leave the Tuner, and when the phone locks or another app comes to the front, so the phone's own recording light goes off.

Conductor: a steady beat, and the conductor's hand



The Conductor on a computer: the pattern for four beats, numbered where the hand falls.

1. Open **Conductor** and choose the beats in a bar: **2**, **3**, **4** or **6**. The drawing shows the pattern a conductor's hand makes, numbered where each beat falls.
2. Set the tempo, from 30 to 240 beats a minute. Its Italian name (*Largo*, *Andante*, *Allegro*) is shown beside it.
3. Tap **Start**. The clicks sound and the hand falls into each beat.

To set the tempo by feel, tap **Tap the beat** four or five times in time with the music in your head; the tempo follows your taps. To follow the hand in silence, during a rehearsal say, untick **Sound the clicks**. The screen stays on while the conductor runs.

Advanced: clicks between beats, quiet beats, a count-in, a speed trainer

Tick **Advanced settings** under **Sound the clicks**.

- **Clicks between beats.** *2 to a beat*, *3 to a beat* (for triplets) or *4 to a beat* adds quieter clicks between the beats, for fast notes.
- **Each beat.** Tap a beat to make it **Loud**, **Normal** or **Silent**. A silent beat still moves the hand. Beat one starts loud and the rest normal.
- **Count in, then silent.** One bar of clicks to start the choir, then the hand keeps time without a sound.
- **Speed trainer.** For learning a hard passage: it starts at the tempo you set and gets a little faster as you go. Choose how much faster, how often (every so many bars), and the tempo to stop at. It never goes past that.

- **Saved tempos.** Give the tempo a name, such as *Hymn 100*, and tap **Save**. One tap on the name brings back its tempo and its beats in a bar. Kept on this phone.

Pieces: the choir's music, on the phone

Pieces keeps the music your choir sings, in two kinds.

A printed page, made clean.

1. Tap **Scan a page** and choose a photo of the printed page.
2. Drag the four dots onto the four corners of the paper.
3. Tap **Make a clean page**. The page is straightened, cropped to the paper, and turned black on white, even with a shadow across it.

Only the clean page is kept, never the photo, so nothing the camera wrote into the photo (such as where it was taken) is kept either.

A score that plays.

1. Tap **Open a score or PDF** and choose either:
   - a MusicXML file (`.musicxml`, `.xml` or a compressed `.mxl`), which MuseScore, Sibelius, Finale and Dorico all save; or
   - a **PDF that a notation program made**, such as MuseScore or Dorico. It is read note by note on the phone: the notes and rhythms of every part, the key, time and tempo, ties, two voices on one staff, the words, and the loud and soft markings.
2. Choose **Your part**. It plays louder than the others; any part can also be silenced.
3. Slow it down to learn it, and tap any note to start from there.

The score is drawn as notes on a strip, higher notes higher and longer notes longer: what a singer learning a part needs. It is not printed notation.

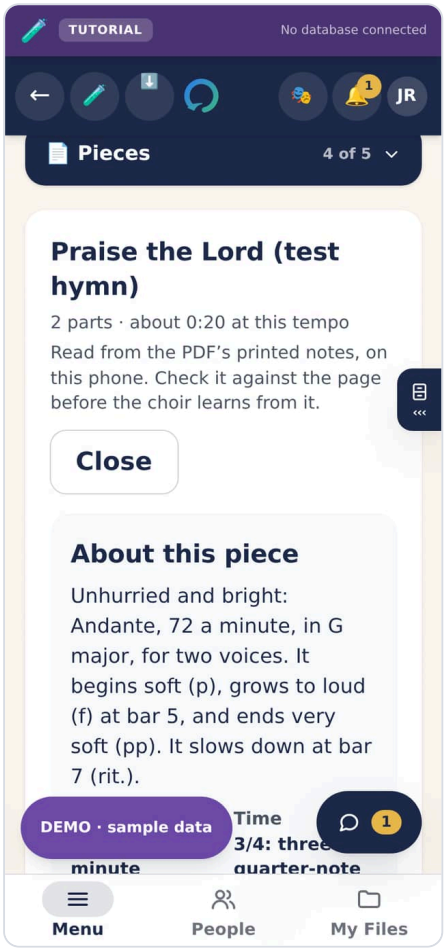
A score read from a PDF says so under its title: *Read from the PDF's printed notes, on this phone. Check it against the page before the choir learns from it.* If any bar did not add up to the time signature, it says how many, so you know where to look. The PDF itself is kept on the phone and read again each time you open it.

> **NOTE**
>
> Which PDFs can be read
>
> A PDF exported by a notation program carries its notes as exact symbols, and those are read. On 80 Bach chorales made with MuseScore that it had never seen, it read 99.78% of the notes exactly right. A **scanned** PDF, or a photo saved as a PDF, is only a picture: Pieces says so, and you can keep it with **Scan a page** to read from instead. PDFs from older Sibelius and Finale use their own music fonts and are not read yet. Tuplets, repeats, second verses and grace notes are not read.

About this piece. Above the strip, the score explains itself, from its own markings:

- one or two sentences on its character, such as *Unhurried and bright: Andante, 72 a minute, in G major, for two voices. It begins soft (p), grows to loud (f) at bar 5, and ends very soft (pp).* It says what the composer wrote, in plain words, and no more;
- its tempo, time, key and length;
- **Loud, soft and speed**: each marking, bar by bar;
- **Each part**: how low and high it goes, and its widest leap, marked *Practise this* when it is a sixth or more (or a tritone);
- **The words** of your part, joined back into words.

Conduct this piece opens the Conductor already set to the score's time and tempo (6/8 is beaten in six, 2/2 in two, 12/8 in four).



A choir PDF opened on a phone: the note under the title says it was read from the printed notes, and About this piece begins below it.

Advanced, for a score. Tick **Advanced settings** under the parts.

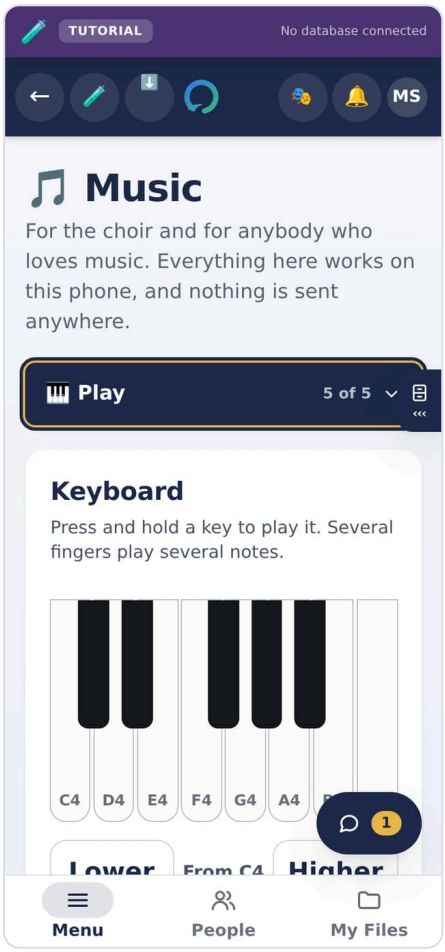
- **Transpose**: move every part up or down, a semitone at a time (up to an octave each way), to suit your voices. The strip moves with it.
- **Loop a passage**: choose the first and last beat and it plays them over and over, to learn them.
- **I sing my part**: your part goes silent and is drawn faintly, so you sing it against the others. Choose **Your part** first.
- **Sound**: a soft voice, an organ or a flute.

Above the strip it says what it will play, such as *Looping beats 1 to 2, up 2 semitones*. Unticking Advanced plays the score as written again.

> **NOTE**
>
> A scanned page does not play
>
> Turning a photo of printed music into notes that play needs either a server to send the photo to, or software the app's security rules do not allow on a phone. The project decided to leave it out for now: scanned pages are for reading, and scores play from MusicXML files and from PDFs that notation programs made.

Play: a keyboard, chords and your own beat

Play is for making music, not only practising it.



Play on a phone: an octave of keys at the choir's concert pitch.

The keyboard. An octave of piano keys. Press and hold a key and it sounds for as long as you hold it; several fingers play several notes. **Lower** and **Higher** move the keyboard an octave at a time. It plays at your concert pitch.

Tick **Advanced settings** and three more cards open.

- **Sound**: a soft voice, an organ or a flute, for the keyboard and the chords.

- **Chords**: choose a key, and the six chords most songs in it are built from are a tap each (in C: C, Dm, Em, F, G and Am). Tap them in time to accompany a tune.
- **Beat maker**: three drums (bass drum, snare, hi-hat) in rows of sixteen squares, each square a quarter of a beat. Tap squares to turn them on, then **Play the beat**; it goes round and round, lighting each square as it plays, and the tempo can change while it plays. **Start from** a ready-made beat (*Steady four*, *Rock*, *Ballad*, *Praise*) or an empty grid, and save your own with a name. Kept on this phone.

Leaving Play, or locking the phone, stops every sound.

For a choir director: a rehearsal with the room

1. Before the rehearsal, ask a section leader to export each piece from MuseScore as **MusicXML** and send it round. Each singer opens it in **Pieces** and chooses their own part.
2. At the start, use **Starting note** in the **Tuner** to give the first note, and **Tuner** itself for anybody unsure of their pitch.
3. Run the hard passages with the **Conductor**, slow at first; untick **Sound the clicks** once the choir has the tempo, and keep the hand on a screen everybody can see.
4. For the printed copies, **Scan a page** turns a photo of each into a clean page that is easy to read on a phone.

What it keeps, and where

What	Where it is kept	Who can see it
Your music, video and playlists	On this device	Only you, on this device
Your clean pages and scores	On this device, in the Music room's own store	Only you, on this device
Concert pitch, the conductor's settings, saved tempos and beats, the notes you chose to sing, and which folders have Advanced open	On this device	Only you
Sound from the microphone	Nowhere: measured and thrown away	Nobody

Because it is all on the device, a new phone starts with an empty Music room. Keep your score files somewhere you can open them again.

CHAPTER 20

Reports, trials and the record

From `docs/JUSTICE.md`

IN THIS CHAPTER

Part 1 — Reporting something 177
Part 2 — Who can see what 178
Part 3 — The activity record, and what leadership cannot see 178
Part 4 — A trial 180
Part 5 — The discipline log 181
Part 6 — What this app will not do 181
Part 7 — If you are asked to handle one 181
If something here does not match what you see 182

For everybody in the church, whatever your role.

This is the part of the app nobody wants to need. It exists so that when something goes wrong there is a way to say so that is not a rumour, and a record afterwards that cannot quietly disappear.

Read the first two sections even if you never expect to use them. Knowing that a thing exists is most of what makes it work.

Part 1 — Reporting something

Who can report

Anybody. You do not need a role, a Guide's permission, or a reason anybody else would agree with.

What happens when you do

1. You write what happened. You choose a reason and add the detail in your own words.
2. The report goes to the people whose job it is to handle it. It does **not** go to the person you are reporting, and it does not appear anywhere public.
3. Somebody claims it, so two people are not working on the same thing without knowing.
4. They decide, and the decision is recorded with their name on it.

What you can see afterwards

Your own report, always. It stays yours to open. You can see its status, who decided it and what the outcome was. Nobody can take that view away from you, including the person who decided it.

You cannot see anybody else's report, and nobody who is not handling yours can see yours.

What the person you reported can see

Not the report. Not your name in it. If the matter goes further and becomes a trial, they are told about the trial, because somebody answering a complaint has to know what it is.

Part 2 — Who can see what

This is enforced by the database, not by a screen hiding a button. A page that forgot to check would still show nothing, because the rules sit underneath every query anybody can make.

	Who can read it
A report	The person who wrote it, and the leadership handling it. Nobody else.
Messages on a report	Only the people on that report.
A trial	Only the people in that trial.
What is said in a trial	Only the people in that trial.
The discipline log	Only those leading the church.
The activity record	Leadership, for the ranks below them. It holds no addresses. See Part 3.

"Nobody else" includes Directors who are not on the case, Guides, and the person who set the app up.

Part 3 — The activity record, and what leadership cannot see

Leadership can see **that** you shared or saved something. It cannot see **what**.

What is recorded

Three things, and only these three:

- A Guide **adding** a resource to the library.
- Anyone **sharing** a resource with the person they walk with.
- Anyone **putting a web app in their pocket**.

Each one records who did it, when, what it was called, and **a label saying what kind of address it was**. Nothing else.

What is not recorded, ever

- **Conversations.** Nothing you say to your Guide, your Explorer, or in a guild room appears here or anywhere leadership can read. That exception is deliberate and it is checked by the build.
- **What you read.** Opening something is not an event. Only adding, sharing and pocketing are.
- **The address itself.** This is the part worth understanding properly.

The addresses are not hidden. They are not kept.

A Director does not see a link because **there is no link in the record to see** — the column that used to hold it was deleted from the database, not merely left out of the screen. Nobody can restore it, including whoever built this, because it is not anywhere to restore.

What replaces it is a label the database works out as the row is written:

The label	What it means
Ordinary	An ordinary web address.
Needs a look	A shortened link, an unprotected connection, a throwaway kind of address.
Not good	Adult content, gambling, a link that runs code, an address disguised as another, a file that installs something.

Alongside it the record says **how many times that person has been to the same place** — not which place. That is what turns a slip into a pattern without telling anybody where somebody went.

Where your links do still live

With you and the person you shared them with. Your Guide's resource keeps its address in the library, visible to that Guide and the Explorer they gave it to. Your pocket keeps your own web apps. Those are yours. The *record* of the act is a different thing, read by a different rank, and it carries the shape rather than the thing.

Nothing is sent anywhere to be checked

The labels are worked out entirely inside your church's own database, by rules about the **shape** of an address. No link a member shares is sent to any outside company to be scored. Doing that would hand a stranger the reading habits of the whole congregation, which is worse than the problem it solves, and it would happen quietly.

The rules are not clever and are not meant to be. They will miss things, and they will occasionally flag something innocent. The label means *somebody should look*, never *this person did wrong*.

Who reads it

- A **Director** reads it for the Guides and Explorers of a church they lead.
- An **Executive Director**, head or otherwise, reads those and the Directors.

- **Nobody reads their own row.** An account that can watch itself is not being watched.
- **A Guide or an Explorer cannot open this record at all.**

What happens when something is labelled Not good

Everyone in leadership is **alerted straight away** — on their phone, if they have notifications on. The alert names the person, what they did and the label. It does not name the address, because nobody in leadership has been shown it.

The person it is about is **not told they are being looked at**, for the same reason a report is not shown to the person reported.

Opening a case from it

Any Director or Executive Director can turn one line of the record into a case, from the row itself. It becomes an ordinary report — the same object anybody could have raised, answered by the same people, kept for as long — carrying what was done and how it was labelled.

It cannot carry the address, because leadership never had it. If the address matters to the case, it has to come from the person, in their own words. That is a real limit and it is the price of the rest of this page.

The record itself is kept for **30 days** and then deleted. A case is not.

Part 4 — A trial

Most reports never become one. A trial is for the serious end: when a decision needs more than one person and needs a record.

Who is in it

- **A head judge**, who runs it.
- **The subject**, the person the matter is about.
- **The person who reported it**, put in automatically when the trial comes out of a report.
- **Other parties**, summoned because they have something to say.

Everybody in a trial can read the whole of it, and nobody outside it can read any of it.

Read that third line twice before you file a report about something serious. If your report becomes a trial you are in the room: you will be able to read what the person you reported says in their answer, and they will know somebody reported them, because a trial has to tell its subject what it is about. They are not shown your report and they are not told your name by the app. Being a party to the trial is a different thing from the report staying private, and both are true at the same time.

This was checked against the live database rather than remembered: a Guide who is in neither the report nor the trial reads nothing of either, an Explorer with no part in it reads nothing, and the person the trial is about can read it and answer in it.

Speaking in one

Anyone summoned can add a statement while the trial is **open**. Once it is closed, nobody can add anything, including the head judge. That is deliberate: a record that can be added to afterwards is not a record.

Statements carry the name of whoever wrote them and the time they wrote it.

Escalation

A trial can be escalated when it is beyond the people currently in it. That is a step upward to more senior leadership, not a punishment, and it is recorded with the time it happened.

The end of it

A trial closes with a **verdict** and a note explaining it. Both stay attached to the trial for good.

Part 5 — The discipline log

When somebody is disciplined, removed or restored, that goes in the log.

The log survives the person. If an account is deleted afterwards, the entry stays, with the name as it was at the time. This is the single most important property in this part of the app: a church cannot lose its record of what was decided by deleting the person it was decided about.

The log carries what was done, the reason, who did it, when, and which guilds were involved. It is readable by those leading the church, and by nobody else.

Part 6 — What this app will not do

Said plainly, because a safeguarding system that overpromises is worse than one that is modest.

- **It is not an emergency service.** If somebody is in danger, call the authorities. This app is a record, not a response.
- **It does not notify the police, a conference or anybody outside the church.** Every message here stays inside your congregation's own database.
- **It does not judge anything by itself.** There is no scoring, no automatic action, nothing decided by the software. Every outcome in here has a person's name on it.
- **It cannot undo a deletion of a report.** Reports are not deleted by design, but no part of this is a backup of itself. Backups are a separate thing and are described in the handbook.

Part 7 — If you are asked to handle one

For Directors and Executive Directors.

- **Claim it before you work on it.** That is what stops two people deciding the same report in two different ways.
- **Decide in the app, not in a conversation.** The outcome field is what somebody will read in a year. A decision made in a chat and never recorded is a decision the church cannot show it made.
- **Write the reason as if the person will read it**, because they may. The reporter can see the outcome on their own report.
- **Escalate rather than sit on it.** A report nobody has claimed is a person waiting without knowing whether they were heard.

If something here does not match what you see

That is worth reporting on its own. A screenshot of the screen, with what you expected, is the fastest way to get it fixed. This document describes the rules that were read out of the live database; a screen that behaves differently is a bug in the screen.

PART V

Every screen, in pictures

An atlas of the whole app as the sample church shows it: every room and every folder, for each role, on a phone beside a computer. Use it to find a screen somebody describes, or to see what another role sees.

21 Explorer screens 184

22 Guide screens 196

23 Director screens 209

24 Executive Director screens 226

25 On a tablet, and before signing in 243

CHAPTER 21

Explorer screens

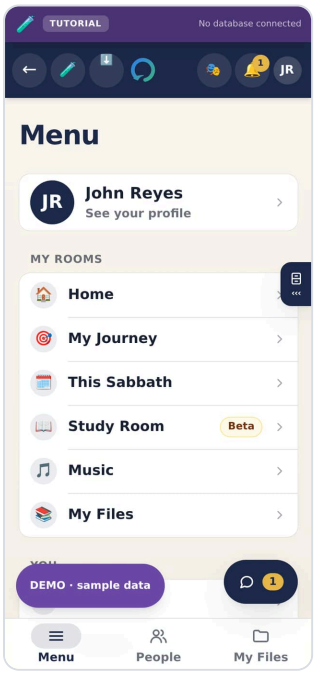
What John Reyes, an Explorer in the sample church, sees: his own journey, the church, music and his own files.

IN THIS CHAPTER

Profile 185
Home 185
My Journey 186
This Sabbath 188
Study Room 189
Music 189
My Files 192
Mail 193
Settings 194

The Menu

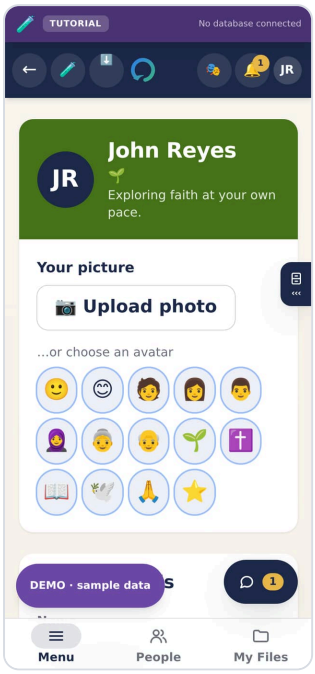
Every room this person has, written out, with their own profile at the top. It is the first of the three words along the bottom of every screen: Menu, People, My Files.



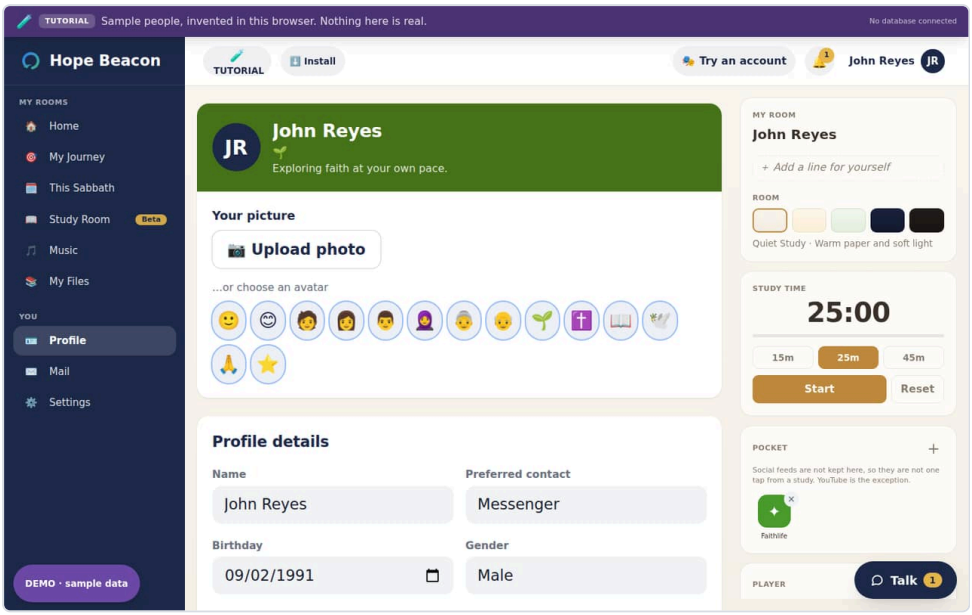
On a phone

Profile

Your own page: your name, your photograph and your details. Everybody has one, and it is the first row of the Menu.



On a phone



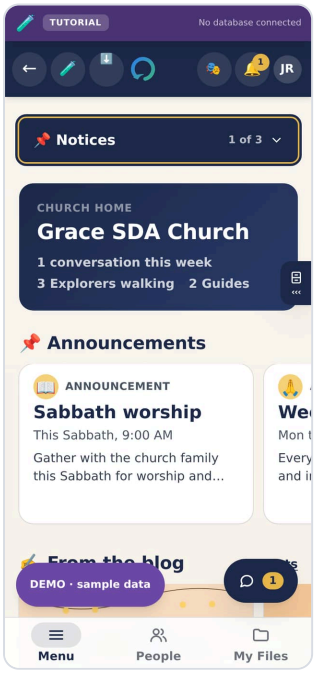
On a computer

Home

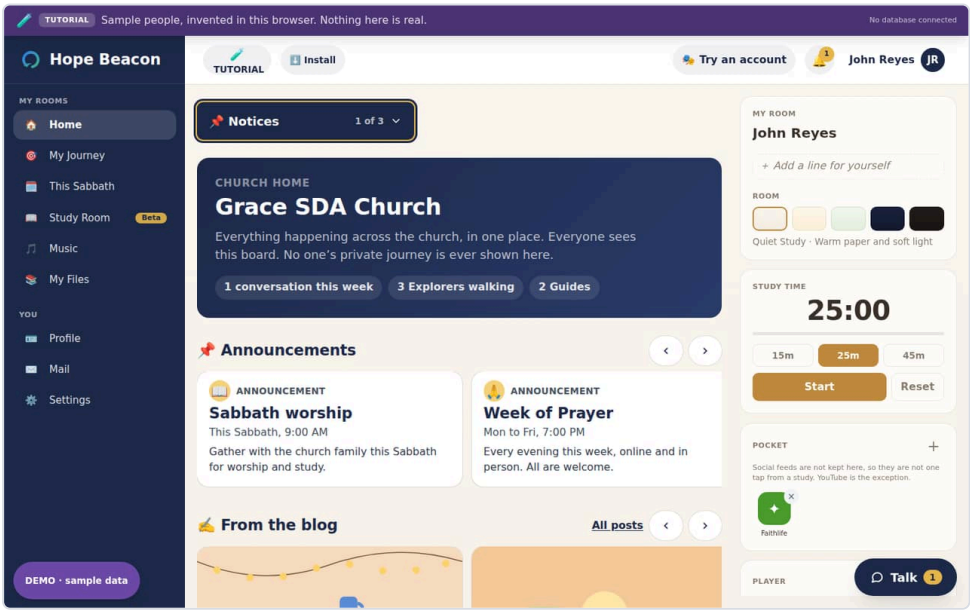
The church home, and the first room on every Menu: what the whole church is saying, before anybody turns to their own work.

Home › Notices

Pinned announcements from the church, newest first, with when each happens.



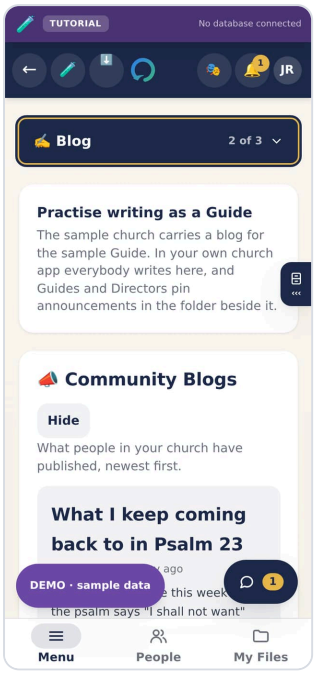
On a phone



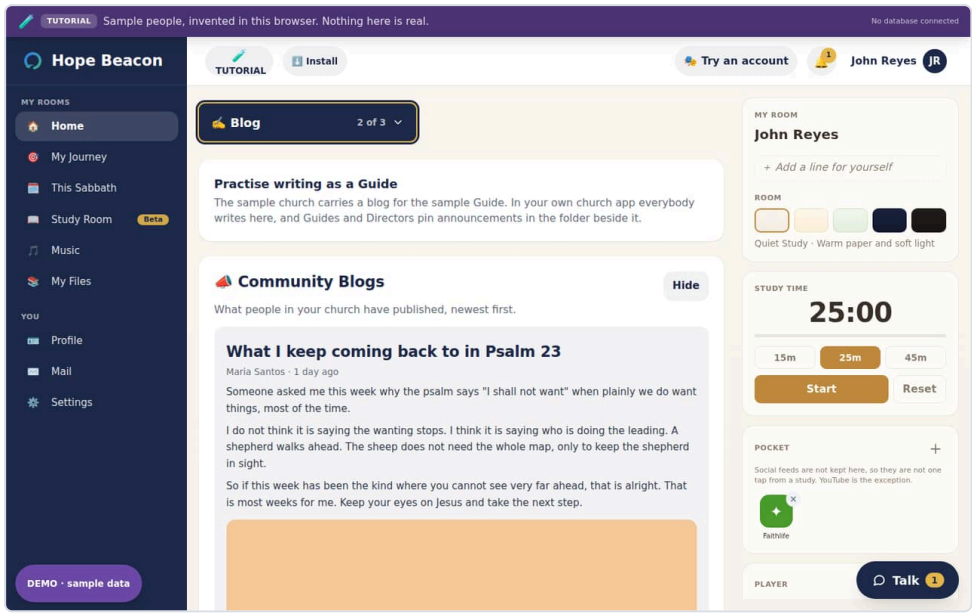
On a computer

Home › Blog

Posts written for the church. **Write a post** is at the top: a title, the words, **Publish**. Advanced settings narrow who reads it, or keep it as a draft.



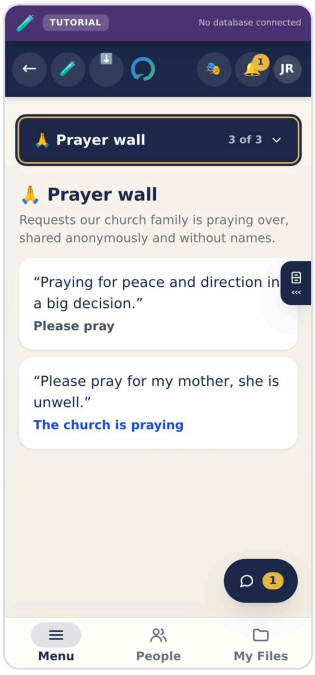
On a phone



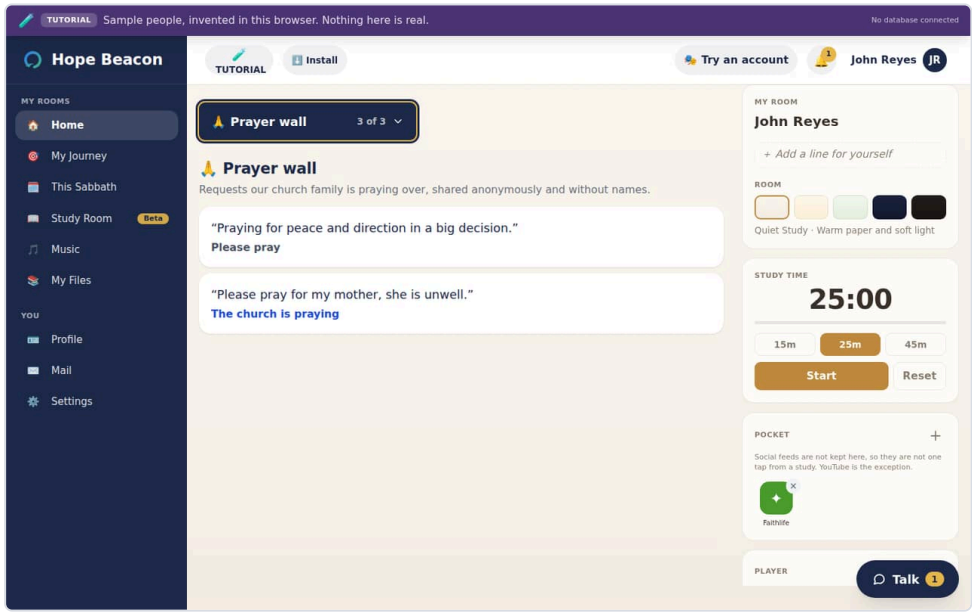
On a computer

Home › Prayer wall

Requests the church has been asked to pray for. A request reaches the wall only when the person asking ticks the box, and their name is never shown.



On a phone



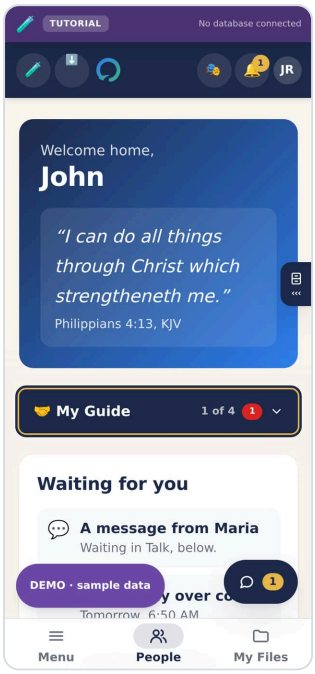
On a computer

My Journey

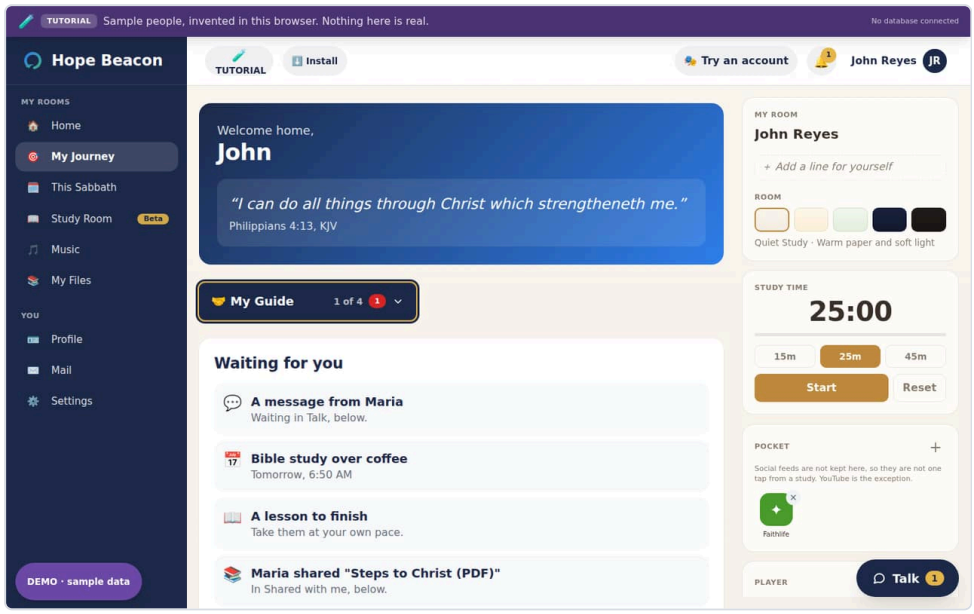
An Explorer's own room. It is built around one relationship, the Guide walking with them, and it holds nothing about anybody else.

My Journey › My Guide

The Explorer's Guide, and anything waiting from them. The conversation itself is the round **Talk** button in the corner.



On a phone

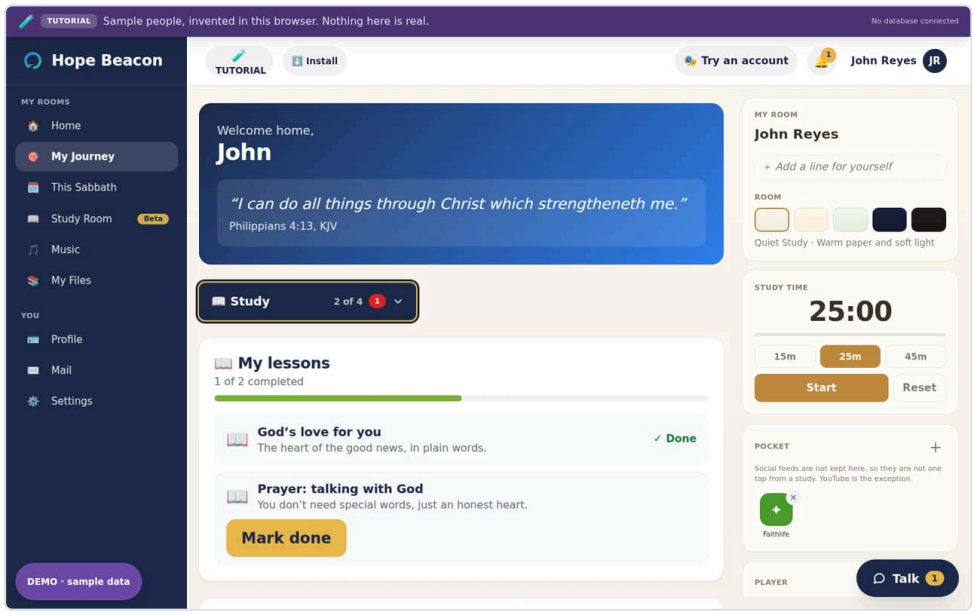


On a computer

My Journey › Study

The lessons the Guide has sent, in the order they were sent. There is no schedule and nothing to fall behind on.

On a phone

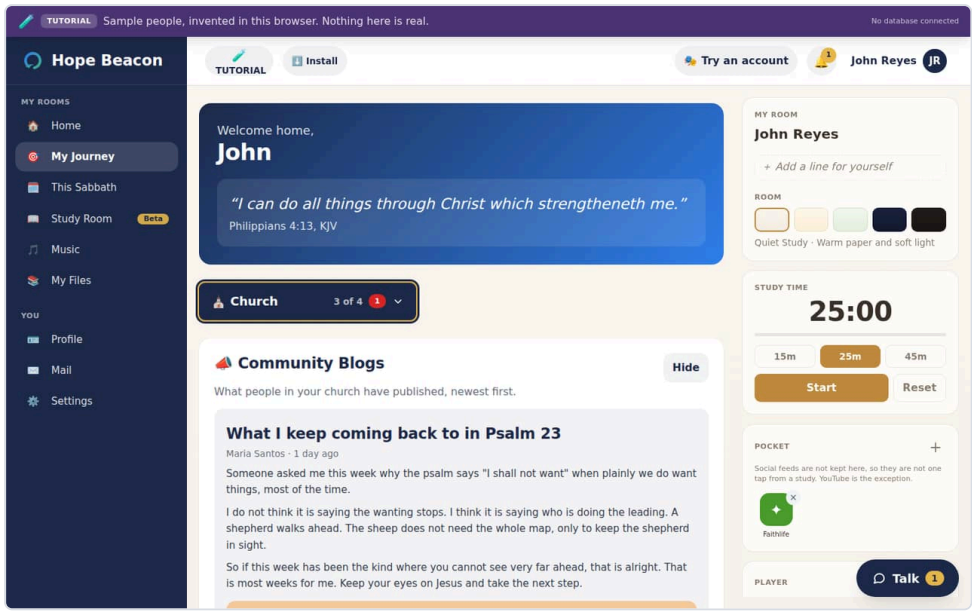


On a computer

My Journey › Church

Notices and writing from the church, to read without owing anybody a reply.

On a phone

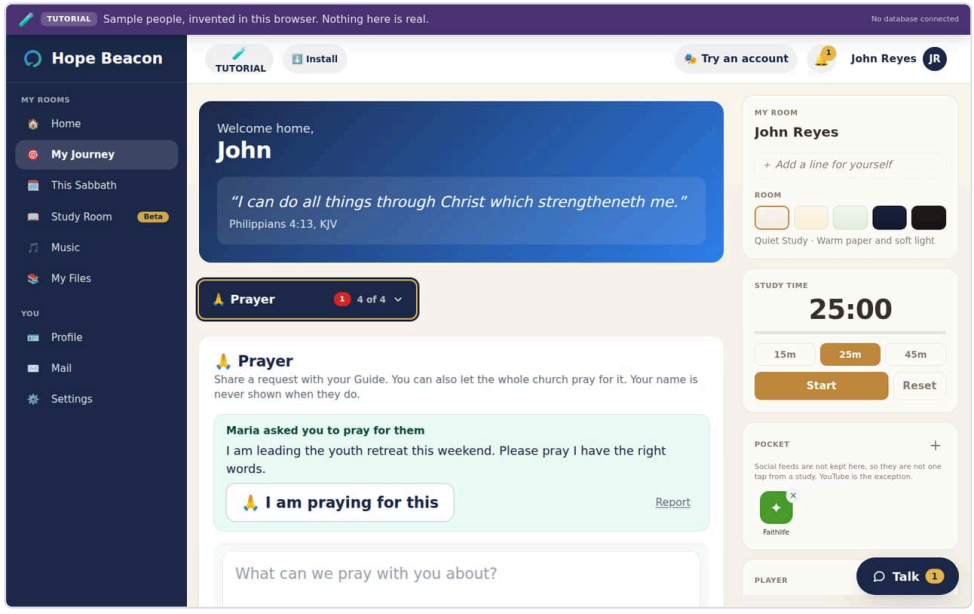


On a computer

My Journey › Prayer

Asking for prayer, and praying for a Guide who has asked. A request goes to the Guide alone unless the Explorer chooses the church.

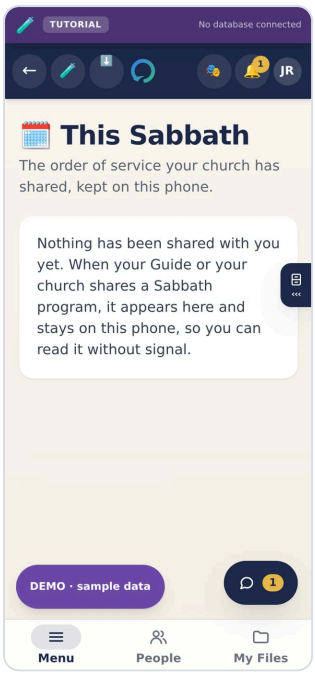
On a phone



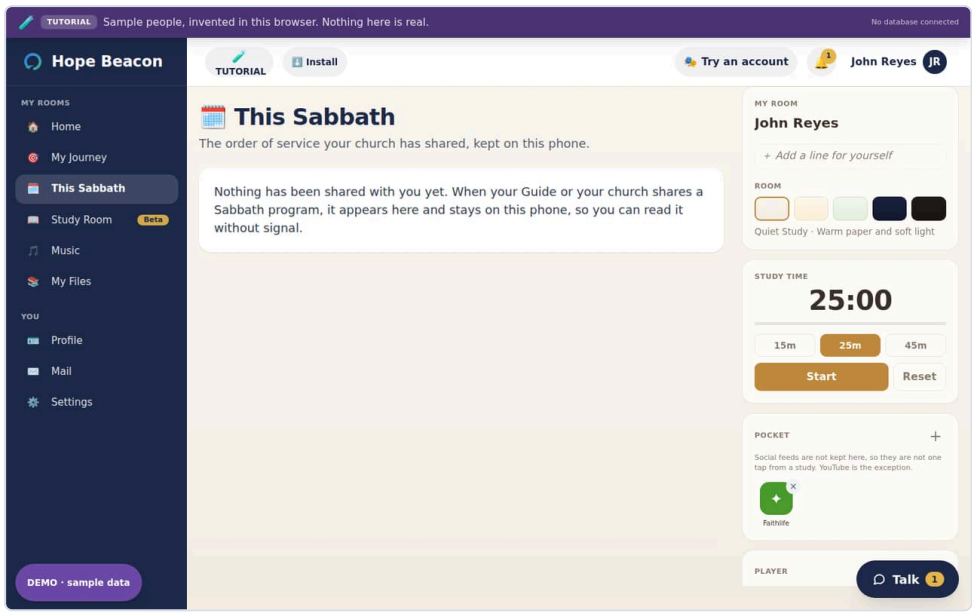
On a computer

This Sabbath

The Sabbath program and any evangelistic meetings a Guide or the church has posted. Once it has been opened with a signal, it opens again with none.



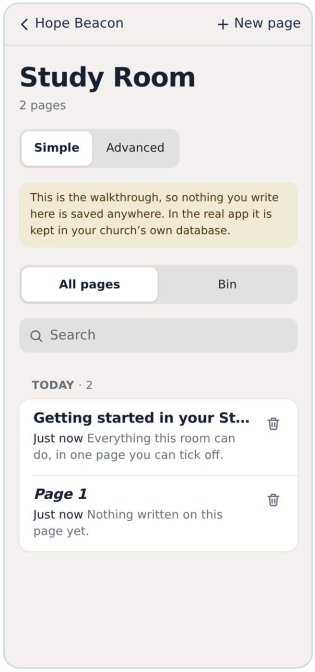
On a phone



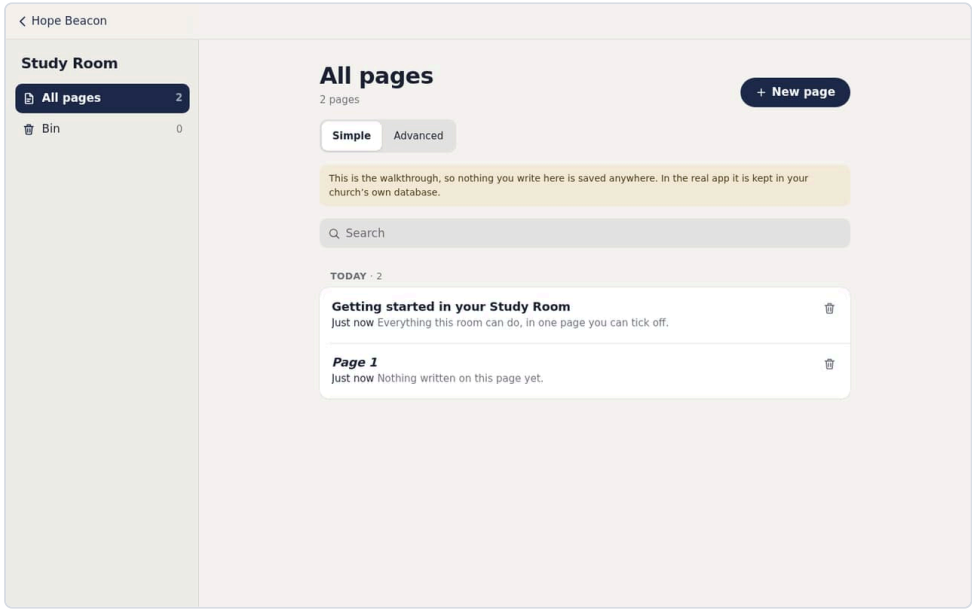
On a computer

Study Room

An Explorer's own place to write while they read. Nobody else sees it. It is marked beta because the editor inside it is borrowed and is the heaviest part of the app.



On a phone



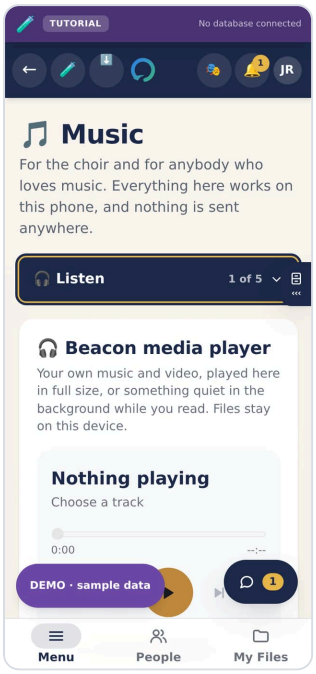
On a computer

Music

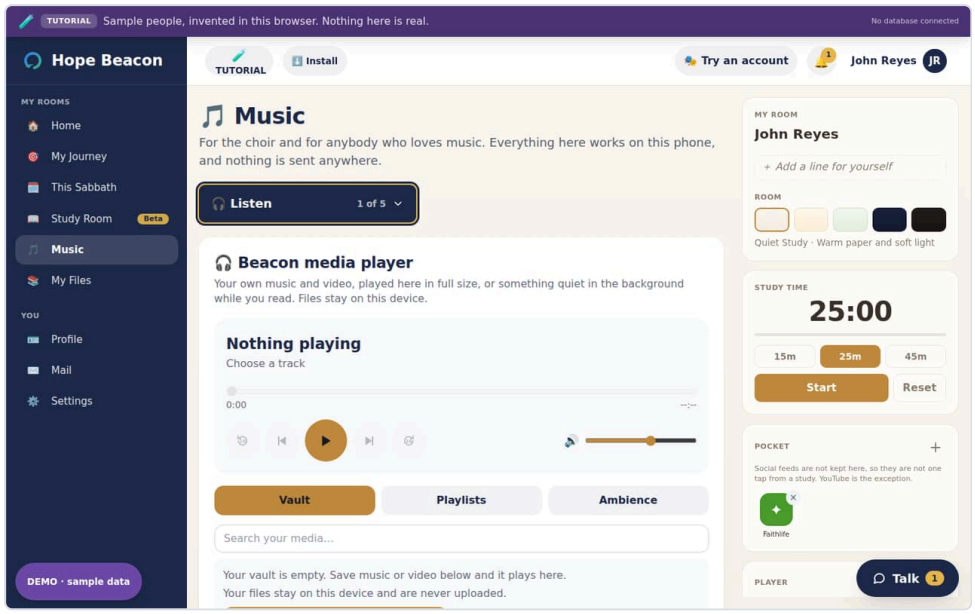
For the choir and anybody who loves music. Everything in it happens on the phone or computer itself; nothing is sent anywhere.

Music › Listen

The player: your own music and video, playlists, and calming sounds for the background.



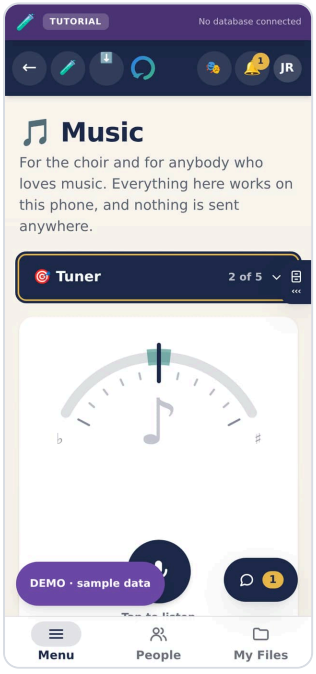
On a phone



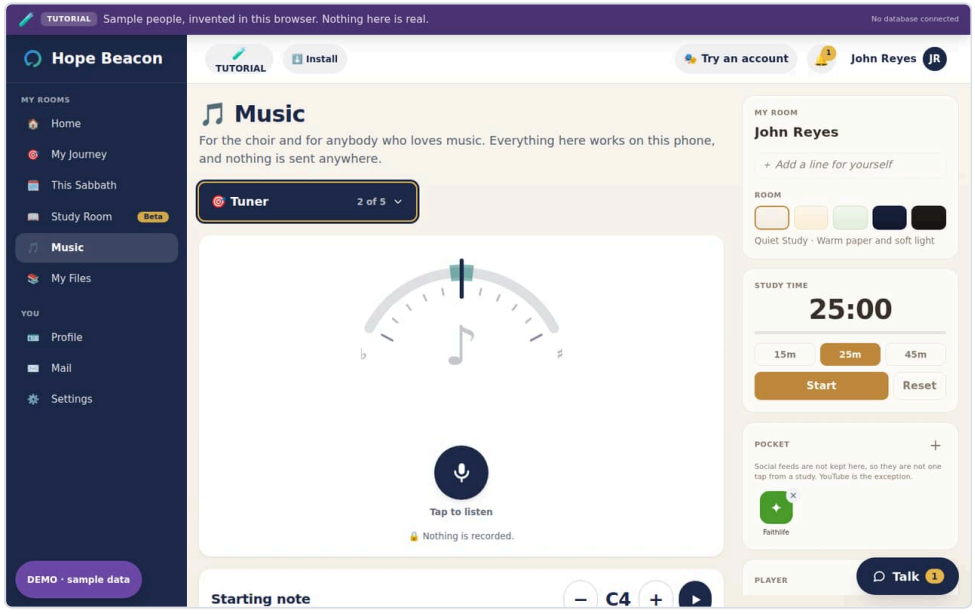
On a computer

Music › Tuner

Which note you are singing or playing, and whether it is flat or sharp. The microphone is used only while it listens, and nothing is recorded.



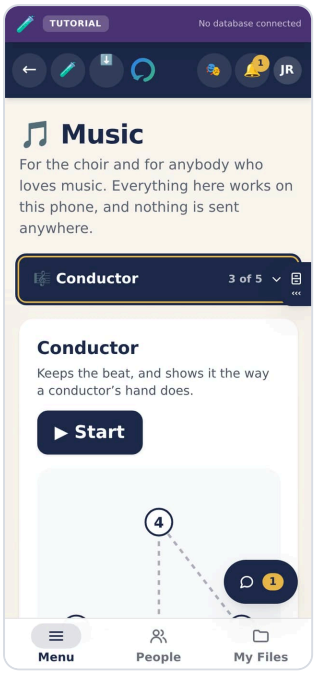
On a phone



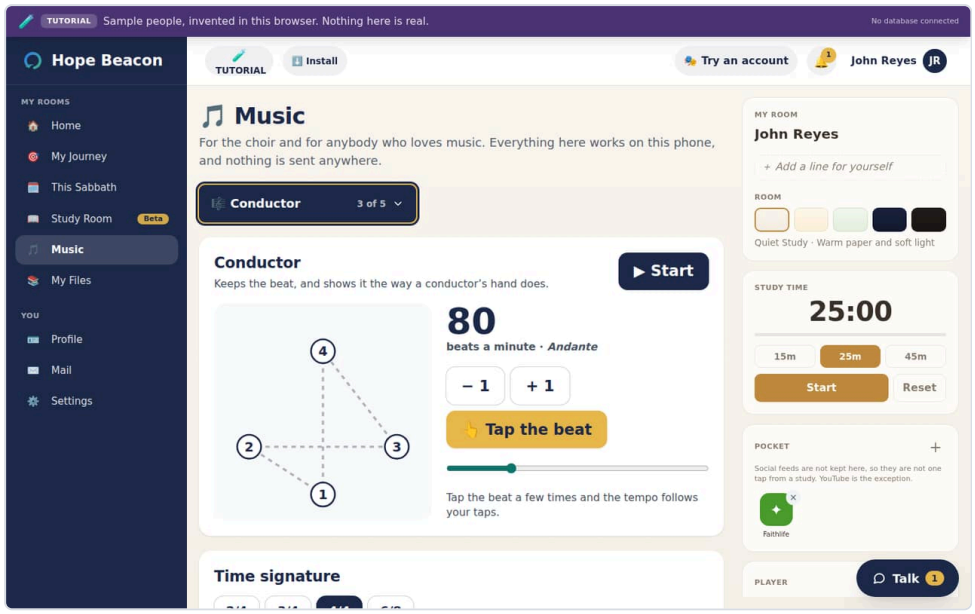
On a computer

Music › Conductor

A steady beat, and the conductor's hand drawn for 2, 3, 4 or 6 beats. Tap the beat to set the tempo.



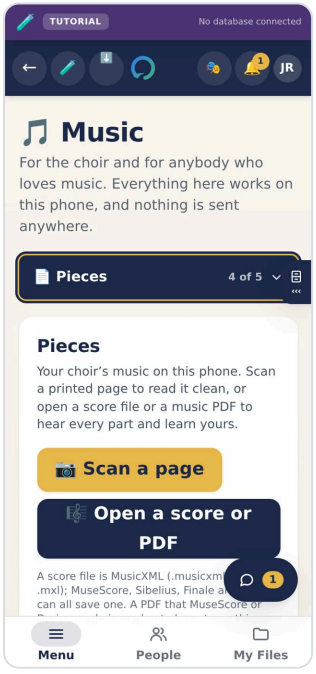
On a phone



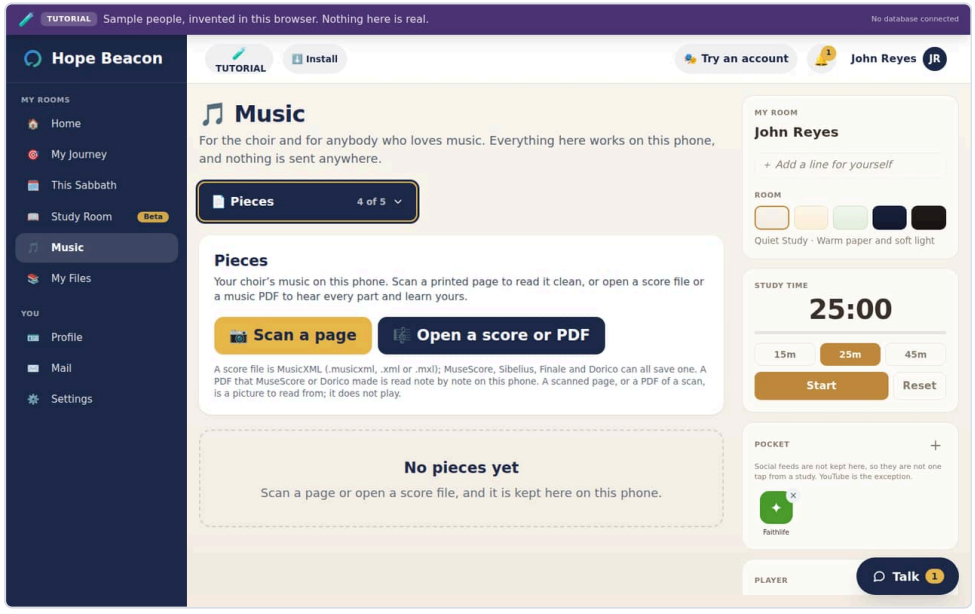
On a computer

Music › Pieces

The choir's music: a photographed page made clean and square, or a MusicXML score or a notation program's PDF that plays, with your own part louder. About this piece explains it from its own markings.



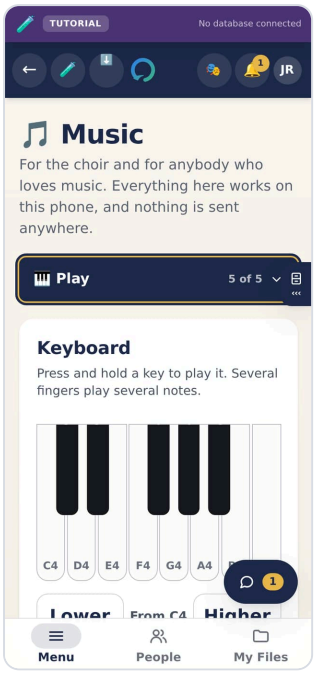
On a phone



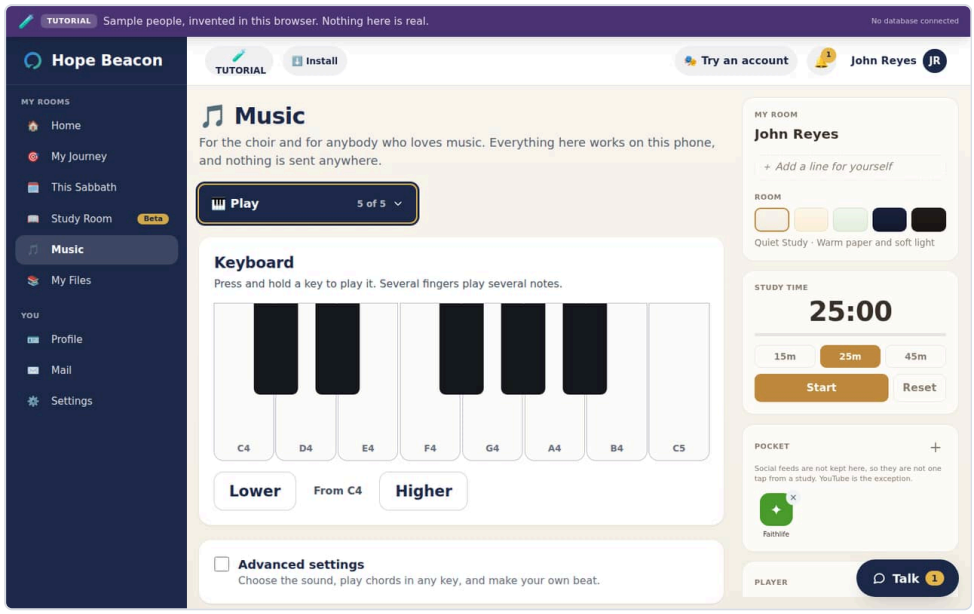
On a computer

Music › Play

A piano keyboard held by each finger at the choir's concert pitch; in Advanced, the chords of any key and a beat maker.



On a phone



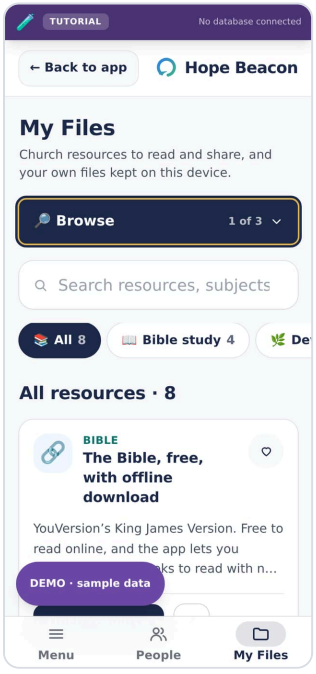
On a computer

My Files

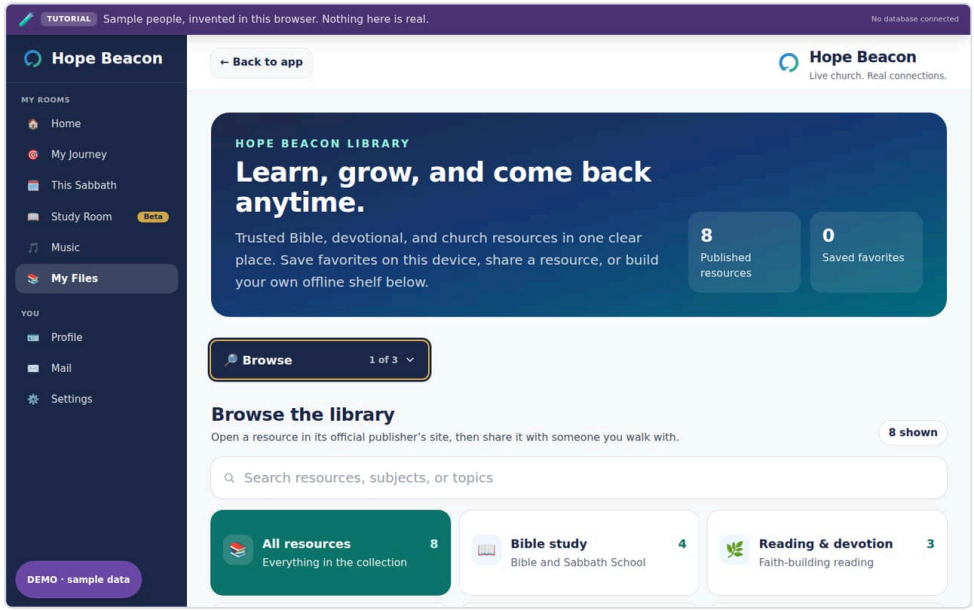
A person's own music, video and documents, saved on their own device. Nothing in it is shared and nothing comes from anybody else.

My Files › Browse

Everything on this person's shelf, with a search box.



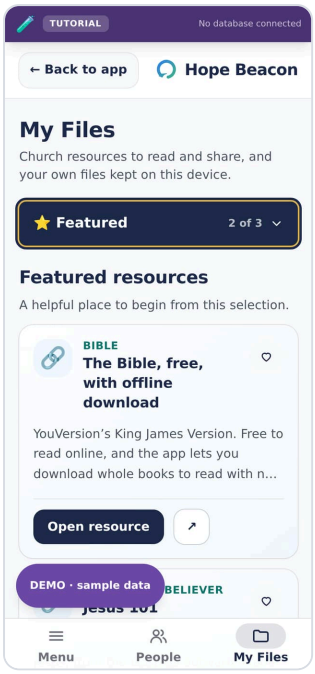
On a phone



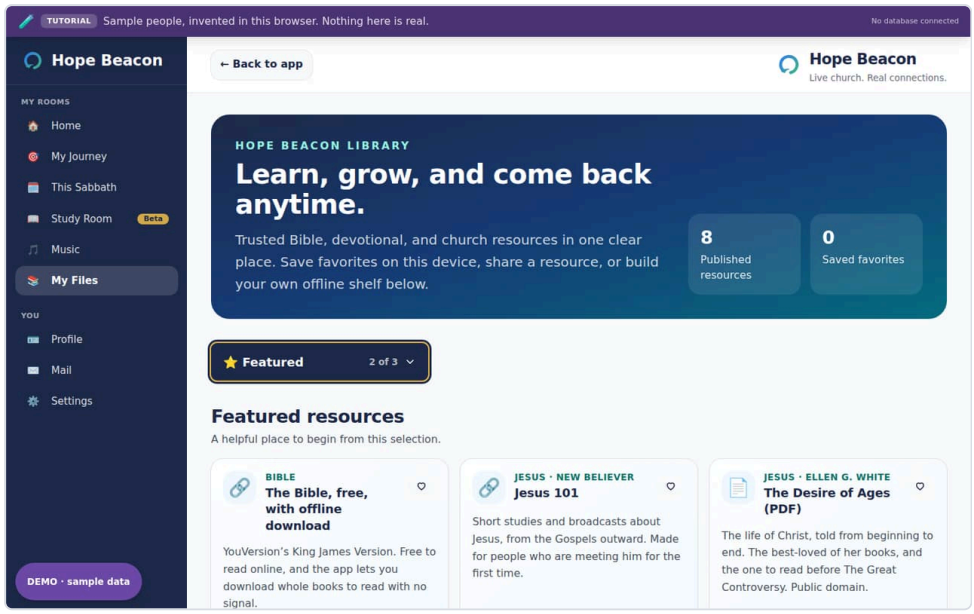
On a computer

My Files › Featured

What the church has put first.



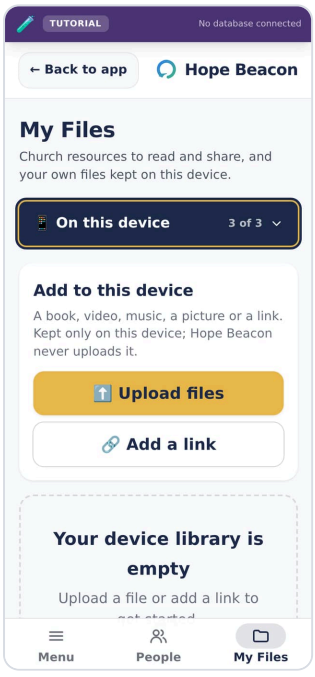
On a phone



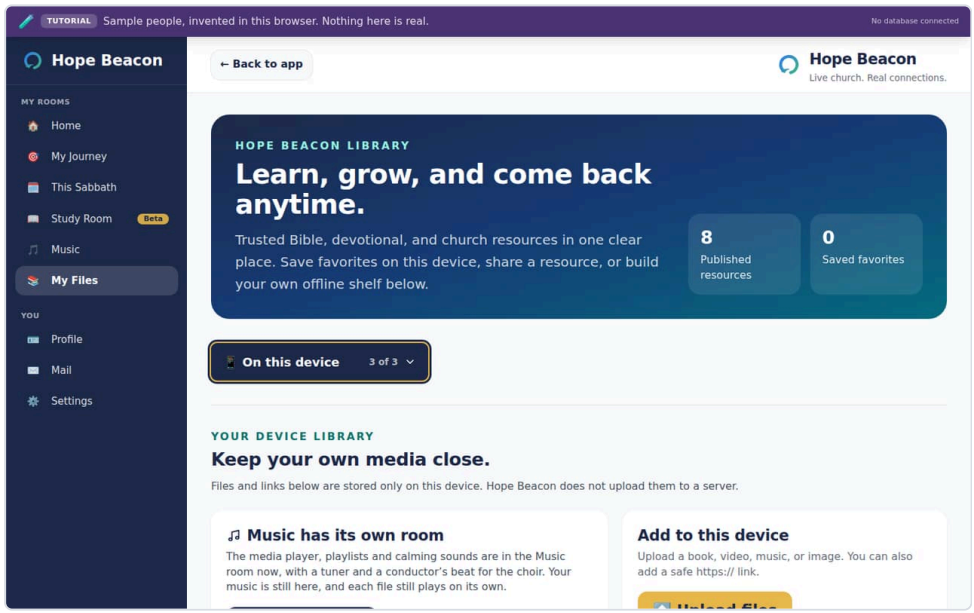
On a computer

My Files › On this device

Files saved on this phone or computer, for reading and listening with no signal. They never leave the device.



On a phone



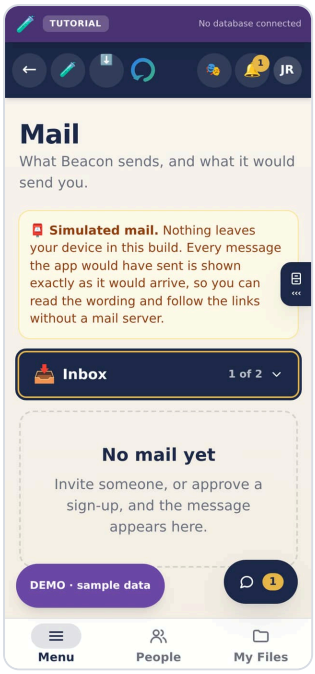
On a computer

Mail

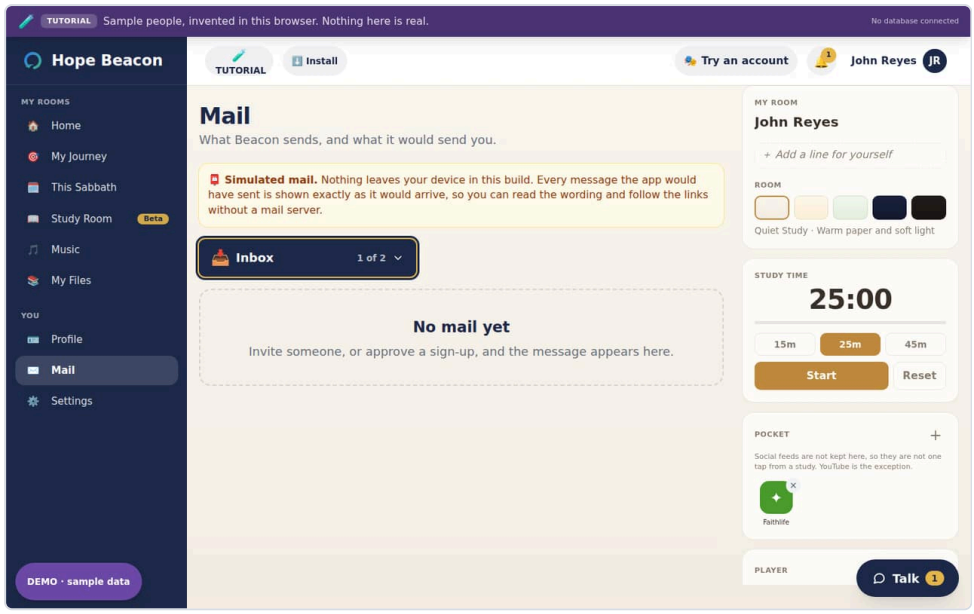
In the sample church, a mailbox showing what the app sends, without sending real email. In a church's own app, Mail is for Directors and Executive Directors, and lists the invitations still open, to resend or cancel.

Mail › Inbox

What the app has sent this person.



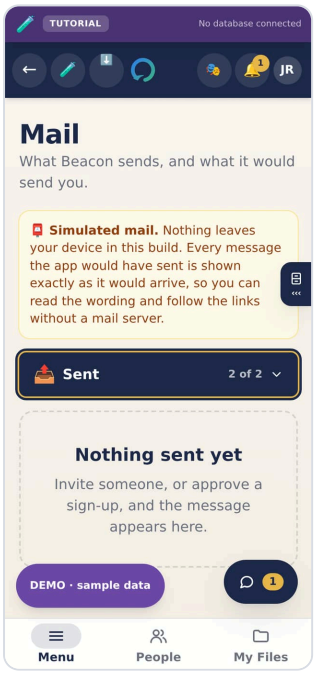
On a phone



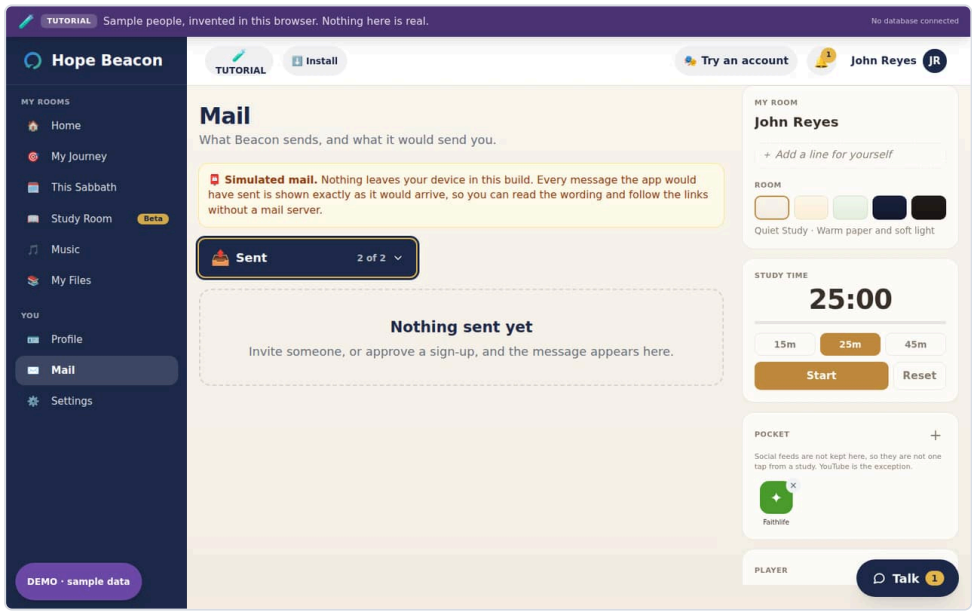
On a computer

Mail › Sent

What this person has sent through the app, such as recommending somebody.



On a phone



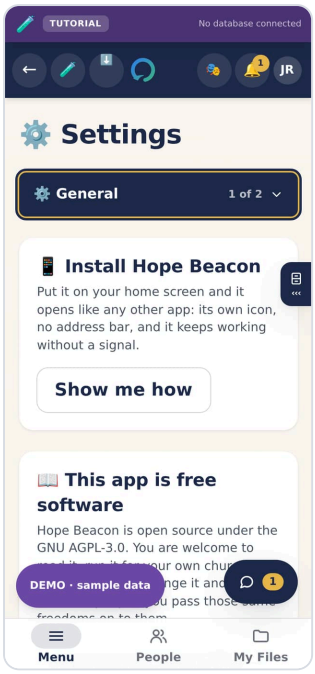
On a computer

Settings

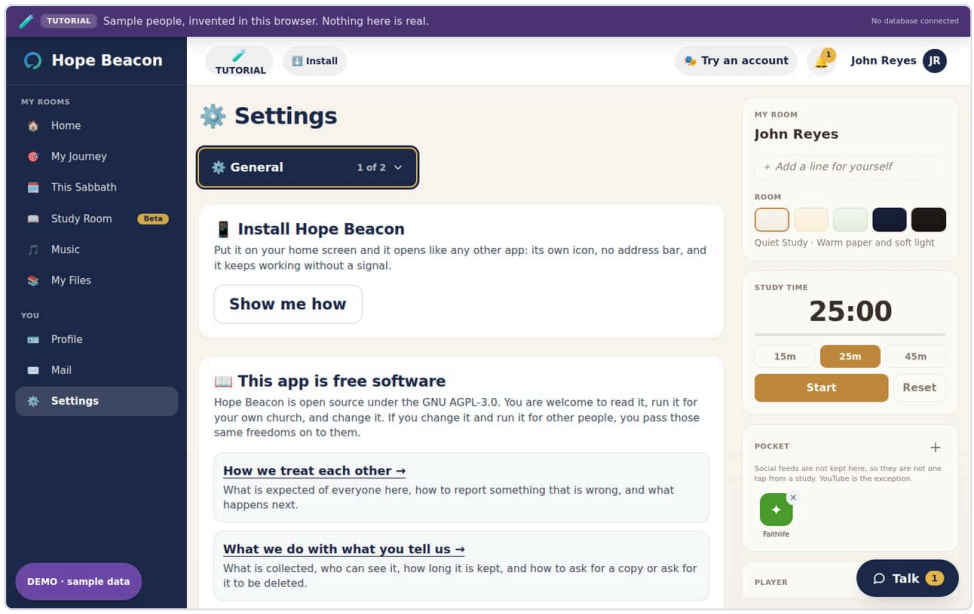
Everything about this device and this account: text size, the look, installing, alerts, language, the guided walk, what is new, and help. A church's own app adds a Password folder and an Admin Reports folder.

Settings › General

Installing, alerts, text size, the look, and language.



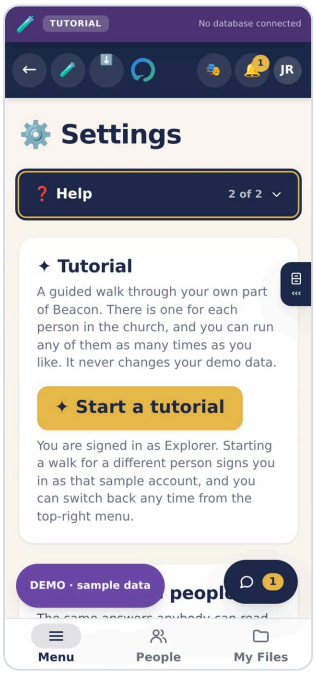
On a phone



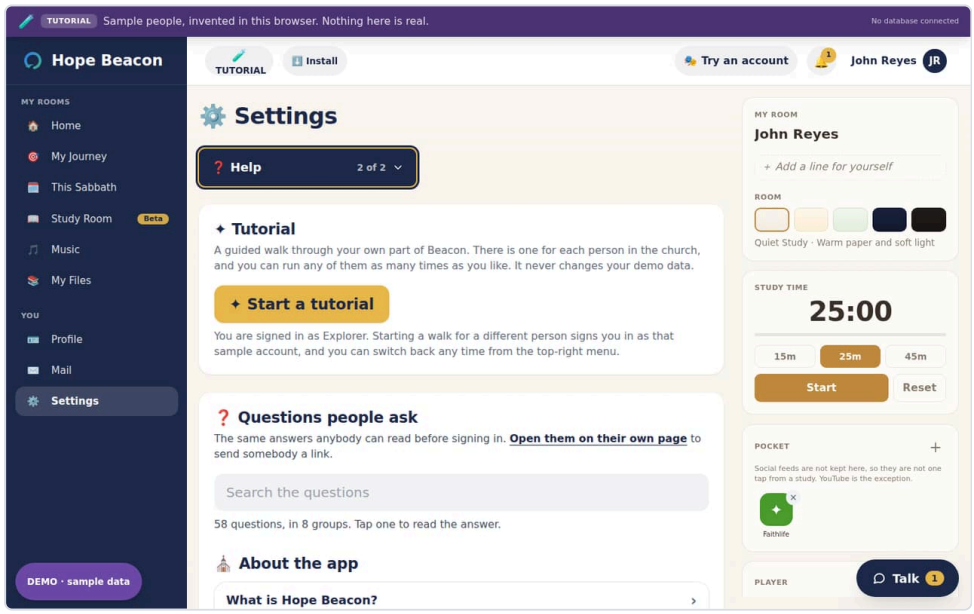
On a computer

Settings › Help

The guided walk, what is new, feedback, and where to find help.



On a phone



On a computer

CHAPTER 22

Guide screens

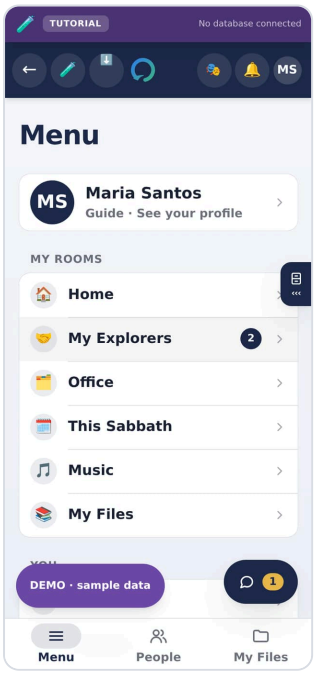
What Maria Santos, a Guide in the sample church, sees: the people she walks with, her Office, and everything an Explorer has.

IN THIS CHAPTER

Profile 197
Home 197
My Explorers 198
Office 199
This Sabbath 202
Music 202
My Files 205
Mail 206
Settings 207

The Menu

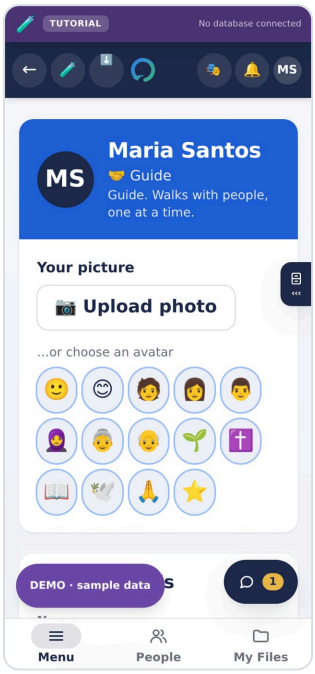
Every room this person has, written out, with their own profile at the top. It is the first of the three words along the bottom of every screen: Menu, People, My Files.



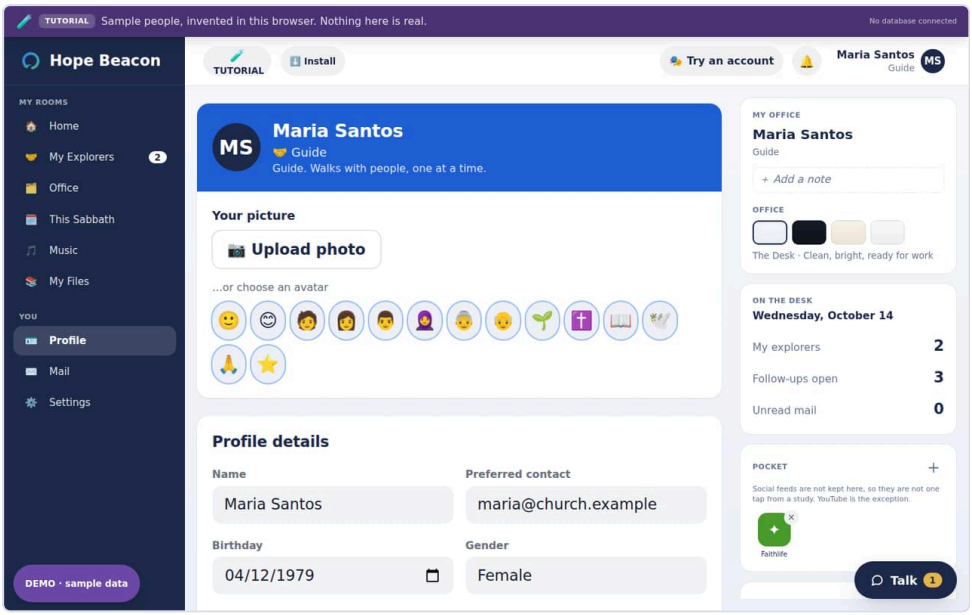
On a phone

Profile

Your own page: your name, your photograph and your details. Everybody has one, and it is the first row of the Menu.



On a phone



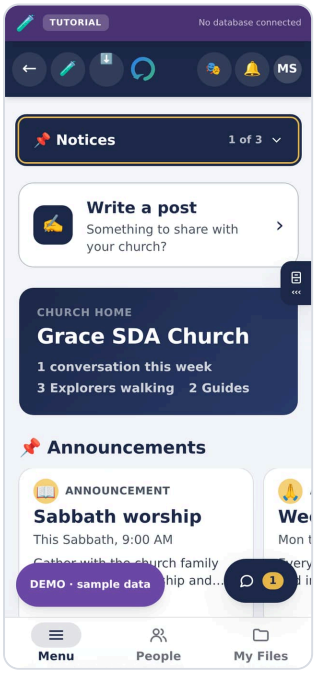
On a computer

Home

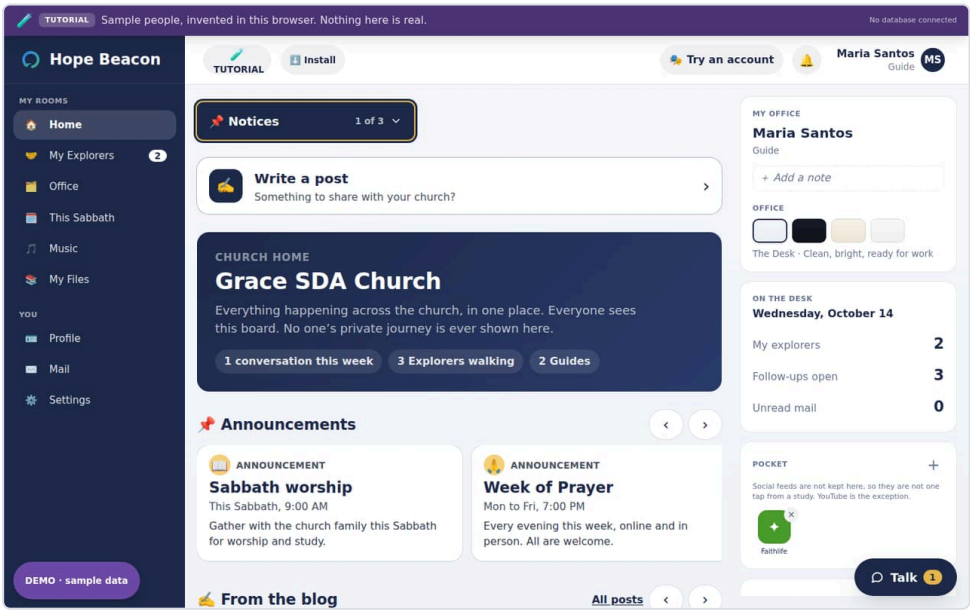
The church home, and the first room on every Menu: what the whole church is saying, before anybody turns to their own work.

Home › Notices

Pinned announcements from the church, newest first, with when each happens.



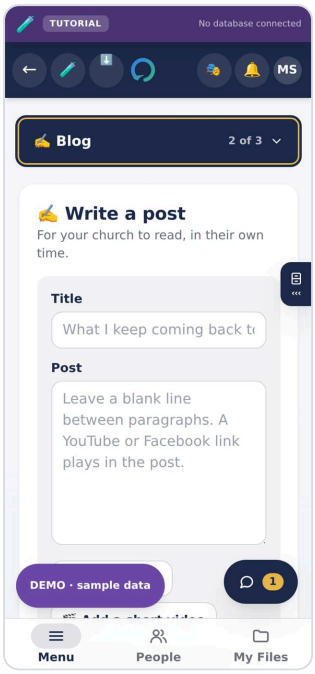
On a phone



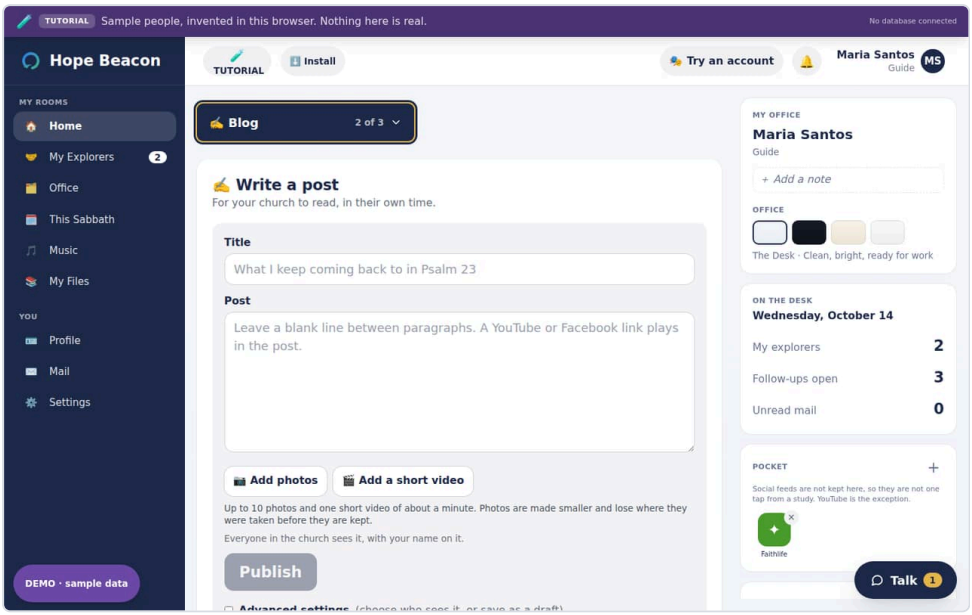
On a computer

Home › Blog

Posts written for the church. **Write a post** is at the top: a title, the words, **Publish**. Advanced settings narrow who reads it, or keep it as a draft.



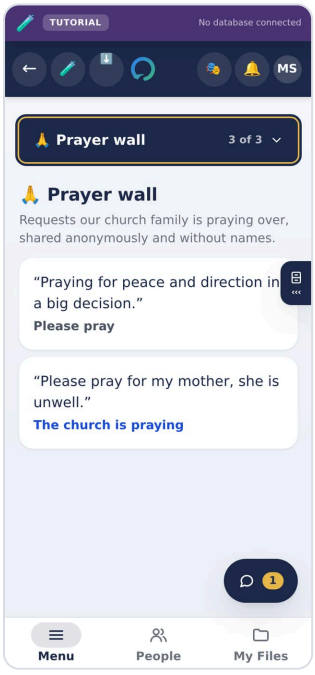
On a phone



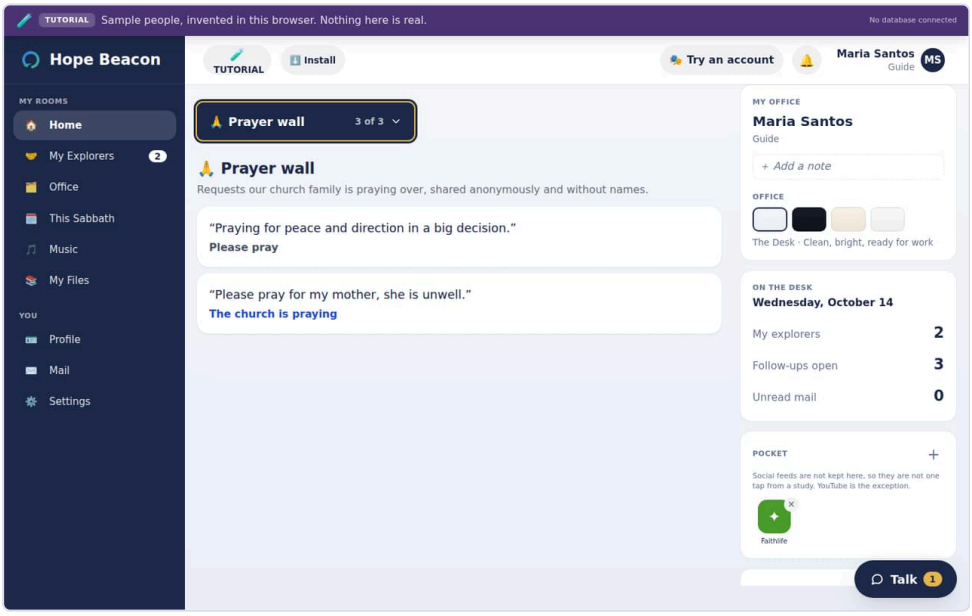
On a computer

Home › Prayer wall

Requests the church has been asked to pray for. A request reaches the wall only when the person asking ticks the box, and their name is never shown.



On a phone



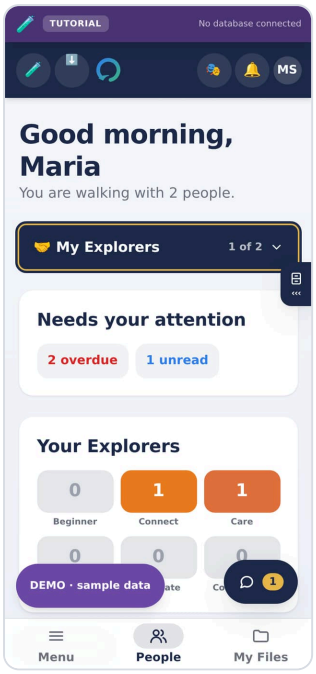
On a computer

My Explorers

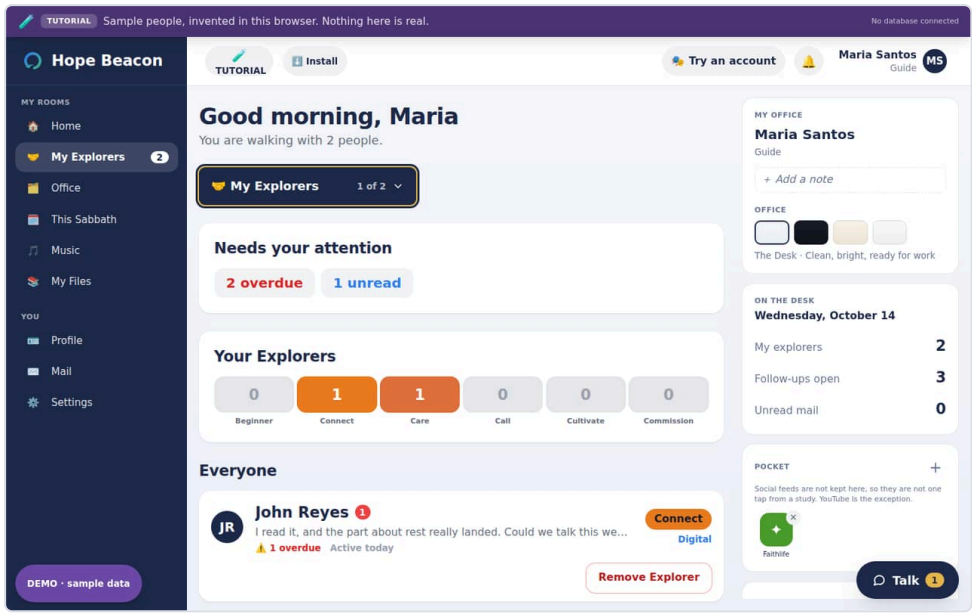
A Guide’s people: everyone they walk with, and what each of them needs this week.

My Explorers › My Explorers

Everyone this Guide walks with: the stage each has reached, who needs attention and why, and the way into each person's page.



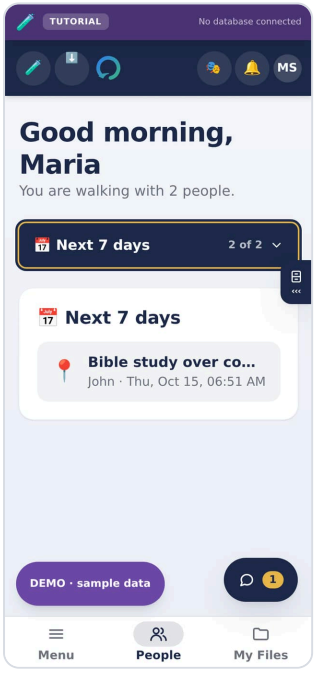
On a phone



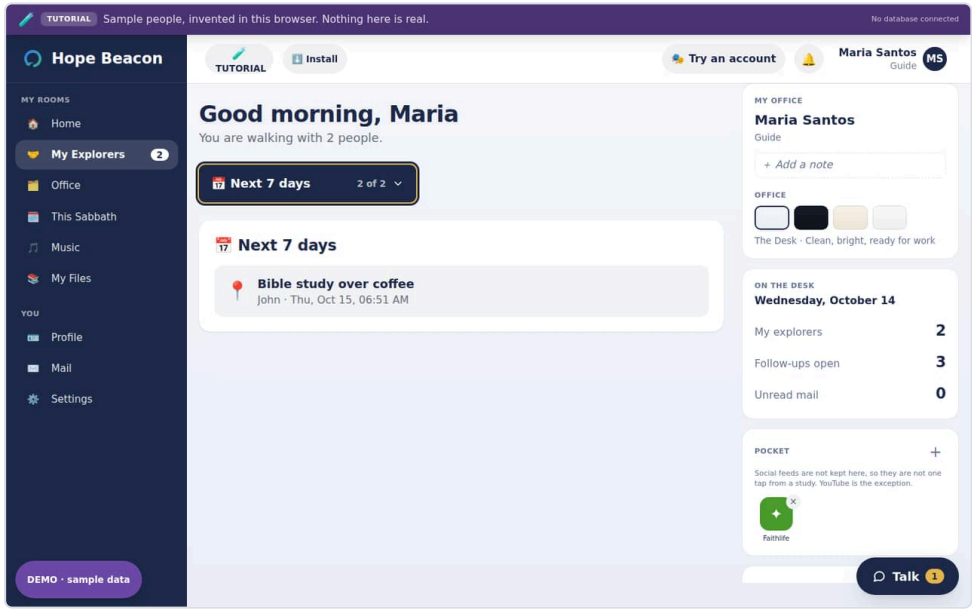
On a computer

My Explorers › Next 7 days

What is coming in the next week: meetings, follow-ups and anything due.



On a phone



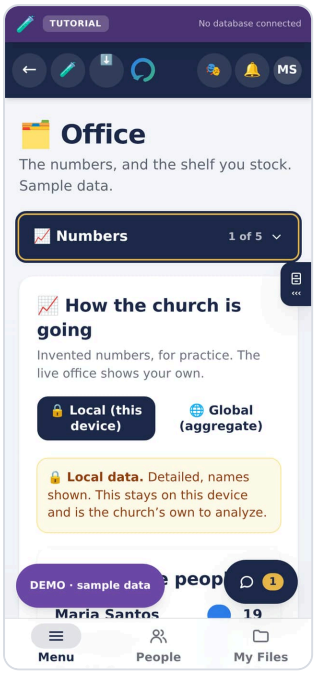
On a computer

Office

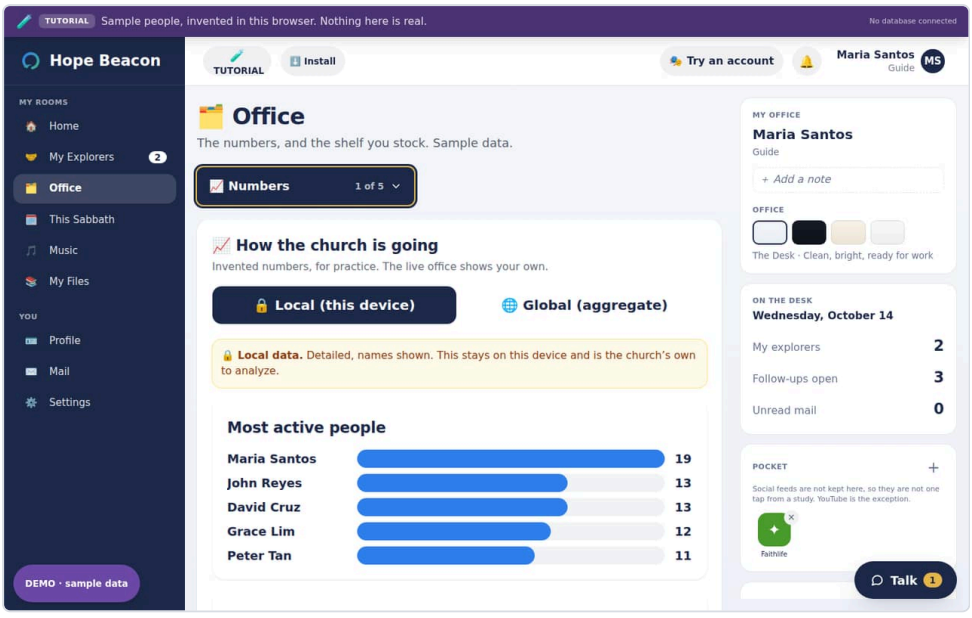
Work rather than conversation: the numbers, lesson studies, the Sabbath program, evangelistic meetings and reports. Explorers have no Office, because none of it is theirs to do.

Office › Numbers

How the church, or this Guide's part of it, is going. The sample's numbers are invented for practice; a church's own Office shows its own.



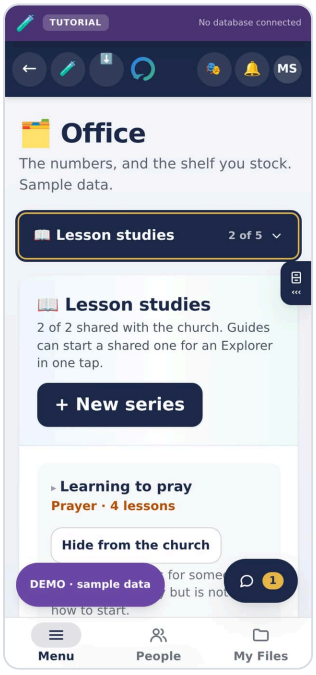
On a phone



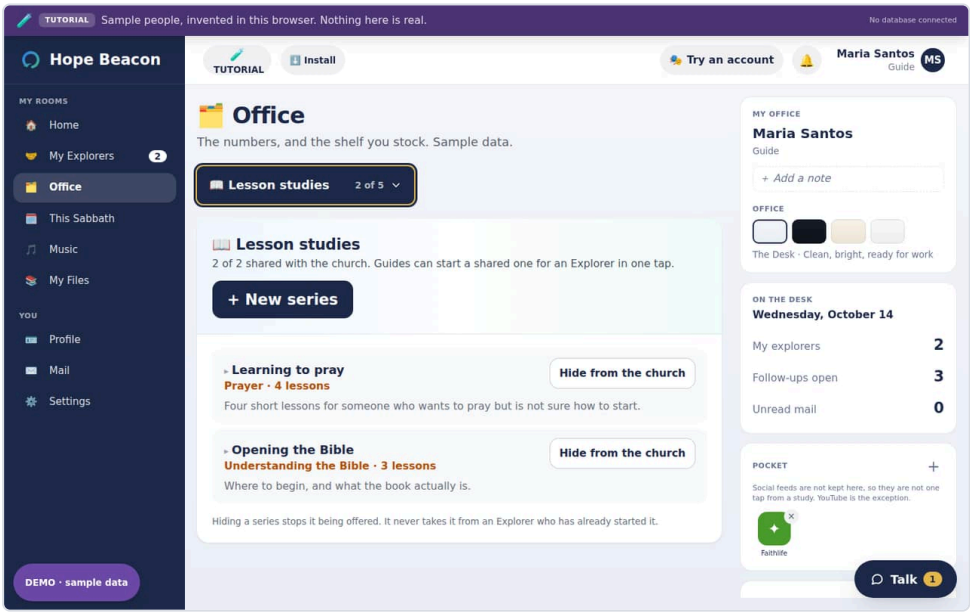
On a computer

Office › Lesson studies

Writing a lesson study once and sending it to the people who need it, with files and drawings attached. Simple by default, with an Advanced mode.



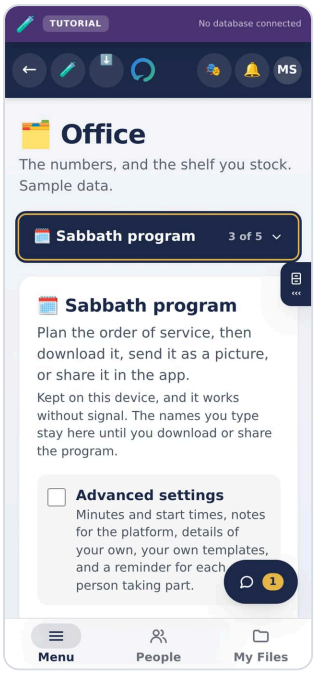
On a phone



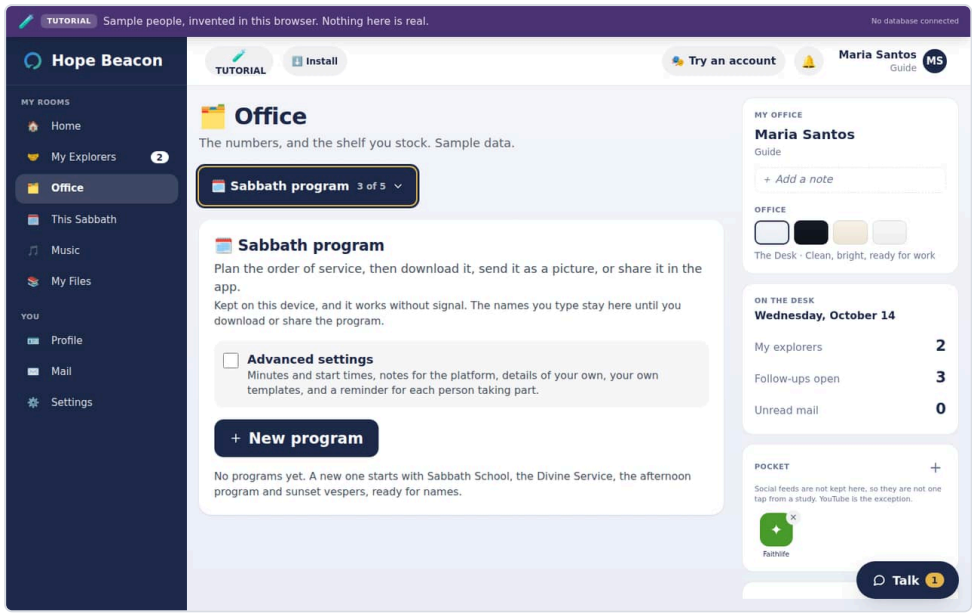
On a computer

Office › Sabbath program

Planning a Sabbath's order of service, then downloading it as a Word file or a picture, copying it as text, or posting it for This Sabbath.



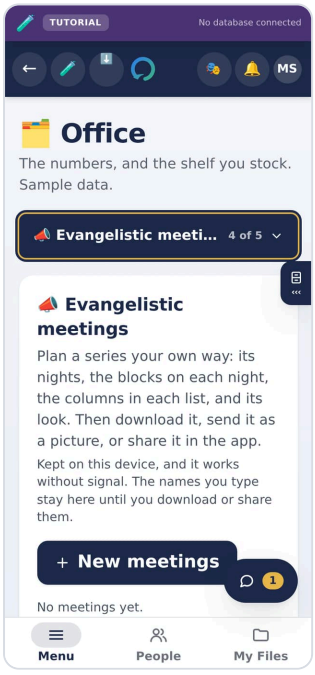
On a phone



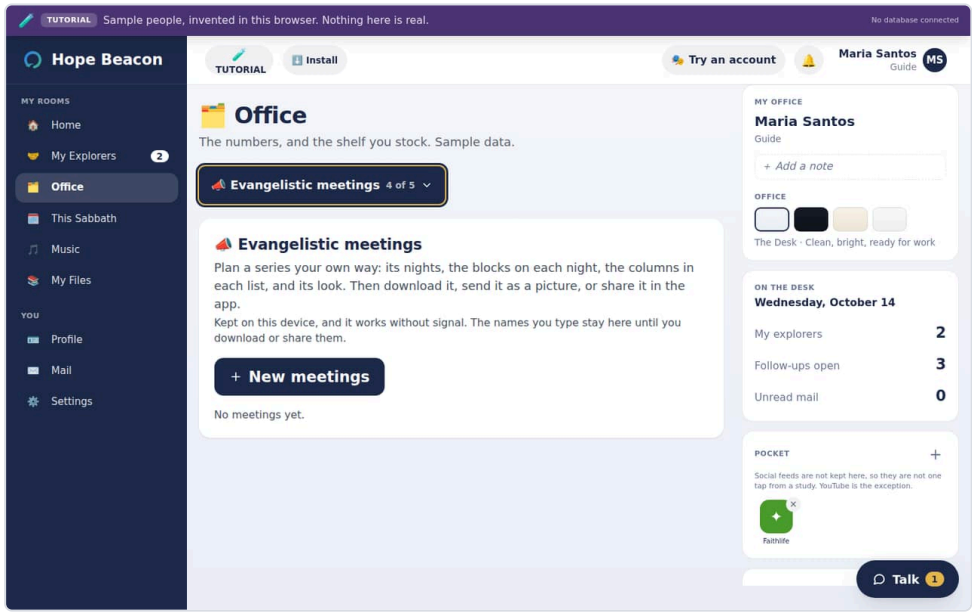
On a computer

Office › Evangelistic meetings

Planning a series of meetings night by night: programs, teams, schedules and checklists, with a look of its own for the Word file and the picture.



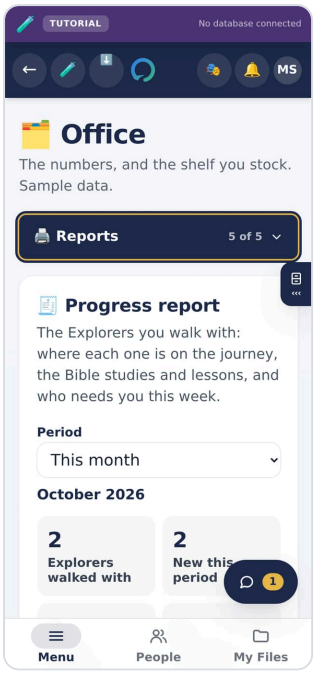
On a phone



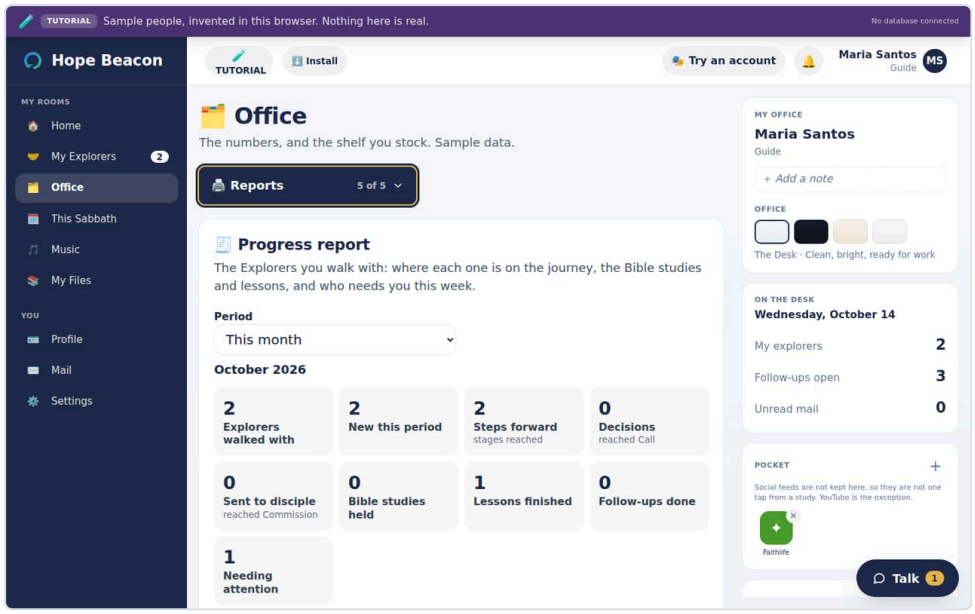
On a computer

Office › Reports

The progress report: how the Explorers are doing this month or quarter, who needs somebody, and a Word file to hand in.



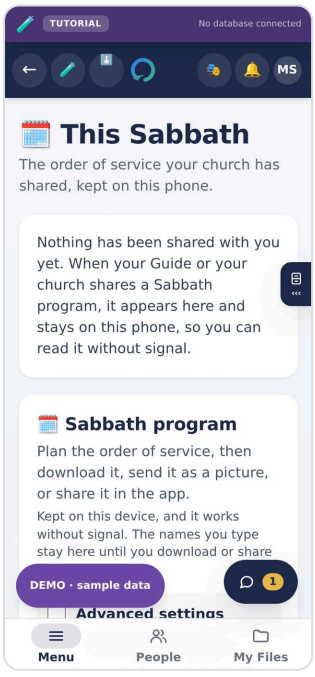
On a phone



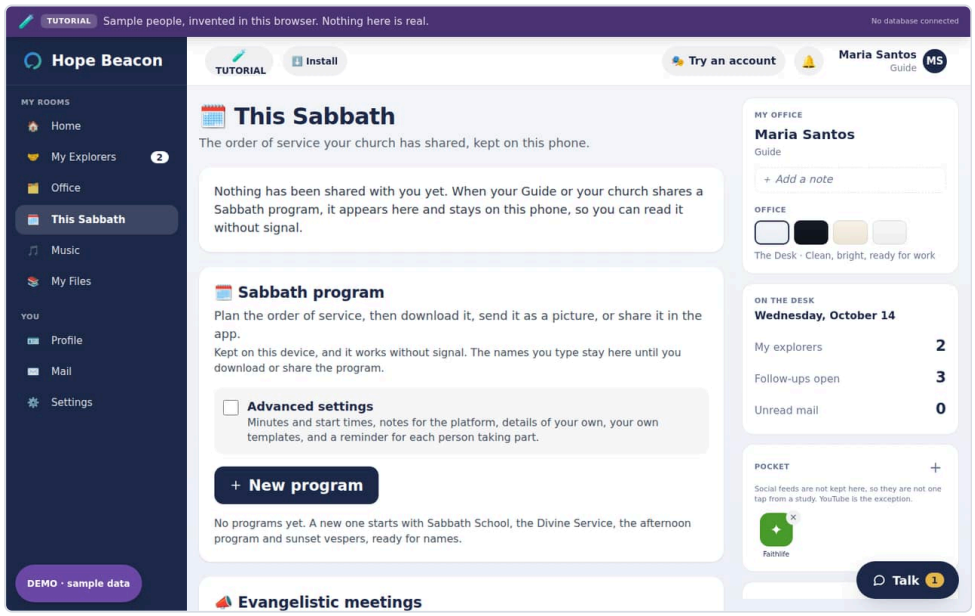
On a computer

This Sabbath

The Sabbath program and any evangelistic meetings a Guide or the church has posted. Once it has been opened with a signal, it opens again with none.



On a phone



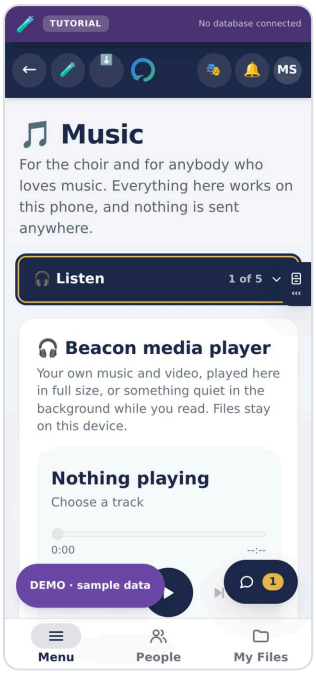
On a computer

Music

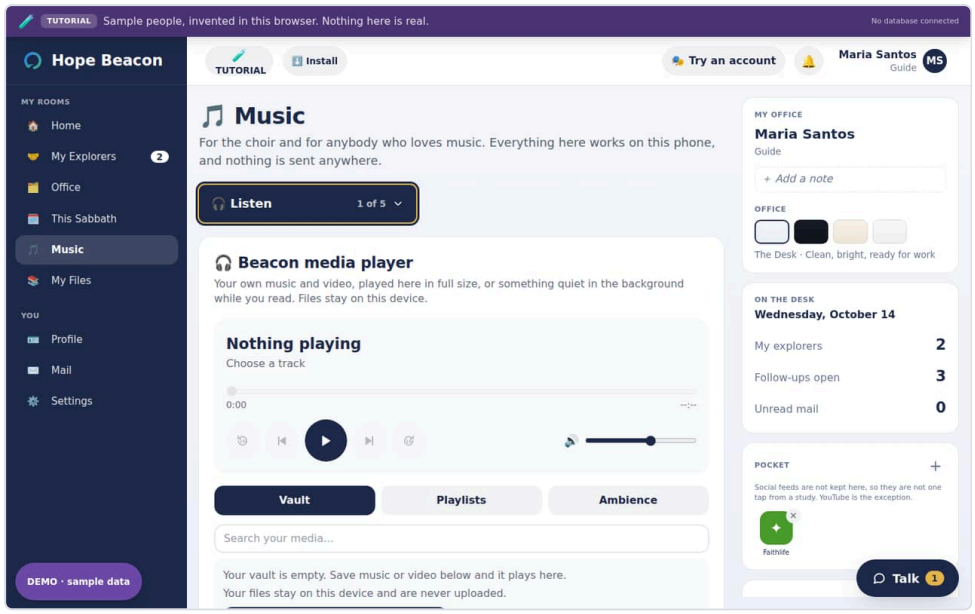
For the choir and anybody who loves music. Everything in it happens on the phone or computer itself; nothing is sent anywhere.

Music › Listen

The player: your own music and video, playlists, and calming sounds for the background.



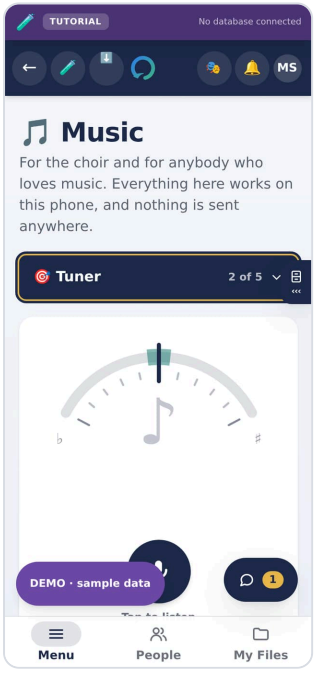
On a phone



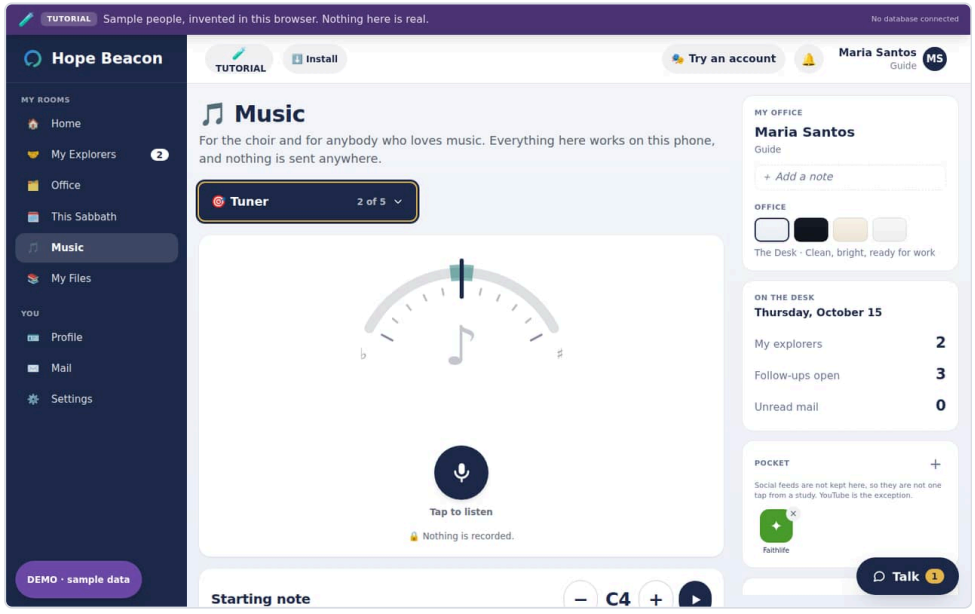
On a computer

Music › Tuner

Which note you are singing or playing, and whether it is flat or sharp. The microphone is used only while it listens, and nothing is recorded.



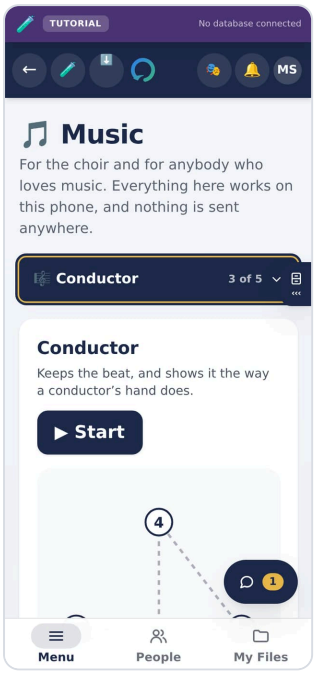
On a phone



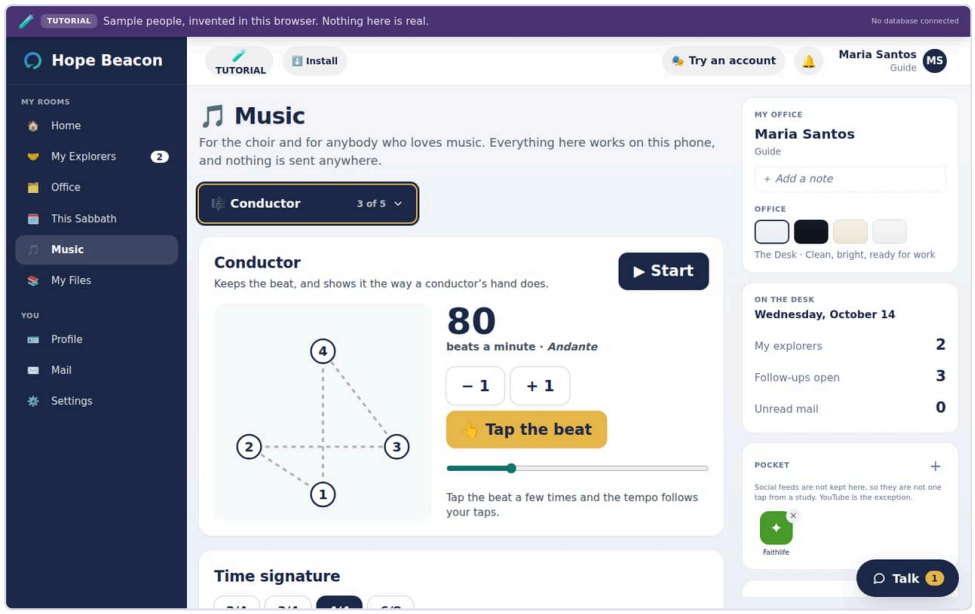
On a computer

Music › Conductor

A steady beat, and the conductor's hand drawn for 2, 3, 4 or 6 beats. Tap the beat to set the tempo.



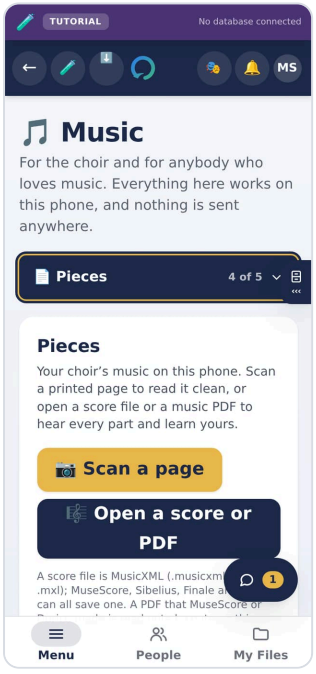
On a phone



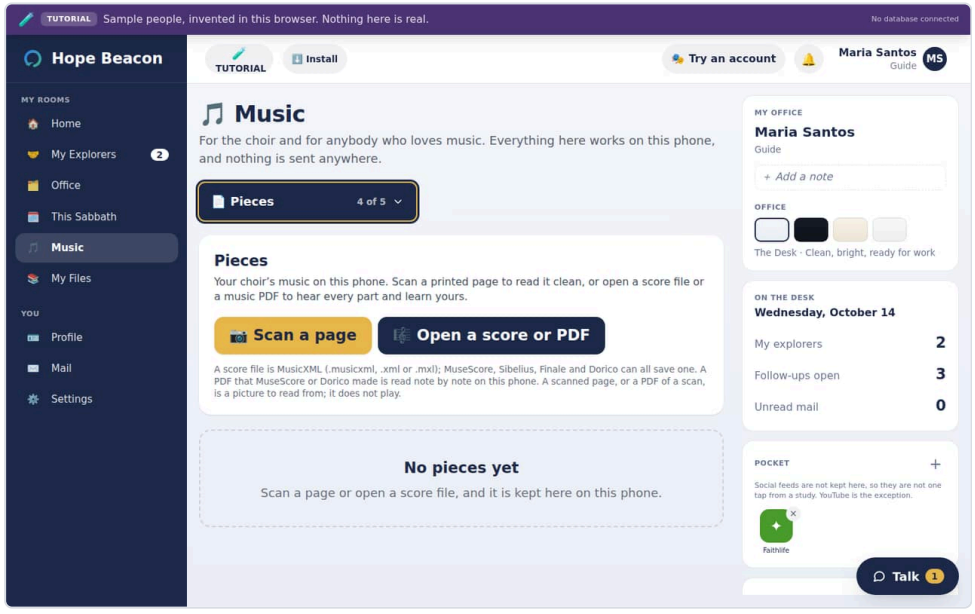
On a computer

Music › Pieces

The choir's music: a photographed page made clean and square, or a MusicXML score or a notation program's PDF that plays, with your own part louder. About this piece explains it from its own markings.



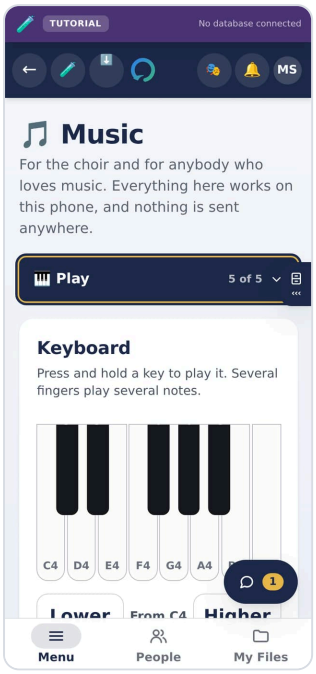
On a phone



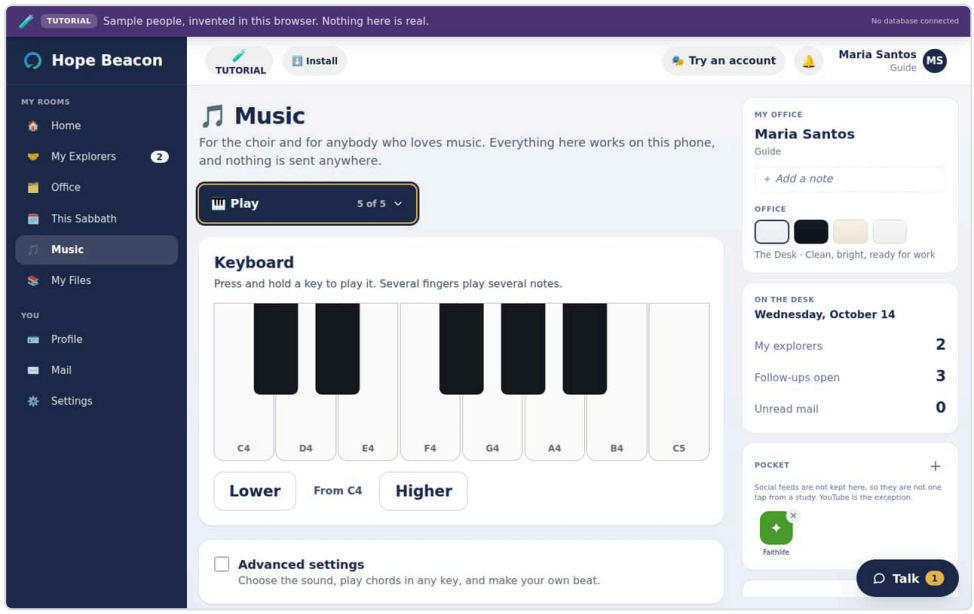
On a computer

Music › Play

A piano keyboard held by each finger at the choir's concert pitch; in Advanced, the chords of any key and a beat maker.



On a phone



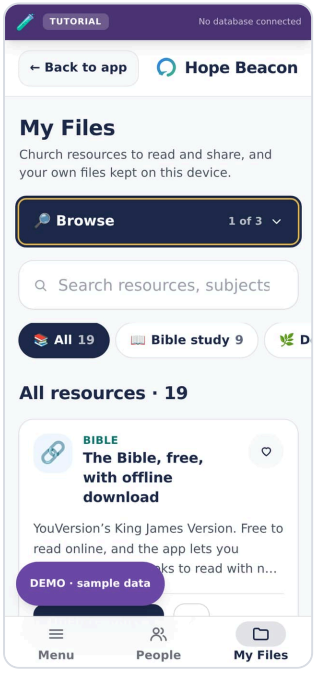
On a computer

My Files

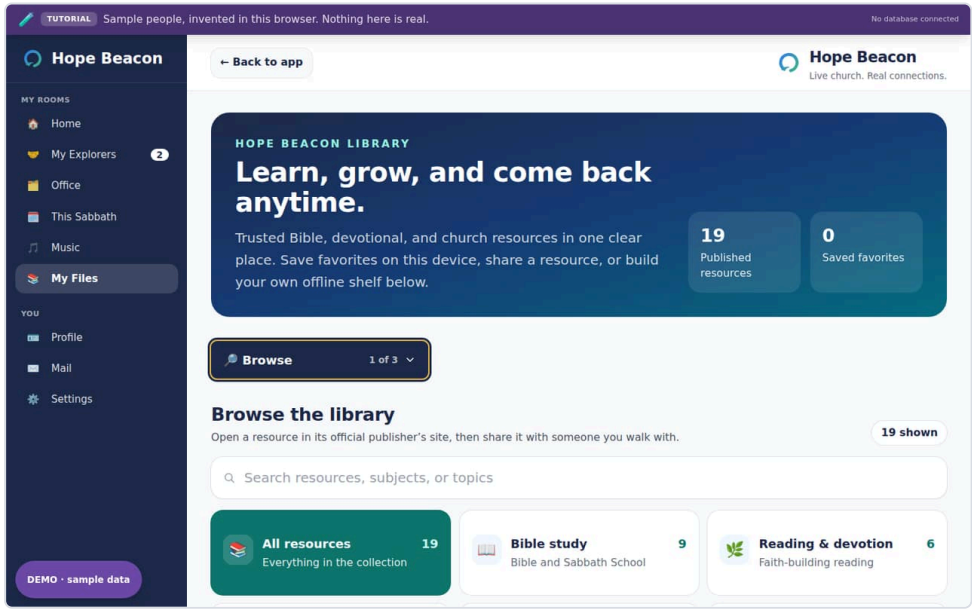
A person's own music, video and documents, saved on their own device. Nothing in it is shared and nothing comes from anybody else.

My Files › Browse

Everything on this person's shelf, with a search box.



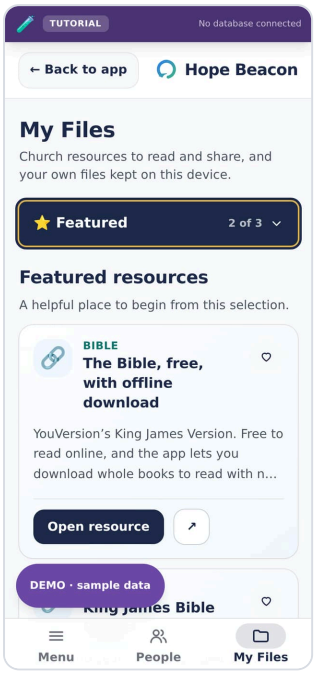
On a phone



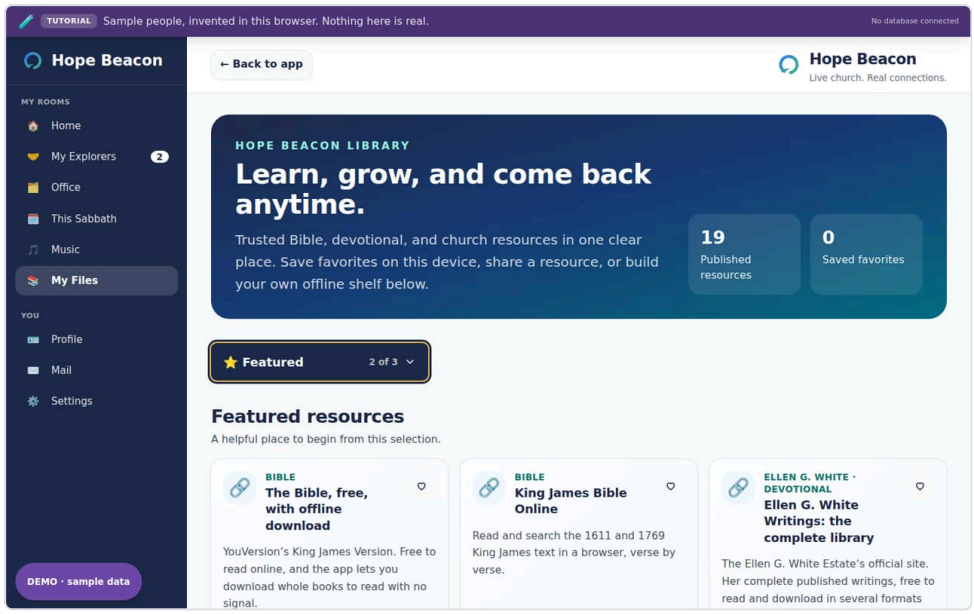
On a computer

My Files › Featured

What the church has put first.



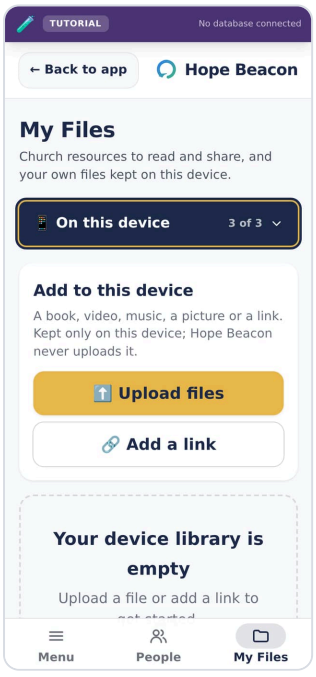
On a phone



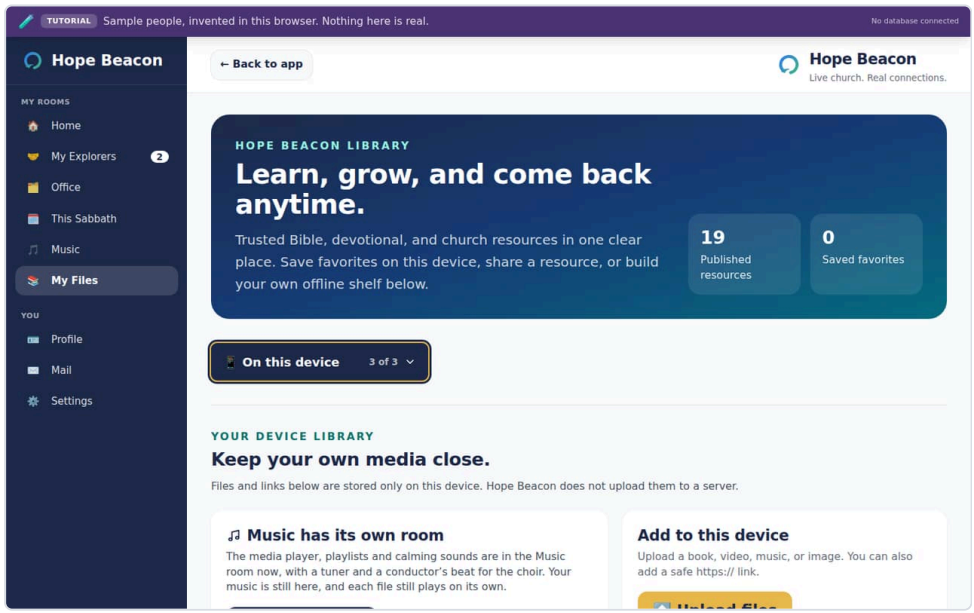
On a computer

My Files › On this device

Files saved on this phone or computer, for reading and listening with no signal. They never leave the device.



On a phone



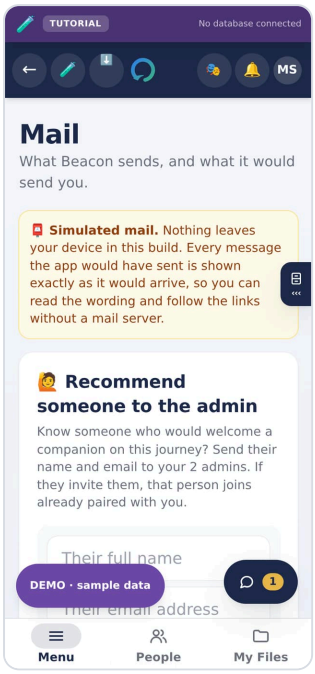
On a computer

Mail

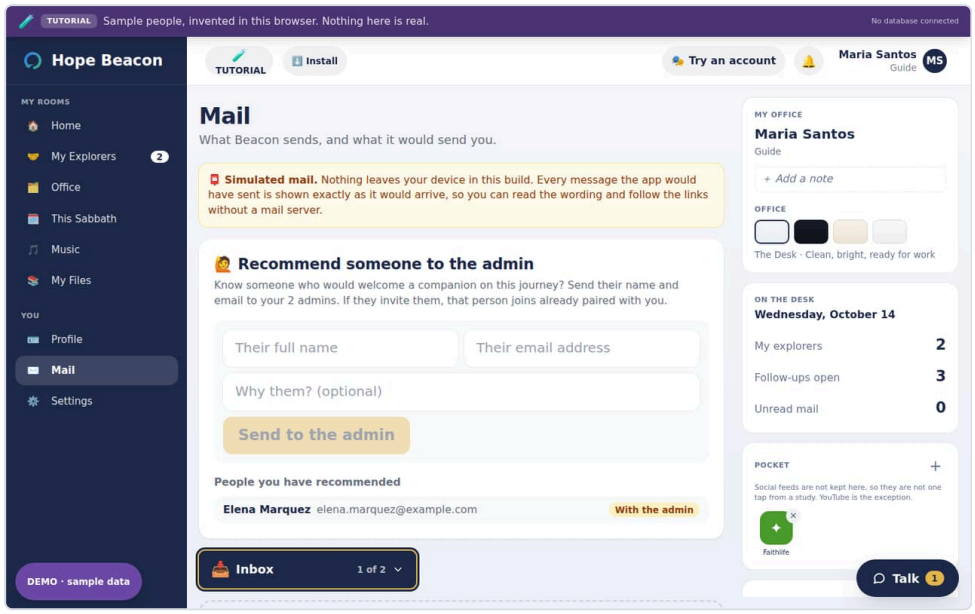
In the sample church, a mailbox showing what the app sends, without sending real email. In a church's own app, Mail is for Directors and Executive Directors, and lists the invitations still open, to resend or cancel.

Mail › Inbox

What the app has sent this person.



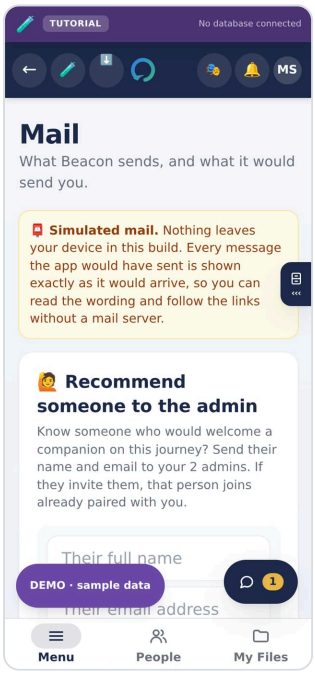
On a phone



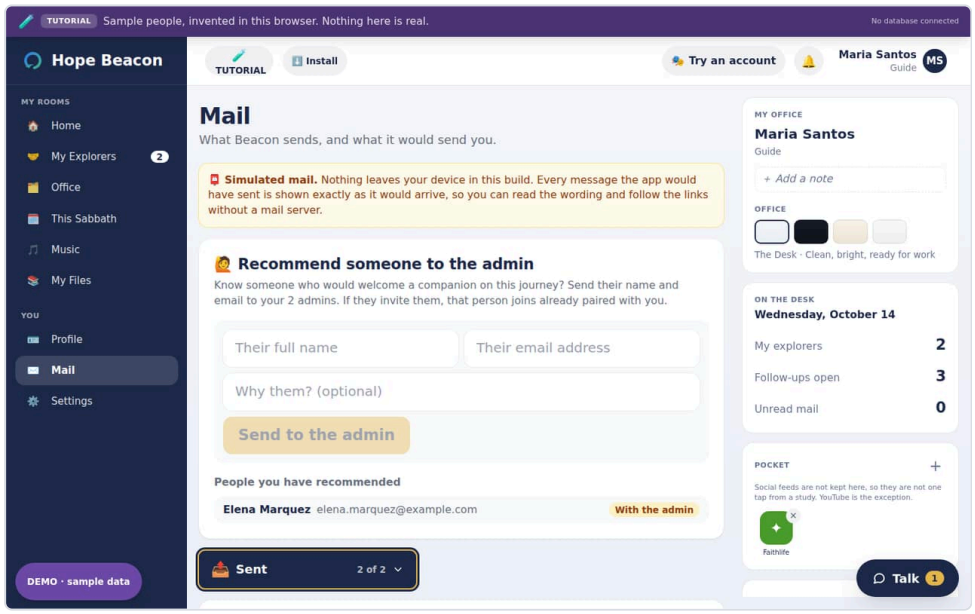
On a computer

Mail › Sent

What this person has sent through the app, such as recommending somebody.



On a phone



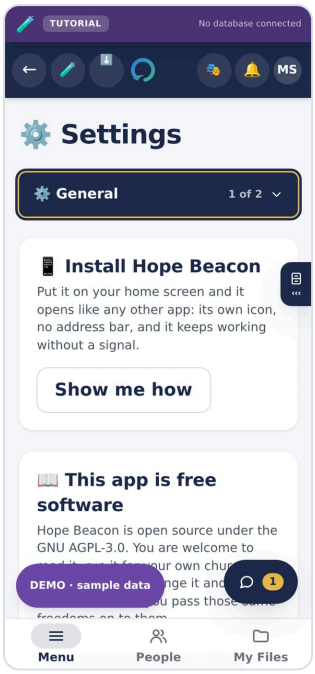
On a computer

Settings

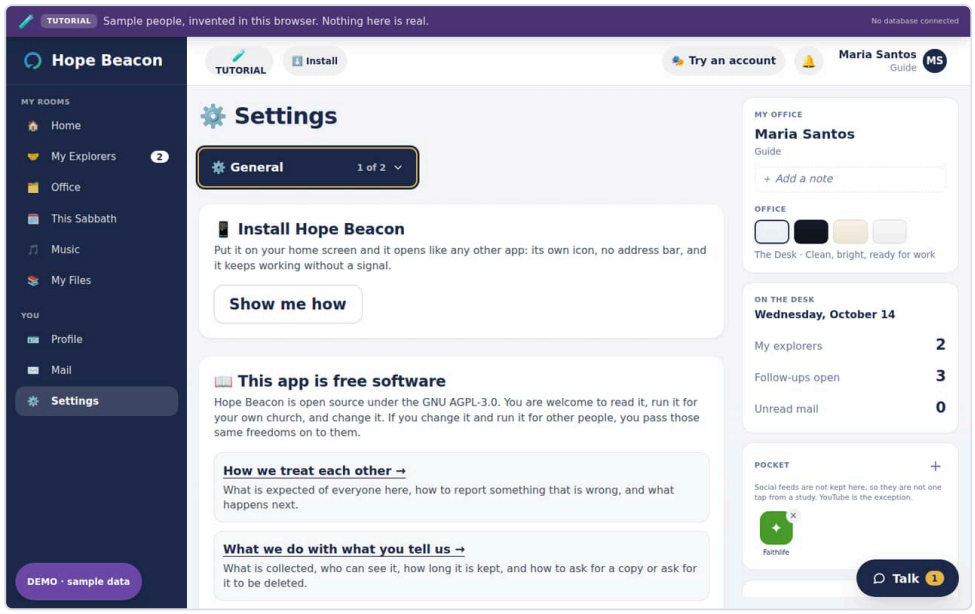
Everything about this device and this account: text size, the look, installing, alerts, language, the guided walk, what is new, and help. A church's own app adds a Password folder and an Admin Reports folder.

Settings › General

Installing, alerts, text size, the look, and language.



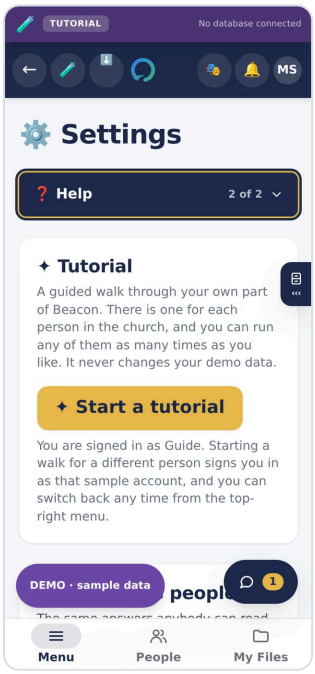
On a phone



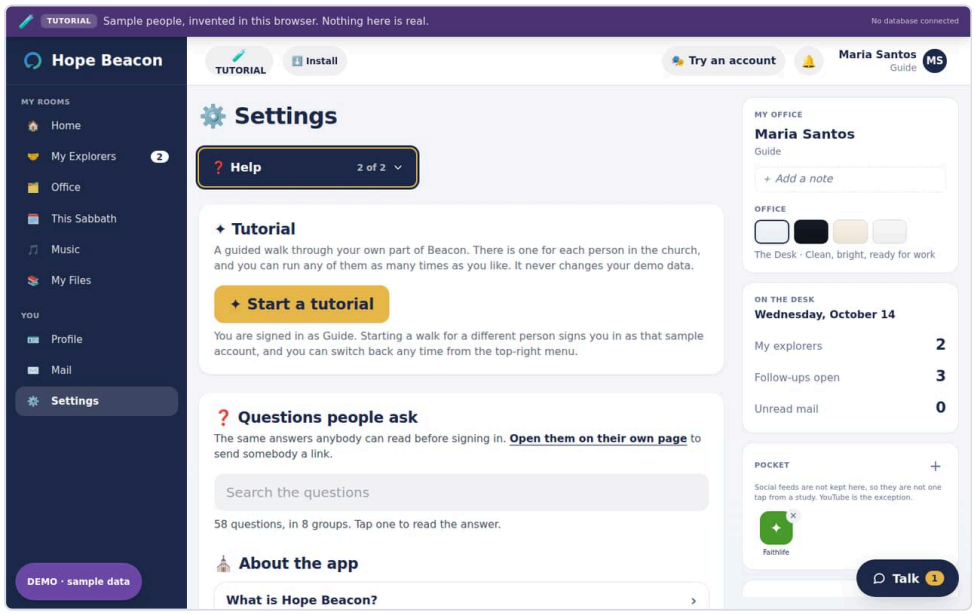
On a computer

Settings › Help

The guided walk, what is new, feedback, and where to find help.



On a phone



On a computer

CHAPTER 23

Director screens

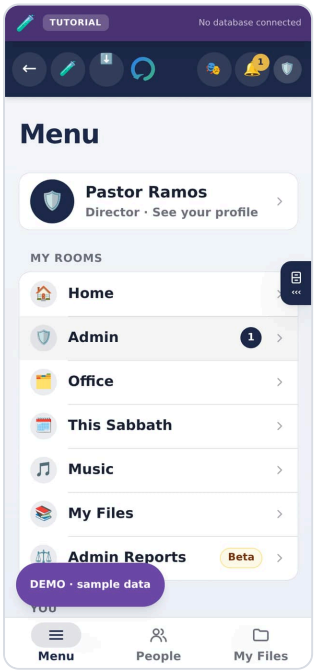
What Pastor Ramos, the sample church's Director, sees: approvals, pairing, safeguarding and the church's numbers.

IN THIS CHAPTER

Profile 210
Home 210
Admin 212
Office 215
This Sabbath 217
Music 218
My Files 220
Admin Reports 222
Mail 222
Settings 224

The Menu

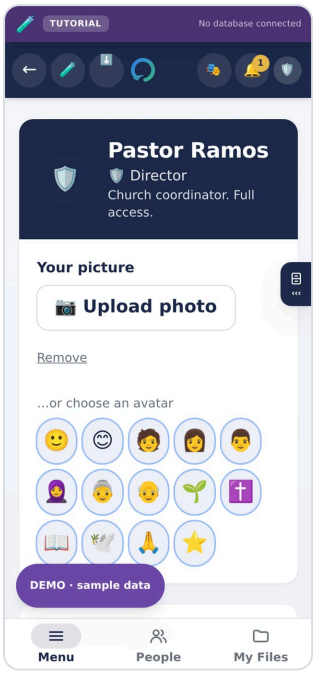
Every room this person has, written out, with their own profile at the top. It is the first of the three words along the bottom of every screen: Menu, People, My Files.



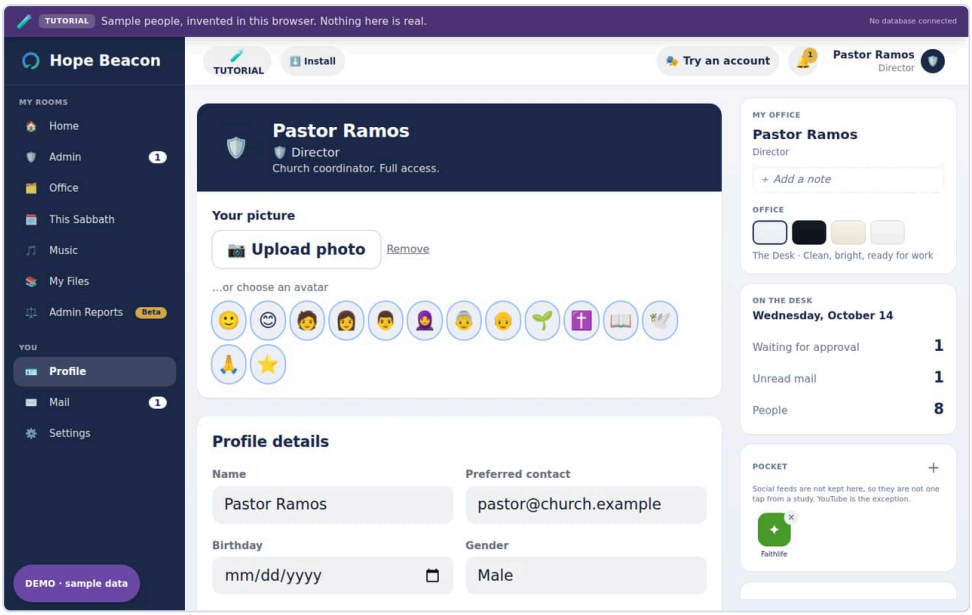
On a phone

Profile

Your own page: your name, your photograph and your details. Everybody has one, and it is the first row of the Menu.



On a phone



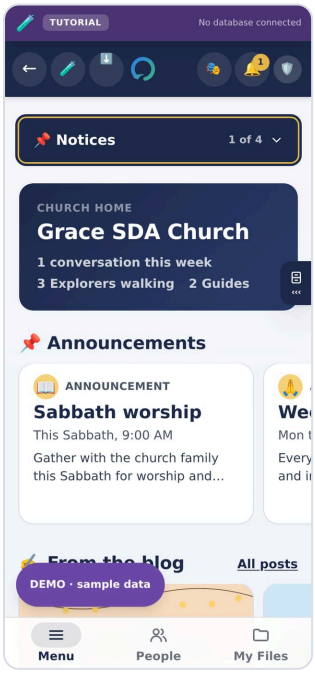
On a computer

Home

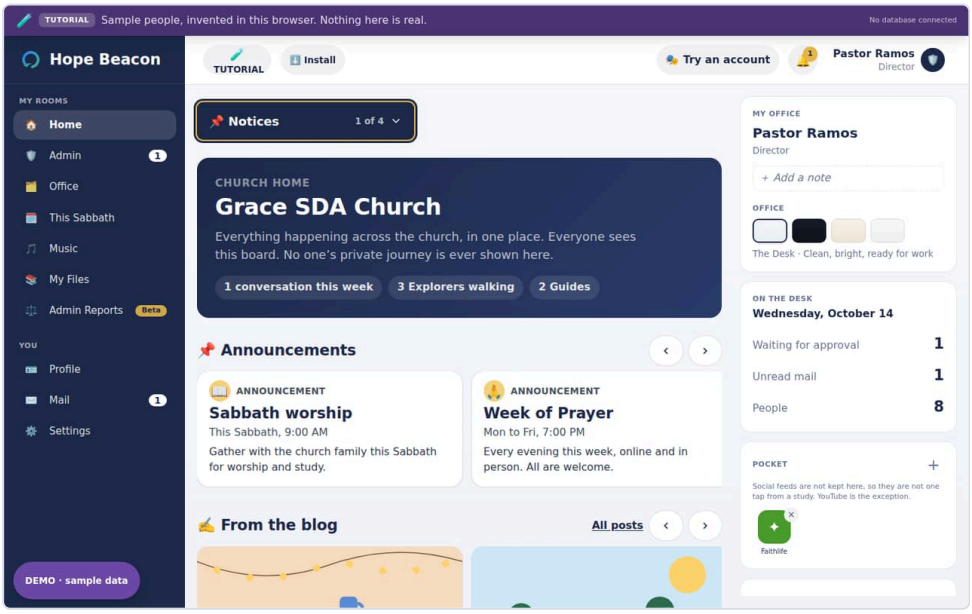
The church home, and the first room on every Menu: what the whole church is saying, before anybody turns to their own work.

Home › Notices

Pinned announcements from the church, newest first, with when each happens.



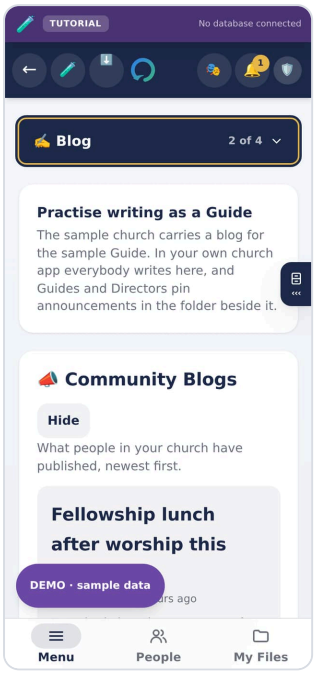
On a phone



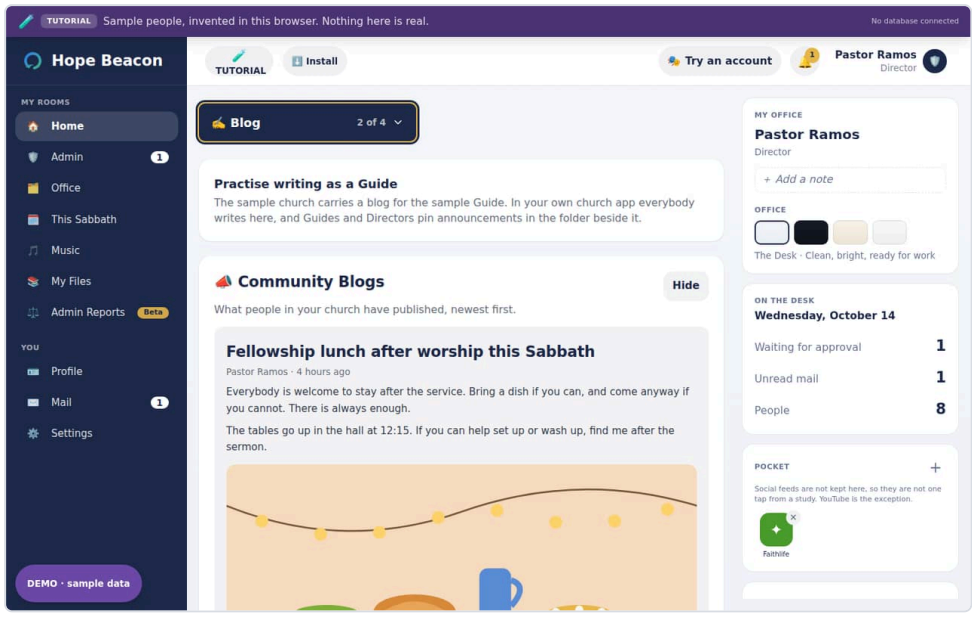
On a computer

Home › Blog

Posts written for the church. **Write a post** is at the top: a title, the words, **Publish**. Advanced settings narrow who reads it, or keep it as a draft.



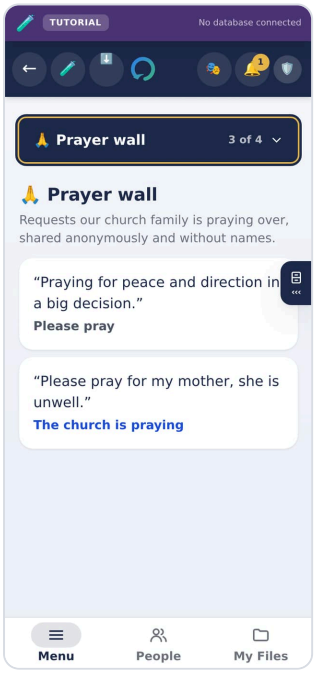
On a phone



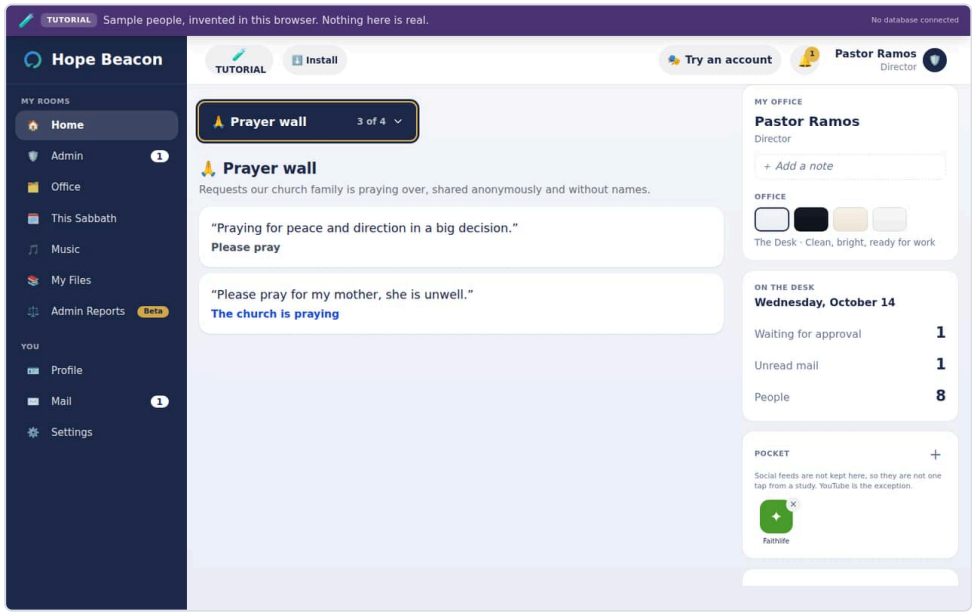
On a computer

Home › Prayer wall

Requests the church has been asked to pray for. A request reaches the wall only when the person asking ticks the box, and their name is never shown.



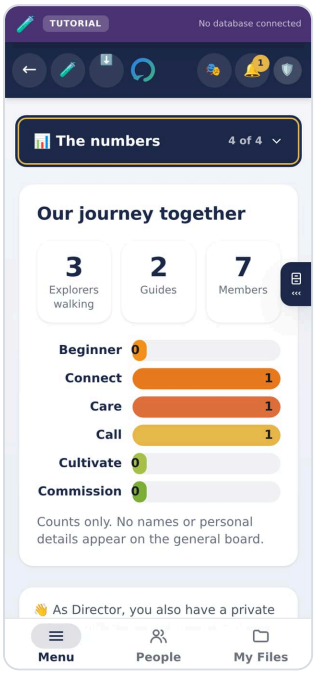
On a phone



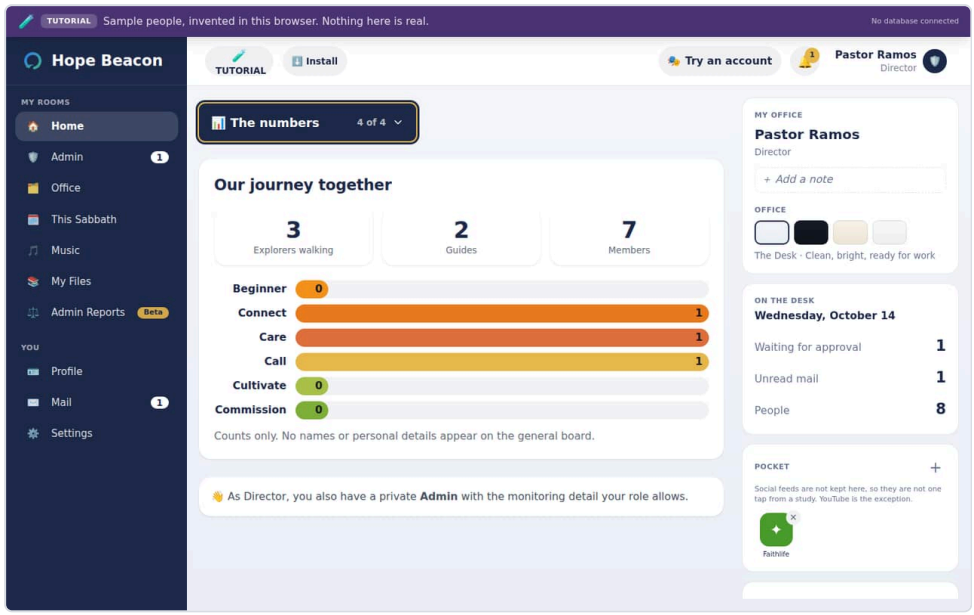
On a computer

Home › The numbers

Counts for the whole church: how many are walking, at which stage, with how many Guides. Counts only; no names and no private details.



On a phone



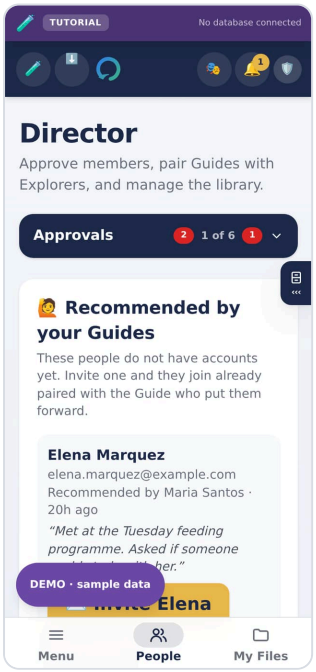
On a computer

Admin

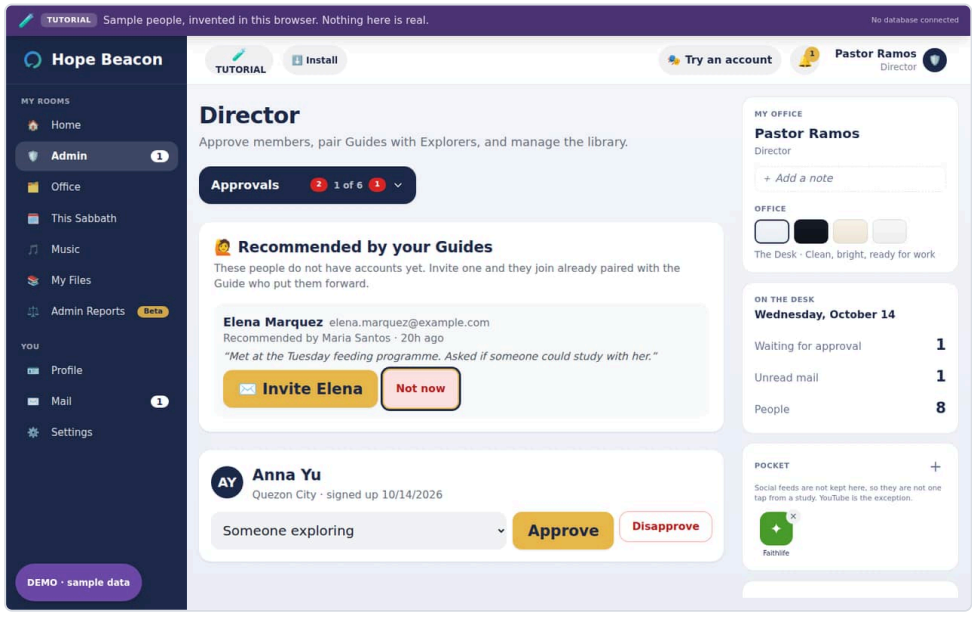
The Director’s desk: who is waiting to be let in, who walks with whom, and the church’s safeguarding.

Admin › Approvals

The most important screen in the app: who is waiting to be let in, and who Guides have recommended. An Explorer with no Guide has no app.



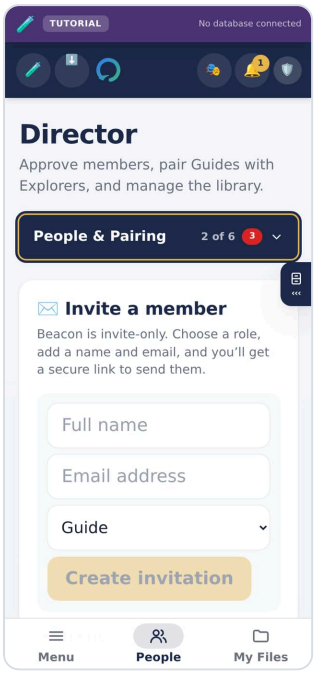
On a phone



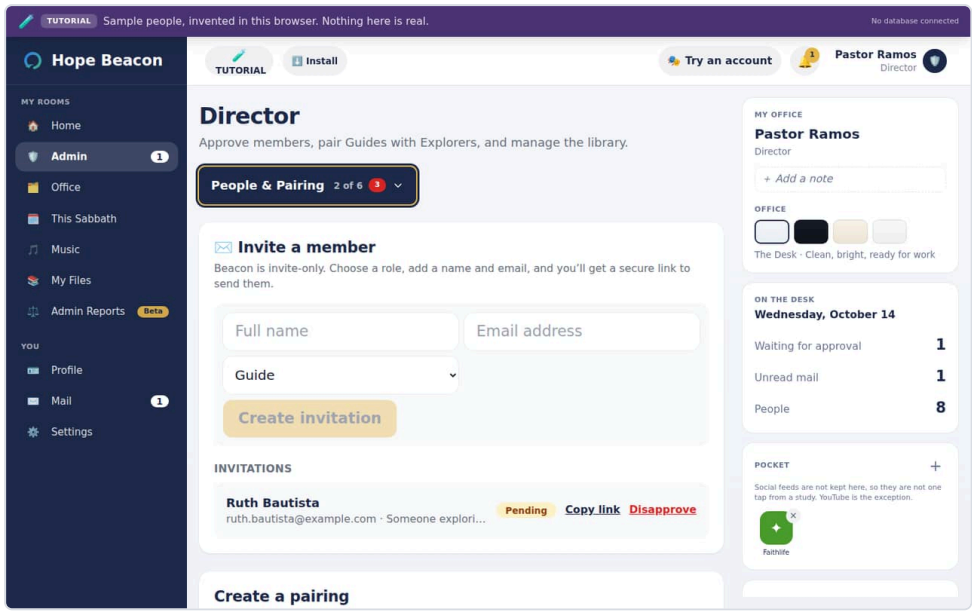
On a computer

Admin › People & Pairing

Who walks with whom. Pair an Explorer with a Guide, see who is unpaired, and who is at their limit.



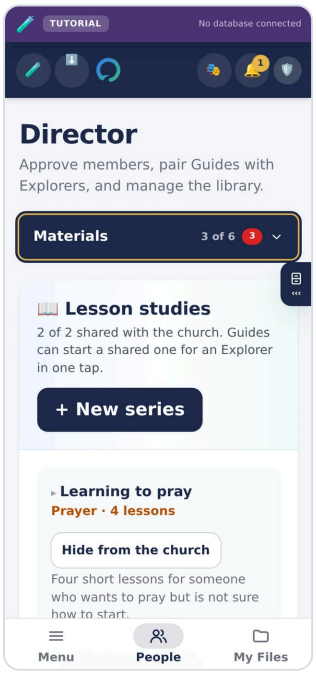
On a phone



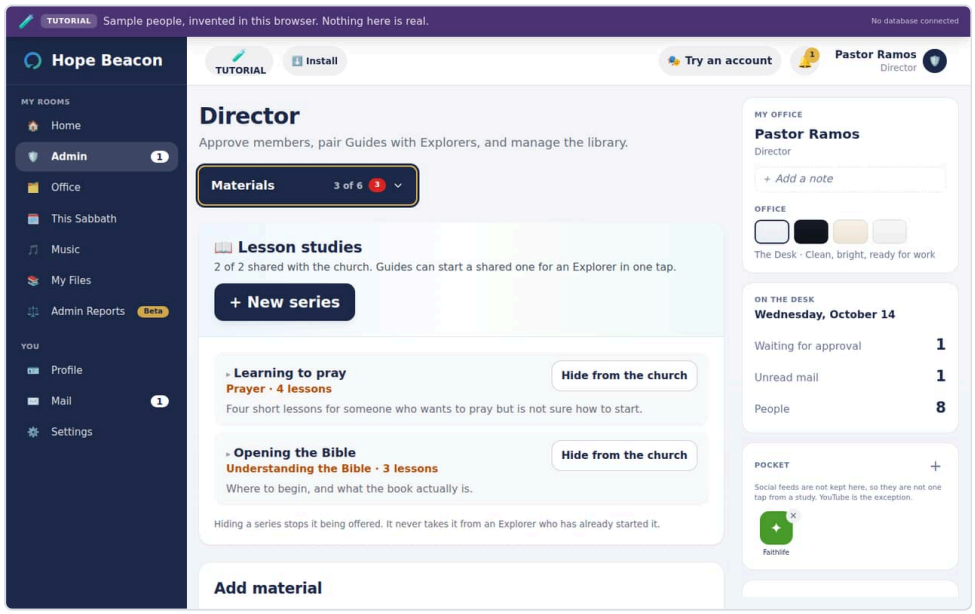
On a computer

Admin › Materials

The church's shared shelf: the resources everybody sees, stocked by the leaders.



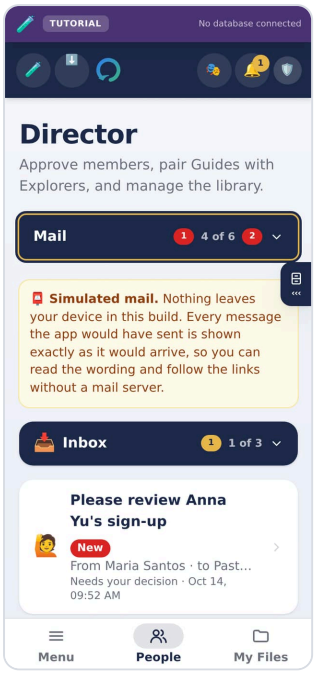
On a phone



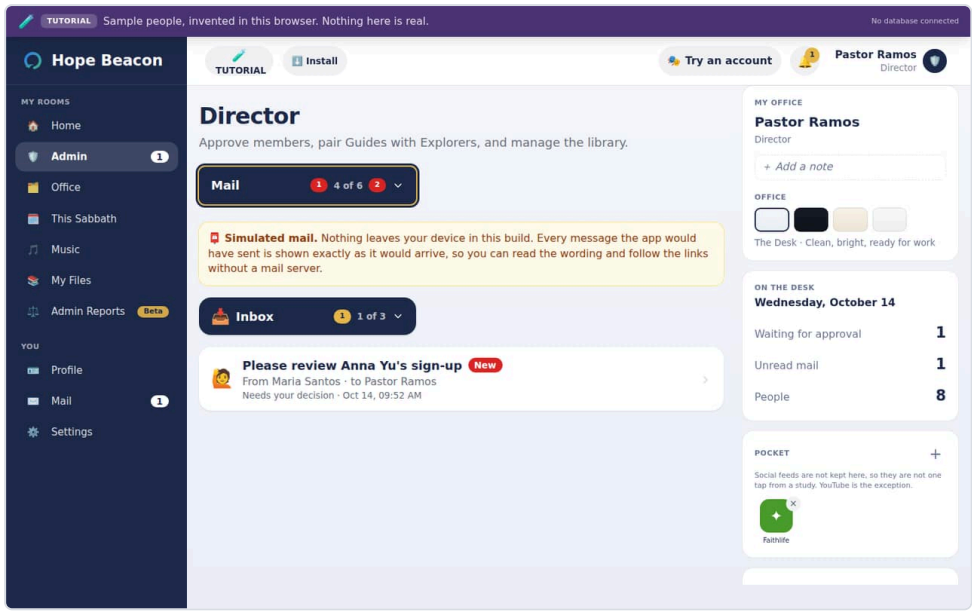
On a computer

Admin › Mail

Invitations and the messages the app sends on the church's behalf.



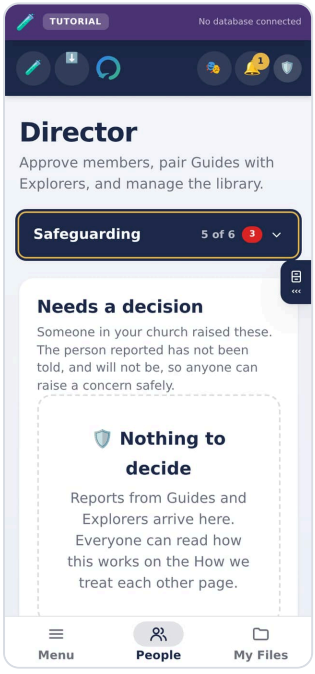
On a phone



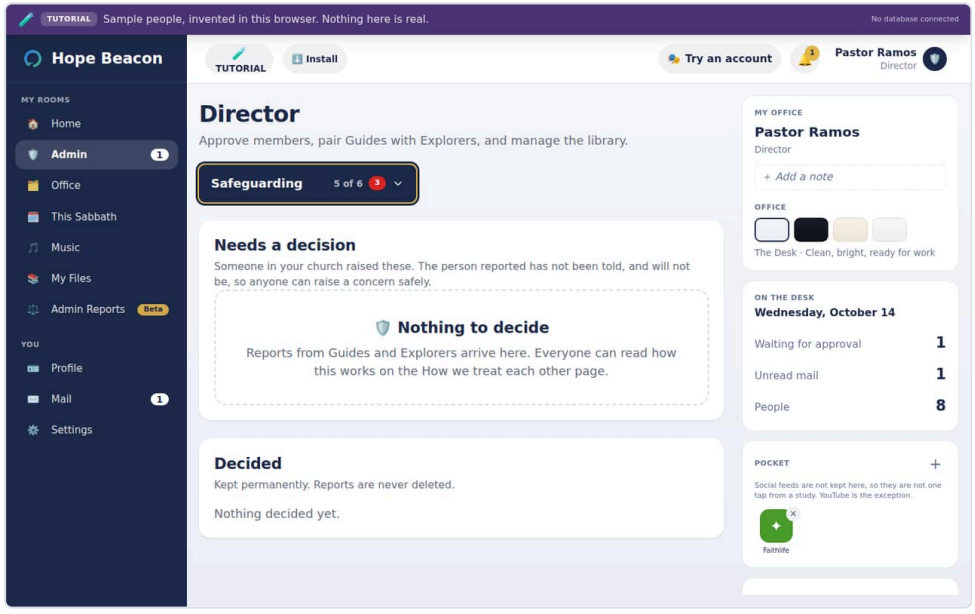
On a computer

Admin › Safeguarding

Reports somebody has made about a message or a person. The one place a leader may read a private conversation, and only the part reported.



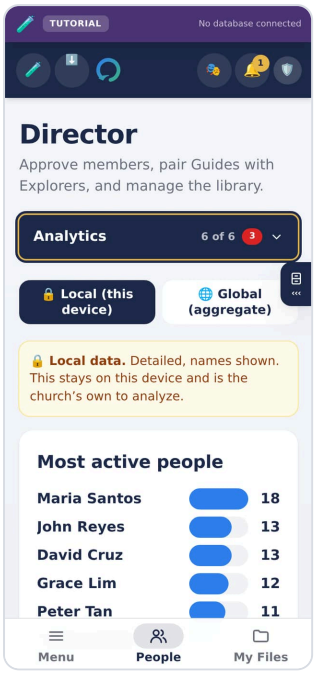
On a phone



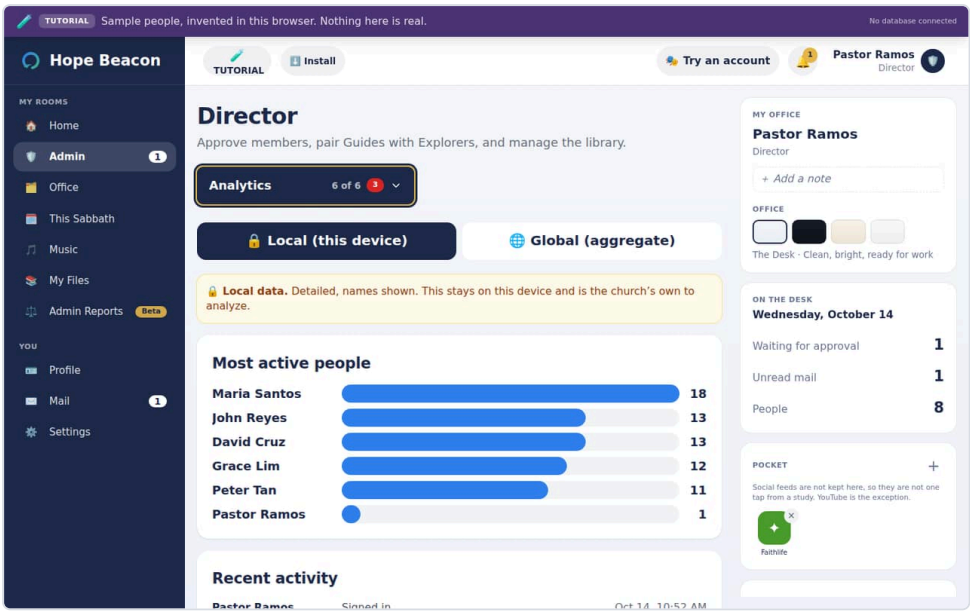
On a computer

Admin › Analytics

The church's numbers over time: growth, stages and how the Guides are carrying their people.



On a phone



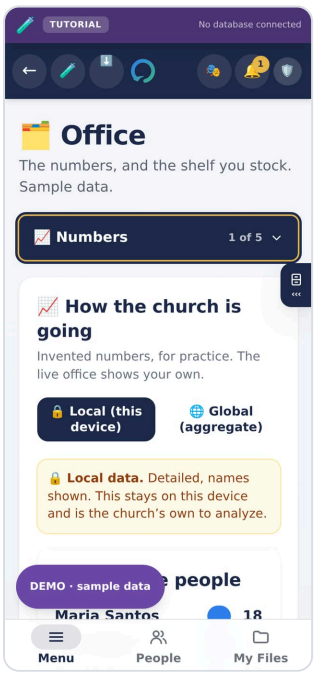
On a computer

Office

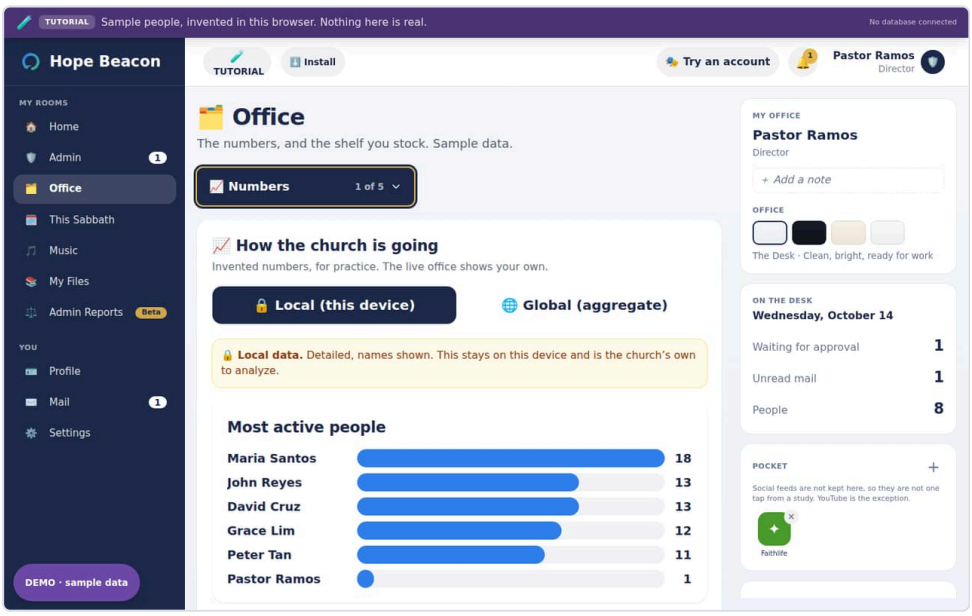
Work rather than conversation: the numbers, lesson studies, the Sabbath program, evangelistic meetings and reports. Explorers have no Office, because none of it is theirs to do.

Office › Numbers

How the church, or this Guide's part of it, is going. The sample's numbers are invented for practice; a church's own Office shows its own.



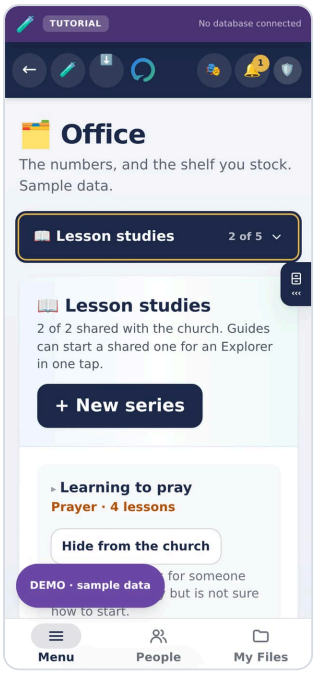
On a phone



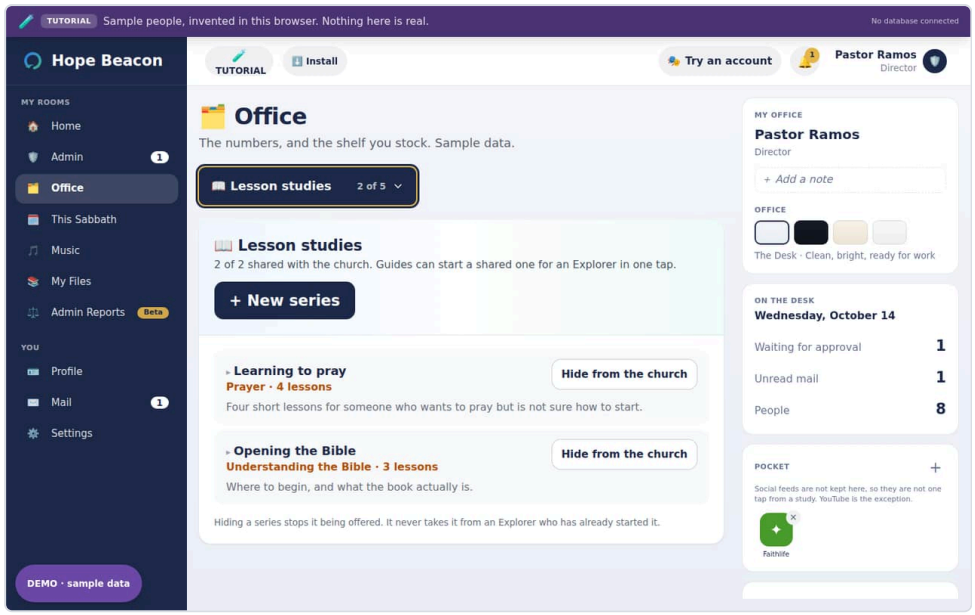
On a computer

Office › Lesson studies

Writing a lesson study once and sending it to the people who need it, with files and drawings attached. Simple by default, with an Advanced mode.



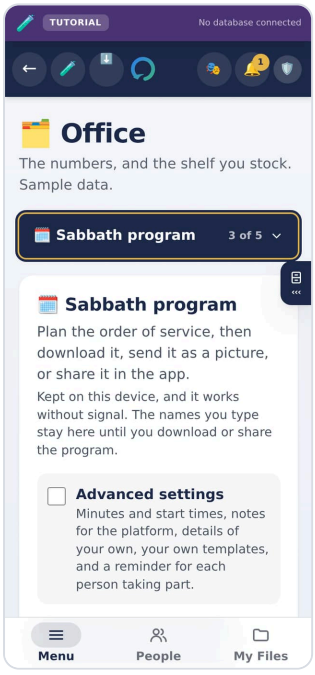
On a phone



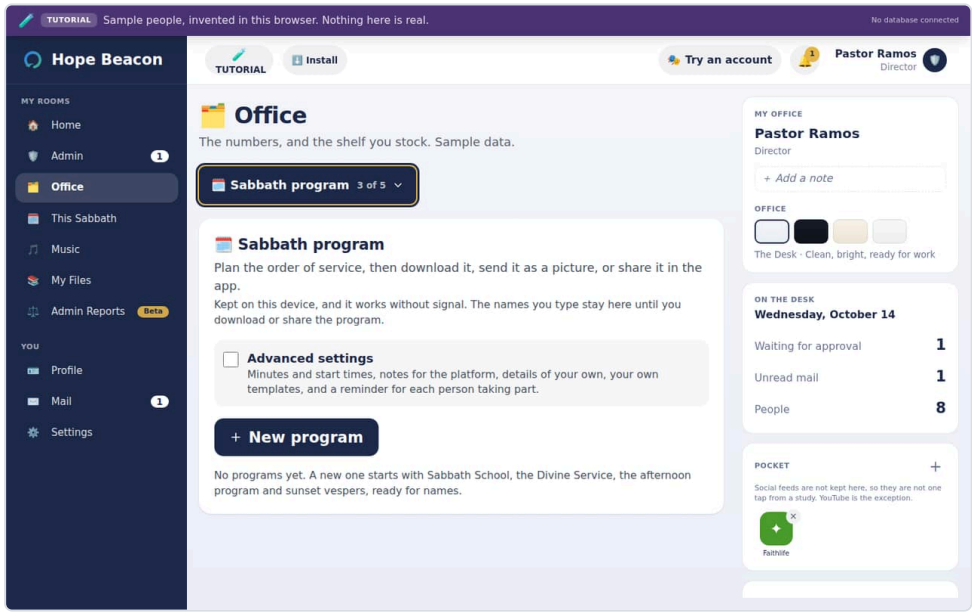
On a computer

Office › Sabbath program

Planning a Sabbath's order of service, then downloading it as a Word file or a picture, copying it as text, or posting it for This Sabbath.



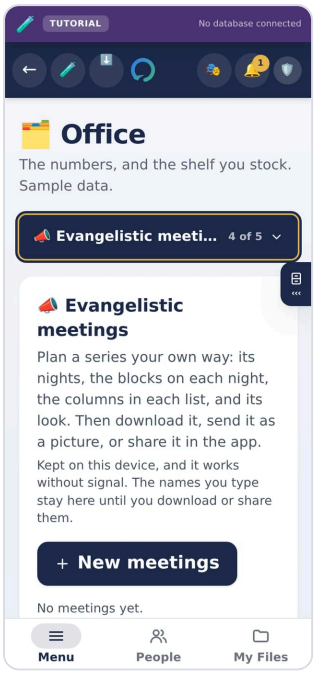
On a phone



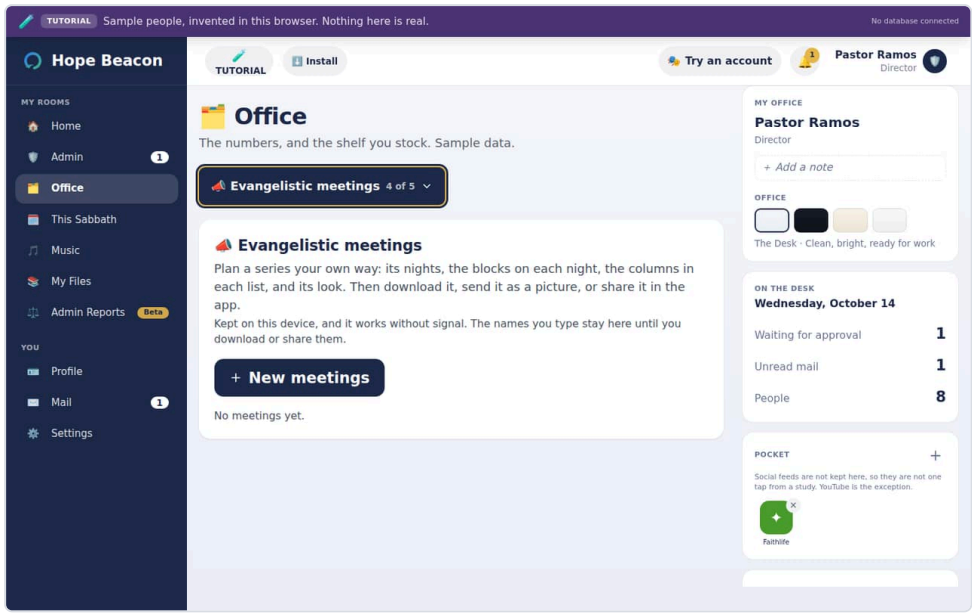
On a computer

Office › Evangelistic meetings

Planning a series of meetings night by night: programs, teams, schedules and checklists, with a look of its own for the Word file and the picture.



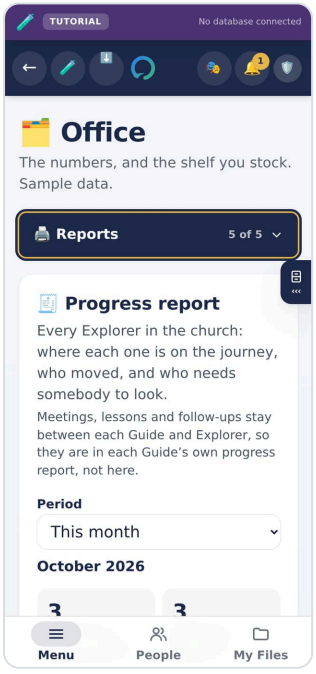
On a phone



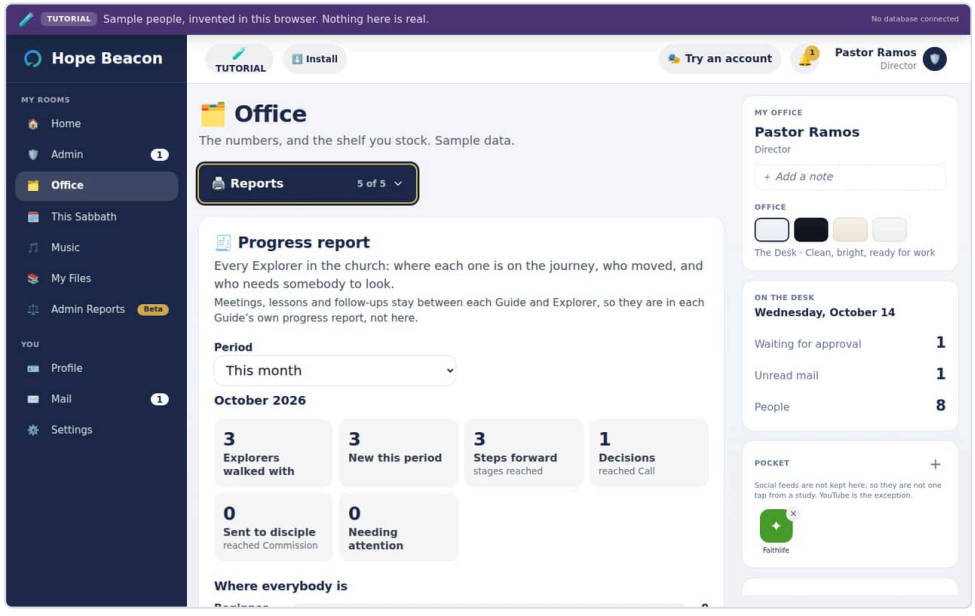
On a computer

Office › Reports

The progress report: how the Explorers are doing this month or quarter, who needs somebody, and a Word file to hand in.



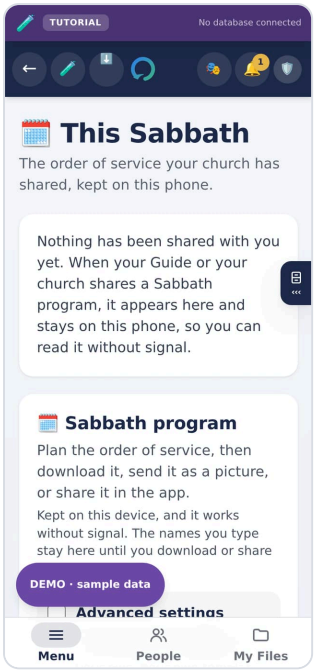
On a phone



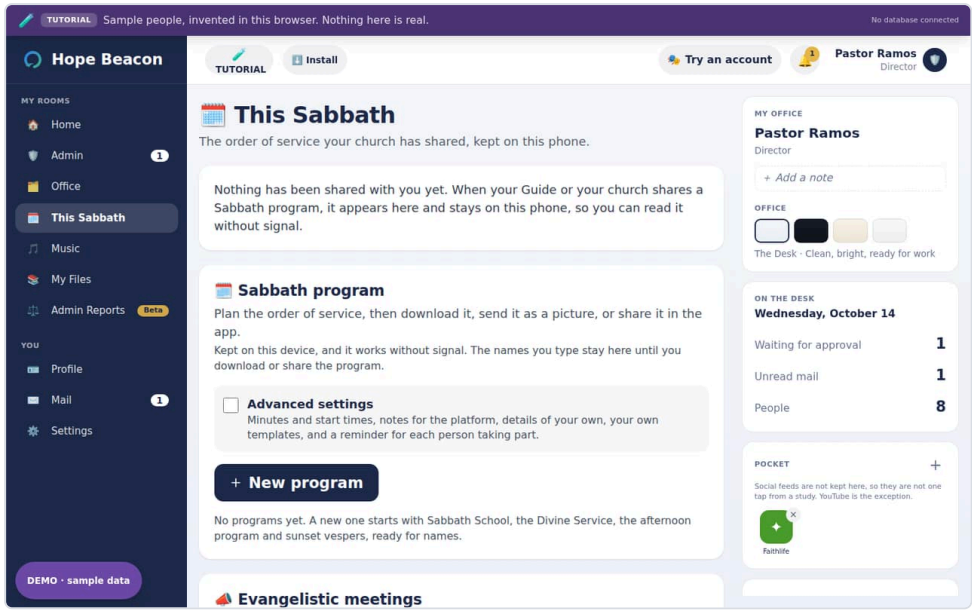
On a computer

This Sabbath

The Sabbath program and any evangelistic meetings a Guide or the church has posted. Once it has been opened with a signal, it opens again with none.



On a phone



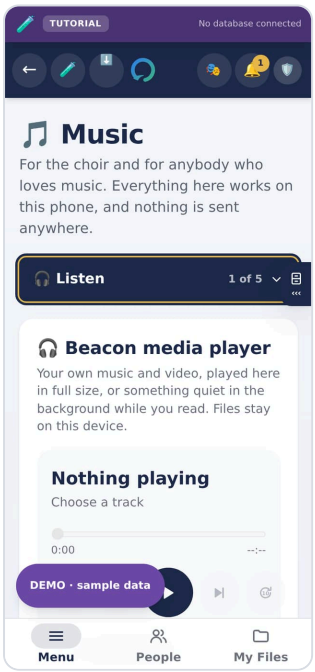
On a computer

Music

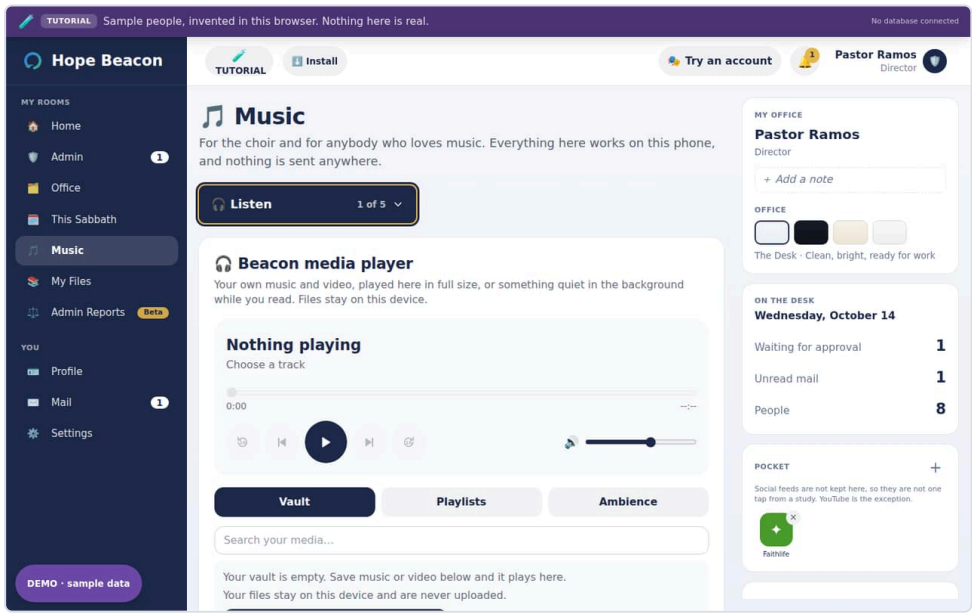
For the choir and anybody who loves music. Everything in it happens on the phone or computer itself; nothing is sent anywhere.

Music › Listen

The player: your own music and video, playlists, and calming sounds for the background.



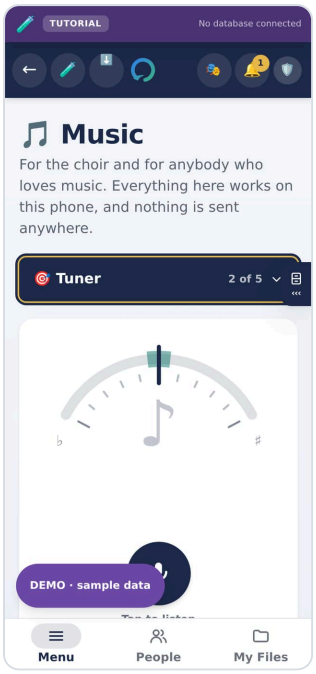
On a phone



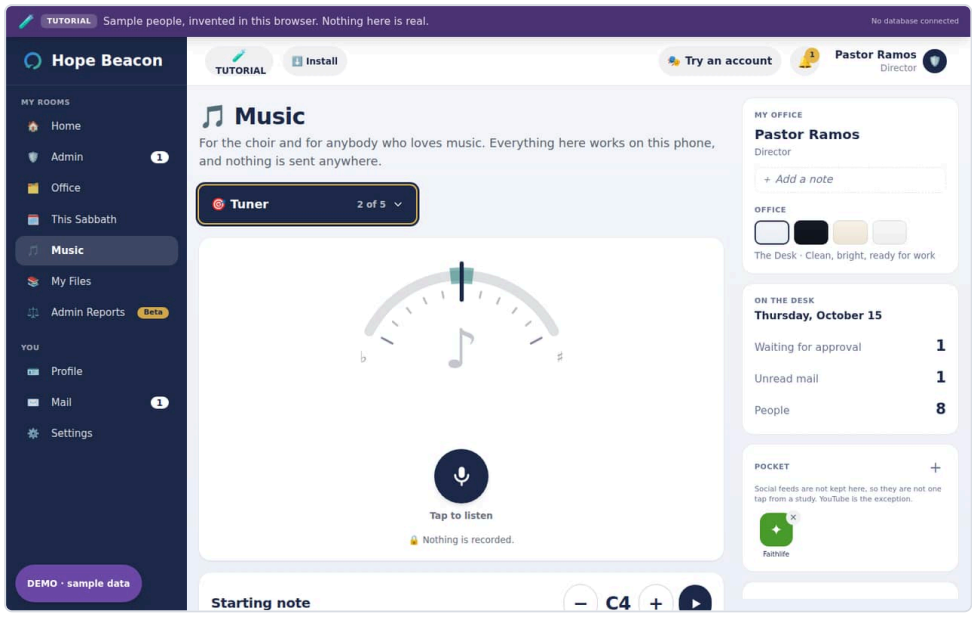
On a computer

Music › Tuner

Which note you are singing or playing, and whether it is flat or sharp. The microphone is used only while it listens, and nothing is recorded.



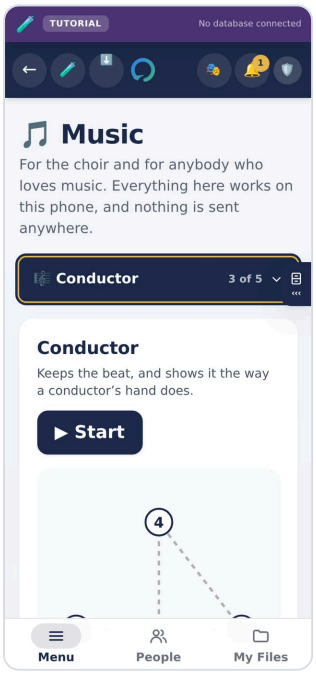
On a phone



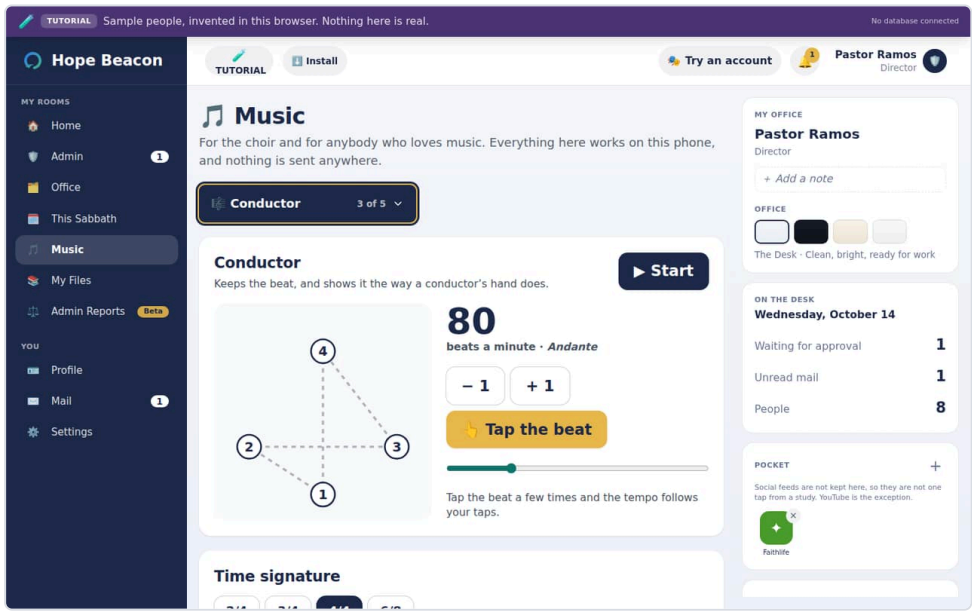
On a computer

Music › Conductor

A steady beat, and the conductor’s hand drawn for 2, 3, 4 or 6 beats. Tap the beat to set the tempo.



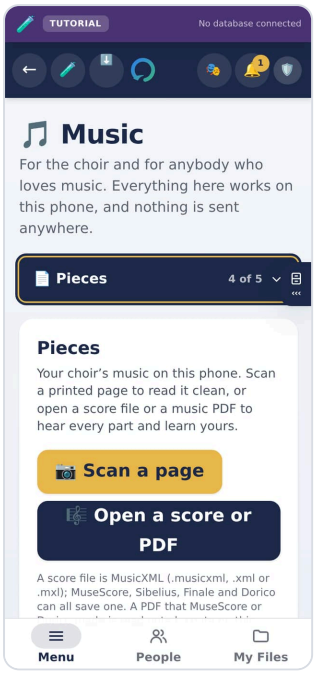
On a phone



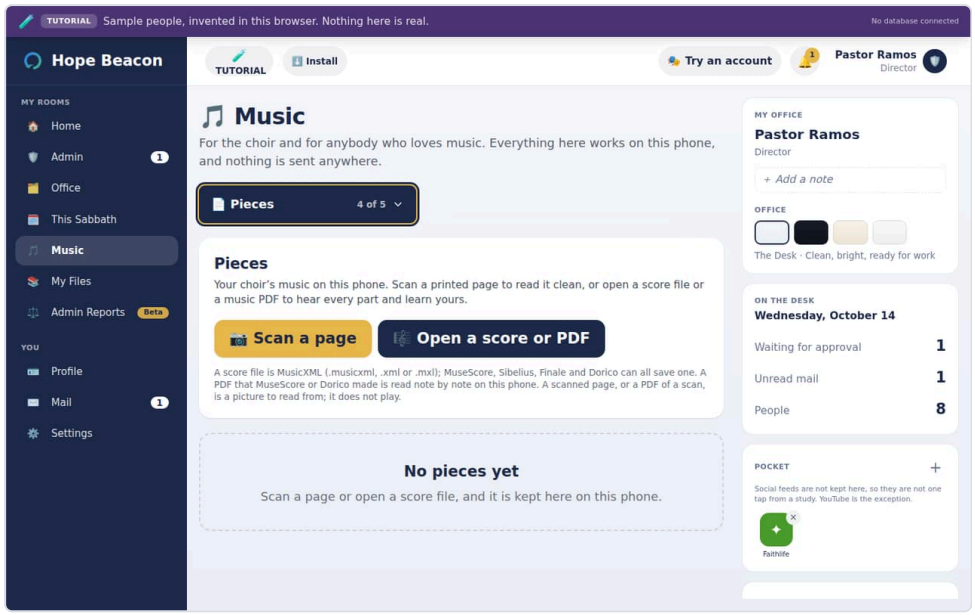
On a computer

Music › Pieces

The choir's music: a photographed page made clean and square, or a MusicXML score or a notation program's PDF that plays, with your own part louder. About this piece explains it from its own markings.



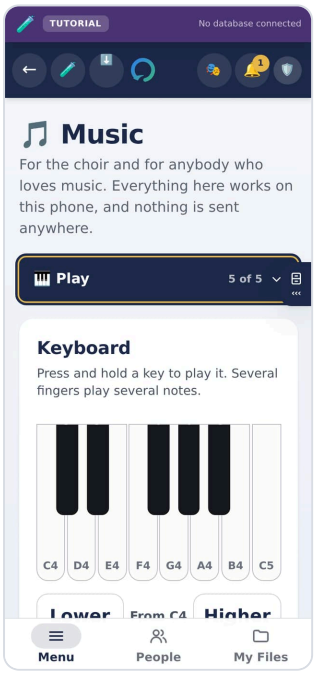
On a phone



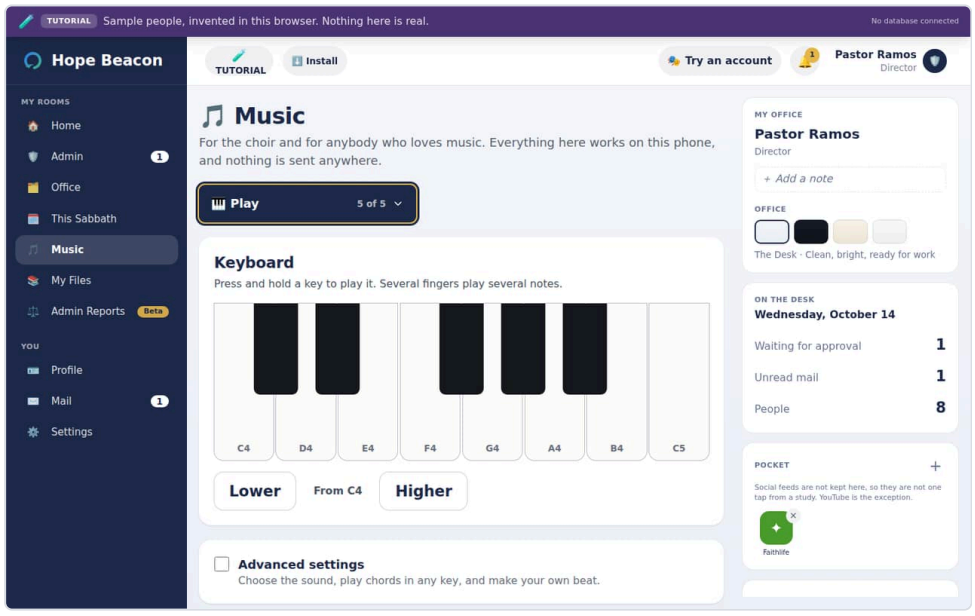
On a computer

Music › Play

A piano keyboard held by each finger at the choir's concert pitch; in Advanced, the chords of any key and a beat maker.



On a phone



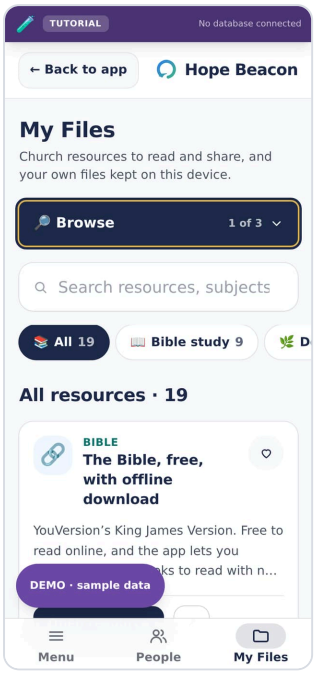
On a computer

My Files

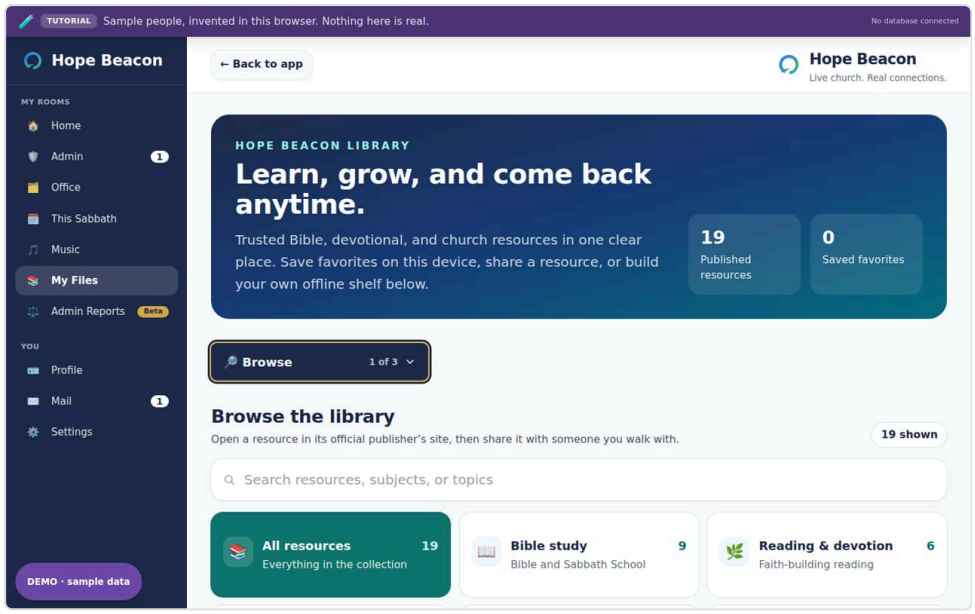
A person's own music, video and documents, saved on their own device. Nothing in it is shared and nothing comes from anybody else.

My Files › Browse

Everything on this person’s shelf, with a search box.



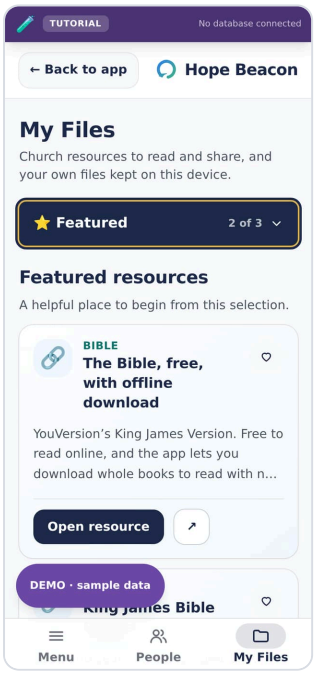
On a phone



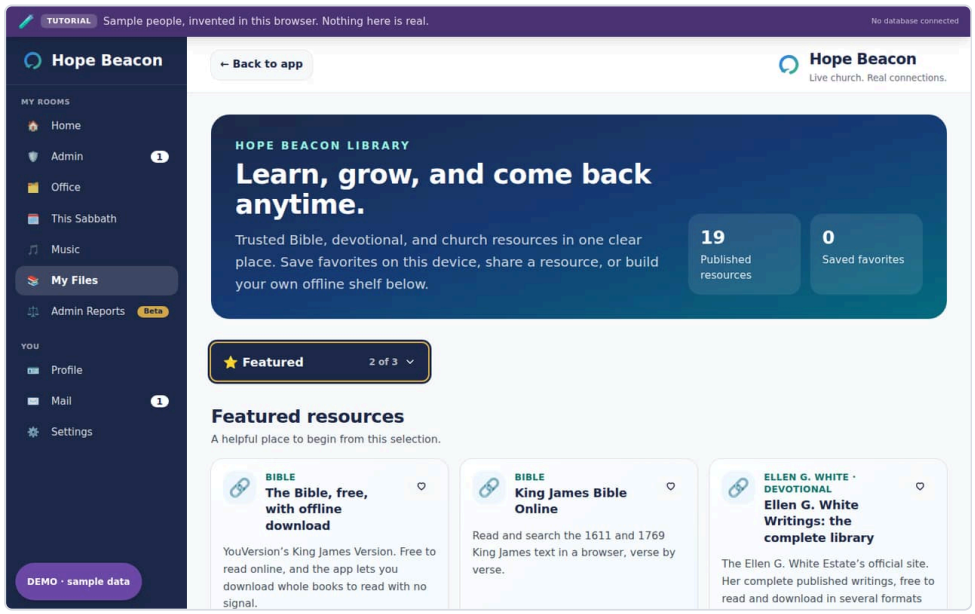
On a computer

My Files › Featured

What the church has put first.



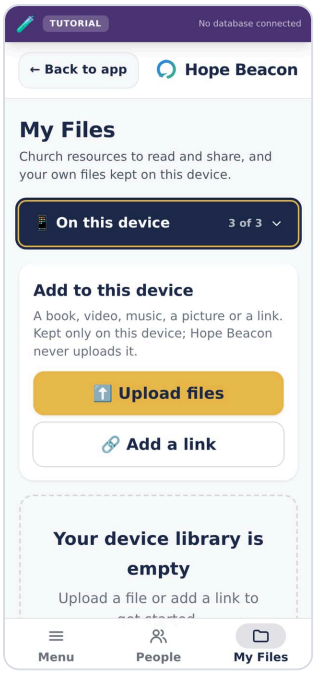
On a phone



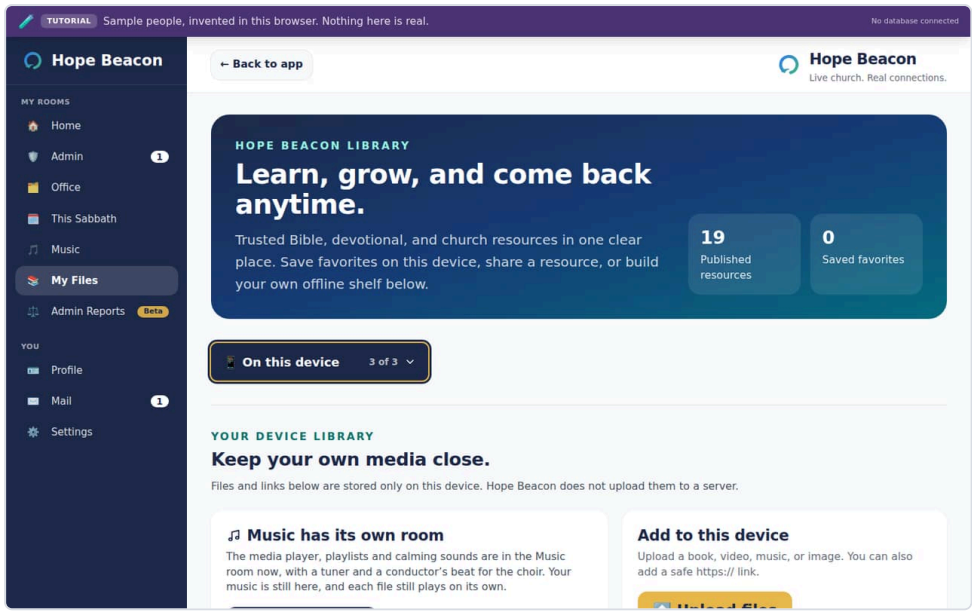
On a computer

My Files › On this device

Files saved on this phone or computer, for reading and listening with no signal. They never leave the device.



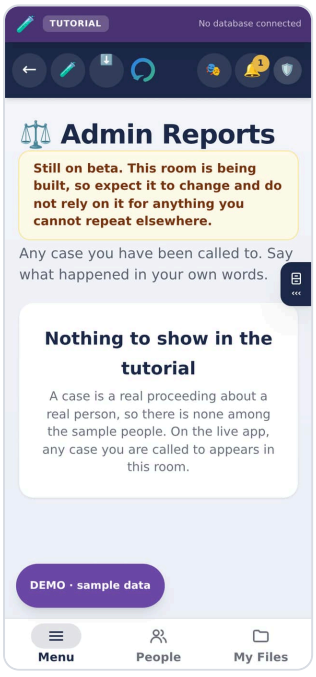
On a phone



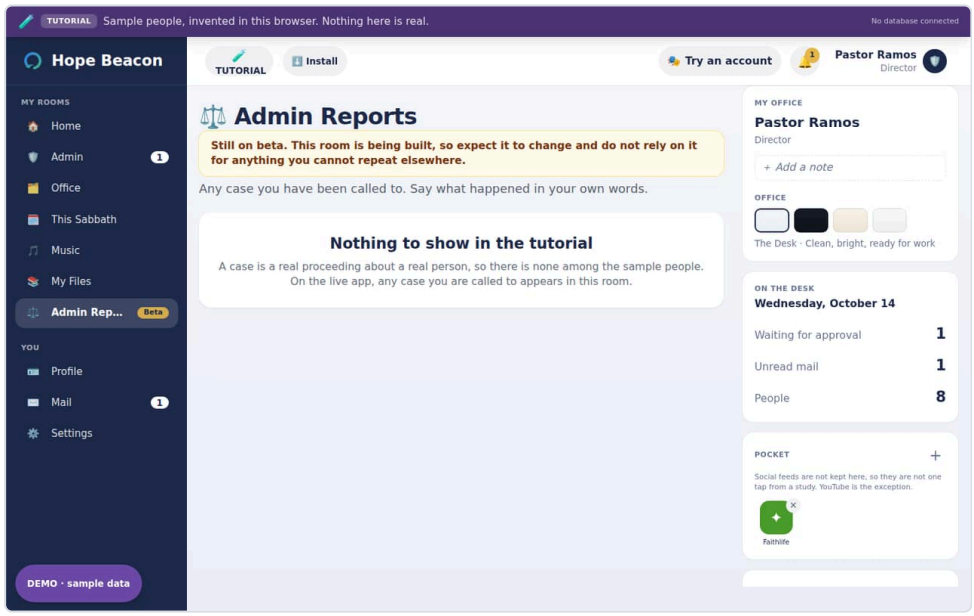
On a computer

Admin Reports

Reports, trials and the record: the part of the app nobody wants to need. It is always in a leader's Menu, and says plainly when nothing is open.



On a phone



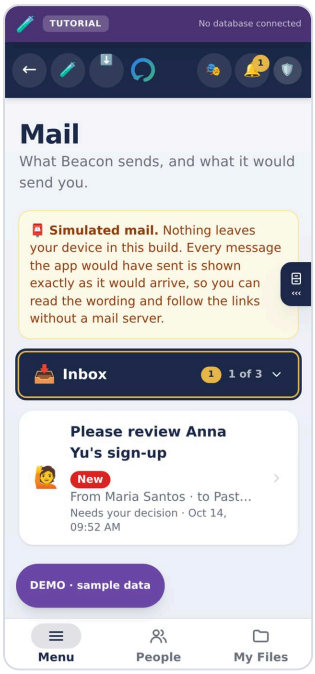
On a computer

Mail

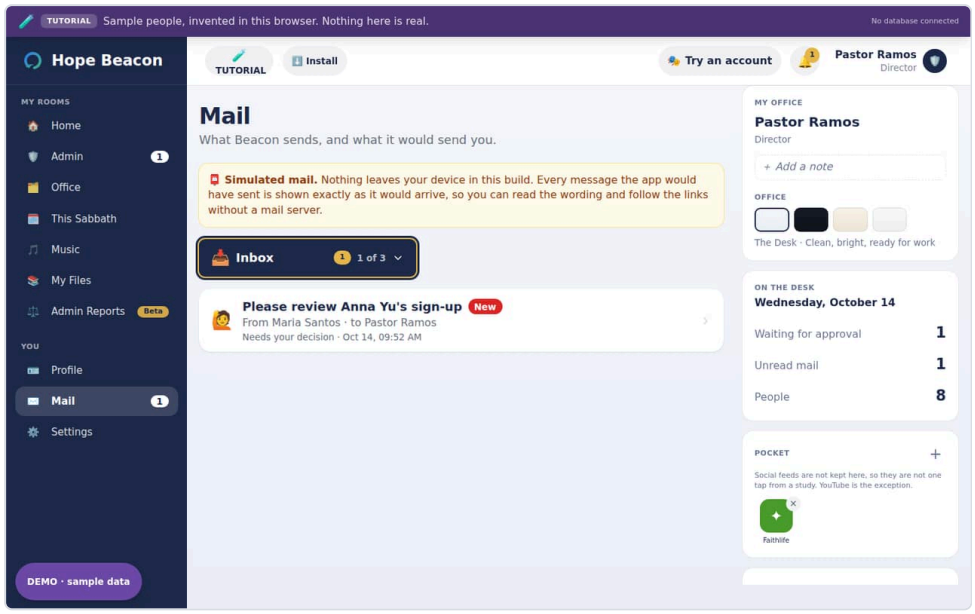
In the sample church, a mailbox showing what the app sends, without sending real email. In a church's own app, Mail is for Directors and Executive Directors, and lists the invitations still open, to resend or cancel.

Mail › Inbox

What the app has sent this person.



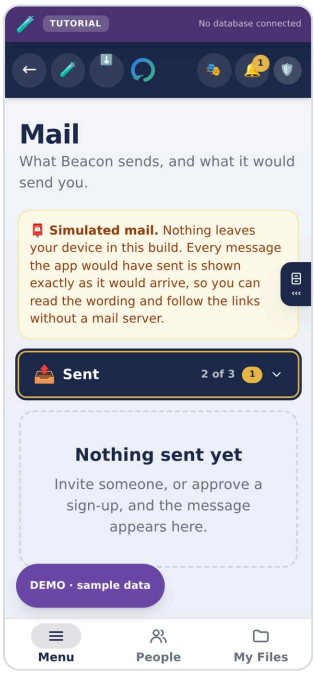
On a phone



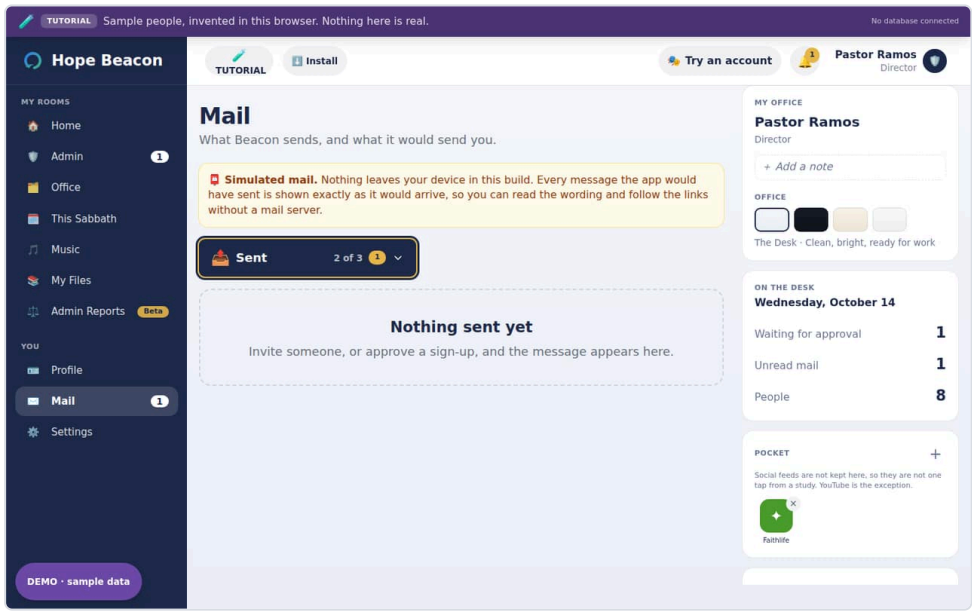
On a computer

Mail › Sent

What this person has sent through the app, such as recommending somebody.



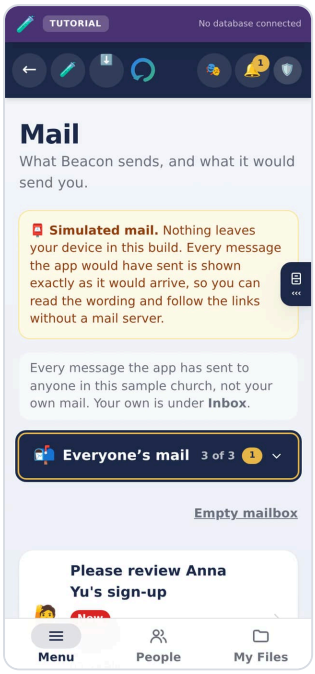
On a phone



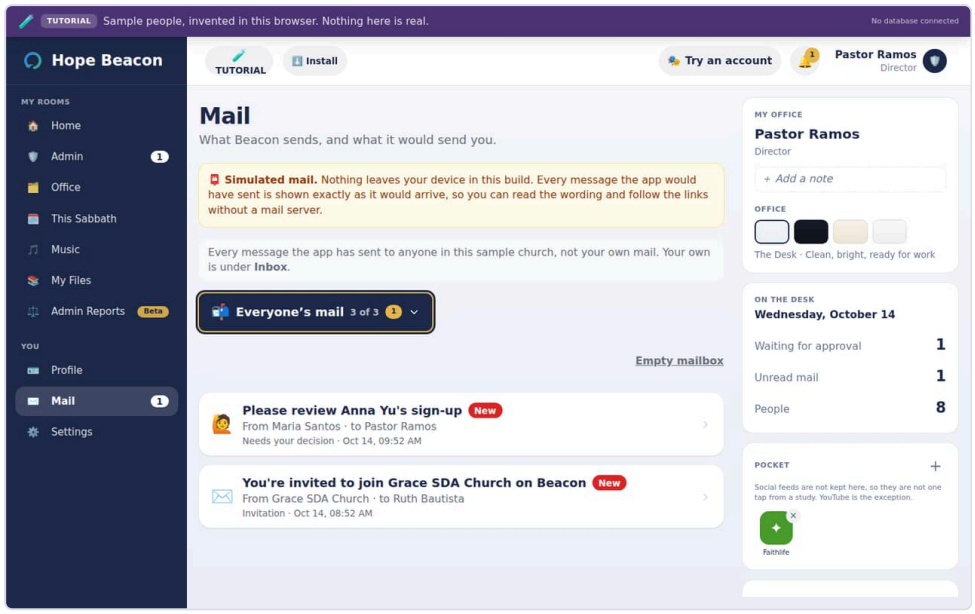
On a computer

Mail › Everyone’s mail

For leaders in the sample church: every message the app has sent, to anybody.



On a phone



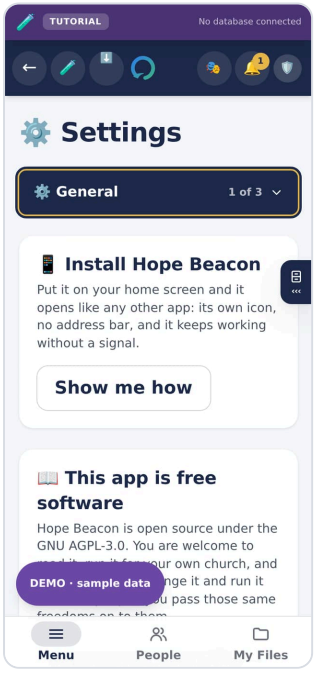
On a computer

Settings

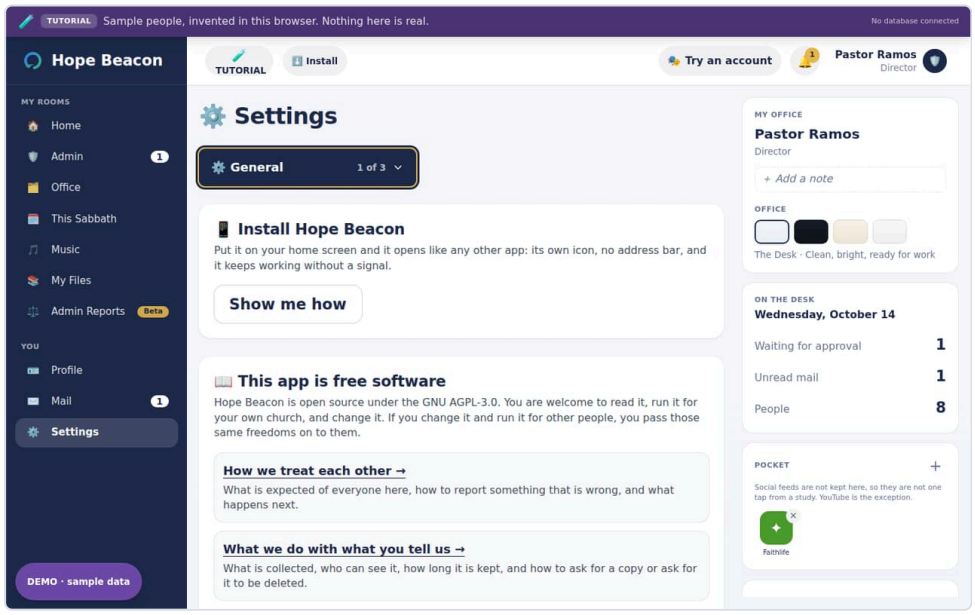
Everything about this device and this account: text size, the look, installing, alerts, language, the guided walk, what is new, and help. A church’s own app adds a Password folder and an Admin Reports folder.

Settings › General

Installing, alerts, text size, the look, and language.



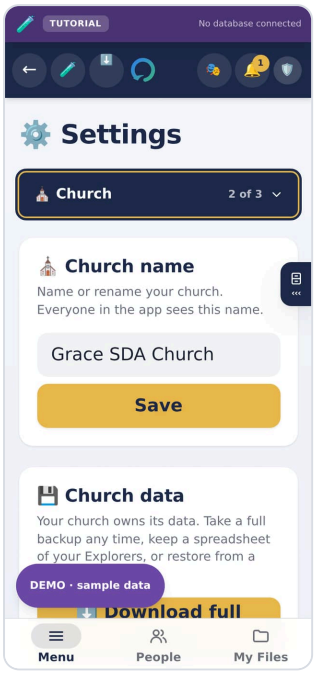
On a phone



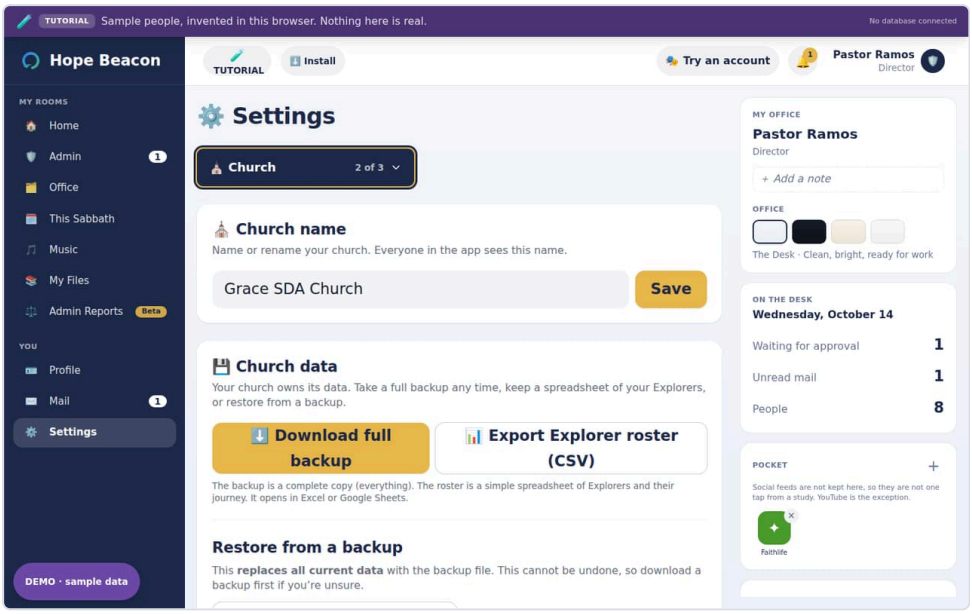
On a computer

Settings › Church

For Directors: the church's name and its data.



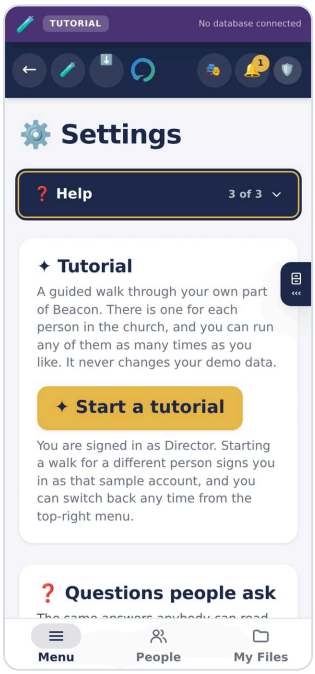
On a phone



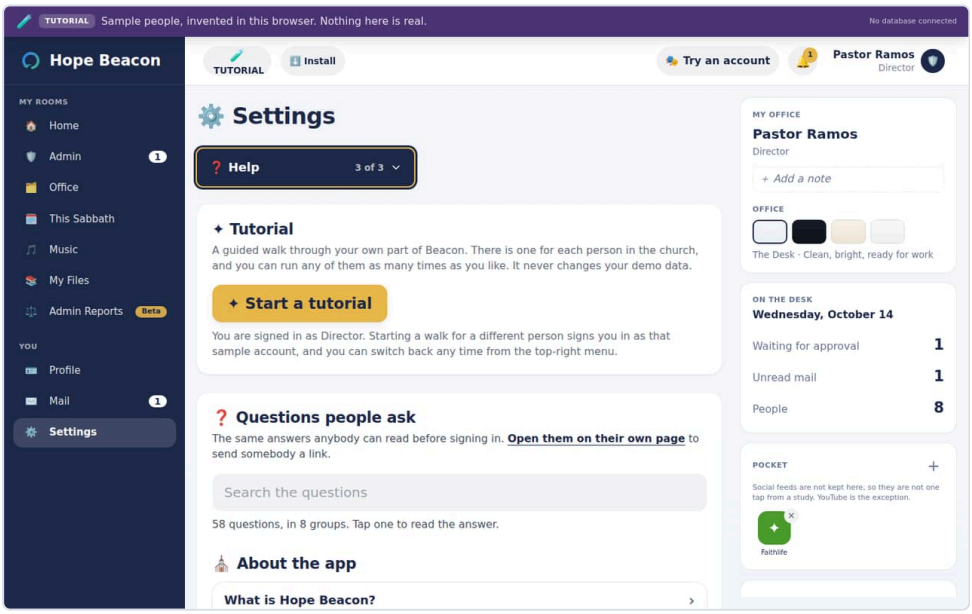
On a computer

Settings › Help

The guided walk, what is new, feedback, and where to find help.



On a phone



On a computer

CHAPTER 24

Executive Director screens

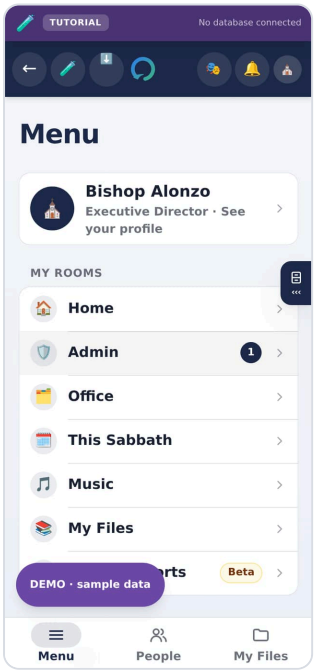
What Bishop Alonzo, the sample Executive Director, sees: everything a Director does, across every church they oversee.

IN THIS CHAPTER

Profile 227
Home 227
Admin 229
Office 232
This Sabbath 234
Music 235
My Files 237
Admin Reports 239
Mail 239
Settings 241

The Menu

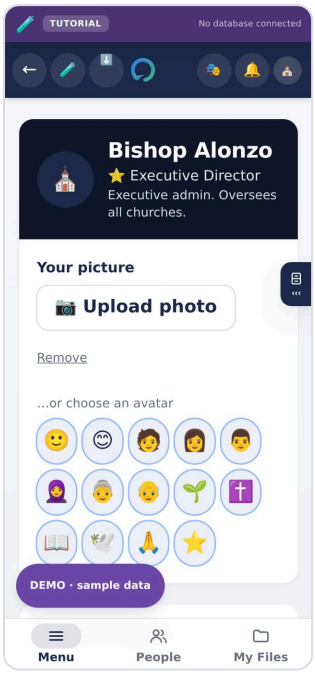
Every room this person has, written out, with their own profile at the top. It is the first of the three words along the bottom of every screen: Menu, People, My Files.



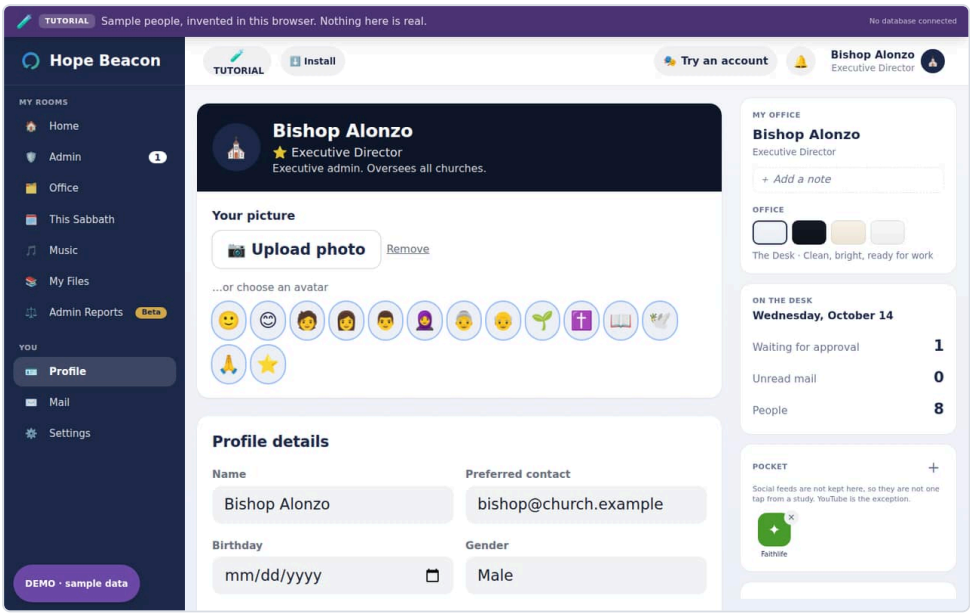
On a phone

Profile

Your own page: your name, your photograph and your details. Everybody has one, and it is the first row of the Menu.



On a phone



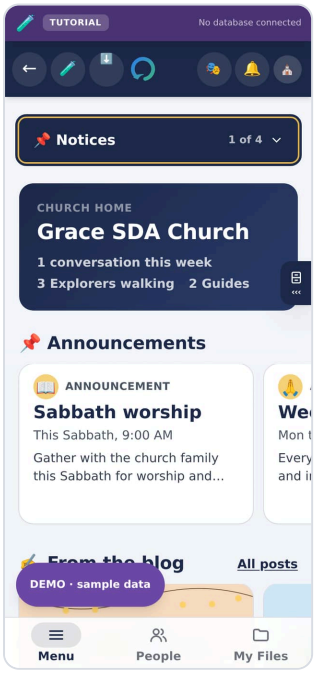
On a computer

Home

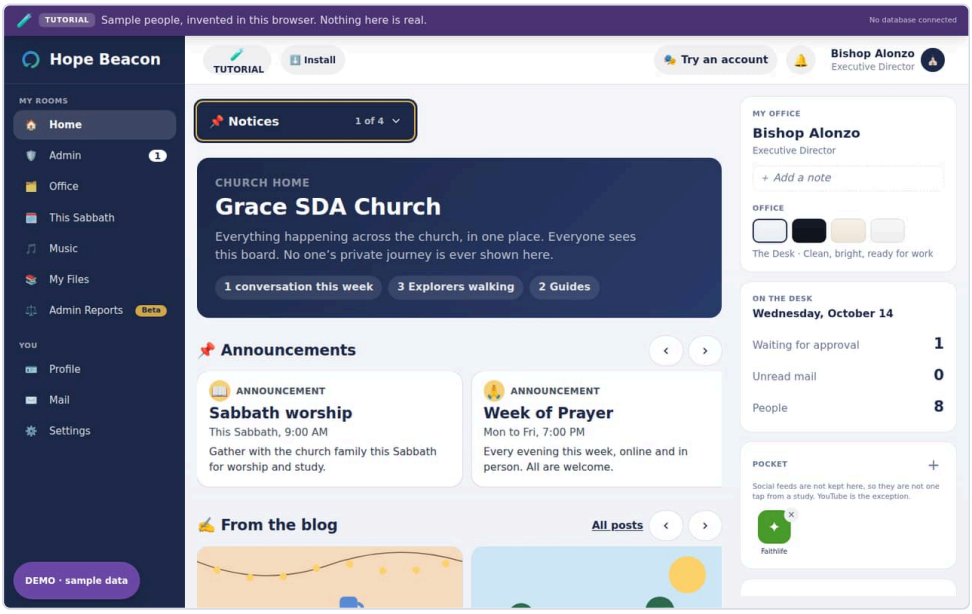
The church home, and the first room on every Menu: what the whole church is saying, before anybody turns to their own work.

Home › Notices

Pinned announcements from the church, newest first, with when each happens.



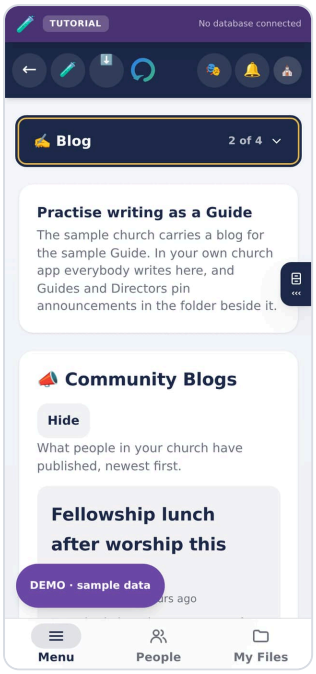
On a phone



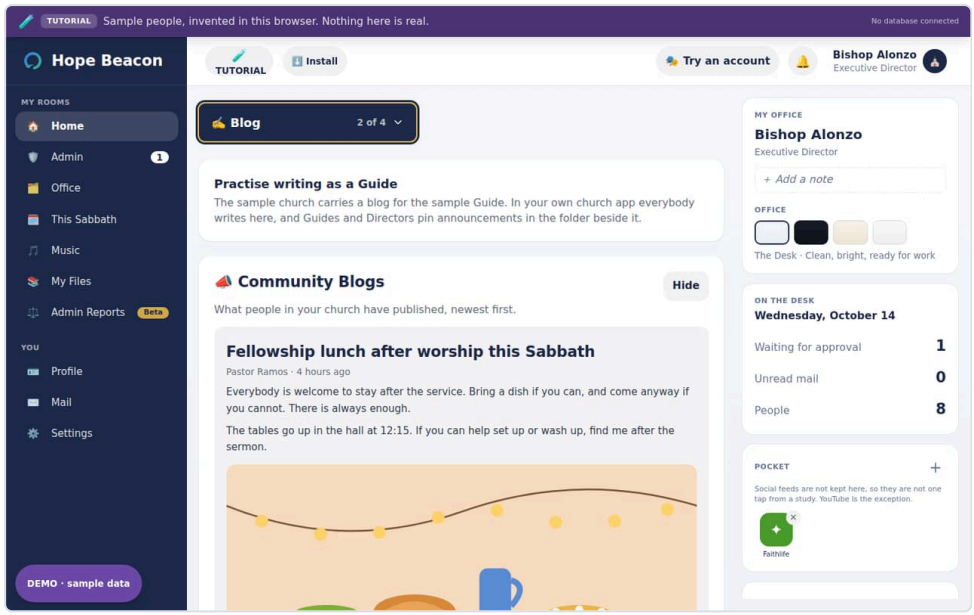
On a computer

Home › Blog

Posts written for the church. **Write a post** is at the top: a title, the words, **Publish**. Advanced settings narrow who reads it, or keep it as a draft.



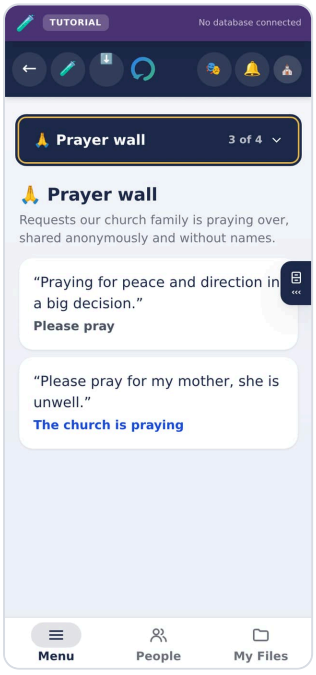
On a phone



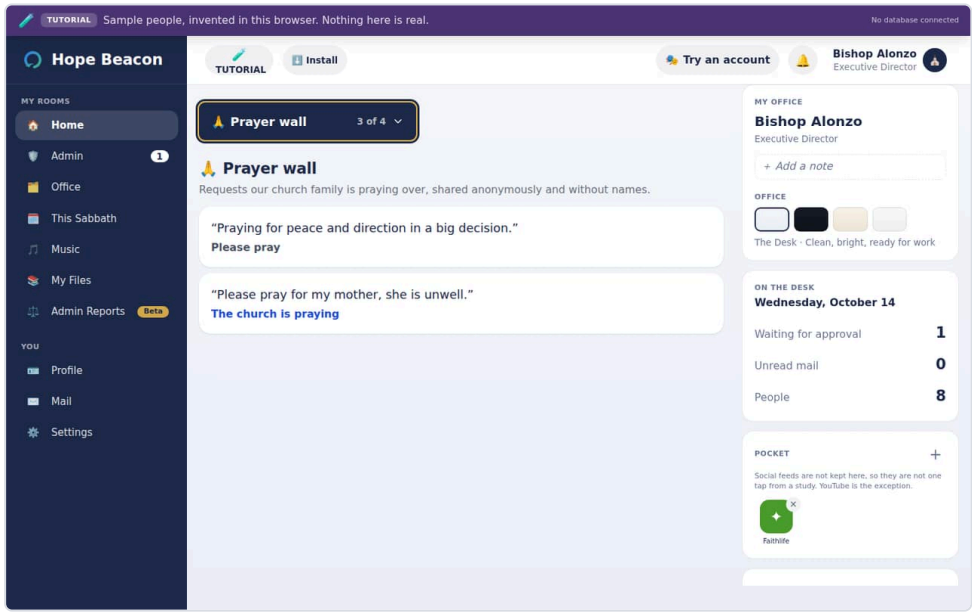
On a computer

Home › Prayer wall

Requests the church has been asked to pray for. A request reaches the wall only when the person asking ticks the box, and their name is never shown.



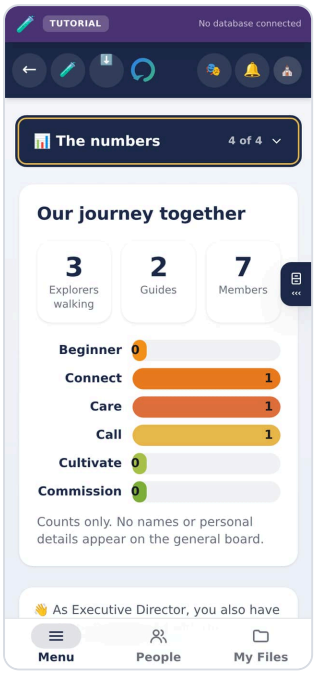
On a phone



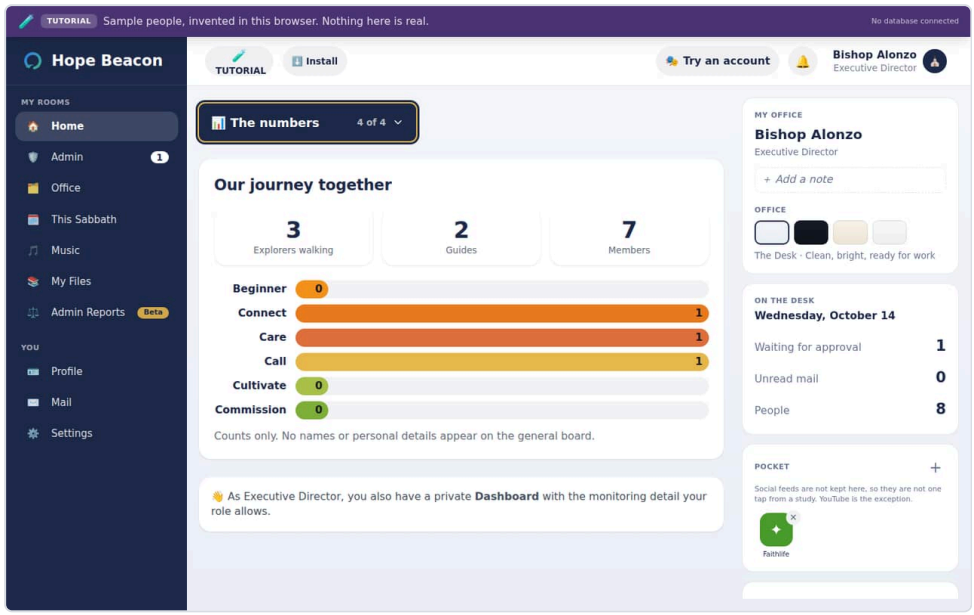
On a computer

Home › The numbers

Counts for the whole church: how many are walking, at which stage, with how many Guides. Counts only; no names and no private details.



On a phone



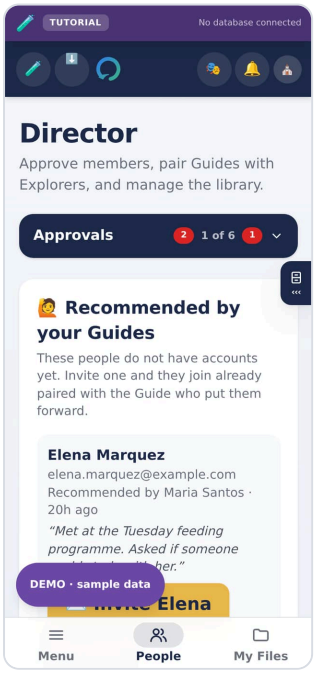
On a computer

Admin

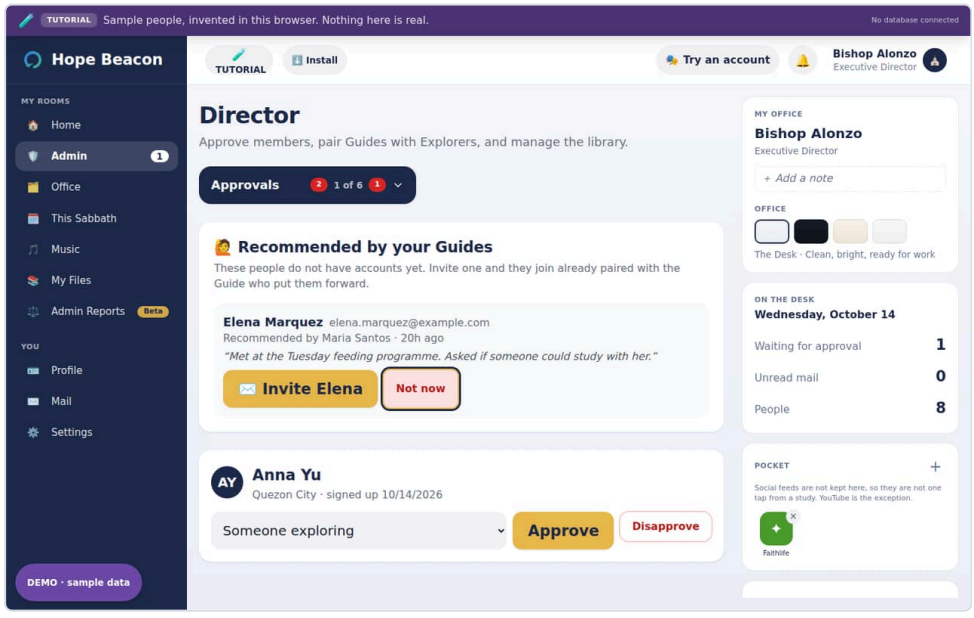
The Director’s desk: who is waiting to be let in, who walks with whom, and the church’s safeguarding.

Admin › Approvals

The most important screen in the app: who is waiting to be let in, and who Guides have recommended. An Explorer with no Guide has no app.



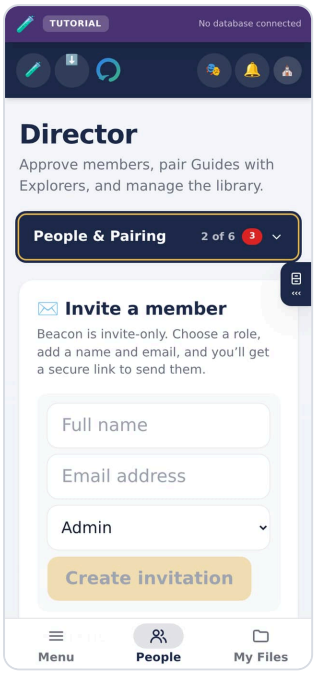
On a phone



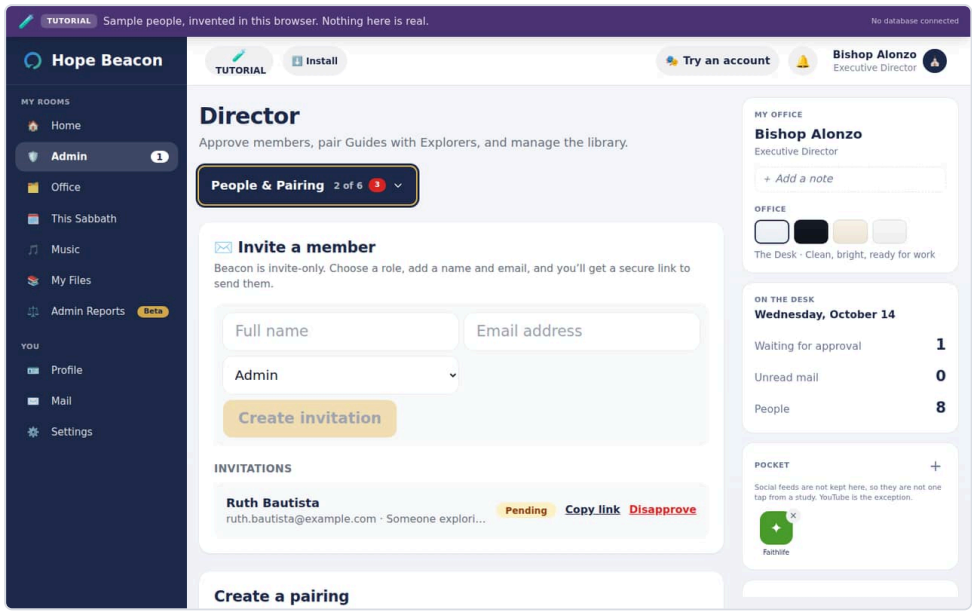
On a computer

Admin › People & Pairing

Who walks with whom. Pair an Explorer with a Guide, see who is unpaired, and who is at their limit.



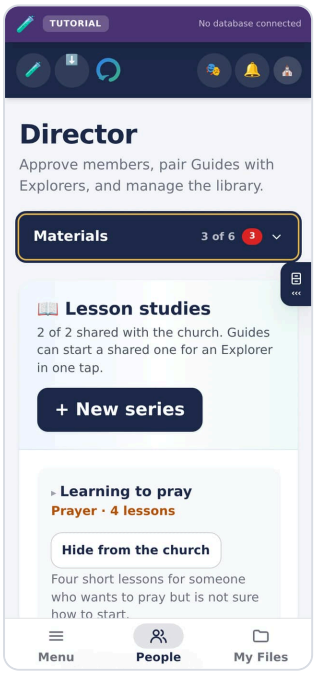
On a phone



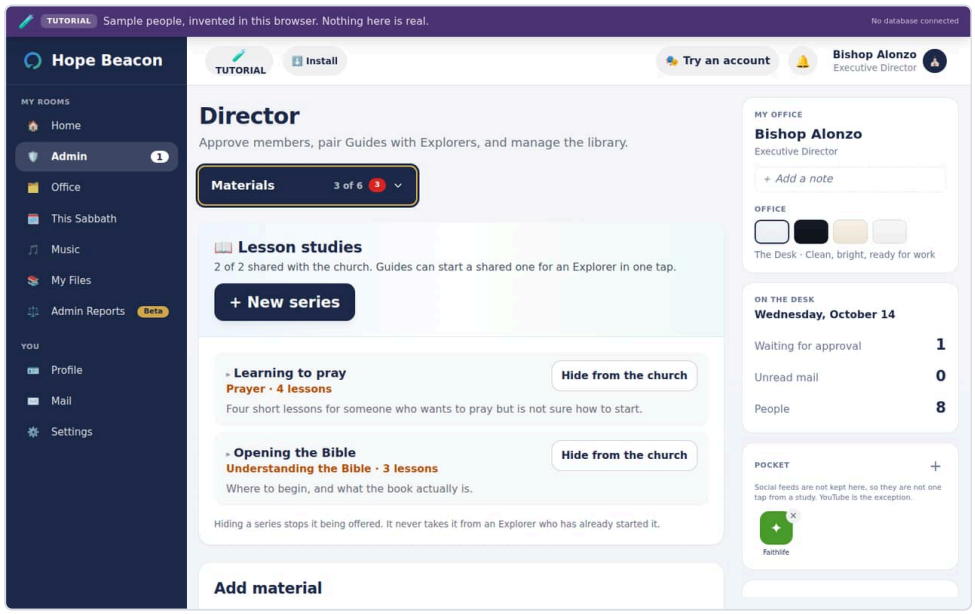
On a computer

Admin › Materials

The church's shared shelf: the resources everybody sees, stocked by the leaders.



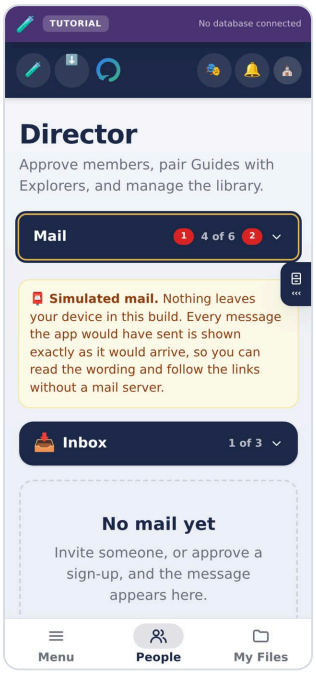
On a phone



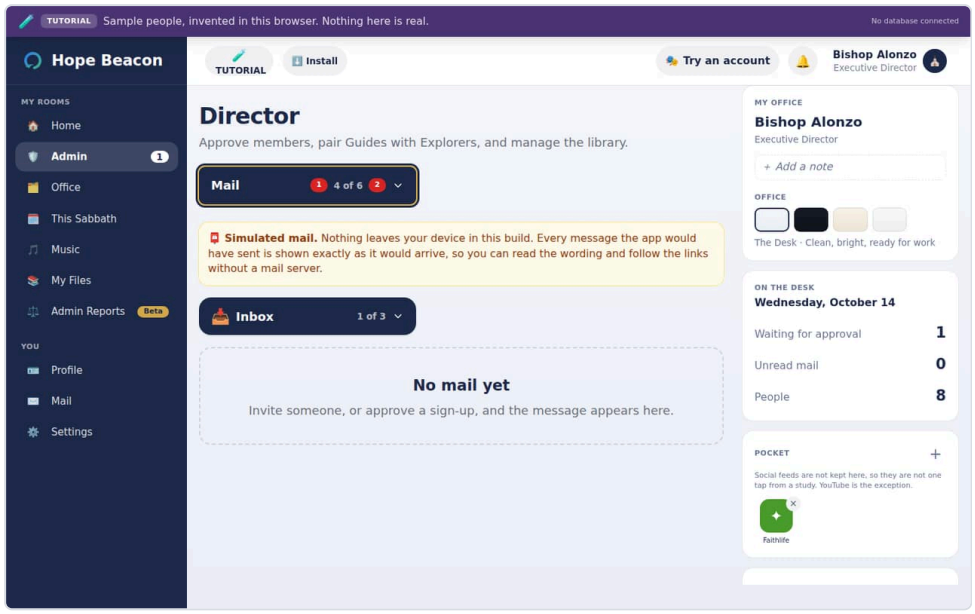
On a computer

Admin › Mail

Invitations and the messages the app sends on the church's behalf.



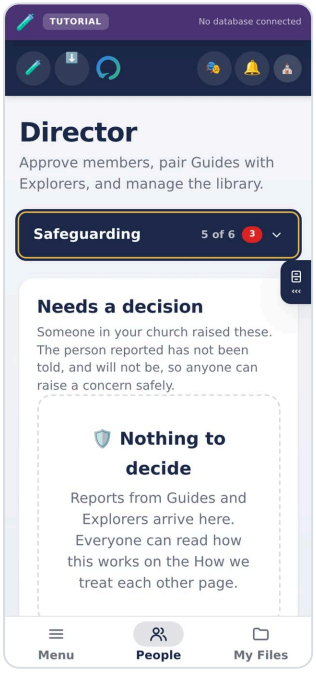
On a phone



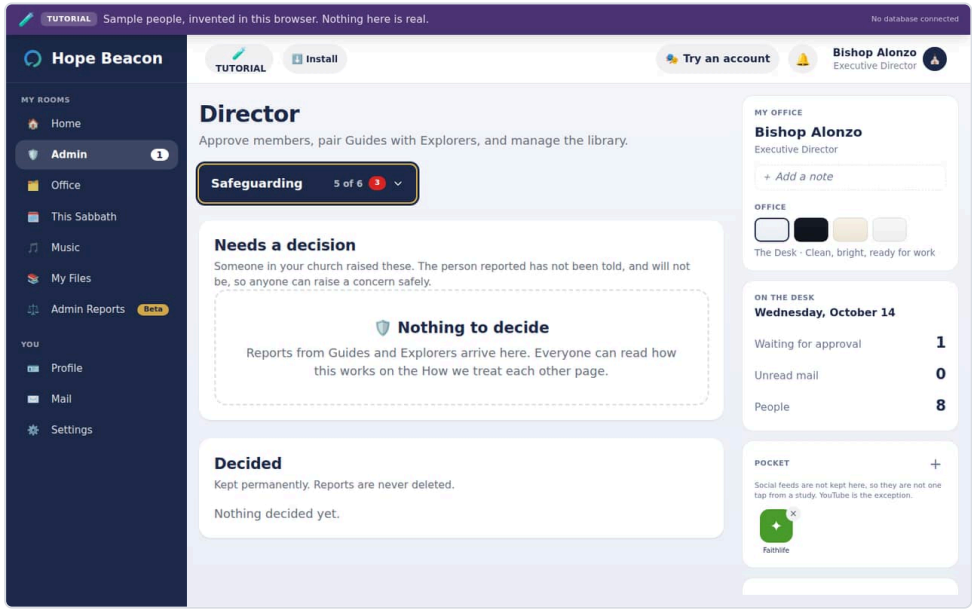
On a computer

Admin › Safeguarding

Reports somebody has made about a message or a person. The one place a leader may read a private conversation, and only the part reported.



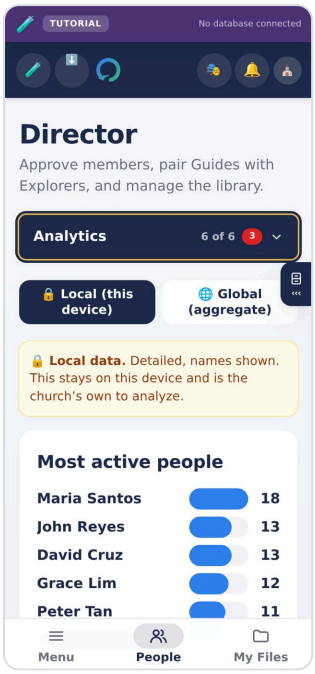
On a phone



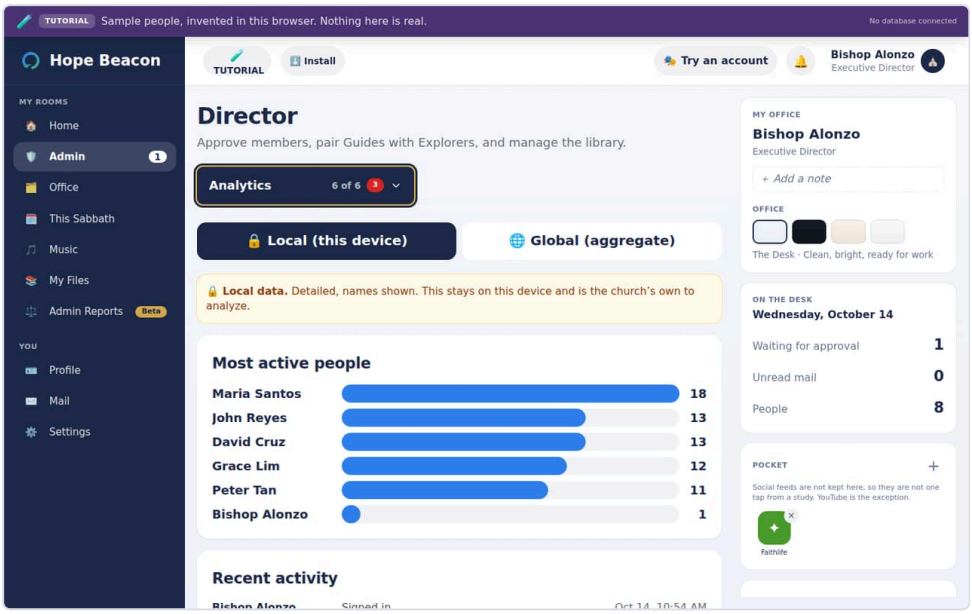
On a computer

Admin › Analytics

The church's numbers over time: growth, stages and how the Guides are carrying their people.



On a phone



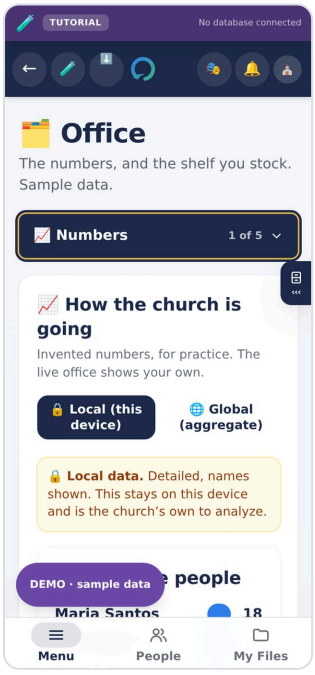
On a computer

Office

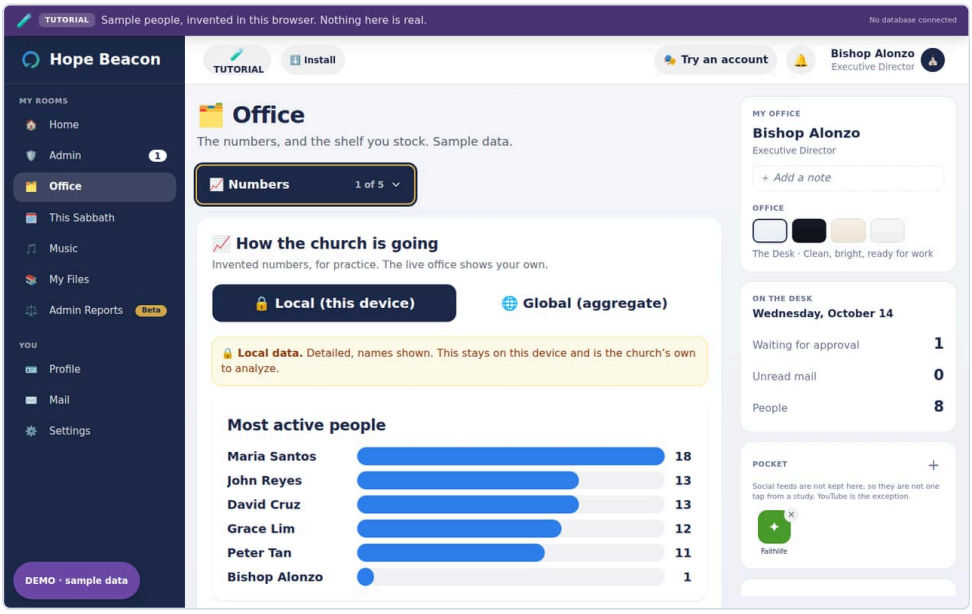
Work rather than conversation: the numbers, lesson studies, the Sabbath program, evangelistic meetings and reports. Explorers have no Office, because none of it is theirs to do.

Office › Numbers

How the church, or this Guide's part of it, is going. The sample's numbers are invented for practice; a church's own Office shows its own.



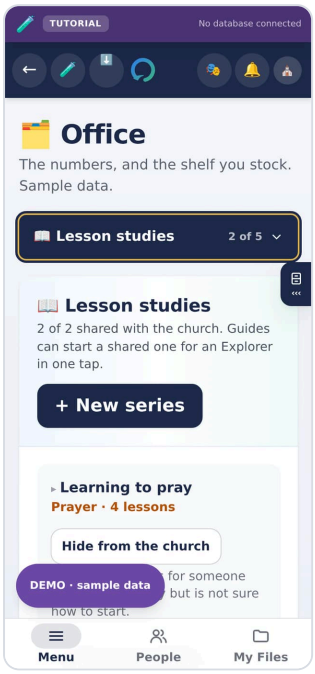
On a phone



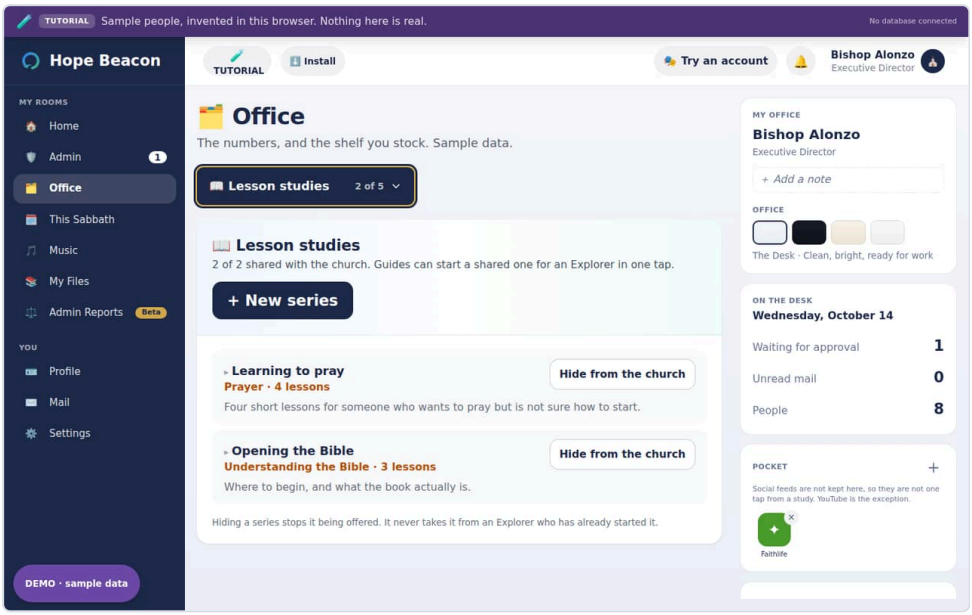
On a computer

Office › Lesson studies

Writing a lesson study once and sending it to the people who need it, with files and drawings attached. Simple by default, with an Advanced mode.



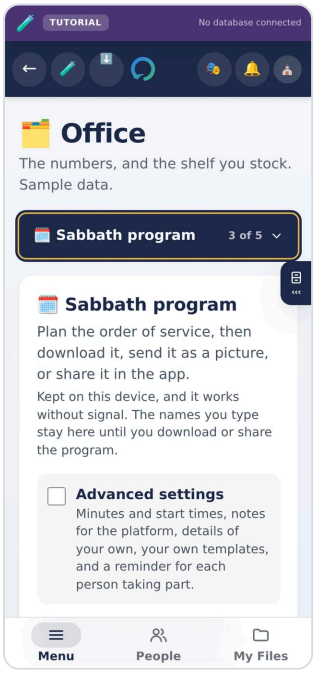
On a phone



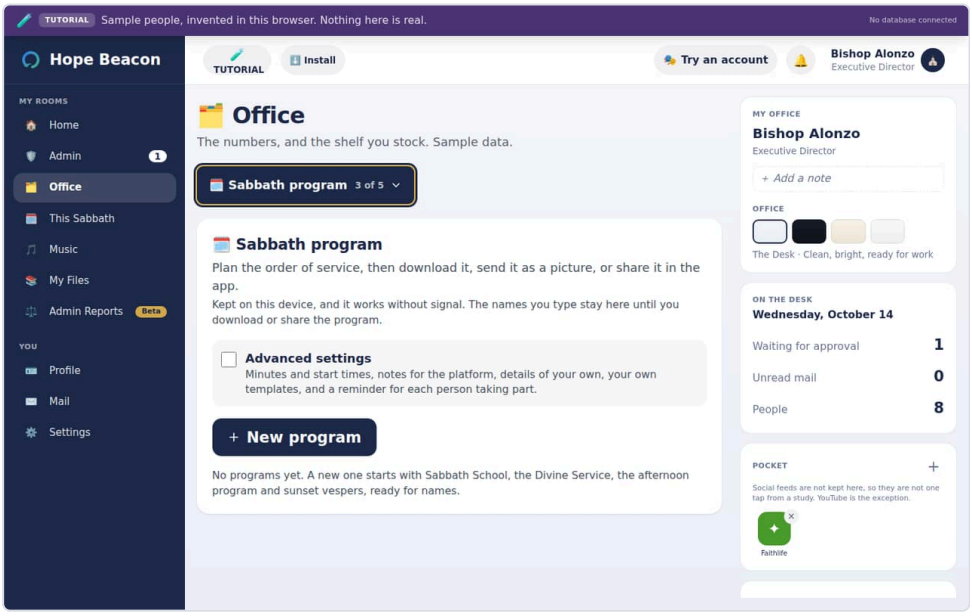
On a computer

Office › Sabbath program

Planning a Sabbath's order of service, then downloading it as a Word file or a picture, copying it as text, or posting it for This Sabbath.



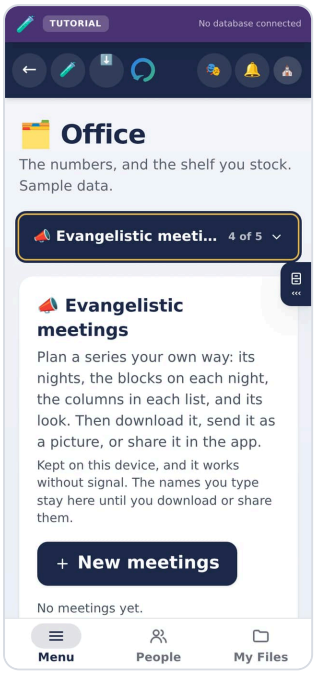
On a phone



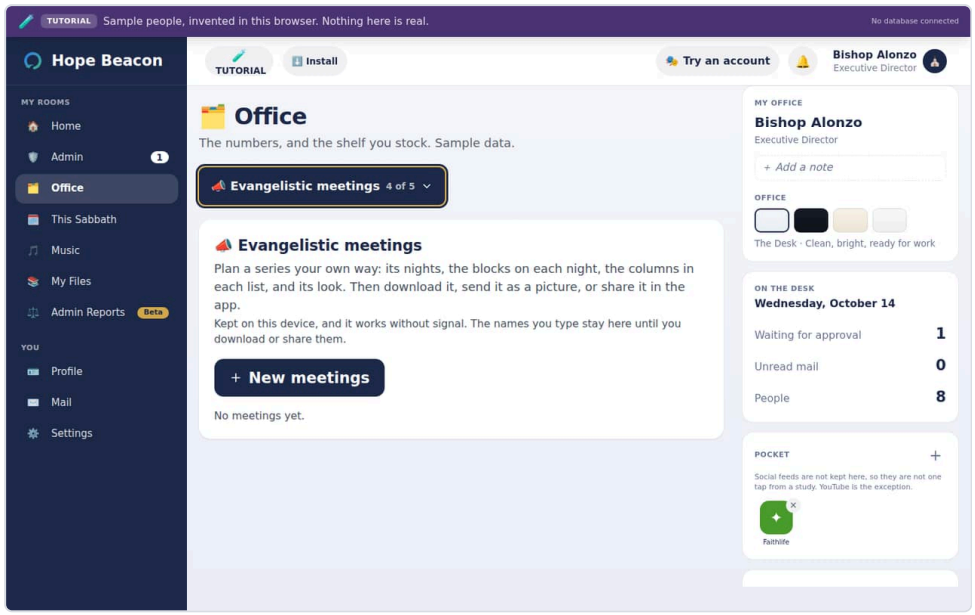
On a computer

Office › Evangelistic meetings

Planning a series of meetings night by night: programs, teams, schedules and checklists, with a look of its own for the Word file and the picture.



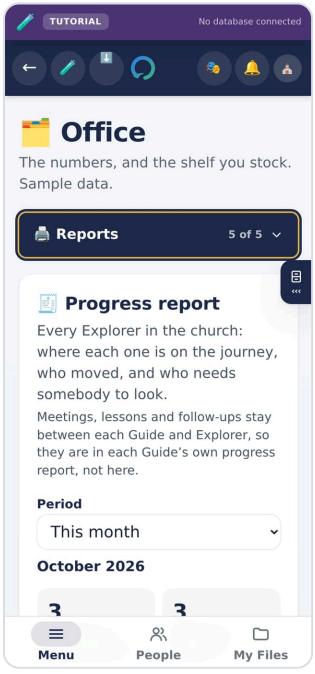
On a phone



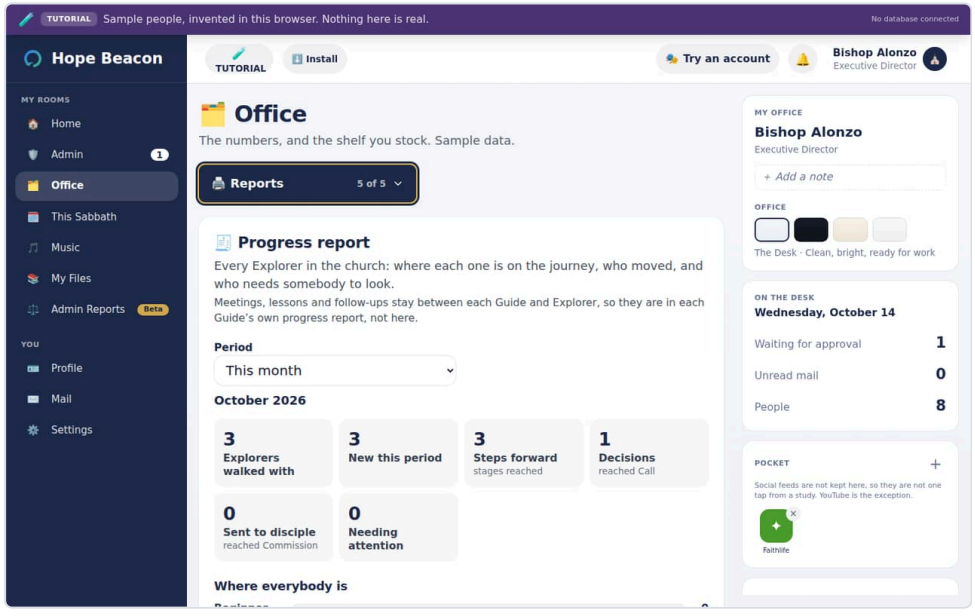
On a computer

Office › Reports

The progress report: how the Explorers are doing this month or quarter, who needs somebody, and a Word file to hand in.



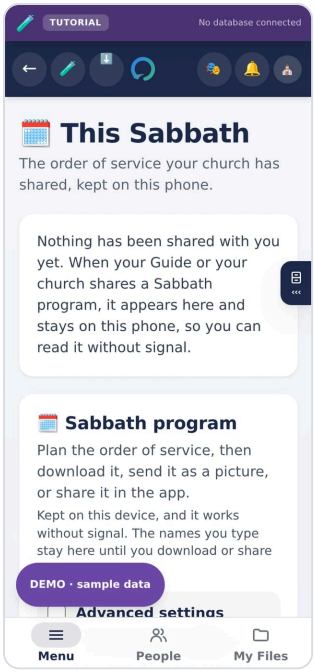
On a phone



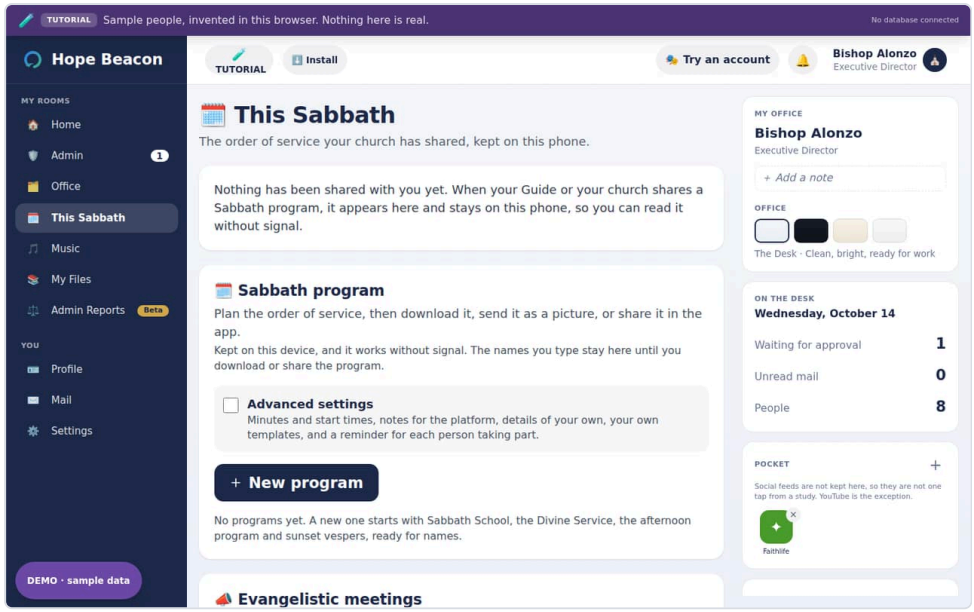
On a computer

This Sabbath

The Sabbath program and any evangelistic meetings a Guide or the church has posted. Once it has been opened with a signal, it opens again with none.



On a phone



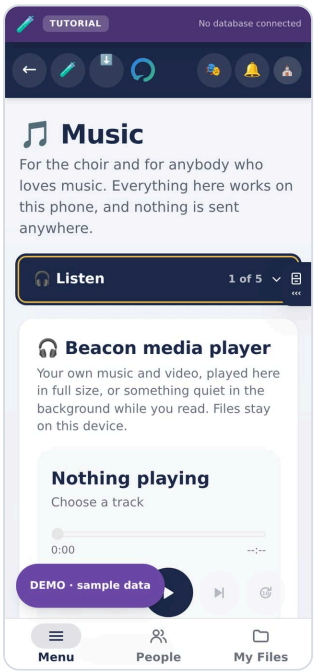
On a computer

Music

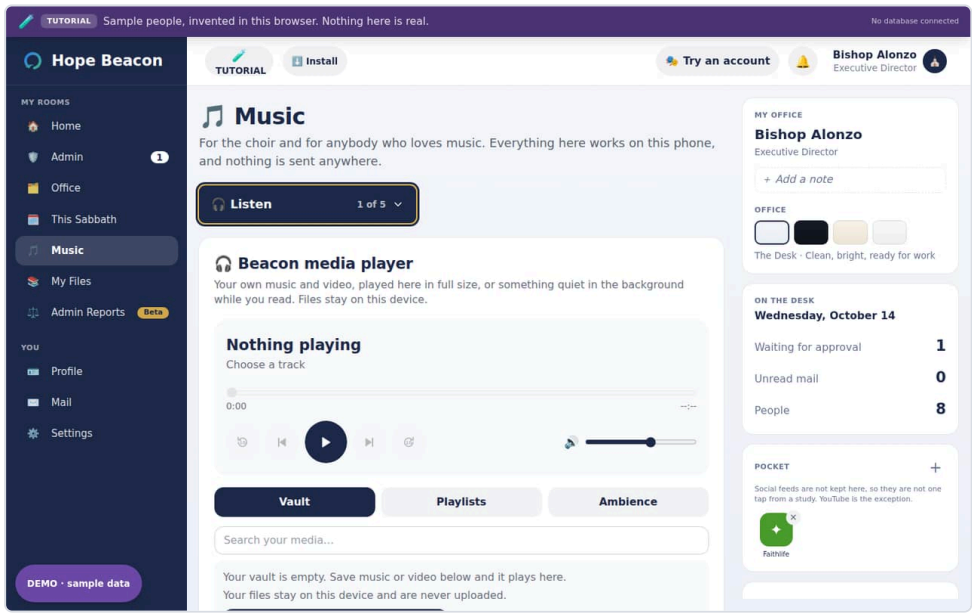
For the choir and anybody who loves music. Everything in it happens on the phone or computer itself; nothing is sent anywhere.

Music › Listen

The player: your own music and video, playlists, and calming sounds for the background.



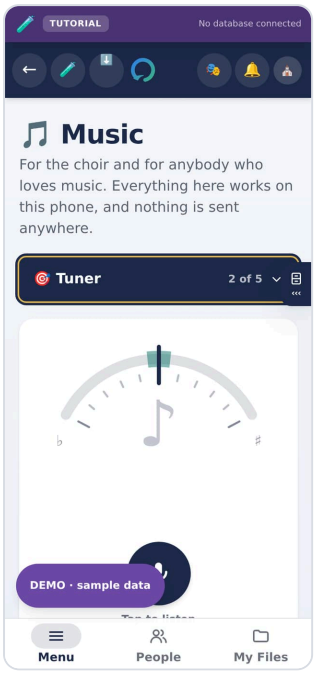
On a phone



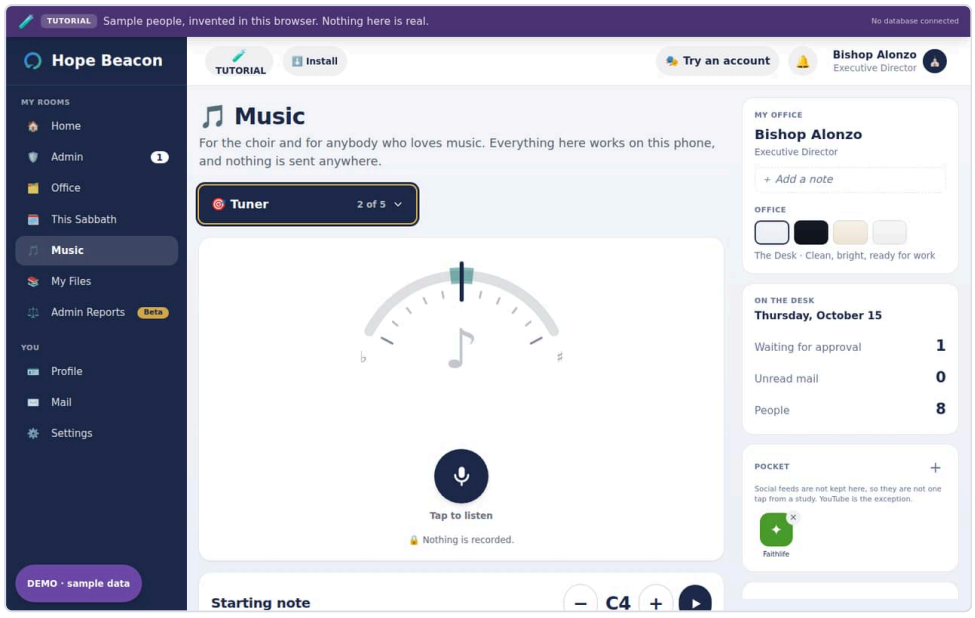
On a computer

Music › Tuner

Which note you are singing or playing, and whether it is flat or sharp. The microphone is used only while it listens, and nothing is recorded.



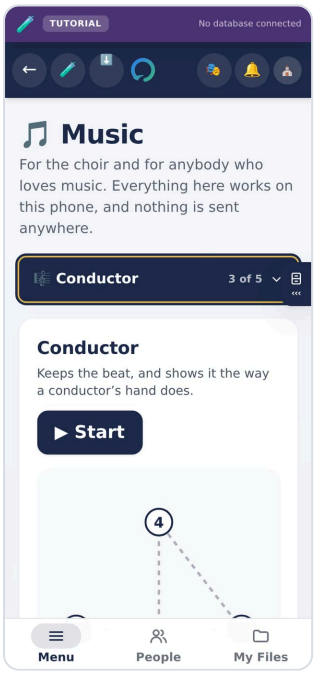
On a phone



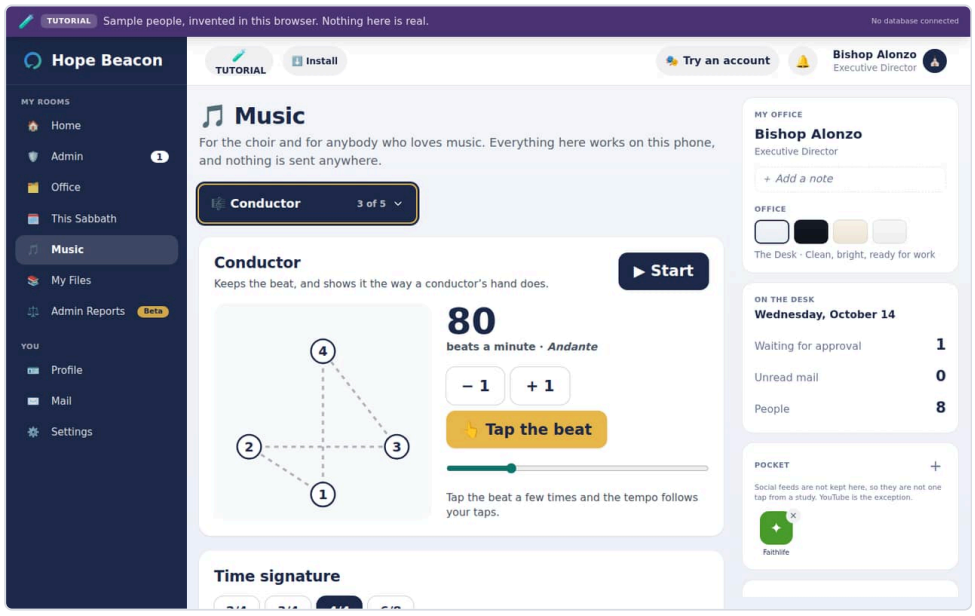
On a computer

Music › Conductor

A steady beat, and the conductor’s hand drawn for 2, 3, 4 or 6 beats. Tap the beat to set the tempo.



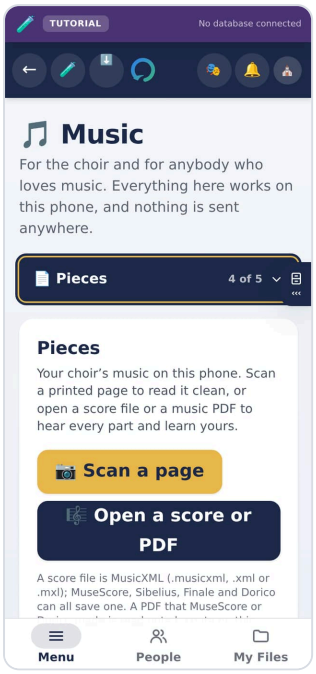
On a phone



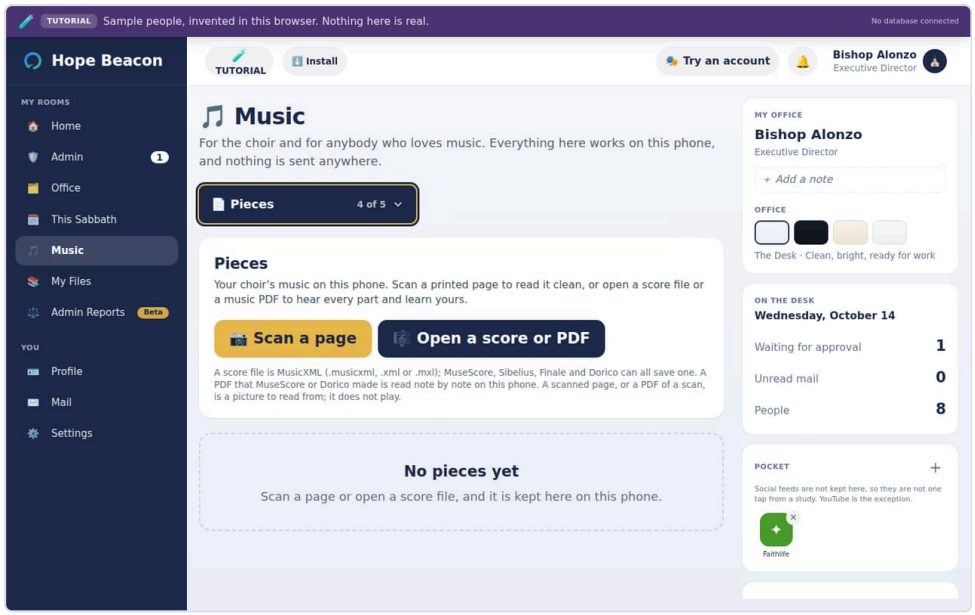
On a computer

Music › Pieces

The choir's music: a photographed page made clean and square, or a MusicXML score or a notation program's PDF that plays, with your own part louder. About this piece explains it from its own markings.



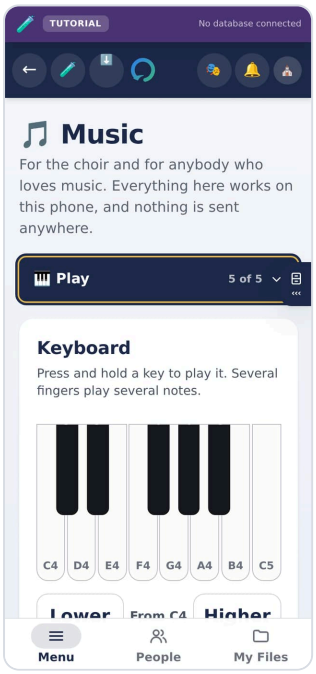
On a phone



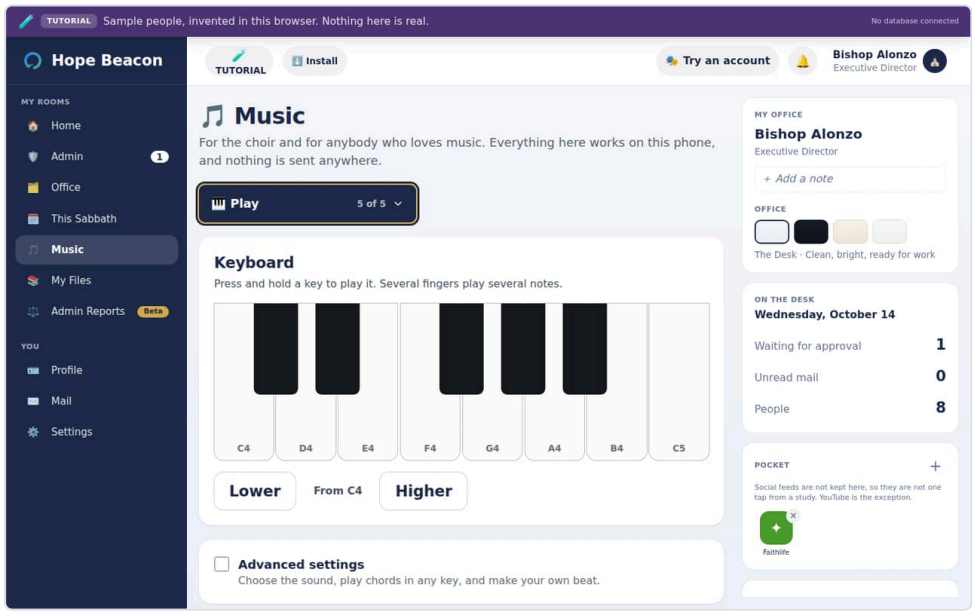
On a computer

Music › Play

A piano keyboard held by each finger at the choir's concert pitch; in Advanced, the chords of any key and a beat maker.



On a phone



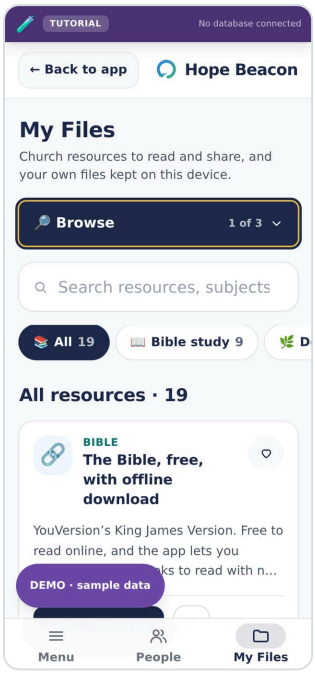
On a computer

My Files

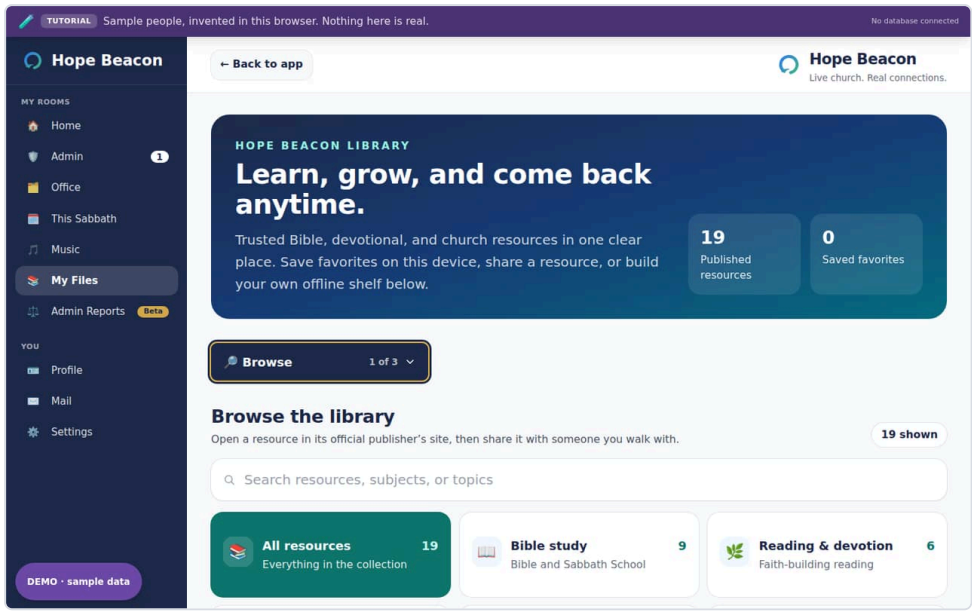
A person's own music, video and documents, saved on their own device. Nothing in it is shared and nothing comes from anybody else.

My Files › Browse

Everything on this person’s shelf, with a search box.



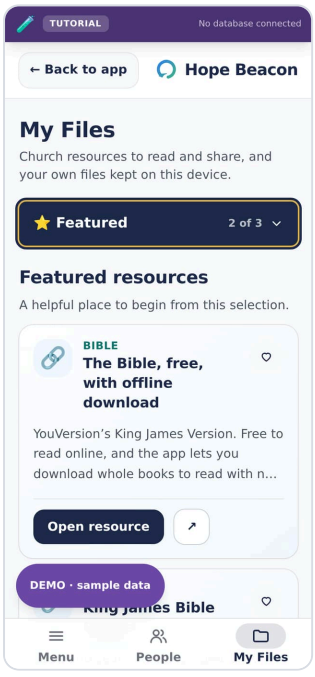
On a phone



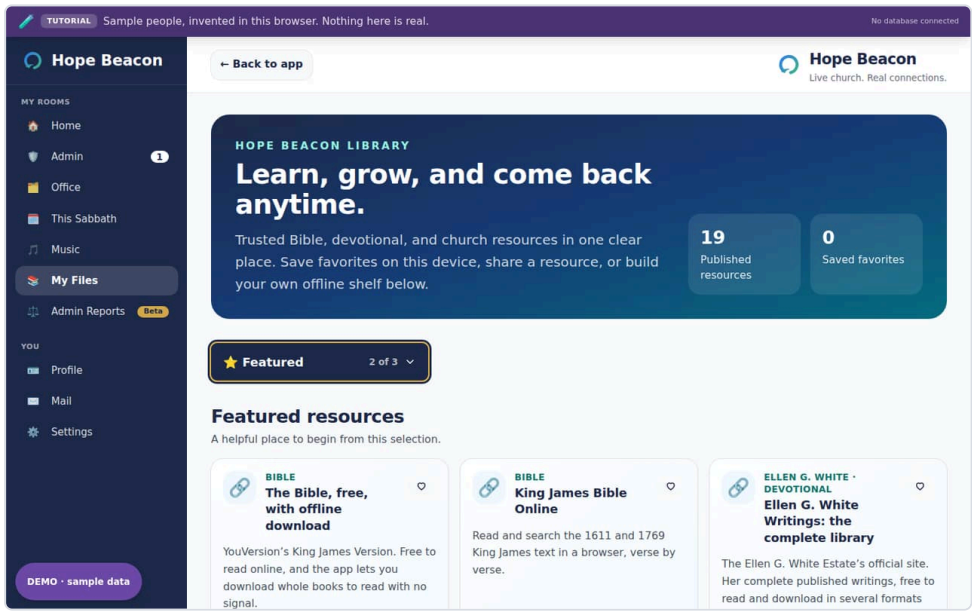
On a computer

My Files › Featured

What the church has put first.



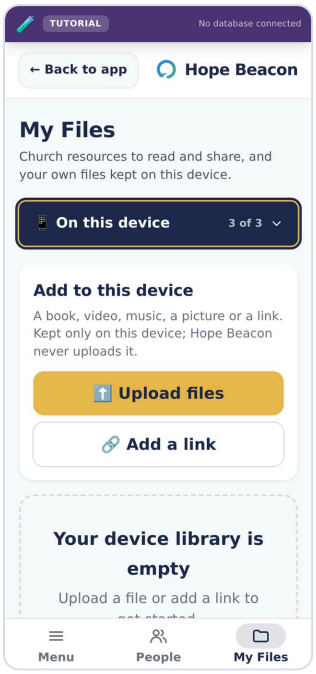
On a phone



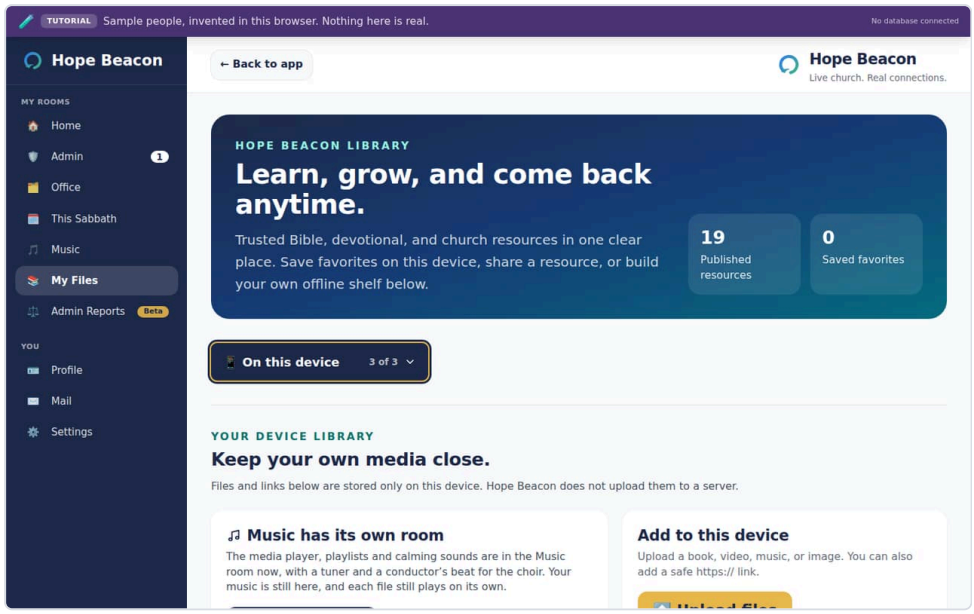
On a computer

My Files › On this device

Files saved on this phone or computer, for reading and listening with no signal. They never leave the device.



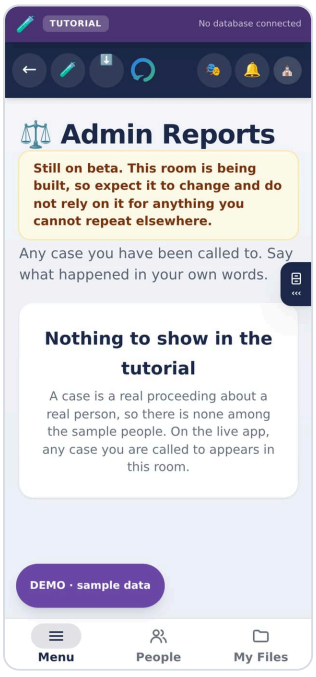
On a phone



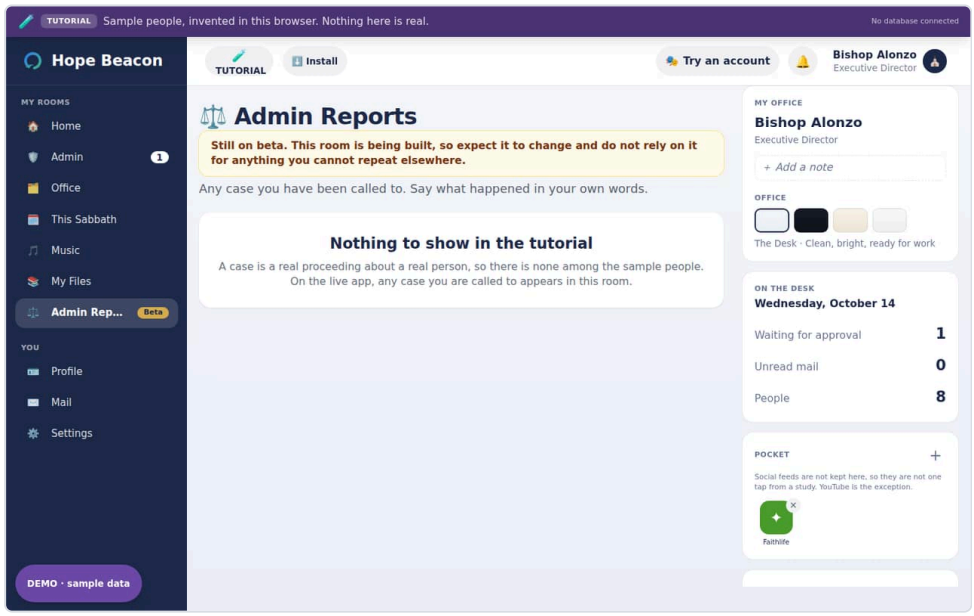
On a computer

Admin Reports

Reports, trials and the record: the part of the app nobody wants to need. It is always in a leader's Menu, and says plainly when nothing is open.



On a phone



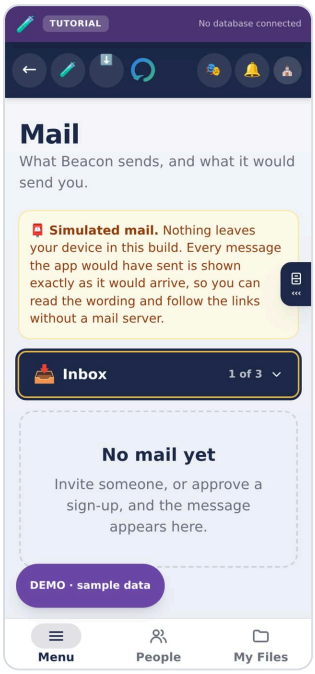
On a computer

Mail

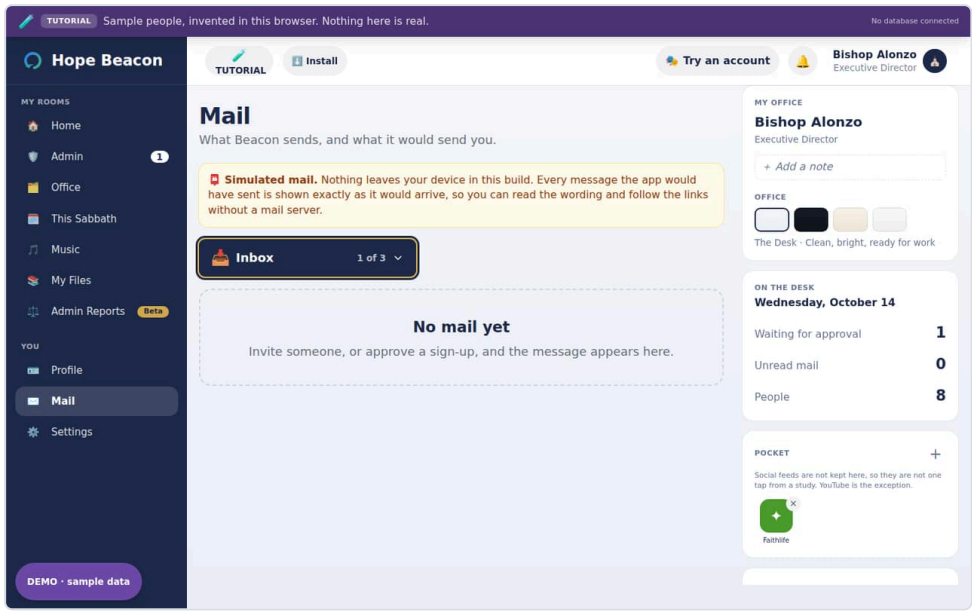
In the sample church, a mailbox showing what the app sends, without sending real email. In a church's own app, Mail is for Directors and Executive Directors, and lists the invitations still open, to resend or cancel.

Mail › Inbox

What the app has sent this person.



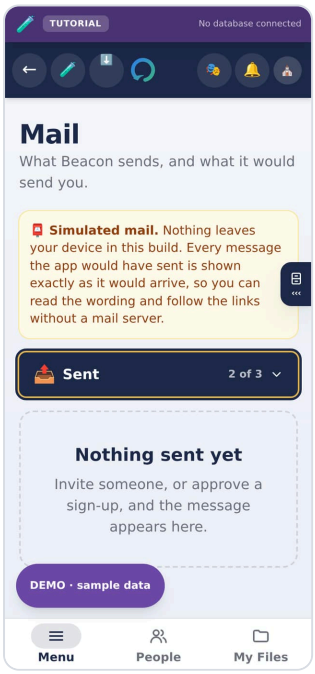
On a phone



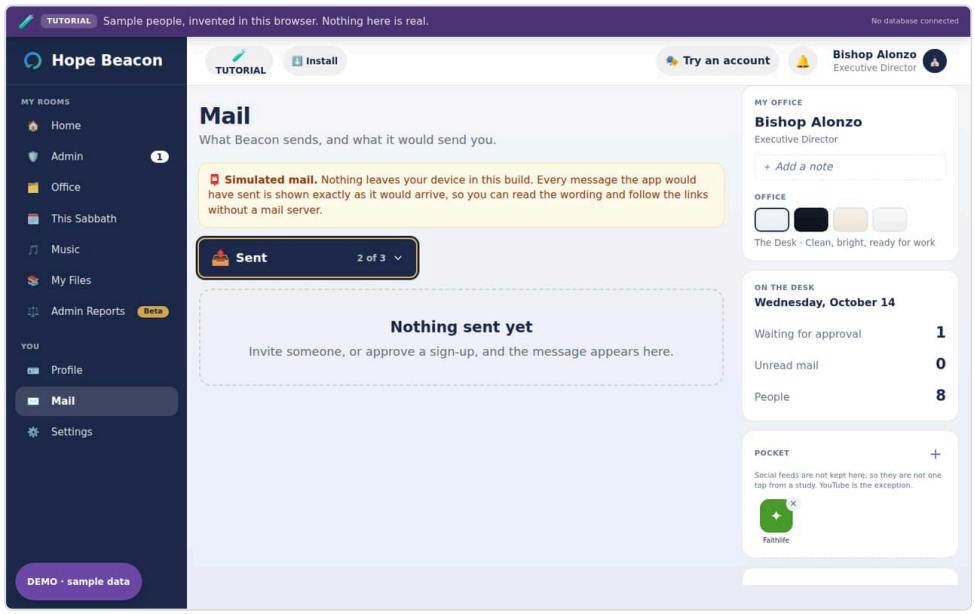
On a computer

Mail › Sent

What this person has sent through the app, such as recommending somebody.



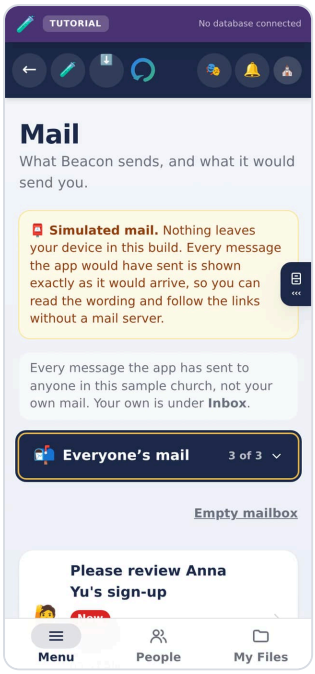
On a phone



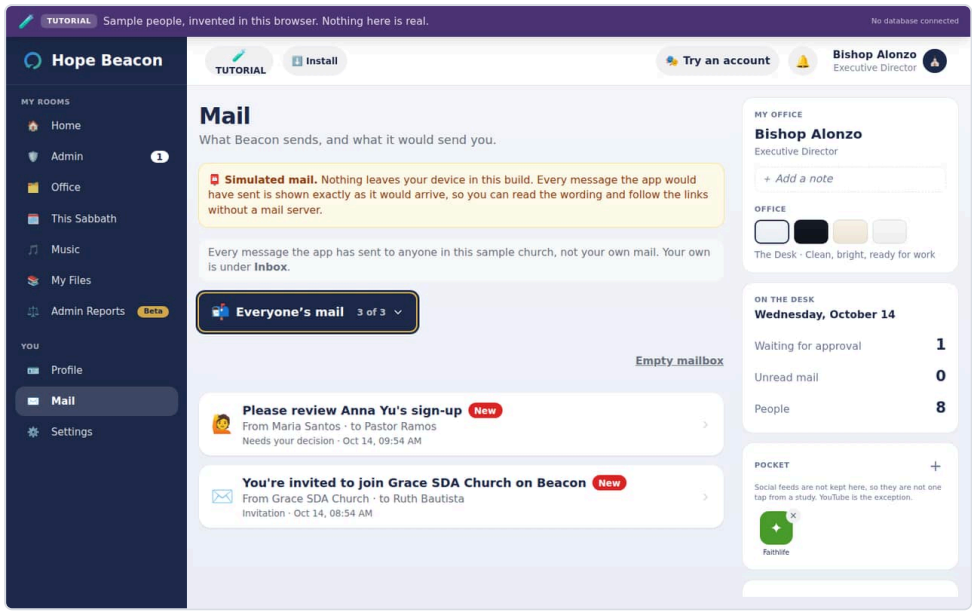
On a computer

Mail › Everyone’s mail

For leaders in the sample church: every message the app has sent, to anybody.



On a phone



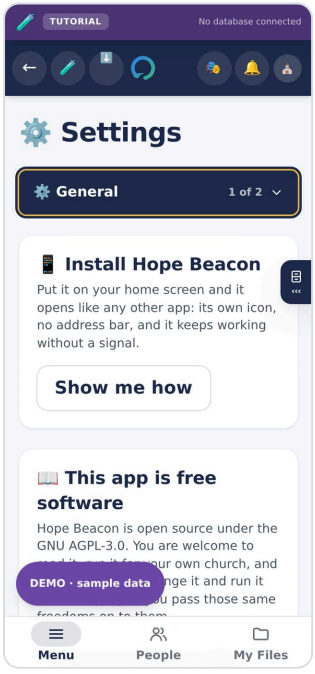
On a computer

Settings

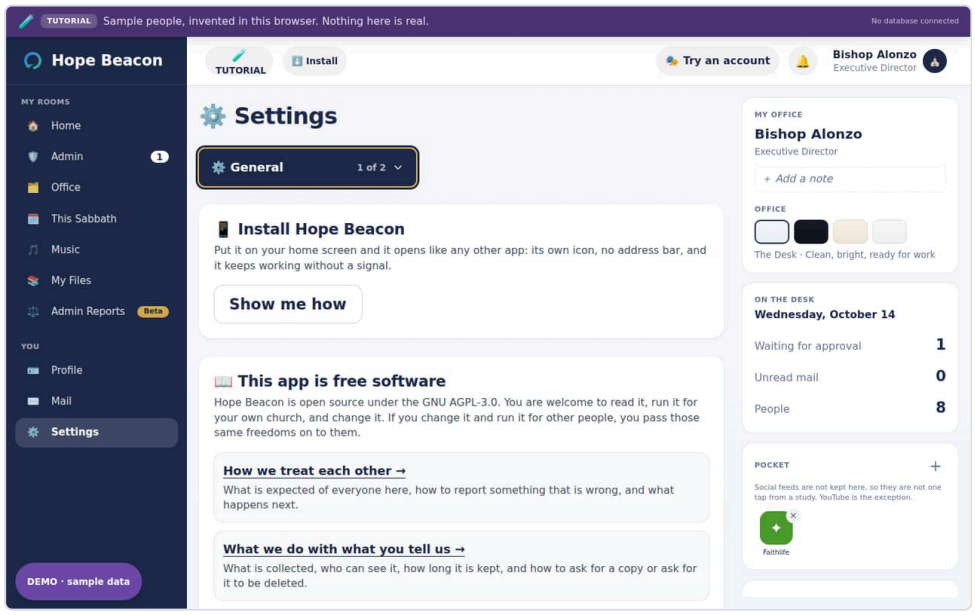
Everything about this device and this account: text size, the look, installing, alerts, language, the guided walk, what is new, and help. A church’s own app adds a Password folder and an Admin Reports folder.

Settings › General

Installing, alerts, text size, the look, and language.



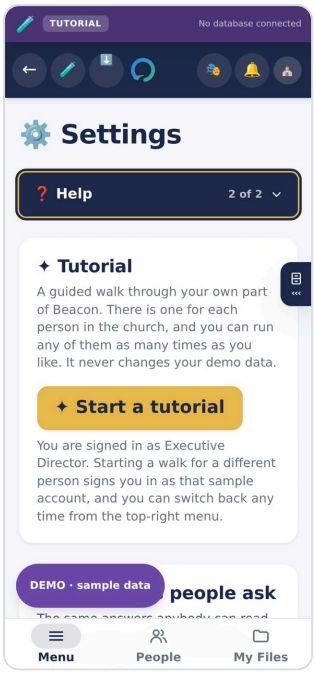
On a phone



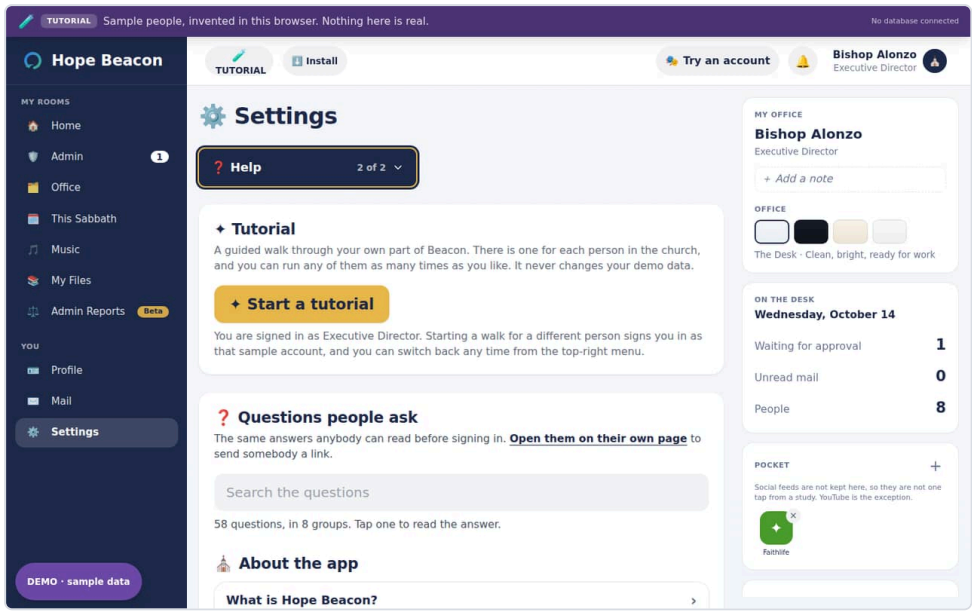
On a computer

Settings › Help

The guided walk, what is new, feedback, and where to find help.



On a phone



On a computer

CHAPTER 25

On a tablet, and before signing in

The same rooms on a tablet held upright, which uses the phone’s layout with more room, and the two screens anybody can open.

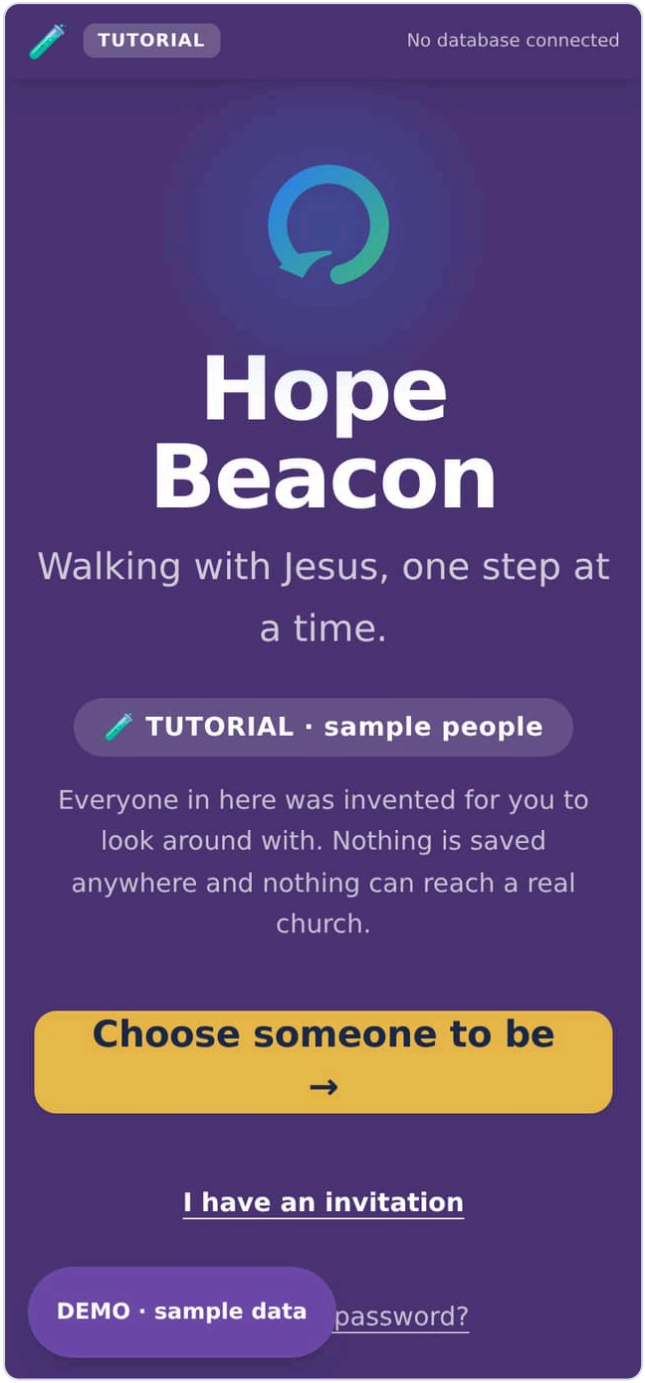
IN THIS CHAPTER

Before signing in 244

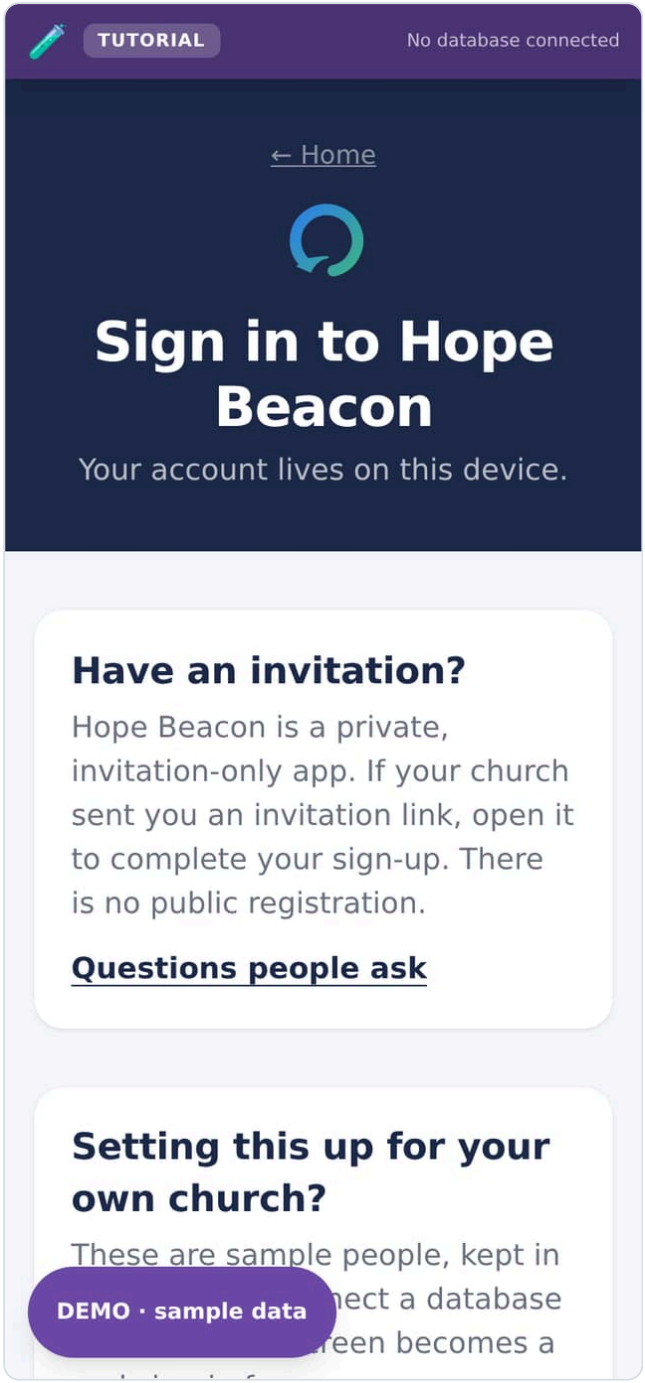
A Explorer on a tablet 245

A Guide on a tablet 250

Before signing in

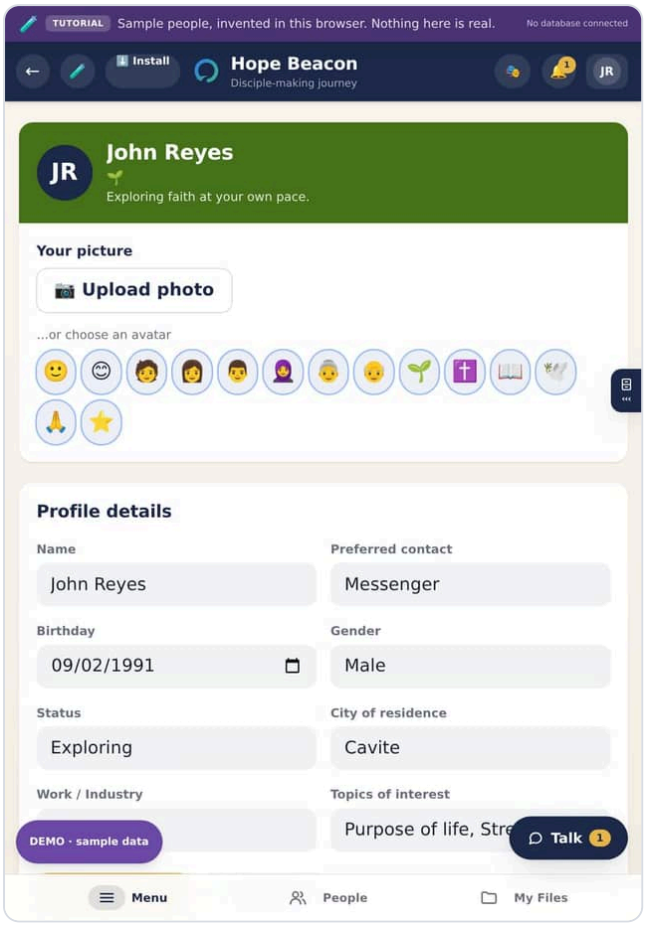


The front door, before signing in

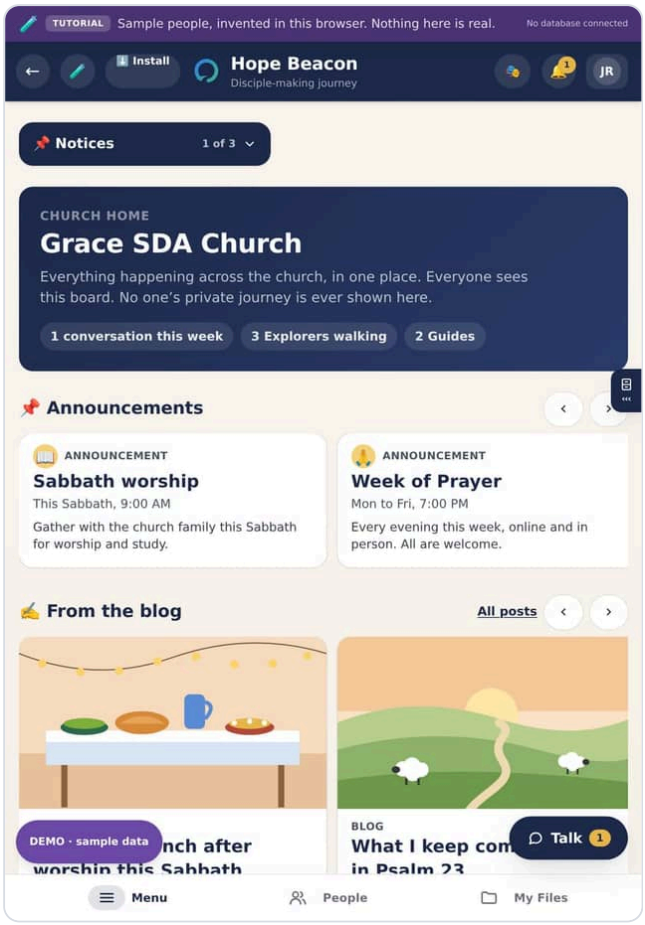


Signing in to the sample church: choose who to be

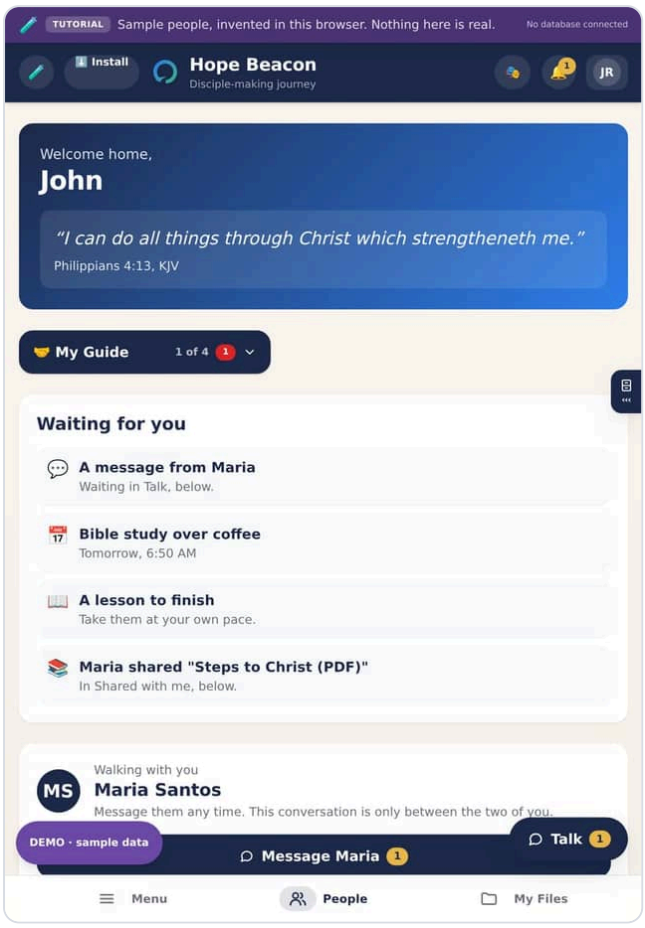
A Explorer on a tablet



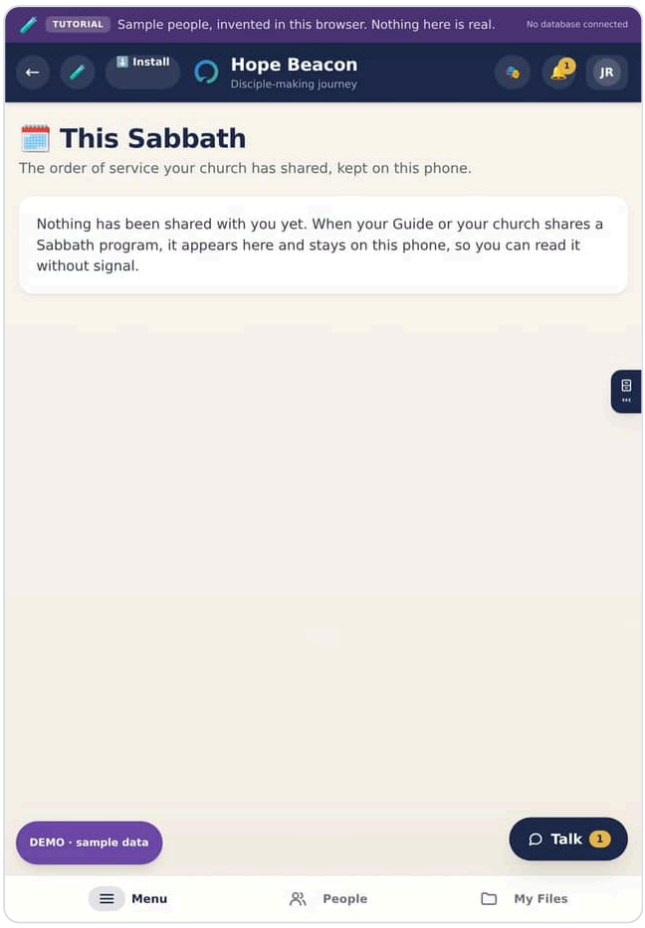
Explorer · Profile



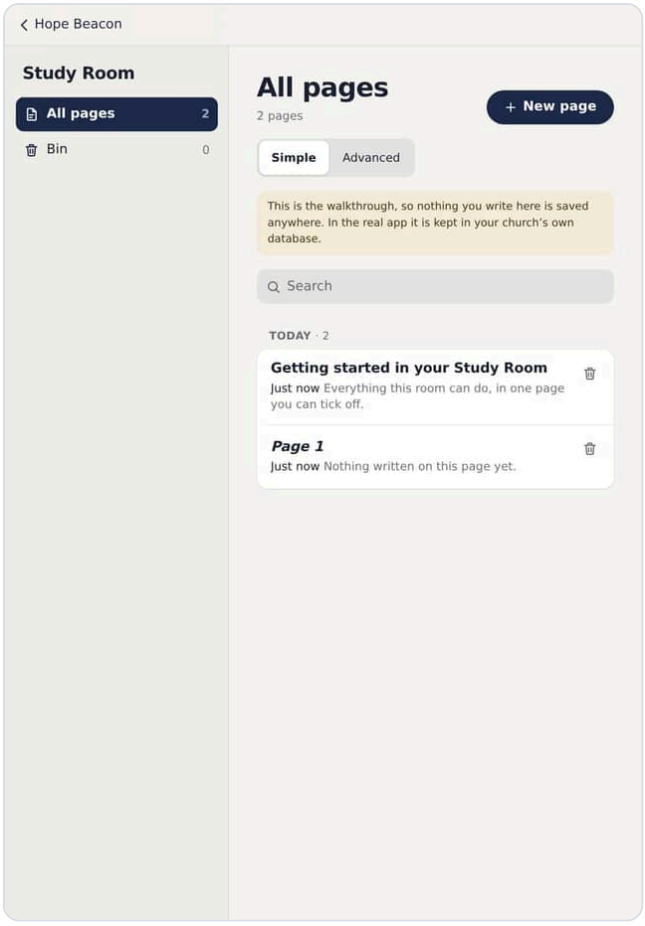
Explorer · Home



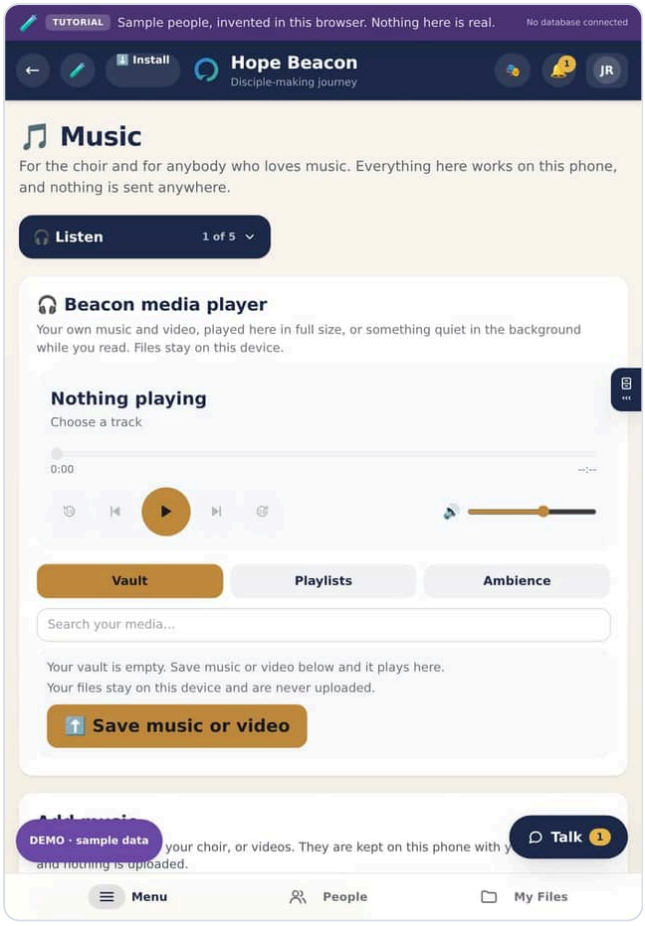
Explorer · My Journey



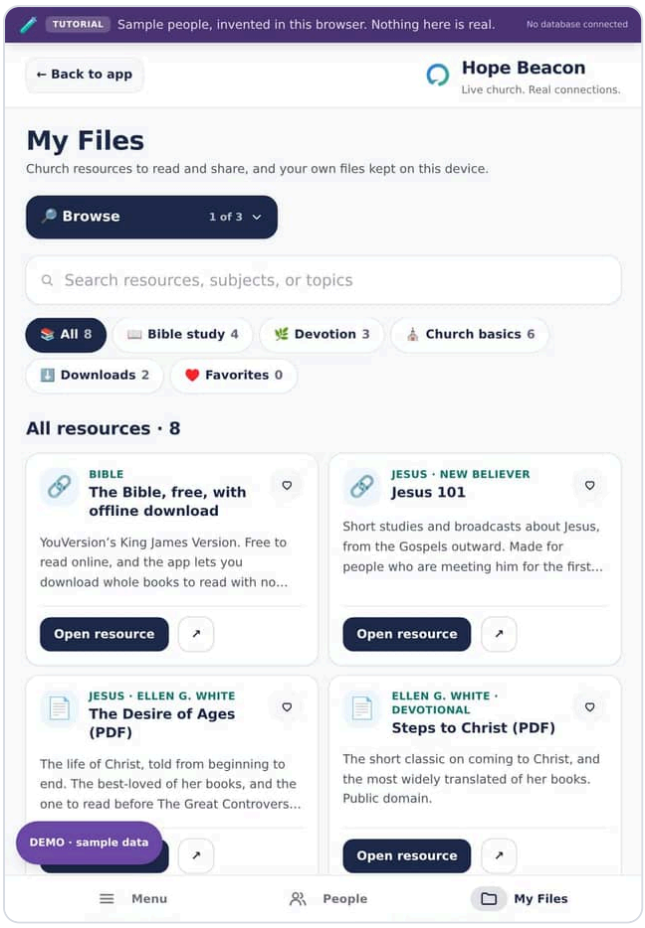
Explorer · This Sabbath



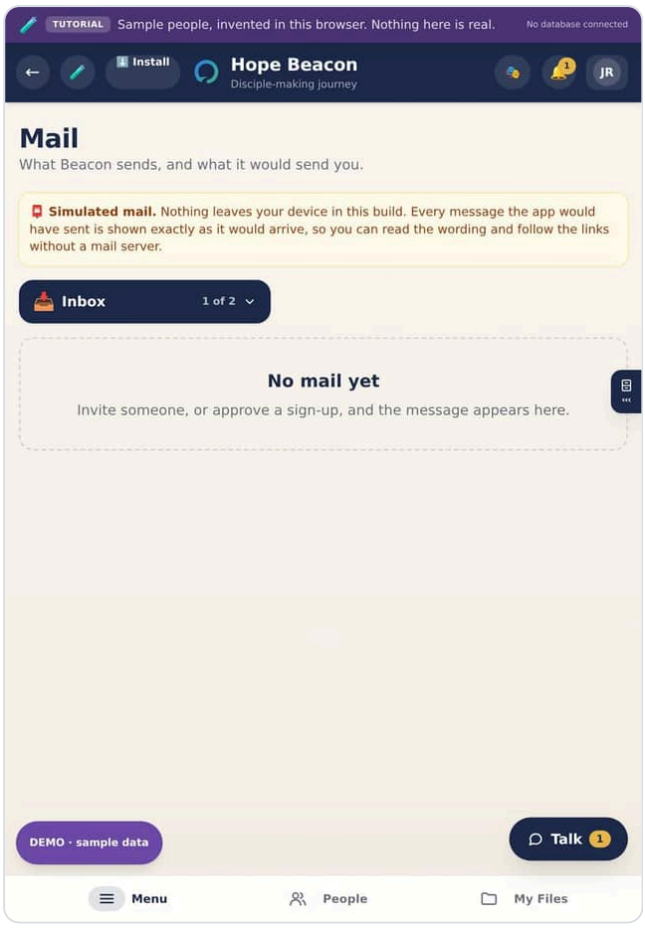
Explorer · Study Room



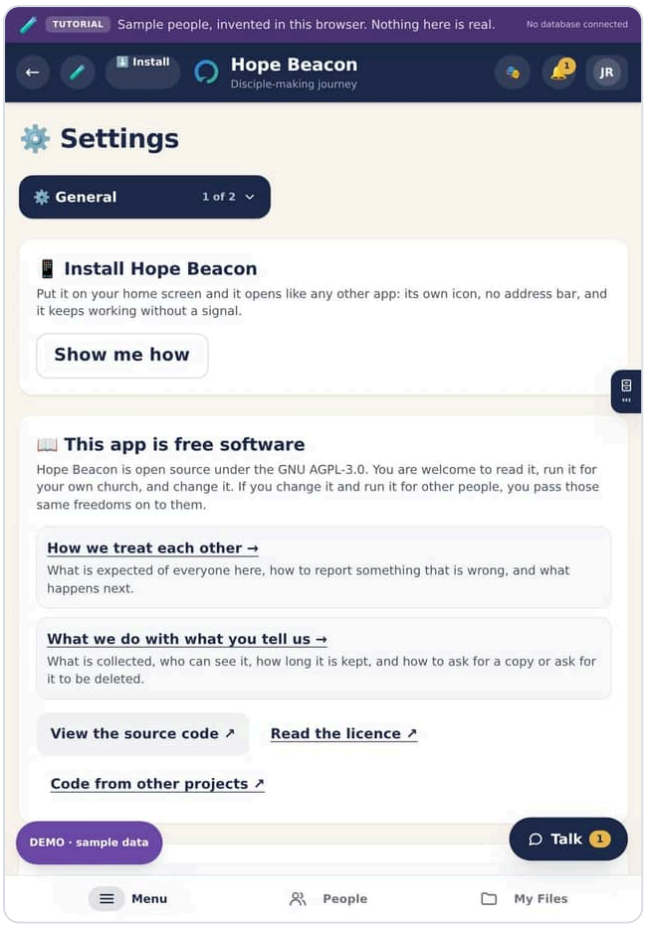
Explorer · Music



Explorer · My Files

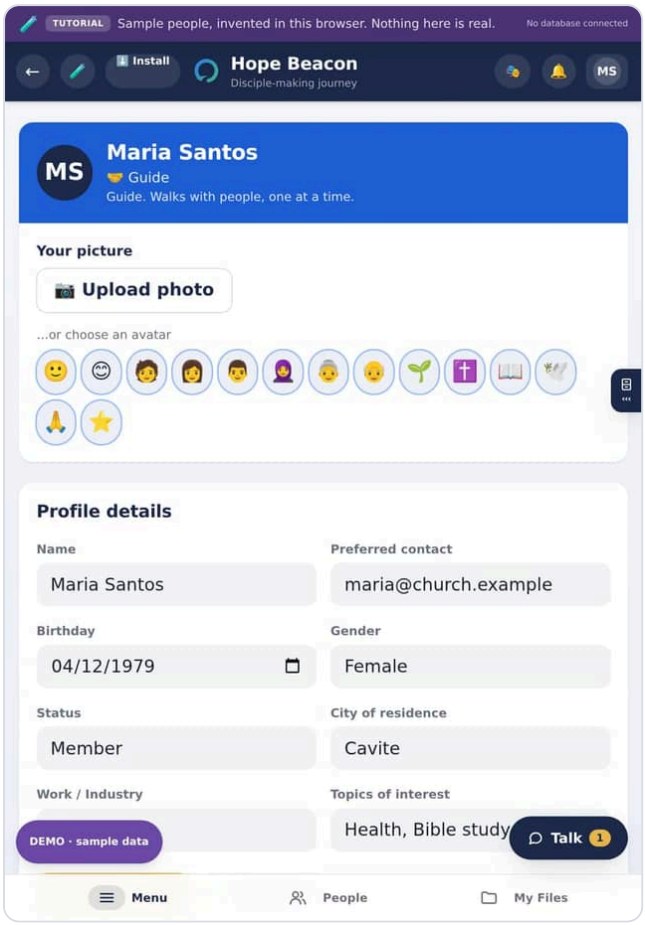


Explorer · Mail

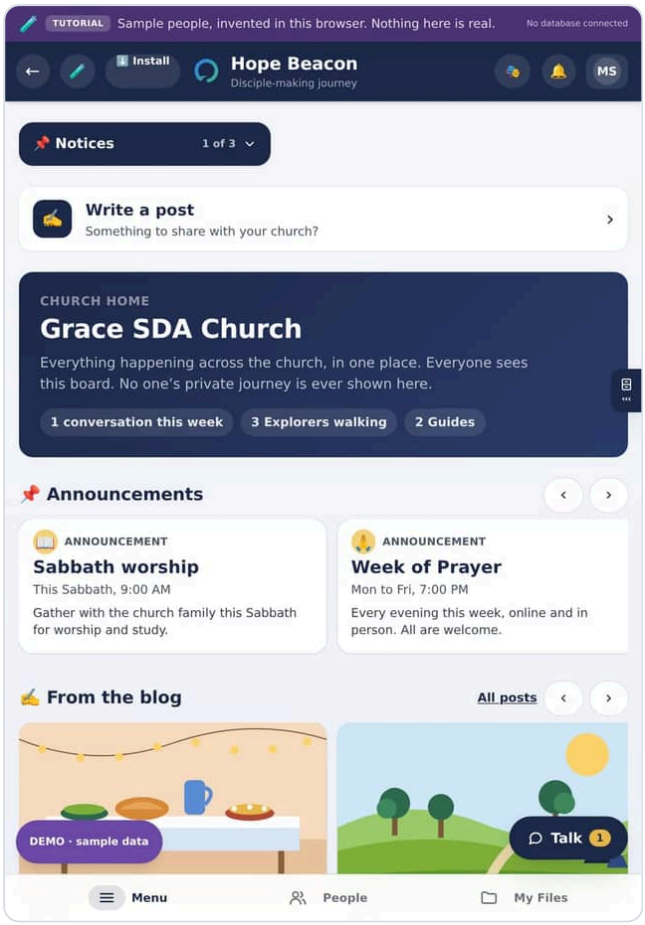


Explorer · Settings

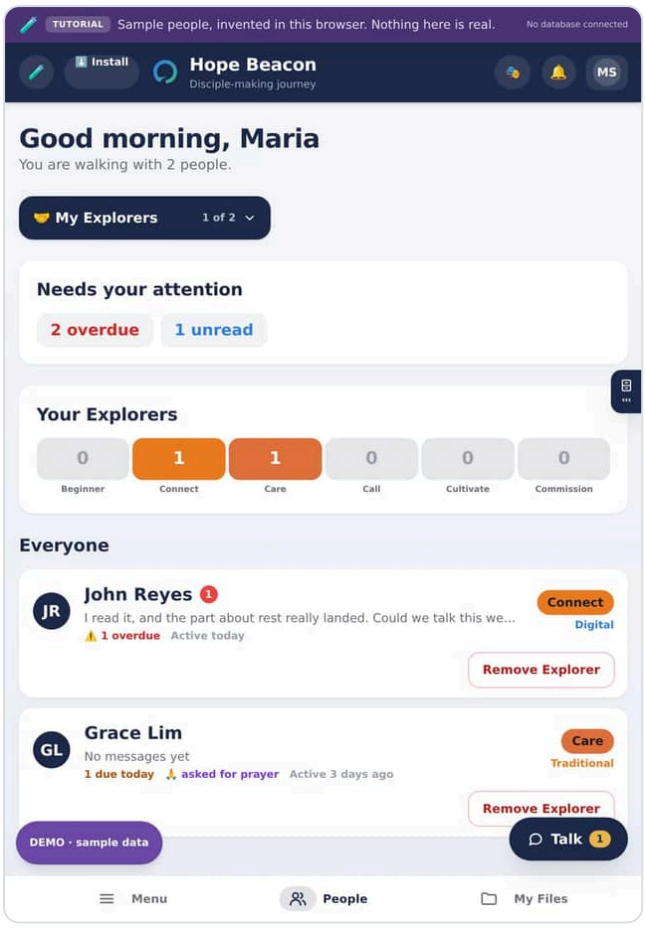
A Guide on a tablet



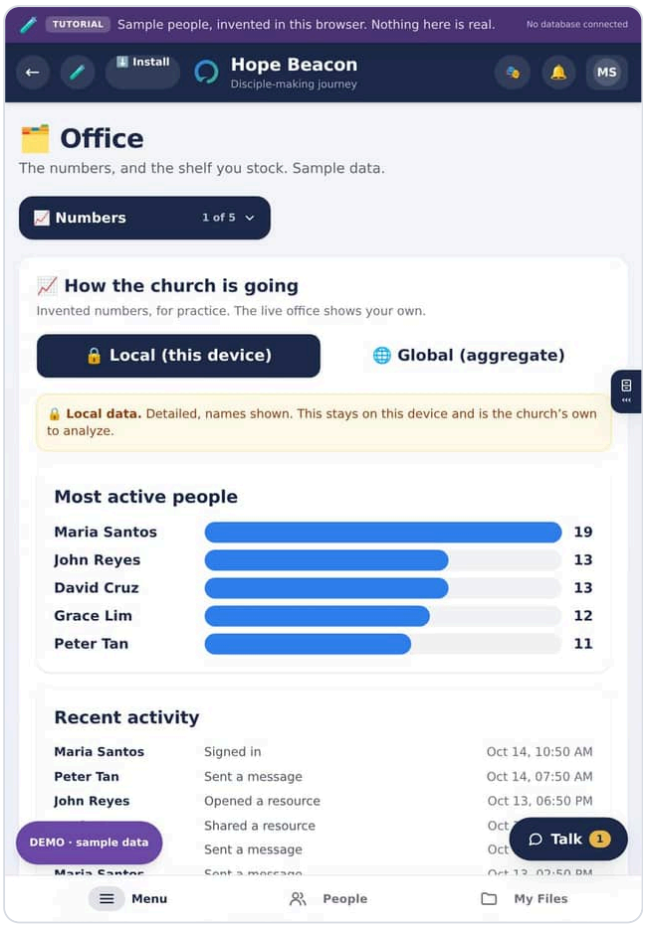
Guide · Profile



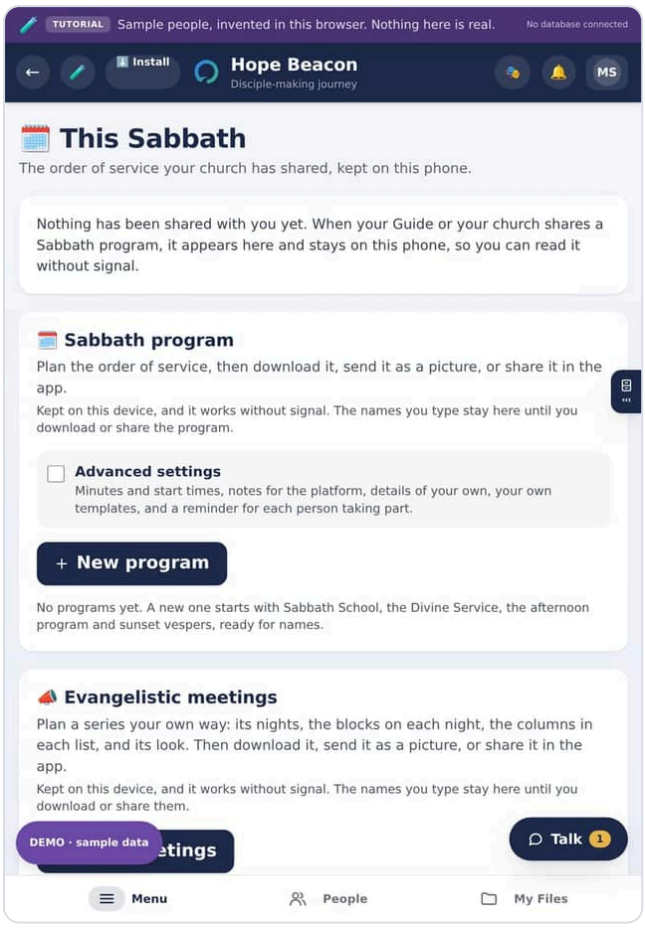
Guide · Home



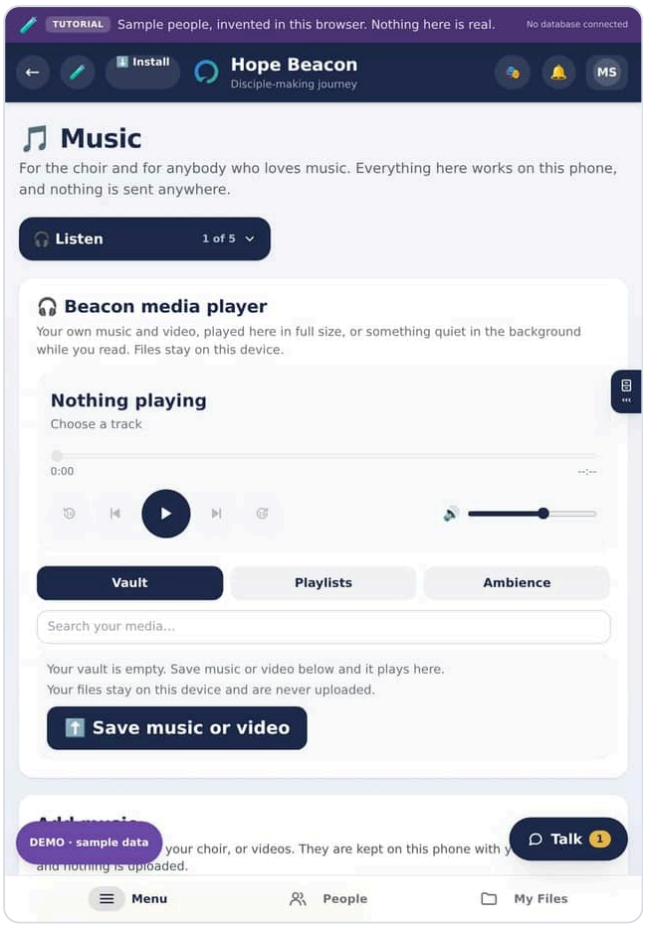
Guide · My Explorers



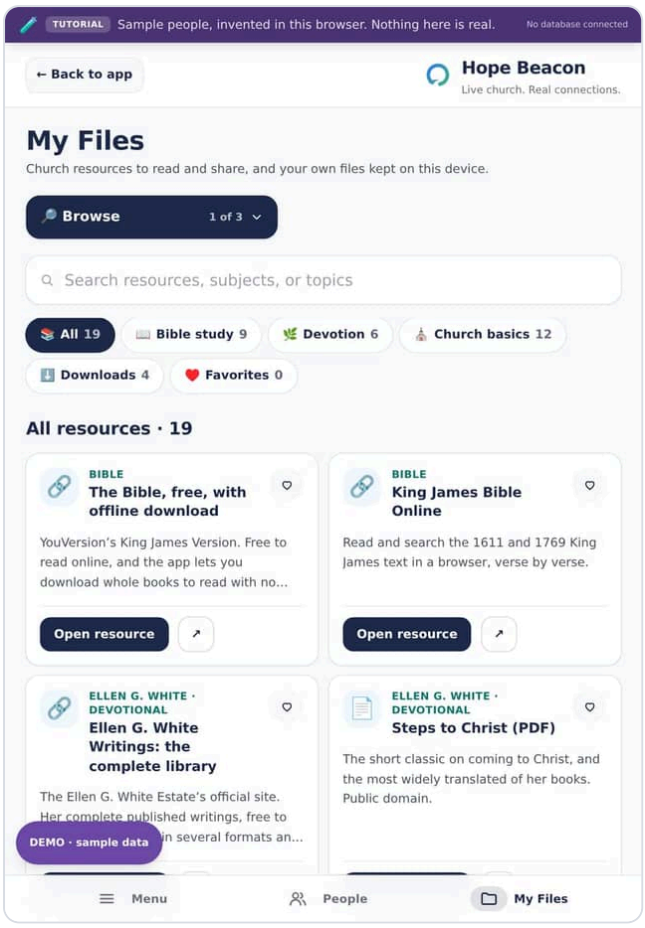
Guide · Office



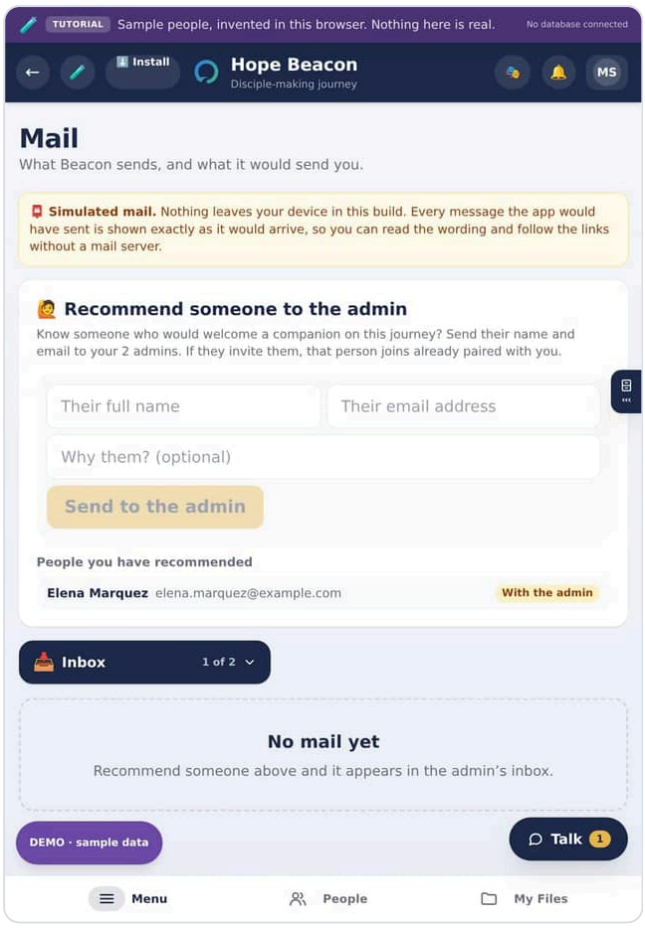
Guide · This Sabbath



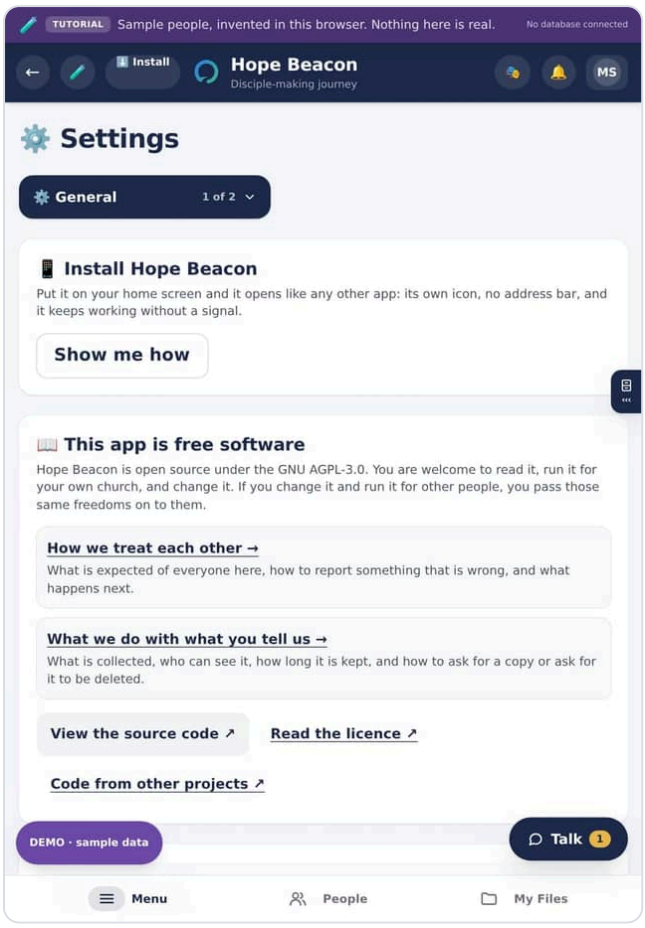
Guide · Music



Guide · My Files



Guide · Mail



Guide · Settings

PART VI

Help and reference

When something looks wrong, the questions people ask, what the app keeps about you, what it costs, and the words it uses.

26 If something looks wrong 256

27 When something breaks 257

28 Questions people ask 262

29 Your information, and how it is protected 267

30 What it costs 271

31 Showing it to a church 272

32 Live presentation runbook 285

33 Glossary 287

34 What changed, release by release 290

35 What is not finished yet 305

CHAPTER 26

If something looks wrong

From `docs/HOW-TO-USE.md`

- **A blank screen, or something out of place after an update.** Close the app fully and open it again. It checks for a new version each time it starts.
- **You cannot find a button somebody told you about.** Check which folder you are in. Tap the button at the top of the screen; what you want may be in another folder.
- **The app says your invitation is not valid.** Invitations expire. Ask your church for a new one.
- **You changed your profile picture and the old one is still showing.** Close and reopen the app once.

Anything else, use **Send feedback** at the bottom of the front door. It takes a sentence.

CHAPTER 27

When something breaks

From `docs/HANDBOOK.md`

What you see	What it usually is	What to do
"This invitation link has expired or has already been used"	A newer invitation was sent to the same address, which switches off the older one. Or somebody already opened it.	Ask them to use the newest email. If unsure, press Re-send and tell them to use only what arrives after that.
"Wrong e-mail or password" with the password from the invitation	The password in an invitation works for three days after it was sent (seven from 29 September 2026, three since 3 October 2026). It is three words and a number joined by dashes, such as `harbor-acorn-river-48`: typed without the dashes, it will not work. After that it is replaced with one nobody knows, on purpose, so an old e-mail cannot be used to get in.	They tap **Send me a link to set my password** on the sign-in page and choose their own. If they never signed in at all, you can also press Re-send.
The invitation email arrives empty	A template using a field the mail system cannot resolve. It abandons the whole message and sends a blank one, and nothing anywhere reports an error.	In a Supabase template, keep to `{{ .SiteURL }}` and `{{ .TokenHash }}`. Never `{{ .ConfirmationURL }}`: it points at Supabase's verify endpoint, which spends the token on any GET, so a mail scanner burns the link before the reader taps it.
No invitation arrives at all, and Brevo's log is empty	The key was refused before a send was recorded. Almost always the IP restriction, occasionally a key of the wrong type.	Check the IP setting on *both* API and SMTP keys. Then confirm the key was made under *SMTP & API → API keys*.
"one message per address per minute"	Working as intended. A second message to one address inside a minute is held back.	Wait the number of seconds shown, then press Send once.
Two invitations arrive and the second looks blank	Gmail collapses a later message that resembles an earlier one in the same thread behind "Show quoted text".	Expand the quoted text. The three roles now have three different subject lines, which prevents most of this.
"already has a Hope Beacon account"	That address finished a sign-up before, possibly at another church.	If they are in your church, change their role from the member list. If they have genuinely left, delete the account, which frees the address.
The install button does nothing on an iPhone	Not Safari. Chrome, Firefox, Edge and in-app browsers cannot install on iOS.	Tap **Open this page in Safari** on the card, then Share, then Add to Home Screen. If that button does nothing, the browser refused the handoff: use its ••• menu instead.

What you see	What it usually is	What to do
The icon opens Safari with an address bar	What was added is a bookmark from before the fix.	Delete the icon and add it again from Safari.
A Sabbath program has gone, or is not on another device	Programs are kept in the browser where they were made, under the account that made them. Another phone, another browser, another account, a private window or cleared site data each start with none.	Open the same browser on the same device, signed in as the same person. Keep the ones that matter by downloading them.
An Explorer cannot see a program their Guide posted	It went to the people that Guide walks with, and this Explorer walks with somebody else; or it is still a draft in your blog (Home, Blog).	Post it again for **Everyone in the church**, or ask their own Guide to post one.
This Sabbath is empty with no signal	The phone keeps a program once it has opened This Sabbath with a signal after the program was posted.	Open This Sabbath once with a signal, the day before.
"This program is too long to post"	A post holds 20,000 characters. A whole day with long announcements can pass it.	Shorten the announcements, or share the Word file or the picture instead.
A note is missing from the Word file	The Word file was made **For the congregation**.	Under **Which copy**, choose **For the platform, with times and notes**, then download again.
A block is missing from a meeting's picture or post	It is marked **Team only**. The picture and posts are always what is shared.	Untick **Team only** on that block if it is for everyone, or use **Everything, for the team** for the Word file.
A meeting's headings print dark, not in the colour chosen	The colour is too pale to read as words on white, so it draws the lines only.	Choose a darker colour, or keep it for the lines.
"This copy can never update"	It was installed from a temporary preview address.	Open the real address, install from there, then delete the old icon.
A setting was changed and nothing happened	The two settings beginning `NEXT_PUBLIC_` are read when the site is built.	Redeploy. Saving alone changes nothing.
Everybody was signed out at once	The database project changed, the web address changed, or the project's signing secret was rotated. A code deploy does not do this.	See Part 7. If the address changed, people must reinstall as well.
"Your account is not ready. JWT expired."	Fixed on 26 August 2026. A sign-in lasts one hour unless the app trades its refresh token for a new one, and nothing did, so everybody was signed out an hour after signing in.	Nothing to do. A session now lasts until somebody signs out, and coming back to the app re-checks it.
A stage was advanced by mistake	Advance is one tap.	**Undo, step back** beside it. Recorded as a correction, and the Explorer never sees their stage either way.

What you see	What it usually is	What to do
A Guide cannot take another Explorer	They are at the church's limit, five by default.	Pair with another Guide, recruit one, or raise the limit in Church settings. Do not raise it to solve a shortage of Guides.
The whole left column is invisible on a dark theme	Fixed on 26 August 2026. The page background was not being themed, so light text landed on a light page.	Nothing to do.
A Guide cannot be given another Explorer	They already have five. The database refuses a sixth.	Pair with a different Guide, or recruit one. Do not raise the cap to solve a shortage of Guides.
"permission denied for table *something*"	**Not** a permissions rule that needs loosening. A rule that refuses somebody shows them nothing; it does not produce this message. This one means the request reached the database with nobody signed in.	Sign out and back in. If it keeps happening, it is the session, not the rule. See the row below.
Signed out after switching tabs, or after opening the app on a second device	Fixed on 28 August 2026. Two copies of the app raced to renew the same session, the loser was told no, and it threw the good session away rather than looking again.	Nothing to do. Signing in now lasts until somebody signs out on that device.
A blank box where an icon should be, on an Android phone	Fixed on 28 August 2026, and again on 31 August. A character that looks like an emoji but comes from a symbol block is drawn only if the phone's font happens to include it. Apple's does; Android's does not.	Nothing to do. Controls are drawn as pictures now, and a check refuses the characters.
A pop-up runs off the bottom or the side, but only in portrait	Fixed on 28 August 2026.	Nothing to do.
An invitation was accepted but the person never appeared in Approvals	Fixed on 29 August 2026. Somebody who already had an account got a recovery link instead of an invitation link, and a recovery link does not carry the church and role across. They existed with no church, visible to nobody.	Nothing to do for new ones. Anybody already stuck in that state was repaired when the fix was applied.
"You do not have permission to do that" when adding to the library	Fixed on 1 September 2026, and it was never about permission. The app saved the resource and asked the database for it back in the same breath, and the read rule could not recognise a row that did not exist a moment ago. It is the same fault as the blog error in Part 9.	Nothing to do. Anybody in the church can add a link now, Explorers included.
A card I used to scroll to has disappeared	Nothing was removed. Six rooms now open in folders, and the card is in one of them: the drop-down at the top of the room lists them all.	Tap the drop-down and choose the folder it belongs to. The room remembers your choice, so it will open there next time.

What you see	What it usually is	What to do
A link took me to a room but not to the card I pressed for	Fixed on 31 August 2026. Links that pointed at a card by name were pointing at something a folder might not be drawing.	Nothing to do. Those links now name the folder as well, and old ones are translated.
A study cannot be written on a phone or an iPad	Fixed on 28 August 2026. The Office was reachable only from the left column, which does not exist below laptop width.	Nothing to do. Office and Cases are in the Menu, on the bar at the bottom of every phone and tablet screen, and down the left on a computer.
Reply, reactions and the microphone are not in the conversation	The database has not had migration `20261001120000`. Working as designed: the conversation keeps everything else.	Nothing, or run that migration to switch them on (Part 9).
No microphone, on a database that does have the update	The browser cannot record here: the page is not on its real `https://` address, or the browser is too old to record.	Open the real address in a current browser. Typing still works, and so does attaching a recording.
"The microphone is switched off for this app"	The browser was once told no, and remembers.	Allow the microphone for this site in the browser's settings, then tap the microphone again.
"You are reacting faster than the app allows" or "sending faster than the app allows"	A pace rule: thirty reaction changes, ten files or forty messages a minute. Set to stop a script, not a person.	Wait a minute.
A voice message offers a file instead of playing	It was recorded in a format this phone cannot play, such as a `.webm` on an older iPhone.	Open the file, or update the phone.
A Sabbath program or a series made on the phone is not on the laptop	The database has not had migration `20261002150000`, or the phone has had no signal since. The line under **Saved** says which.	Open it on the phone with a signal. If it says nothing about the account, run that migration (Part 9).
A Director's progress report shows no Bible studies or lessons	Working as designed. Those stay between each Guide and Explorer; leadership's report is stages only, and says so on screen.	Ask the Guide for theirs, or for its Word file.
The calendar shows a night twice	The night's file was opened in two different calendars, or the series was copied rather than downloaded again.	Delete the extra night by hand. Opening a fresh download in the same calendar should replace, not add.
Nothing happens on Add to calendar on an Android phone	The download finished but the phone has no app that opens calendar files.	Open the downloaded file from the phone's Files app, or use **Google Calendar** one night at a time.

Where the code lives

Written down because a church that cannot hand this to somebody else owns a liability rather than an app.

Looking for	Open
The signed-out door: home, sign-in, sign-up, joining by invitation	`components/live/DoorPages.tsx`
The Director and Executive Director screen	`components/live/AdminPage.tsx`
A Guide's roster, and one Explorer's page	`components/live/GuidePages.tsx`
An Explorer's own journey	`components/live/ExplorerPage.tsx`
The conversation, and the small parts screens share	`components/live/shared.tsx`
Everything that talks to the database	`lib/live/data.ts`
The rules that keep the promises	`supabase/migrations/`

All of those live screens were one file of three thousand lines called `LiveCorePages.tsx` until they were split by screen. That file still exists and re-exports them, so nothing that imported it had to change; new code should import from the file that holds the screen.

> **NOTE**
>
> Two checks went quiet during that split, and that is the lesson
>
> They read `components/LiveCorePages.tsx` by name, so when the screens moved, ten assertions stopped testing anything while still reporting nothing wrong. One of them was a safeguarding placement check. They read every live screen now, so the next move cannot switch them off. **A check pinned to a file name is a check a refactor can silently delete.**

CHAPTER 28

Questions people ask

From `docs/guides/using/04-faq.md`

IN THIS CHAPTER

Getting in 262
Using it day to day 263
Your privacy 264
For Guides 265
For Directors 265
About the app itself 266

The questions that come up most, with short answers. Each answer names the chapter that says more.

Getting in

How do I join?

Somebody at your church invites you. There is no public sign-up, and there never will be: the invitation is the only way in. If you have not had one, ask the person at your church who looks after the app.

My invitation says it has expired, or has already been used.

A second invitation to the same address switches off the first one, and a link works once. Use the **newest** email you were sent. If you are not sure which that is, ask your church to press **Re-send**, and use only what arrives after that.

The password in my invitation does not work.

It works for three days after it was sent. It is three words and a number joined by dashes, such as `harbor-acorn-river-48`: type the dashes too. After three days, tap **Send me a link to set my password** on the sign-in page and choose your own.

Do I need to download it from an app store?

No. Hope Beacon is a website that installs like an app. Open the link, then add it to your home screen: in **Safari** on an iPhone or iPad, or in **Chrome** on Android. *Getting it on your phone* has the steps with pictures.

Which phones and computers does it work on?

Any current phone, tablet or computer with an up-to-date browser. *Which platforms this runs on* separates what has been tested from what is expected to work.

It asked me to sign in again after I installed it.

That is normal, once. The installed copy keeps its own sign-in, and remembers you after that.

Using it day to day

Where is the conversation with my Guide?

It is the round **Talk** button in the corner of every screen. A number on it means your Guide has written.

Can I take back a message I sent?

Yes. Tap your message, then **Edit** or **Delete**. An edited message is marked *edited*, and a deleted one leaves a line saying a message was deleted, so the other person is never left wondering whether they imagined it.

How long can a voice message be?

Up to two minutes. It never sends on its own: tap the arrow to send, or the bin to throw it away.

I cannot see Reply, the reactions or the microphone.

Your church's database has not had the update that switches them on yet. Everything else in the conversation works the same. Tell whoever looks after the app; the companion guide explains the update.

I cannot find a button somebody told me about.

Check which folder you are in. Tap the button at the top of the room: what you want is almost always in another folder of the same room.

Does it work with no signal?

Yes, for anything you have opened before. Rooms open, **This Sabbath** shows the last program you saw, your music plays, and what you write waits on the phone and goes up by itself when the signal comes back.

How do I make the words bigger?

Settings, **General**, **Text size**: choose a size, check the preview, then tap **Apply**.

Can the app be dark?

Yes. In **Settings**, **General**, **Look**, choose **Focus** or **Dark Aero**. *Settings, looks and reading comfort* shows every look side by side.

How do I update the app?

You do not. It updates itself the next time it starts, with nothing to press. If something looks out of place right after an update, close the app fully and open it again.

My new profile picture is not showing.

Close the app fully and open it again, once.

Your privacy

Can church leaders read my conversation?

No. A conversation belongs to the two people in it. The only exception is a safeguarding report: if somebody reports a message, a Director may read the part that was reported, and the app says so on the screen where a report is made.

If I ask the church to pray for me, will they see my name?

No. A request goes to your Guide alone unless you tick the box for the whole church, and when the church prays for it **your name is never shown**.

Is my music uploaded anywhere?

No. My Files and the Music room are kept on the device you are holding and are never uploaded. A new phone starts with them empty.

Who can read my Study Room?

Nobody but you: not your Guide, not a Director, not the person who set up the app. Your pages are kept in the church's database so they follow you to another device, under rules the database itself enforces that let only you read them.

Does the tuner record me?

No. It listens only after you tap its **microphone** button, measures the sound on the phone, and throws it away. It lets go of the microphone when you stop, when you leave the Tuner, and when the phone locks.

Where was my photo taken? Can others see that?

No. Photographs are made smaller and have their location removed before they are sent in a conversation.

Can I have a copy of everything the app holds about me?

Yes. **Profile**, then **A copy of your information**. No reason is needed and nobody has to approve it. *Your information, and how it is protected* says what is in the file, and the three things that are left out and why.

Can I change my own role?

No, and nobody else can change their own either, including the Executive Director. A role is chosen by the church when somebody is let in, and the database itself refuses anybody who tries to change their own.

For Guides

How many Explorers can I walk with?

As many as your church has set. It starts at five, which is roughly how many people one person can really walk with. A Director can raise it in the church's settings; a Guide cannot raise their own.

I advanced somebody's stage by mistake.

Tap **Undo, step back** beside it. It is recorded as a correction, and the Explorer never sees their stage either way.

Can I invite somebody myself?

You can **put a name forward** from the Office. A Director then invites them, and they arrive already paired with you.

My Sabbath program is not on my other phone.

In a church's own app, programs follow you to every device where you sign in, once the phone that made them has had a signal. The line under **Saved** says whether it has reached your account yet.

An Explorer cannot see the program I posted.

It went to the people you walk with, and that Explorer walks with somebody else; or it is still a draft in your blog. Post it again for **Everyone in the church**.

For Directors

What is the most important screen?

Admin, then **Approvals**. An Explorer with no Guide has no app, so anything waiting there is somebody being left alone.

What is the difference between Disapprove and Delete?

Disapprove switches an account off and keeps it, and can be undone. **Delete** removes the account, its messages and its pairings for good, and frees the email address. Use Disapprove when you are looking into something, and Delete when somebody has left.

What should I look at each week?

Four questions, five minutes: is anybody waiting in **Approvals**; is anybody unpaired; is any Guide at their limit while Explorers wait; and is there anything in **Admin Reports**.

Somebody reported a message. What do I do?

Open **Admin**, then **Safeguarding**. *Reports, trials and the record* explains the whole process, and why the person reported is never told who reported them.

About the app itself

Who makes it, and who owns our data?

The app is open source, made by volunteers and shared under the GNU Affero General Public License. Your church's copy runs on your church's own database, so your church holds its members' information, not the people who wrote the app.

What does it cost?

The app itself is free. Running a church's own copy costs whatever the database and the web host charge; *What it costs* has measured figures, and the companion guide explains each service.

Can we change it?

Yes. That is what open source means here. The companion guide, *Building Hope Beacon*, starts from a first download and ends at a reviewed change.

Something is wrong and it is not in this guide.

Use **Send feedback**, at the bottom of the front door or in **Settings**, **Help**. A sentence is enough.

CHAPTER 29

Your information, and how it is protected

From `docs/HANDBOOK.md`

IN THIS CHAPTER

What the conversation added, 1 October 2026 267
The Sabbath program, 2 October 2026 268
Evangelistic meetings, 2 October 2026 268
The progress report, folders and the account copy, 2 October 2026 268
Asking for a copy of your own information 269

Somebody will eventually ask what the law requires of a church running this, and the answer starts with one fact.

This app holds sensitive personal information. Under the Philippine Data Privacy Act (RA 10173) a person's **age**, **marital status** and **religious affiliation** are all sensitive, and this app records a birthday, a life status, and the whole of somebody's participation in a church. Membership is a religious affiliation, so every row is sensitive whether the column looks it or not.

That raises the standard in four ways: consent has to be **express** rather than implied, a **Data Protection Officer** is expected, the church must **register with the National Privacy Commission** once it passes a thousand members, and the penalties for getting it wrong are higher.

docs/DATA-PROTECTION.md →docs/DATA-PROTECTION.md **is the map**: every table that holds anything about a person, why it is there, who can read it, how long it stays, and which company holds it. It also lists what is still missing, and the list is the point of the document.

What the conversation added, 1 October 2026

- **A voice message** is a recording, kept and protected exactly like a photo in the conversation: only the two people can play it, and it goes when its sender removes it. The microphone is asked for only when somebody taps to record, and released when they stop.
- **A reaction** is seen by the two people, like the conversation itself.
- **Playing a shared YouTube or Facebook video** loads that company's player, and only when Play is tapped. From that tap the company sees the browser play the video, as on its own site. The privacy notice now says so, and `docs/DATA-PROTECTION.md` lists them as separate controllers rather than processors.

The Sabbath program, 2 October 2026

- **A program leaves the device it was made on only when its maker chooses**: in a file or picture they download or share, or when they press **Post it**. Nothing else sends it anywhere, and a check fails the build if the tool itself ever talks to the database or the network (`tests/a-sabbath-program-is-a-word-file.mjs`).
- **A posted program is an ordinary post**: a row in `posts`, with the sender's name, for the audience they chose, read by the same rules as every other post and taken down the same way, from your blog in Home. It needed no new table and no migration.
- **Notes for the platform never leave the device by the app's own hand.** The picture and every post are the congregation's copy, which has no notes; the same check proves it of the picture by recording every word it draws.
- **A program shared with somebody is kept on their phone**, the most recent 20, so This Sabbath opens with no signal. It is what the post already showed them, kept under their own account.
- **The file names the program, not its author.** Its author field says the app's name, because a program gets forwarded.
- **A shared computer keeps each account's list apart.** Signing out does not delete them; clearing the browser's site data does.

Evangelistic meetings, 2 October 2026

- **The same rules as the Sabbath program**: kept on the device under the account that made them, sent nowhere unless somebody downloads, shares or posts them, and a posted series is an ordinary post. The same kind of check holds it (`tests/evangelistic-meetings-are-yours-to-shape.mjs`).
- **A block marked Team only never leaves the device by the app's hand.** It is in the team's copy of the Word file, which the person chooses to download, and in nothing else: not the picture, not a post, not the shared copy. The check proves it of the picture by recording every word drawn.
- **A series shared with somebody is kept on their phone**, the most recent 20, to read with no signal.

The progress report, folders and the account copy, 2 October 2026

- **The progress report reads nothing new.** A Guide's is built from what their sign-in could already read about the Explorers they walk with; leadership's from every Explorer's stage and its history, which leadership could already read, and nothing from inside a pairing. No rule was added or widened. Its notes are kept on the device, per account and per period, and leave only in a Word file or text somebody chooses to take (`tests/a-progress-report-counts-what-happened.mjs`).
- **Sabbath programs and evangelistic meetings now have an account copy**, in `office_plans`, on a database that has had migration `20261002150000`. Each row is one program or series and is readable and writable only by the account that made it: four

owner-only rules, nothing for a signed-out visitor, and nothing for leadership. It holds what the device holds, including **Team only** blocks and platform notes, because it is the owner's own copy. A deletion keeps a row with its content emptied, so another device does not bring the program back. Limits keep the database from being anybody's free storage: each plan up to 200 KB, and per account up to 200 plans, 1000 rows and 10 MB in all (migration `20261003120000`, which also lets only an approved member keep one). A real 31-night series is about 55 KB. The app keeps a plan over 150 KB on the device rather than sending it. Deleting the account deletes them.

- **A calendar file holds what is shared only**, never a Team only block or a platform note, and is made on the device. **Google Calendar** is the one button here that sends anything to another company: tapping it opens Google Calendar with the night's name, time, place and what is shared filled in, which reaches Google as it would if typed there. The privacy notice says so.

Asking for a copy of your own information

Anybody signed in can download everything the app holds about them, from **Profile → A copy of your information**. No reason is needed and nobody has to approve it. The file is JSON, which is the form both laws ask for so it can be carried somewhere else.

It is built from what that person could already read. There is no privileged path assembling "everything about member X", because that is one mistake away from handing somebody a stranger's conversation, and the file would look the same either way. Proved against the live database: reading every message as one Explorer returned three, all theirs, and none from a conversation they are not in.

Three things are deliberately left out, and the file says so on its front page: a safeguarding report about them, a Guide's private notes, and the record of approvals and removals. A report names whoever raised it, and this app promises that person the one they reported is never told; handing it over would break that promise and could put somebody at risk. Both laws allow an access request to be limited where answering it would identify another person who has not agreed.

The file names each exclusion, gives the reason, and says to write to the Data Protection Officer, who can weigh a particular case. That is the difference between an omission somebody was told about and one they were not.

The two largest gaps today:

1. **The privacy notice is a draft.** `/privacy` in the app is written and reachable from Settings, with the church's name, the DPO's contact, the hosting region and the retention periods marked as blanks. They cannot be guessed, and a notice with a plausible wrong name on it is worse than one that admits it is unfinished.
2. **Nobody has decided the retention periods.** Everything except the 30-day library record is kept because nothing deletes it, not because a period was chosen. The privacy notice has a blank waiting for the answer.

CAUTION

This is the factual half, not a legal opinion

An engineer can say what the app collects and who can see it. Whether that satisfies a regulator is a question for a lawyer, and neither the document nor this section is legal advice. What they do is give a lawyer the map they cannot produce themselves.

CHAPTER 30

What it costs

From `docs/HANDBOOK.md`

Worked out from the live systems rather than estimated, and it produced two surprises worth stating here.

This app is not on a free plan. The Supabase organisation is on **Pro**, and there are **two projects** on it: the live one, and the predecessor with nine accounts that nobody uses. That is about **$35 a month, roughly ₱2,030**, against a stated budget of ₱2,000. Pausing the old project brings it to about **₱1,450**, and is the single cleanest saving available.

Every document in this repository said "free plan", including this handbook, and that error was informing decisions.

Storage will not be a problem this decade. Sixteen days in, with 63 members, the database is 16 MB of an 8 GB allowance and the files are 34 MB of 100 GB. Traffic is the meter that moves, because a private file is downloaded again on every view.

The bill does not multiply as churches join, because the plan is per organisation and the app is already multi-tenant. Ten churches on one instance is about ₱145 each. Ten separate projects would be ten times the compute for the same work.

docs/WHAT-IT-COSTS.md →docs/WHAT-IT-COSTS.md has the measured figures, the video question costed both ways, and the list of what could not be seen from here. Chief among it is the Vercel account that actually serves the site, which is the one number that could still put the church over budget.

CHAPTER 31

Showing it to a church

From `docs/PRESENTING.md`

IN THIS CHAPTER

Contents 272
Part A — The facts 273
Part B — Every concept, twice 273
Part C — The three audiences 277
Part D — The demo script 279
Part E — Questions you will actually get 281
Using AI tools properly 282
Evidence, and a warning about numbers 283
For an AI reading this file 284

One file, four jobs:

1. **Your own briefing.** Every concept is explained twice — in plain words, then in full technical detail — so that whoever asks, you have the right answer at the right depth.
2. **Three audience tracks.** Church directors, IT people, and enthusiasts want different things. Each track says what to show, what to skip, and in what order.
3. **A demo script.** Literal click paths, so nothing is improvised on stage.
4. **A machine-readable source.** If you hand this file to an AI and ask it to build a presentation, everything it needs is here. See For an AI reading this at the end.

> **On numbers.** This document deliberately contains almost no statistics. See Evidence — the short version is that a figure you cannot defend when a director challenges it will cost you more than it gains, and the argument for this app does not need one.

Contents

- Part A — The facts
- Part B — Every concept, twice
- Part C — The three audiences
- Part D — The demo script
- Part E — Questions you will actually get
- Evidence
- For an AI reading this file

Part A — The facts

Everything here is checked against the code. Nothing is aspirational.

What it is	A web app that helps a church walk with one person at a time, from first contact to the point where they start walking with somebody else.
Licence	AGPL-3.0. Free. Fork it, rename it, sell services around it — improvements to a hosted version stay open.
Runs on	Any modern phone or computer. Installs from the browser — no app store. Developed and CI-tested on Linux, Windows and macOS.
Needs to run	Nothing. No sign-up, no database, no keys, no configuration.
Works offline	Yes, fully, after the first load.
Attachments	Images, audio, video and documents on a conversation. Bytes stay on the device, in IndexedDB, never in the saved database.
Live sync	Every open window on ONE device stays in step with no refresh. Across devices needs a backend; the transport is a seam you swap.
Roles	Explorer, Guide, Director, Executive Director.
Journey stages	Create → Connect → Care → Call → Cultivate → Commission (six).
Sample people	10, all invented, at email domains that can never reach a real inbox.
Guided walks	4 — one per role. Executive 3 steps, Director 5, Guide 5, Explorer 3.
Built with	Next.js, React, TypeScript. Three runtime dependencies.
Tests	30 checks including 18 real-browser walks, two at phone size. All passing.

The one thing to be clear about in every room: as it ships there is **no server and no database**. Everything lives in the browser on your own device. That is why it is safe to hand to anyone, and it is also the thing a church changes when it wants two people to share the same information.

Part B — Every concept, twice

Read both levels of each. In the room, use whichever the question deserves.

1. Pairing — the heart of the whole thing

Plain words. A church notices someone exploring faith. Instead of putting their name on a list, one person from the church is assigned to walk with them — one to one. That relationship is the unit the whole app is built around. Everything else — the messages, the lessons, the stages — hangs off it.

In detail. A pairing is a record joining two people: a Guide and an Explorer, plus a stage and a track. It is created one of two ways:

- A Director pairs two people directly.
- **The recommendation chain**, which is the designed path. A Guide recommends somebody by name and email. That recommendation goes to a Director, who invites them. When that person accepts the invitation, **the pairing is created in the same operation that creates their account** — with the Guide who recommended them, at stage `connect`.

That last detail is the one worth defending. There is never a moment when a new Explorer exists with nobody attached to them, because attachment happens in the same step as creation rather than as a follow-up task somebody has to remember.

Why a Guide cannot invite directly. They recommend; the Director decides. That keeps one person accountable for who enters the church's records. In this build the rule is enforced by the screens; in a real deployment you enforce it in the database, because anybody can send a request without using your screens.

2. How an app works with no backend

Plain words. Normally an app keeps your information on a computer somewhere else, and asks for it every time you open a screen. This one keeps everything on your own device. Nothing is sent anywhere. That is why it works with no signal, and why there is nothing to break into.

In detail. Every screen reads and writes one React context — `lib/demo/store.tsx` — which persists to `localStorage` and normalises on load, so a save written by an older version still opens in a newer one. No component fetches. The `Ctx` interface at the top of that file is the complete list of what the application can do, which makes it the backend contract: anything satisfying it can replace the store, and no screen notices.

The trade-off, stated plainly: one device, one person. Clear the browser and it is gone. That is correct for evaluating, training, and demonstrating. It is not a multi-user system, and it does not pretend to be.

3. How email works

Plain words. In this version, nothing is actually emailed. Every message the app *would* send — an invitation, a welcome, a notification — appears in a **Mail** screen instead, worded exactly as it would arrive. You can read it and click the links. It is a rehearsal of the real thing with no mail server anywhere.

In detail. `lib/demo/store.tsx` builds a `DemoEmail` for each event and stores it in `db.emails`; `app/mail/page.tsx` renders the mailbox, open to every role on purpose — a Director reads what the app sends and acts on recommendations, a Guide writes them, an Explorer sees the welcome they were sent. The simulation is only useful if everyone can stand in it.

When you connect a backend, you replace that with a real provider. The invitation flow is the one to get right: a single-use token, an expiry, and a link that only works for the address it was sent to. Anything that sends email must be rate limited **on your server**, keyed on something the caller cannot change for free.

4. Desktop and phone

Plain words. The same app, and it adapts. On a phone you can add it to your home screen and it opens like any other app — full screen, its own icon, no browser bar. On a computer you can install it the same way. It updates itself; nobody ever has to uninstall and reinstall.

In detail. It is a Progressive Web App: a web manifest makes it installable, and a service worker caches the shell so every route works offline, not only the screens you happened to visit. Updates do not rely on the service worker's own mechanism, which is the part that fails in practice — the app fetches `/version.json` with `cache: 'no-store'` a few seconds after launch, on every return to the foreground, and every fifteen minutes, and compares the build id against the one compiled into its own bundle. Different means stale, and it offers a one-tap restart. Measured at about 28 seconds from deploy to prompt.

The manifest pins `id` to `/` so a rename relabels the installed app instead of creating a second one beside it.

5. Making your own Beacon

Plain words. Copy the project, change the words, and it is yours. The roles, the six stages, the sample people and the lessons are ordinary files. Nothing is locked. There is no licence to buy and nobody to ask.

In detail. Fork, then:

- `lib/brand.ts` — the app's name and colours. One edit renames it everywhere; a test fails if a name gets hardcoded somewhere a rename would miss.
- `lib/types.ts` — every shape in the app, in one file. Roles live here.
- `lib/demo/seed.ts` — the sample people. **This is also the schema**, because the normaliser derives the expected shape from it.
- `lib/quest.ts` — the four guided walks.

Then `npm run icons` regenerates the favicon and home-screen icons from the same drawing, so the brand cannot drift.

6. Deploying it

Plain words. It is a normal website. Put it anywhere that hosts websites — most have a free tier that covers a church comfortably. Nothing to configure.

In detail. Standard Next.js. Vercel, Netlify, Cloudflare, a container or your own Node server all work; there is nothing platform-specific in it. The build identity is read from whichever host you use — Vercel, Netlify, Cloudflare Pages, GitHub Actions, GitLab CI, Heroku or Render — with a `BUILD_ID` override, so redeploying the same code never tells an installed copy it is out of date.

What belongs to whoever deploys it: HTTPS, browser security headers, the domain, and the decision about whether it should be public at all. It ships `noindex` by default across three places — the meta tag, `robots.ts`, and the `X-Robots-Tag` header — because a shared deep link that gets indexed is the cheapest possible leak. Change all three or none.

7. Connecting your own database

Plain words. The day two people need to see the same thing on two phones, you add a database. You choose which one — we do not pick for you. The app is built so that this is a swap underneath, not a rebuild.

In detail. `docs/BUILD-YOUR-OWN.md` is the full walkthrough. The shape:

- `Ctx` and `DemoContext` are exported. Implement `Ctx` against your database, provide it in place of `DemoProvider`, and every screen keeps working.
- Type your object as `Ctx` and the compiler lists what you still owe.
- Start with the feedback sink in `lib/backend/feedback.ts` — the same pattern at one twentieth the size, working end to end in about fifteen minutes.

The rule that matters more than the code: your screens decide what to *show*; your database decides what somebody is *allowed to have*. Put the permission rules with the data. Anybody can send a request without using your screens.

Five rules your data layer inherits: a Guide reads only their own pairings; private notes are readable by their author alone; an Explorer never receives their own stage; only a Director invites and pairs; and nobody can change their own role.

8. Attachments and live sync

Plain words. You can attach a photo, a voice note, a video or a document to a conversation, and both people in that conversation see it. Nobody else does, not even a Director. And if you have the app open in two windows, a message sent in one appears in the other straight away, with no refresh.

The honest limit, say it before anybody tests it. Live sync works between windows on *one device*. Two different phones cannot sync through a server that does not exist. Add a backend and the same code syncs across devices, because the transport is a seam you replace, not a thing baked in.

In detail.

- Attaching goes through `attachMedia(pairingId, file)`. It returns immediately and writes the bytes in the background — the same optimistic rule as every other write. If the disk refuses, the row is removed again, so you never see an attachment whose file is not there.
- **The bytes are never in the database row.** They go to IndexedDB; the row holds metadata and an id. That is not a preference: this database is serialised into localStorage on every write, and localStorage holds about 5 MB. One phone photo inlined would break saving for everything else.
- Who may see an attachment follows the **pairing**, never the file. The screens call `mediaFor(pairingId)` and never filter the collection themselves, because the rule belongs in one place — and in a real deployment that place is a database policy.
- Live sync is `lib/realtime.ts`. The default transport is a `BroadcastChannel`; `setRealtimeTransport()` swaps it for your provider.

The two mistakes to know about, because both are silent.

1. **A private row pointing at a public file.** Row rules govern rows, not objects. If the file is reachable by anyone holding the link, the link *is* the permission, and anybody ever sent one keeps it forever. Private bucket, short-lived signed URLs, minutes not days.
2. **A change feed is a second way out of the database** and does not inherit the rules you wrote for queries. On Postgres providers, row-level security for the replication stream is a separate switch. Subscribe per pairing, and test it with two clients signed in as two different people — a feed leak is invisible from the sending side.

Both have matching policies in `docs/examples/schema.sql`, sections 2b and 2c, and that file has been run.

Part C — The three audiences

Track 1 — Church directors

They are deciding whether this is worth their church's attention. They do not want architecture. They want to know whether it solves a problem they recognise.

Open with the problem, not the app. Say it roughly like this, and watch for recognition:

> Someone comes forward on a Sabbath. A name goes on a card. The card goes in a folder, or into somebody's pocket. Six weeks later, nobody in this room can tell me what happened to that person — not because anybody stopped caring, but because the follow-up lived in one person's memory.

That is the whole case, and it needs no statistic. Every director in the room has lived it.

Then the answer in one line: Beacon replaces the card with a named person and a visible next step.

What to show, in this order:

1. **One person, walking with one person.** The pairing. Not a database of contacts — a relationship with somebody accountable for it.
2. **The six stages**, and the fact that the last one turns around: Commission is where the person being walked with begins walking with somebody else. The model is designed to multiply, not to accumulate.
3. **Their own screen.** Run the Executive Director walk — three steps, about a minute. They see the church in numbers and the journey chart.
4. **What they will never see.** This is the trust moment. Leaders get counts; Guides get the relationship. There is no screen anywhere that shows a pastor somebody's private conversation. Say it plainly: *"I cannot read Maria's messages, and neither can you, and that is deliberate."*
5. **Cost.** It is free and open source. No licence, no per-seat fee, no vendor.

What to skip entirely: the store, the backend seam, TypeScript, tests, the repository.

The one thing they most need to hear: an Explorer never sees their own stage. A stage is a note the church keeps to organise its work, not a grade shown to a person about themselves. Directors immediately understand why that matters pastorally, and it demonstrates the app was designed by people thinking about dignity rather than data.

Track 2 — IT people

Mixed room: some professionals, some not. **Pitch to the middle and offer depth on request.** The professionals will ask; the others will be glad you did not assume.

Lead with the thing that is unusual: this app has no backend, and that is a design decision rather than an unfinished state. Then explain what that buys — runs anywhere, nothing to breach, evaluate the whole thing before committing — and what it costs: one device, one person.

Cover, in this order:

1. **Architecture in one sentence.** Next.js front end; every screen reads one store; the store is the only thing that touches persistence.
2. **The seam.** `Ctx` is the backend contract, exported so you can implement it. Show the interface. This is the part professionals will judge you on, and it holds up: no screen fetches, so replacing the store replaces everything.
3. **Run it themselves, live.** `git clone`, `npm install`, `npm run dev`. It works in under two minutes with nothing to configure. Do this on screen — it is more persuasive than any slide.
4. **Connecting a database.** Walk `docs/BUILD-YOUR-OWN.md`. Emphasise that the schema and permission rules in `docs/examples/` **have been run against a real PostgreSQL 16 database** and attacked from a second account — fourteen checks, all passing. Mention that running them the first time found five defects, including one that silently broke this app's most important promise: an Explorer could read their own journey stage straight out of the database, even though every screen hid it. Engineers trust a project more when it admits that, not less.
5. **Contributing.** `CONTRIBUTING.md`. The bar is "will the next person understand why it is like that". Comments explain *why*. Guardrails are tests, not agreements. New tests must fail first.
6. **Maintaining it.** CI runs typecheck, tests and a build on every push with read-only permissions and no secrets, so a fork has working CI on the first click of Fork.

Have ready if asked:

- Three runtime dependencies. Deliberately small so one person can audit it.
- The image optimiser is off — a security decision as much as a cost one.
- CSP allows this origin and nothing else; add your backend to `connect-src` only.
- The demo role switcher and `setMyRole` must be **deleted** before real users.

Track 3 — Enthusiasts

Casual. No slides if you can avoid it. Hand them your phone.

The whole pitch is three sentences:

> A church meets someone who wants to know more. Normally what happens next depends on a card in a folder and somebody's memory. This gives the church one place for that, and gives each person involved exactly the part of it they need.

Then: **"Here, have a look."** Let them tap. Point out three things as they go:

1. **Pick who you are** — and the app becomes a different app. Same information, four completely different views.
2. **It works with no signal.** Turn on flight mode while they hold it. Nothing breaks. That single moment does more than any explanation.
3. **It is free, and it is yours.** Anyone can take it and make their own.

If they ask how it works: *"Everything is stored on the phone itself, not on a company's server. That is why it works with no signal, and why there is nothing to leak."* Stop there unless they push.

Part D — The demo script

Do these steps in order. They build.

Before you start — every time

1. Open **Sign in** → press **Reset demo data**. The tutorial and demo write to browser storage; if you have rehearsed, the state is dirty and the numbers will look wrong.
2. **Do not push to `main` during your presentation window.** There is no update banner to switch off any more — the app takes a new build by itself as soon as the screen has been quiet for twenty seconds, which during a demo is most of the time. It will not interrupt you mid-sentence and it will not lose anything you have typed, but the page can reload while you are talking. The only reliable way to stop that is to ship nothing while you are on stage.
3. If you installed it to the home screen, install from the real address, never a preview link — a preview is a different origin and becomes a second app that can never update.

The five-minute version

#	Do this	Say this
1	Open the front door	"This is what a member of your church sees."
2	Scroll down	"And this is what you can do before deciding anything."
3	**Who are you in your church?** → Executive Director	"Three steps. It teaches you your own job, not somebody else's."
4	Complete the walk	Let the arrows do the talking. Do not narrate every step.
5	Header → **Try any account** → a Guide	"Same church. Same information. Completely different app."
6	Open an Explorer → **Talk**	"This conversation is private to these two people. I cannot read it. Nor can the pastor."

Step 5 is the moment that lands. Everything before it is setup.

The full version — add these

#	Do this	Shows
7	Guide → **Recommend someone** — name and email	A Guide recommends; they cannot invite
8	Switch to Director → **Mail**	The recommendation arrived. "This is the email that would have been sent."
9	Director → invite them	The chain: recommend → decide → invite
10	Show the pairing appears at **Connect**	"Paired the moment they accept. Nobody has to remember."
11	Director → **Analytics**	Counts and trends. No names.
12	Flight mode on, keep clicking	Works offline. This surprises people.
13	Settings → **App version**	Updates itself; nobody uninstalls anything.

For an IT room, add

#	Do this	Shows
14	Terminal: `git clone`, `npm install`, `npm run dev`	Two minutes, nothing to configure. Verified from a clean clone on 2026-08-12; `tests/dev-server.mjs` keeps it that way
15	Open `lib/demo/store.tsx`, show `Ctx`	The backend contract
16	Open `docs/examples/schema.sql`	Tables and permission rules, already run
17	Run `prove-the-rules.sql`	Sixteen attacks from a second account, all refused
18	`npm test`	Every static check (178 on 4 October 2026); `npm run verify:all` adds every browser walk (74)

Part E — Questions you will actually get

Both levels for each. Use whichever fits the asker.

"Is our members' data safe?" *Simple:* In this version nothing leaves your device — there is no server to break into. When you connect a real one, the safety of that is your church's responsibility, and the app is built to make the right thing the easy thing. *Full:* No network calls, no analytics, no telemetry. Tests enforce that on every build. With a backend, authorisation must live in the database rather than the screens, and `docs/BUILD-YOUR-OWN.md` walks through it with a schema that has been run and attacked.

"Can the pastor read people's messages?" *Both levels, same answer:* **No.** There is no screen that shows it. Leaders get counts and trends, never conversations. If you connect a database, that boundary becomes a rule you enforce there — it is easy to lose by accident and hard to explain afterwards.

"What does it cost?" Nothing. AGPL-3.0 licence. Hosting for a church fits comfortably in most free tiers. Running it unmodified obliges you to nothing; if you change it and host it for people, you offer them your changed source. Your costs are a domain if you want one, and whoever maintains it.

"What if the developer disappears?" You have the entire source code under a licence nobody can revoke. Any competent developer can pick it up — that is exactly why the comments explain *why* rather than *what*.

"Does it work without internet?" Yes, fully, after the first load. Demonstrate it rather than answering it.

"Do people need to download it from an app store?" No. They open a link and choose "Add to Home Screen". It then behaves like any other app. No store, no review, no fee, no waiting.

"How is this different from a spreadsheet or a WhatsApp group?" *Simple:* A spreadsheet tells you who exists. This tells you who is walking with whom, where they have got to, and what happens next — and it shows each person only their own part. *Full:* The unit is the pairing, not the contact. Stage, materials, meetings, notes and messages hang off the relationship, and role-based views mean the same data serves four different jobs without anybody seeing more than they should.

"Can we change the stages / the wording / the roles?" Yes. They are ordinary files. Stages and roles are one edit each.

"Who else is using it?" Answer honestly: it was built for one church and has just been open-sourced. Do not imply a user base that does not exist — an IT person will check.

"Is it finished?" The app is complete and tested. What is deliberately not included is a backend, because that is the church's own choice. Also say plainly: promoting an Explorer to become a Guide is **not built yet**, because it needs decisions nobody has made — what happens to the old pairing, who approves, what history carries over.

Using AI tools properly

This app was built with heavy AI assistance, and you will be asked about it — by IT people who want to know if the code can be trusted, and by directors who have read something worrying. Answer from experience rather than from either enthusiasm or fear. What follows is what this project actually learned.

The one rule that matters

AI is excellent at producing work that looks correct. It has no way of knowing whether it is.

That is not a criticism, it is the shape of the tool. It writes from patterns, so its output is plausible by construction — and plausible is exactly what you cannot tell apart from correct by reading.

The evidence from this project

The database rules in `docs/examples/` were written by AI, reviewed carefully, and read perfectly well. Then somebody actually ran them against a real database. **Five defects**, including:

- The whole thing failed on the first policy — the SQL assumed one particular vendor's function that does not exist in plain Postgres.
- One policy recursed infinitely. The app could not list anybody at all.
- An Explorer could read their own journey stage directly from the database, even though every screen hid it. **The app's most important promise, broken, in code that had been read and approved.**
- A safety rule written to stop people promoting themselves also stopped Directors approving anyone — and it failed silently, so the church would have concluded the app was broken with nothing in any log to explain it.

None of those were visible by reading. All of them appeared within minutes of execution. That is the entire lesson.

How to use these tools well

Do	Don't
Use it to draft, explain, and find things in a large codebase	Ask it whether its own output is correct — it will say yes
Run everything it writes. Execute the code, apply the schema, click the screen	Approve by reading. Reading catches typos, not logic
Ask it to write the test that would catch the mistake, then break the code and watch the test fail	Trust a test that has never failed. A test that cannot fail is decoration
Make it state what it did *not* verify	Accept confident summaries at face value
Give it the real files and let it check	Let it work from memory of your project
Ask it to explain *why*, and keep that in the code	Keep only the code and lose the reasoning

Three hard rules for a church

1. **Never paste real member data into an AI tool.** Not names, not prayer requests, not pastoral notes, not a spreadsheet export. Use the invented sample people. Anything you paste may be stored or reviewed, and the person whose crisis you pasted did not consent to that.
2. **Never let it invent a number.** Ask it for research and it will produce statistics that sound right. Every figure needs a primary source you have read yourself. This document contains almost no statistics for exactly that reason — see the section below.
3. **A human is accountable, always.** "The AI wrote it" is not an answer you can give a member whose information leaked. Somebody named must have run it, tested it, and decided to ship it.

What to say when asked

To a director: *"AI helped write it, the way a very fast assistant would. Everything it produced was tested by a person before it went anywhere near real people — and testing found real mistakes that reading had missed. That is exactly why we test."*

To an IT person: *"Every claim in the docs is checked. The schema and the permission rules have been applied to a real database and attacked from a second account. The test scripts are in the repository, so you do not have to take my word for it — run them."*

To an enthusiast: *"It let one person build something that would normally take a team. It also confidently wrote several things that were wrong, which is why nothing goes out until it has actually been run."*

Evidence, and a warning about numbers

Do not put a statistic on a slide you cannot defend. If a director challenges a figure and you cannot source it, you lose the room, and the argument for this app does not need one. The card-in-a-folder story is stronger than any percentage because everyone present has lived it.

If your denomination has its own follow-up or retention data, **that** is worth citing — it is yours, it is local, and nobody will dispute it.

Publicly discussed research you may want to read and verify yourself before using. **These are starting points, not verified citations** — read the primary source before quoting any number:

- Barna — The State of Discipleship →https://www.barna.com/research/new-research-on-the-state-of-discipleship/
- Lifeway Research — Most Churches Rarely Evaluate Their Discipleship Strategies →https://research.lifeway.com/2025/10/07/most-churches-rarely-evaluate-their-discipleship-strategies/
- Billy Graham Association — report on intentional discipleship →https://billygraham.org/decision-magazine/articles/new-report-reveals-lack-of-intentional-discipleship-in-churches
- Church Answers — preventing members from dropping out →https://churchanswers.com/blog/six-critical-issues-to-prevent-church-members-from-dropping-out/

One figure was deliberately left out of this document: a widely repeated claim comparing how many friendships new members form versus those who leave. It fits this app's argument almost too well, and it could not be traced to a primary source. If you find it properly sourced, it is a strong point. Until then, do not use it.

For an AI reading this file

You have been given this document to generate a presentation, summary, or training material about **Open Sentry Beacon**. Everything you need is above. Constraints, in priority order:

1. **Do not invent statistics, user numbers, church counts, or testimonials.** This project has been open-sourced recently and has no user base to claim. If a slide needs a number, use only the verified figures in Part A.
2. **Three audiences, different content.** Church directors (non-technical, decision-makers), IT (mixed skill, implementers), enthusiasts (casual). Part C defines what each needs. Do not merge them into one generic deck.
3. **The central claim** is: *one person walking with one person, with each role seeing only their own part.* Everything else supports that.
4. **The trust claim** must appear in any director-facing material: leaders see counts, never conversations; an Explorer never sees their own stage.
5. **Be accurate about the backend.** As shipped there is no server and no database; everything is in the browser. This is a deliberate design decision, not an incomplete state. A church adds its own backend, and the app is built for that swap.
6. **State limits honestly.** Not built: promoting an Explorer to Guide. Not included: any backend. Not claimed: any existing user base. **Live sync works between windows on one device, not between devices** — say that plainly wherever sync is mentioned, because it is the first thing somebody will test.
7. **Tone.** Plain, concrete, unhurried. No hype, no exclamation marks, no invented urgency. The subject is pastoral care, and overselling reads as disrespect for it.

Suggested deck shapes:

Audience	Slides	Arc
Church directors	10–14	the problem they recognise → the pairing → the six stages → their own screen → what they will never see → cost → what is next
IT	14–20	no backend and why → architecture → the store as contract → run it live → connect a database → the permission rules → attachments and live sync → contributing → maintaining
Enthusiasts	5–8	the three-sentence pitch → pick who you are → offline → it is yours

Source files worth quoting from, all in this repository: `README.md`, `ARCHITECTURE.md`, `docs/BUILD-YOUR-OWN.md`, `docs/ONBOARDING.md`, `docs/SECURITY.md`, `docs/examples/schema.sql`, `docs/BACKENDS.md`, `lib/realtime.ts`.

CHAPTER 32

Live presentation runbook

From `docs/LIVE-DEMO-RUNBOOK.md`

IN THIS CHAPTER

Before the room arrives 285
The ten-minute live story 285
If mail or Wi-Fi is slow 286
Final checks 286

The live church app and the sample tutorial are two different experiences. Never use the tutorial as the sign-in path: on a configured live deployment, **Sign in** always opens an e-mail and password form.

Before the room arrives

1. Open the live deployment in a desktop browser and sign in as the Executive Director.
2. Keep the sample-data deployment in another tab as the offline fallback and feature tour. Its tutorial is intentionally not part of live sign-in.
3. Prepare two inbox addresses you can open: one Guide and one Explorer. Gmail plus aliases are useful, for example `yourname+guide@gmail.com` and `yourname+explorer@gmail.com`.
4. Send the two invitations before the presentation as a safeguard against venue Wi-Fi or mail delays. You can also send one fresh invitation live.

The ten-minute live story

1. **The gateway:** tap **Sign in** on desktop, then on a phone. Point out that both ask only for e-mail and password—no tutorial and no sample role picker.
2. **Governance:** as Executive Director, invite a Guide. Only an Executive Director can invite a Director; a Director can invite Guides and Explorers.
3. **Mailbox:** open the Guide's invitation, set a password, and show the awaiting-approval screen.
4. **Approval:** return to the Executive Director screen and approve the Guide. The Guide can now sign in and reaches only the Guide workspace.
5. **Recommendation:** invite an Explorer and select that Guide. Open the invitation on a phone, set the Explorer's password, then approve the account. Pairing is created only after approval, at Connect.
6. **Two devices:** send a message from the Guide's desktop and reply from the Explorer's phone. The Explorer sees the relationship, but never the church's private journey-stage

note.

7. **Open source:** finish at the GitHub repository and `CONTRIBUTING.md`. Show that another church can fork the code, create its own Supabase project, add its own Vercel variables, and keep its congregation's data in its own project.

If mail or Wi-Fi is slow

Use the invitation already sent before the session. If the live path is not healthy, switch openly to the sample-data deployment and say that it is the offline feature tour. Do not make sample data look like the live church system.

Final checks

- Live home has one **Sign in** button.
- Live sign-in has e-mail and password fields.
- Invitation opens `/join` and sets a password.
- New member sees **awaiting approval** before any workspace.
- Director/Executive Director can approve; Guide and Explorer cannot.
- Guide/Explorer pairing appears only after approval.
- Desktop and phone layouts do not scroll sideways.

CHAPTER 33

Glossary

From `docs/guides/using/05-glossary.md`

The words the app uses, and what each one means in it.

Word	What it means in Hope Beacon
Admin	The Director's room: Approvals, People and Pairing, Materials, Mail, Safeguarding and Analytics.
Admin Reports	Reports, trials and the record. In every leader's Menu; a Guide or Explorer who is part of a case reaches it through Settings. Marked beta.
Advanced settings	A tick box that shows more choices on a screen that keeps them out of the way, such as minutes and platform notes on a Sabbath program. Nobody ever has to open it.
Ambience	Calming sounds made on the phone as they play, in the Music room's Listen folder: *Calm* and *White noise*.
Announcement	A notice pinned at the top of everybody's Home, with when it happens.
Approvals	Who is waiting to be let in, and the names Guides have put forward. The most important screen for a Director.
Beta	A part of the app that works but is still being finished. It says so beside its name.
Blog	Posts written for the church, in Home. Anybody may write one with **Write a post**.
Classic	The app's own look, and the default. Every other look is chosen beside it.
Commission	The idea behind the journey: an Explorer who has been walked with becomes a Guide, and walks with somebody else.
Concert pitch	The note A that the Tuner measures everything against, 440 Hz unless you change it.
Conductor	The Music room's metronome, which draws the conductor's hand for 2, 3, 4 or 6 beats.
Desk	A Guide's or leader's side panel: the date, what is waiting, a note, the pocket and the colour squares. A drawer on a phone.
Director	Runs the church's account: invites, approves, pairs, and reads safeguarding reports.
Disapprove	Switch an account off, keeping it. It can be undone. Compare *Delete*, which cannot.
Evangelistic meetings	A planner in the Office for a series of meetings, night by night, with a Word file, a picture and a post to share.
Executive Director	Oversees one or more churches, appoints Directors, and sees what a Director sees across all of them.
Explorer	Somebody the church is walking with. They have one Guide.

Word	What it means in Hope Beacon
Folder	One part of a room. The button at the top of a room says which folder you are in; tap it to see the rest.
Front door	The first page of the app, before signing in.
Frutiger Aero	A family of five looks made of glass and light: Frutiger Eco, Dark Aero, Technozen, DORFic and Four Colors.
Guide	A church member who walks with a few Explorers.
Guided walk	The tutorial: a highlight that points at the next thing to tap and says what it is for. **Start a tutorial**, in Settings, Help.
Head Executive Director	The one account at the root of the church's authority. Nobody can suspend or remove it, so a church can never lock itself out.
Home	The church home: Notices, Blog, the Prayer wall, and for leaders the numbers. First in every Menu.
Install	Add the app to a home screen or dock so it opens like any other app.
Journey	The five stages an Explorer moves through at their own pace: Beginner, Connect, Care, Call and Cultivate.
Lesson study	A study a Guide writes once in the Office and sends to the people who need it.
Look	How the whole app is drawn: its colours and shapes. Chosen in Settings, General, Look, and kept on the device.
Mail	In the sample church, a mailbox showing what the app sends. In a church's own app, the invitations still open, for leaders.
Menu	The list of every room you have. The first of the three words along the bottom.
MusicXML	A file format for written music that MuseScore, Sibelius, Finale and Dorico all save. The Music room plays it.
My Files	Your own files, on this device. Never uploaded.
My Journey	An Explorer's own room: My Guide, Study, Church and Prayer.
New	A green mark on anybody who joined in the last seven days.
Office	The room for work rather than conversation: numbers, lesson studies, the Sabbath program, evangelistic meetings and reports.
Pairing	Putting an Explorer with a Guide. They can talk from that moment.
People	The second of the three words along the bottom: the people you walk with.
Pieces	The Music room's folder for the choir's music: clean scanned pages and scores that play.
Pocket	A place on the desk for a few links you use often.
Post it	Share a Sabbath program or a series of meetings inside the app, for the people you walk with or the whole church.
Prayer wall	Requests the church has been asked to pray for, in Home. Names are never shown.
Progress report	In the Office, Reports: how the Explorers are doing over a month or a quarter, with a Word file to hand in.

Word	What it means in Hope Beacon
Reduce motion	A setting on your own phone or computer. Hope Beacon follows it everywhere and stops things moving.
Report	Telling the church's leaders about a message or a person. The person reported is never told who made it.
Room	One of the places in the Menu, such as Home, Music or the Office.
Sabbath program	A planner in the Office for a Sabbath's order of service.
Safeguarding	Where Directors read reports. The one place a leader may read part of a private conversation, and only the part reported.
Sample church	The invented church the app shows when it has no database behind it. Every picture in this guide is from it.
Shelf	The church's starter resources. An Explorer is shown eight first, opening with a Bible they can read on a phone.
Stage	Where an Explorer has reached on the journey. A note for the Guide, never a score, and never shown to the Explorer.
Study Room	An Explorer's own place to write while reading. Nobody else sees it. Marked beta.
Talk	The round button in the corner of every screen: your conversation.
Team only	A tick on part of an evangelistic meeting that keeps it out of the picture and anything posted.
Text size	How big the words are, chosen in Settings, General, and applied with **Apply**.
This Sabbath	The room that shows the program and meetings your church has posted. Opens with no signal once seen.
Tuner	The Music room's folder that names the note you sing or play and says whether it is flat or sharp.
Vault	The Listen folder's tab for your own music and video, saved on this device.

CHAPTER 34

What changed, release by release

From `docs/guides/building/generated/G-release-notes.md`

IN THIS CHAPTER

A simpler Tuner: a dial, a button, and a keyboard to sing to 292
Sing the note, and a tuner that hears each note exactly 292
Choose your language before you sign in 292
Two-step sign-in 293
Questions people ask 293
Who can do what, kept by the church's own rules 293
Home is a billboard 293
Clearer conversations, a simpler Study Room 294
Easier to read, in every look 294
Your look, from the first moment 294
My Files, simpler on a phone and a pad 295
Music PDFs, read on your phone 295
A quicker tuner, and the Music room in every look 295
Advanced settings in the Music room, and a new Play folder 296
Concert pitch you can hear 296
A Music room, for the choir and everyone who loves music 296
Five new Frutiger Aero looks 297
A tidier column on computers 297
Smoother on your phone 297
Write a post straight from Home 297
Your desk colours work in every look 297
Safer signing in and out 298
Three new looks, the same familiar rooms 298
Write your blog and announcements from Home 298
Try a text size before you apply it 298
Classic is the computer design now 299
A computer's top bar on a computer 299
Computers open in the Desktop look 299
Classic, and a Desktop look for computers 299
A progress report, folders, calendars, and your plans on every device 300
Plan evangelistic meetings your own way 300
Share the Sabbath program, and find it on This Sabbath 300
Make the Sabbath program in the Office 300
A friendlier chat: reactions, replies and voice messages 301
Smoother, calmer movement 301
Talk in the bubble, appointments first, and less scrolling 301
Menu, People and My Files, along the bottom 302
Invitation e-mails and live church accounts 302
Simpler names, and updates that just happen 302
Video keeps its original quality 303
Clearer, safer feedback 303
Church home, a real music player, and updates you can see 303
The tutorial works properly now 303

Works offline, and tells you when you are 303
A real starter library 304

The app's own release notes (`lib/release-notes.ts`), newest first: 45 releases, as members read them in Settings, What's new.

A simpler Tuner: a dial, a button, and a keyboard to sing to

2026-10-15

- The Tuner is a dial with your note in the middle, and one round button to start and stop listening. The words are gone; the dial says In tune, or how far off you are.
- Starting note and Concert pitch are one line each. Tap Concert pitch to open it.
- Sing the note, in Advanced settings, is a piano keyboard. Tap a key, sing it and hold it, and it says Perfect, Close, or Try again with what you sang. Sing again after a breath and it tells you again.
- The voice trail, the drone and your instrument are under More tools.

Sing the note, and a tuner that hears each note exactly

2026-10-14

- In the Music room, Tuner, tick Advanced settings and you will find Sing the note. Choose one note, or a run of five to ten (or let the app pick them for your voice), sing each one and hold it, and the tuner tells you whether you hit it: the right note, in the right octave. If you did not, it tells you what you sang instead.
- Hit every note and you are told so: Perfect pitch!
- Choose how close counts: Choir (within a quarter of a semitone) or Exact (within a tenth). Leave Play each note before I sing it off for the real test, from memory.
- The tuner itself hears more exactly: a singer with a wide vibrato is shown one note, not two; "ee" at the top of a voice is no longer missed; and a thin phone microphone no longer shows a low note an octave out. It was checked against real singing marked by trained musicians.
- Your voice, the drawing of the last ten seconds, is redrawn: one octave at a time, a row for each note with its name large enough to read on a phone, the note you are singing lit, and each note its own line. A stray sound no longer draws a tall streak.
- The microphone is used only while you sing, and nothing is recorded or sent.

Choose your language before you sign in

2026-10-13

- The front door and the sign-in page now have a language chooser in the corner. Sixteen languages are offered, and the phone or computer keeps your choice after you sign in.

- The front door, the sign-in page and its messages, the code screen of two-step sign-in, and the bar along the bottom are translated. Arabic reads right to left. Everything else is still in English for now, including the permission you give when you join.
- The translations are drafts. If you speak one of these languages and something reads wrong, tell your church so it can be corrected.
- For developers: a guide and working examples for building your own app or server in Rust, C++, JavaScript, Python, PHP, Go, Java, Dart or plain REST, with the privacy rules kept in the database (docs/IN-ANY-LANGUAGE.md).

Two-step sign-in

2026-10-13

- You can add a second step to signing in: a six-digit code from an authenticator app on your phone, such as Google Authenticator or Microsoft Authenticator. Somebody who learns your password still cannot sign in as you.
- Turn it on in Settings, on the Password page. It is recommended for Directors and Executive Directors.
- Once it is on, each new sign-in asks for your password and then the code.

Questions people ask

2026-10-07

- Answers to the questions people ask: what the app is, who can see what, signing in, your information and the law, and finding your way around. Search them, or tap a question to read its answer.
- They are on the front door and the sign-in screen for anybody, before signing in, and in Settings, under Help, once you are in.
- The privacy notice now says plainly that conversations are encrypted on their way and where they are kept, but not end to end.

Who can do what, kept by the church's own rules

2026-10-07

- Only an Executive Director can make somebody a Director or an Executive Director. A Director looks after Guides and Explorers.
- Directors can give an Explorer a different Guide with Change Guide. The Explorer keeps their place on the journey, the new Guide starts a fresh conversation, and nobody else ever reads what the two wrote to each other.

Home is a billboard

2026-10-07

- A post can carry photos and one short video of about a minute. Photos are made smaller and lose where they were taken before they are kept. For anything longer, a YouTube or Facebook link plays inside the post.
- Share on an open post or notice sends its title and a link. Only people in your church can open the link.
- Home opens on the church's announcements and its newest blog posts, as cards you swipe sideways. A post with a picture shows the picture.
- Tap a card to read the whole thing, with its photos and any YouTube or Facebook video in it.
- The church's banner is shorter on a phone, so the cards are on the first screen.
- Whoever pinned a notice, or anybody in leadership, can take it down from the notice itself. Put back up is in the Announcements folder.

Clearer conversations, a simpler Study Room

2026-10-07

- In a conversation your messages are blue and the other person's are white, so you can always tell who said what. The dark looks have a dark version of the same two.
- The box you write a message in now lines up with the paperclip and the send button.
- The Study Room starts Simple: your pages, New page and search, and on a page the writing and a few basics. Tap Advanced for folders, tags, Starred, the Journal and the whiteboard. Nothing you have written is hidden by switching.
- In Focus and Dark Aero the writing on a Study Room page was almost black on black. It is light now.
- An appointment that was called off no longer shows a Join button or counts as coming up, and Clear from my list takes it off your list once you have seen it.

Easier to read, in every look

2026-10-06

- Small grey writing (dates, hints, "Report") is a shade darker, so it reads easily.
- A profile's banner is a deeper green or blue, so the name and the line under it stand out.
- Labels on coloured shapes, such as journey stages and the bars in The numbers, now pick dark or white writing, whichever reads.
- In Focus and Dark Aero, the featured resources, the bell's count, the Music player's buttons and a prayer request from your Guide could be almost invisible. They read clearly now.

Your look, from the first moment

2026-10-06

- On a slow connection the page could show Classic for a moment before the look you chose. Now your look is there from the very first moment.

My Files, simpler on a phone and a pad

2026-10-06

- My Files opens with a short title instead of a big banner, so the first resource is on the first screen.
- The filters are one row of chips with a count on each, and the list says which one you chose.
- On this device puts Upload files and Add a link at the top, with your files right below.
- Deleting one of your files now asks a second time, since nothing can bring it back.

Music PDFs, read on your phone

2026-10-06

- Pieces now opens a PDF that MuseScore, Dorico or a similar program made, and reads it note by note: every part's notes and rhythm, the key, time and tempo, the words, and the loud and soft.
- It then plays, explains itself and can be conducted like any score. Under its title it says it was read from the print, so check it against the page before the choir learns from it.
- A scanned PDF is only a picture, and Pieces says so. Older Sibelius and Finale PDFs are not read yet.
- The reader is downloaded only the first time you open a PDF, and the PDF stays on your phone.

A quicker tuner, and the Music room in every look

2026-10-06

- The tuner moves to a new note in about a tenth of a second, keeps its needle steady while you sing, and holds the last note for a moment when you stop.
- Its scale now shows the in-tune zone as a green band, with a bold line for the exact note, easy to see in the dark looks too.
- In dark looks, the conductor's hand, every part on a score and the play line can all be seen now.
- Drop-down lists, sheets and the chat no longer let the page show through them in the Frutiger Aero looks, so their words never mix with the words behind.
- A score in Pieces now explains itself: its tempo, time and key, where it is loud and soft, how high and low each part goes and its hardest leap, its words, and a sentence on its character, read from the score's own markings.
- Conduct this piece opens the Conductor already set to the score's time and tempo.

Advanced settings in the Music room, and a new Play folder

2026-10-05

- Every Music folder opens as simple as before. Tick Advanced settings at the end of one for more, and untick it to put it back.
- Tuner: watch your voice as a line over the last ten seconds, sing against a held drone note, and see notes as a clarinet, trumpet, saxophone or horn reads them.
- Conductor: clicks between the beats, loud or silent beats, a one-bar count-in, a speed trainer that gets a little faster as you go, and tempos saved by name.
- Pieces: move a score up or down to suit your voices, loop a hard passage, silence your own part to sing it, and choose the sound.
- Play is a new folder: a piano keyboard to play with your fingers, the chords of any key a tap each, and a beat maker with a bass drum, snare and hi-hat.
- As before, it all happens on your phone, and what you save stays there.

Concert pitch you can hear

2026-10-04

- In the Music room's Tuner, every change of concert pitch now plays the new A, and says in plain words what it does to every note.
- The common pitches are one tap away: 415 for baroque music, 432, 440 the standard, and 442 for many orchestras.
- Compare with 440 plays the standard A, then yours, so you can hear the difference.
- Listen for the A: ask the organist or pianist to hold an A, and the app measures it and offers it as your concert pitch. Nothing is recorded.
- The tuner shows the pitch it measures against, and the starting note shows the frequency it will play.

A Music room, for the choir and everyone who loves music

2026-10-04

- Music is a new room for everybody, in your Menu and down the left on a computer.
- Listen: the media player, playlists and calming sounds are here now. Your music stays in My Files too, and each file there still has its own Play button.
- Tuner: sing or play a note and see which note it is and whether it is flat or sharp. There is a starting note for the choir, like a pitch pipe, and you can change concert pitch from A 440 for an older organ.
- Conductor: a steady beat with a picture of the conductor's hand for 2, 3, 4 and 6 beats. Tap the beat to set the tempo, or turn the clicks off and follow the hand in silence.
- Pieces: photograph a page of music and get it back straight and clean, black on white. Or open a MusicXML score file to hear every part, make yours louder, slow it down and start from anywhere.

- Everything in the Music room happens on your phone. The tuner uses the microphone only while it is listening, records nothing and sends nothing.

Five new Frutiger Aero looks

2026-10-04

- Settings, General, Look has a new row, Frutiger Aero. Tap it to see five looks side by side, each with a picture and a line about it.
- Frutiger Eco, Dark Aero, Technozen, DORFic and Four Colors: glass, light and a gentle shine, from fresh and green to deep blue.
- Your rooms and everything in them stay the same. Classic is still one tap away.

A tidier column on computers

2026-10-04

- In the Beacon, Study and Focus looks, the column down the left of a computer now starts with your rooms. Menu, People and My Files stay along the bottom of phones and tablets; on a computer, every room, My Files included, is already in the column.

Smoother on your phone

2026-10-04

- Moving between pages, and opening a conversation, now has less work to do in the moment the screen slides in, so it stutters less.
- Scrolling is lighter in the Beacon, Study and Focus looks.

Write a post straight from Home

2026-10-04

- Home now opens with "Write a post" near the top. One tap, and you are typing the title.
- The writing box is simpler: a title, your post, Publish. It tells you when your post has gone out.
- Advanced settings are still there, under Publish, for choosing who sees a post or saving a draft. You never have to open them.

Your desk colours work in every look

2026-10-04

- The colours on your desk now change Beacon, Study and Focus too, not only Classic. The first one is the look's own colours, so you can always go back.

- Each look keeps its own light or dark. In Focus, Warm Office becomes a warm evening brown, and everything stays as easy to read as before.
- Each look remembers its own colour on this device.
- A few buttons in Settings were hard to read in Focus. They now follow every look.
- On a Mac, the invitation to install no longer covers the Talk button, and it steps aside while a conversation is open.

Safer signing in and out

2026-10-04

- Sign out now ends that sign-in for good, not only on the screen in front of you. Your other devices stay signed in.
- A new invitation's password is three short words and a number, joined by dashes, such as harbor-acorn-river-48. It works for three days, so choose your own when you first sign in.
- If too many sign-ins arrive at once, the app now asks you to wait a few minutes instead of saying your password is wrong.

Three new looks, the same familiar rooms

2026-10-04

- Choose bright Beacon, warm Study or dark Focus in Settings, General, Look. Each fits your phone, tablet and computer.
- Your choice stays on this device. Return to Classic whenever you like; its familiar look stays the same.
- First-time sign-in is no longer interrupted by an automatic refresh.

Write your blog and announcements from Home

2026-10-03

- Home has a Blog folder: the writing box is open as soon as you arrive. A title, your post, Publish.
- Guides and leaders also have an Announcements folder in Home, to pin a notice for everybody.
- Need more? Tick Advanced settings to choose who sees a post, save a draft, or add when an announcement happens.
- There is no Publish room any more. Old links to it open Home's Blog folder.
- Offline, the app now simply says Offline.

Try a text size before you apply it

2026-10-03

- Settings, General, Text size: choosing a size now shows it in the preview first, at exactly that size.
- Press Apply when it reads well, and every screen follows. Leave without pressing it and nothing changes.

Classic is the computer design now

2026-10-03

- On a computer, Classic has your rooms down the left side and a light bar across the top. There is no separate Desktop choice any more: it is Classic.
- Nothing has changed on a phone or tablet.
- At the very end of a page, the desk on the right no longer slides under the top of the screen.

A computer's top bar on a computer

2026-10-03

- On a computer, the top of the screen is now a light bar with your bell, your name and Sign out on the right. The Back arrow and the second logo are gone: the logo is in the sidebar, and your browser has Back.
- The desk on the right no longer slides under the top of the screen as you scroll, in Classic or Desktop.
- The look you chose is on the page from the very first moment it opens.

Computers open in the Desktop look

2026-10-03

- On a computer, your rooms are now down the left side and the bar along the bottom is gone. Phones and tablets have not changed.
- Prefer the look you had before? Settings, General, Look, then Classic. Your choice stays.

Classic, and a Desktop look for computers

2026-10-03

- Settings, General, has a new Look card. The look you know is called Classic, and it stays chosen until you choose otherwise.
- On a computer, choose Desktop: your rooms go down the left side and the bar along the bottom goes away. On a phone or tablet it looks just like Classic.
- Classic itself has not changed, and any looks added later will appear beside it.

A progress report, folders, calendars, and your plans on every device

2026-10-02

- Guides, Directors and Executive Directors have a progress report in the Office, under Reports: for a month or a quarter, how each Explorer is moving along the journey, the Bible studies and lessons, and who needs you this week. Add your own notes, then download it as a Word file.
- Evangelistic meetings now start from the night as many churches run it: children's time from 5:30 PM, health time, Bible study, then snacks. Each night has an end time too.
- Keep Sabbath programs and meetings in folders, and put them on your phone's calendar with Add to calendar, or one night at a time in Google Calendar.
- Your programs and meetings are still saved on your device first, and now also follow you to any phone or computer where you sign in. Only you can see that copy.

Plan evangelistic meetings your own way

2026-10-02

- Guides and Directors have a new Evangelistic meetings folder in the Office. Start with a plan (a night for each day, each with the usual program) or start blank.
- Shape it freely: add blocks to the whole series or to any night, name a list's columns yourself, copy a night to make the next, and choose its colour and heading style.
- Mark anything Team only to keep it off the picture and posts. Download a Word file or a picture, or post a night for the people you walk with or the whole church. Explorers find it on This Sabbath.

Share the Sabbath program, and find it on This Sabbath

2026-10-02

- Guides and Directors can now post a Sabbath program in the app, to the people they walk with or to the whole church. Explorers find it on This Sabbath, in the Menu, and it is still there with no signal once they have opened it.
- Download picture makes a picture of the program for a group chat or a phone's gallery. A free Canva account can design a bulletin from it: in Canva choose Upload and add the picture or the Word file.
- Advanced settings adds minutes and start times, a note for the platform that stays off the congregation's copy, details of your own such as who is on duty, your own templates, and a reminder for each person taking part.

Make the Sabbath program in the Office

2026-10-02

- Guides and Directors have a new Sabbath program folder in the Office. A new program starts with Sabbath School, the Divine Service, the afternoon program and sunset vespers, ready for names.
- Download it as a Word file, which also opens in Google Docs, or copy it as text for a group chat. Reuse next week starts the next one from this one, names and all.
- Your programs are kept on your own phone or computer, not sent anywhere. Download the ones you want to keep or share.

A friendlier chat: reactions, replies and voice messages

2026-10-01

- Tap any message to react with 🙏 or a heart, to reply to that one message, to copy it, or to change or delete your own. You can also hold it, or swipe it to the right to reply.
- With nothing typed, the round button records a voice message: tap to start, then send it or delete it. Up to two minutes. The app only uses your microphone while you are recording.
- Photos open full screen inside the app, the time sits inside each message, and a button takes you back to the newest message when you have scrolled up.
- The tutorial shows you how, and moves along when you have done it.

Smoother, calmer movement

2026-10-01

- Menus, the bell and the account switchers now open out of the button you pressed and fold back into it when you close them, instead of popping in and vanishing.
- Choosing another part of a room fades it in where the last one was, and a person's profile eases open under Profile.
- If your phone, tablet or computer is set to reduce motion, the app now honours it everywhere, including the tutorial's arrow, which used to keep bouncing.

Talk in the bubble, appointments first, and less scrolling

2026-10-01

- Your conversations are in the Talk bubble in the corner of every screen. Message on a person's page opens it straight at them, and Report is at the top of it.
- A Guide's page for an Explorer opens on Appointments, and an Explorer's own screen has their appointments near the top, so arranging a time takes no scrolling.
- Rooms with several parts now open them from one list at the top: tap it to see them all. It says which one you are in and how many there are.
- On a phone or an iPad your desk (your note, the pocket and the player) waits behind a small tab on the right edge. Tap it, or swipe in from that edge, to open it.

- Guides and Directors can see an Explorer's profile and picture: Profile is next to Message, and faces are shown in the lists of people.

Menu, People and My Files, along the bottom

2026-09-30

- On a phone, an iPad or a computer, three buttons along the bottom of the screen now take you everywhere: Menu, People and My Files.
- Menu lists every room you have in words, with your profile at the top and the way out at the bottom. The small pictures under the top bar, and the column down the left side of a computer screen, are gone.
- People opens your own people: your Explorers if you are a Guide, your Guide if you are walking with one.
- My Files opens the files you keep on this device.
- Inside a conversation the buttons step aside to give the messages room. The arrow at the top left takes you back.

Invitation e-mails and live church accounts

2026-08-16

- Directors can now invite a person by e-mail in the role their church chose.
- An invited person sets their own password, then waits for a Director to approve access.
- Directors can suspend an approved account without deleting it, then approve it again when access should return.
- Approved Guides and Explorers enter their own private workspace; only the paired two can read their conversation.
- Sign-in now stays on Hope Beacon’s own secure connection, so browser privacy shields do not mistake a valid password for a failed login.

Simpler names, and updates that just happen

2026-08-12

- Beacon now installs new versions by itself. There is no button to press and nothing to dismiss.
- It waits until you are not in the middle of writing something, so a half-finished message is never lost to an update.
- Missionaries are now called Guides, and Admins are called Support. Anyone being walked with is shown by their name, with no label at all.

Video keeps its original quality

2026-08-03

- Videos saved to Beacon now play in a full-size player with seeking, volume and fullscreen controls.
- Beacon keeps the original file on this device and shows its actual resolution. 4K/60 playback depends on the file format, browser, device and display.
- Beacon checks that a video can play before saving it and explains when a different format is needed.

Clearer, safer feedback

2026-08-03

- Unfinished words stay on your device, so a closed form or failed connection does not erase them.
- Beacon shows a receipt only after your feedback is actually saved. If storage is unavailable, it says so and keeps your words ready to copy or retry.
- Your feedback record does not include your IP address, browser or device details, cookies, or church records.

Church home, a real music player, and updates you can see

2026-07-30

- New Home board. Announcements, milestones and new members all in one place, before your own dashboard.
- Upload your own music and video, search it, and delete what you no longer want. Everything stays on your device.
- This “What’s new” panel, so you can always see what changed.
- The app now checks for updates on its own, without needing to be reinstalled.

The tutorial works properly now

2026-07-30

- It guides you to the right screen instead of saying “not on this screen”.
- You can replay it any time from Settings, and it never changes your demo data.
- Fixed steps that pointed at buttons which were not on screen yet.

Works offline, and tells you when you are

2026-07-29

- Every screen now works with no signal, not only the ones you had already opened.

- A clear Offline and Back online indicator, plus a Connection row in Settings.
- Your saved library files and notes are always available offline.

A real starter library

2026-07-29

- The Bible, Ellen G. White’s writings, the church’s statements of belief and this quarter’s Sabbath School. All free, all from the official publishers.
- Play saved audio and video straight from your library.
- YouTube and Facebook links open in place, only when you tap them.

CHAPTER 35

What is not finished yet

From `docs/HANDBOOK.md`

Stated plainly, because a plan that hides its gaps is worse than no plan.

Item	Status
Whether the latest deploy is live	Unverified from here, and it has been unverified for every push. The sandbox cannot reach the site or the hosting dashboard. Needs a person with a browser: open `/version.json` on a phone and check the date.
The iPhone install fix on real Safari	The missing tag is confirmed in the built page. It has not been tested on a physical iPhone.
A restored backup	The job runs and its failure paths are tested. No restore has ever been performed.
Non-English wording	Eleven translations still use the old words for Explorer and Guide. Whether those names translate at all is a decision per language.
The guided tutorial	**Fixed.** The spotlight really was landing on nothing, on a phone, for the Guide's and the Explorer's walks: the panel reserved its clear space on the wrong side, a placement that left the target off screen still counted as done, and the ring could be drawn past the right edge of a 412px screen. All four walks now finish at 393, 412, 768 and 1280 wide.
The tutorial at 375px	The Executive Director's walk still mis-points at one step, and only at iPhone SE width. Director, Guide and Explorer pass at every size.
Three photographs of deleted people	Three avatars belong to accounts that no longer exist. No rule can reach them, so no user can see them, and no rule can delete them either. They need removing from the Storage dashboard by hand.
Creating a new church without a developer	Possible in the database, not yet possible from a screen.
Bulk invitations	**Built**: pasting a list, and dragging a spreadsheet onto the screen. Suggested pairing after a batch is the part still to do.
The Sabbath program's Word file in Word, Google Docs and Pages	**Built**, and opened here by LibreOffice Writer and two other readers, and held to the order Word's schema gives. It has not been opened in Microsoft Word, Google Docs or Pages, and **Share the picture** has not been tried on a real phone.
Sharing a Sabbath program inside the app	**Built**, as an ordinary post, and walked in the sample church: a Guide posts, the Explorer they walk with reads it on This Sabbath, with the network off too, and an Explorer they do not walk with does not see it. Not yet done from a church's own app with a real sign-in, and This Sabbath's no-signal page for a real account has not been seen.
Evangelistic meetings	**Built**, kept on the device and shared as posts, and walked in the sample church: a Guide shapes a series, posts a night, the Explorer she walks with reads it with the network off, and one she does not walk with does not see it. Not yet done from a church's own app with a real sign-in; neither Word file has been opened in Word, Google Docs or Pages.

Item	Status
The progress report	**Built** for both halves and walked in the sample church as a Guide and as a Director. Not yet seen from a church's own app with a real sign-in, and its Word file has not been opened in Word.
Calendar files	**Built** and held to the standard by a check, and the walk downloads one. Nobody has yet opened one on a real iPhone, Android phone or in Outlook.
Beacon, Study and Focus, and the desk's colours in each	**Built**, and walked in the sample church on a computer and a phone, with every look measured against every colour for readable text. Not yet seen on Safari, an iPhone or the owner's own devices.
Frutiger Aero: five looks in one drop-down	**Built**, and walked in the sample church on a phone and a computer, each look measured for readable text on glass and on its gloss. Not yet seen on Safari, an iPhone or the owner's own devices.
The computer layout	**Built**, Classic's since 3 October 2026, and walked in the sample church at 1280, 1440 and 1920 pixels and on a phone. The live header's top bar has been seen on the owner's own screen; a live sign-in walk does not exist yet, and Safari has not been tried.
Programs on every device	**Built**: the merge rules are tested case by case and the table's rules are written. Two real devices signed in to the same account have not been tried from here, because this sandbox cannot sign in to a church's site.
The Sabbath program in Canva	The way in is Canva's own Upload, on a free account. That Canva's free plan takes the Word file comes from search results quoting Canva's help; nobody has tried it on a real Canva account.
Safari and iOS behaviour	Checked at iPhone sizes in Chromium, which is not WebKit. WebKit itself is covered by `safari.yml`, which runs every suite on a real macOS machine on each push. Nothing in this app has been seen running on a physical iPhone.
A picture on most Guides' profiles	Almost none have set one, so the card meant to show an Explorer a real person falls back to initials. The app asks them; somebody has to follow it up.
Guild boards in use	The room, the report route and the take-down are built and were proved against the live database. Nothing has yet been posted on one by a real member.
The one-tap Safari handoff on a real device	Tested against simulated iPhone browsers. Never run on a physical iPhone.
Publishing a post, from a real sign-in	The rules were proved against the live database as a real Explorer, Guide, Director and Executive Director, including that a draft never reaches anybody else. It has not been done through the app by a person with a password.
"Active" as a count of visits	Not built and deliberately so. Beacon does not record when somebody opens the app, and the screen says what the number does mean instead of implying otherwise.
Reply, reactions and voice on this church's own site	Built and shipped. Switched off here, because this church's database has not had migration `20261001120000`, by the owner's choice; every copy built from the repository has them.
The conversation without its update, on the live site	Held by tests. Never seen running from here, because this sandbox cannot sign in to the live site.

Item	Status
The new conversation on a real iPhone, and with a screen reader	Not tried. Checked in Chromium at phone and computer sizes, with a pretend microphone.
What else other open-source chats do well	A "New messages" line, "Not sent: try again", an offline line and more, each traced to the file it would change, in `docs/CHAT-RESEARCH.md`.
Nine decisions for the owner	Keeping removed files for safeguarding, a daily size cap, HEIC photos, read-only ended pairings, lock-screen previews, a copyright line, the sample church's name, a trademark search on "Sentry", and AI-written code. Listed with reasons in `docs/CHAT-RESEARCH.md`.

Bulk invitations, as built

Inviting twenty-five people one form at a time is not a workflow. The design was three stages so each could ship on its own; the first two are done and the third is not.

Stage	What it does	The rule it must not break
1. Paste a list, built	Paste any number of addresses, choose one role for the batch, see every row parsed in a preview, then send. Each row reports its own result.	Nothing is sent until the Director has seen the preview. Duplicates, malformed addresses and people who are already members are flagged before sending, not after.
2. Drop a file, built	Drag a spreadsheet onto the screen. The app finds the email, name and role columns and shows what it found.	Detection is always shown and always correctable. A mis-read role column would invite twenty-five people as Directors, and that is not a mistake you can take back.
3. Suggested pairing, not built	After a batch of Explorers, propose which Guide takes whom, and show the whole proposal for approval.	The cap of five is respected, and nobody is ever paired silently. A pairing is a relationship between two people, not a row in a table.

> **NOTE**
>
> The one sentence to keep
>
> The app's limit is not servers, it is Guides. Everything about running this well follows from that: recruit a Guide, train them, pair them with up to five people, and watch the number of Explorers waiting for one.

Open Sentry Beacon is free software under the AGPL-3.0-only. This handbook contains no keys, no passwords and no member details, and is safe to share.